MULTIGROUP MEDIATION MODELLING OF EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE, JOB SATISFACTION AND LECTURERS' PERSISTENCE TO PUBLISH IN SCOPUS-INDEXED JOURNALS IN THE UNIVERSITY OF CALABAR, NIGERIA

BY

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(REG. NO.: EDT/M.Ed/20/002)

DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATIONAL FOUNDATIONS,
UNIVERSITY OF CALABAR,
CALABAR, NIGERIA.

NOVEMBER, 2023.

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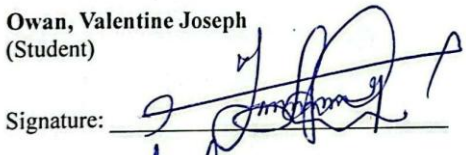
IN PARTIAL FULFILMENT OF THE REQUIREMENTS FOR THE AWARD OF MASTER'S DEGREE IN EDUCATION (M.ED) (RESEARCH, MEASUREMENT AND EVALUATION)

NOVEMBER, 2023.

DECLARATION

I Owan, Valentine Joseph, with registration number EDT/M.Ed./20/002, hereby declare that this thesis on Multigroup Mediation Modelling of Emotional Intelligence, Job Satisfaction and Lecturers' Persistence to Publish in Scopus-Indexed Journals in the University of Calabar, Nigeria, is original, and has been written by me. It is a record of my research work and has not been presented before in any previous publication.

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Date: 14/12/2023

CERTIFICATION

We certify that this thesis entitled Multigroup Mediation Modelling of Emotional Intelligence, Job Satisfaction and Lecturers' Persistence to Publish in Scopus-Indexed Journals in the University of Calabar, Nigeria, By Owan, Valentine Joseph (Reg. No.: EDT/M.Ed./20/002), carried out under our supervision, has been found to have met the regulations of the University of Calabar. We, therefore, recommend the work for the award of Master's Degree in Educational Research, Measurement and Evaluation.

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ABSTRACT

This study assessed the extent to which job satisfaction mediates the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals in the University of Calabar, Nigeria. The study was guided by 12 specific objectives, with their corresponding research questions that were further converted into null hypotheses. The researcher adopted the cross-sectional survey research design for this study. Through a systematic random sampling procedure, 681 participants were selected from a population of 1,253 lecturers in the University of Calabar with at least one document in the Scopus database. Academic Staff Emotional Intelligence Questionnaire (ASEIQ), Lecturers' Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (LJSQ), and the "Persistence to Publish Questionnaire (PPQ) were used for data collection. The instruments were assessed for face and content validity. Exploratory factor analysis provided the dimensionality structure of the three instruments. Cronbach's alpha measure of internal consistency was employed for reliability analysis, with coefficients ranging from .858 to .989 across all the subscales. Primary data were collected for this study through the physical and electronic administrations of the instruments. Although 681 participants were targeted, usable data were gathered from 644 respondents. All the hypotheses of this study were tested at .05 alpha level using Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modelling and Multigroup Analysis (where applicable). Findings revealed, among others, that job satisfaction significantly mediated the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. This mediation effect is observed even though there is no significant direct association between emotional intelligence and job satisfaction, and job satisfaction itself did not directly predict lecturers' persistence to publish to a significant extent. Gender moderated the mediation effect of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. Job satisfaction was more influential in motivating and explaining persistence in female lecturers compared to males. In contrast, education level did not significantly moderate the mediation effect, with emotional intelligence and job satisfaction being equally important for both master's degree and Ph.D. holders. Marital status does not alter the mediation significantly, indicating that emotional intelligence and job satisfaction are equally crucial for both single and married lecturers. It was concluded that emotional intelligence alone does not directly predict lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals; instead, job satisfaction serves as the critical bridge connecting emotional intelligence with the various aspects of lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. It is lecturers with higher emotional intelligence and job satisfaction in key aspects of their work who exhibit the dedication, motivation, and adherence to academic publishing standards that drive their scholarly productivity. It was recommended, among others, that universities should consider implementing emotional intelligence training programs tailored to the specific needs of academic staff. These programmes can help lecturers develop skills in self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, and social skills, which, in turn, may bolster their resilience and commitment to scholarly publishing.

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CHAPTER ONE

INTRODUCTION

1.1. Background to the study

Scopus, an indexing service and bibliographic database provided by Elsevier, is a major academic resource. It is recognised as one of the largest citation databases, encompassing various disciplines, such as: science, technology, medicine, social sciences, education, psychology, and humanities. Researchers can access various scholarly publications in Scopus, like journal articles, book chapters, conference proceedings, and preprints. The platform has numerous features and tools that aid researchers in discovering, analysing, and monitoring scholarly information.

With its extensive coverage of documents from numerous publishers, Scopus offers invaluable functions, such as citation analysis, author profiles, and advanced search options. Researchers and academics frequently rely on Scopus to locate relevant literature, track citations, identify potential collaborators, and evaluate the impact of their work. It is widely adopted within the academic community to conduct bibliometric analyses, assess research productivity and impact, and stay abreast of the latest scholarly publications across various fields.

Given the rigorous assessment process that journals undergo before being considered for inclusion in the Scopus database, many academic institutions globally have considered journals included in the Scopus and Web of Science (Thompson Reuters) databases as mainstream producers of scientific knowledge (Nejadghanbar & Hu, 2022; Owan & Asuquo, 2022; Yeo, Renandya & Tangkiengsirisin, 2022). The longstanding reputation of Scopus has led numerous higher education institutions to attach great importance to publishing in journals indexed in this database. For instance, the University of Calabar have mandated that their lecturers publish a ratio of their articles in Scopus-indexed journals as part of their promotion requirements. This mandate has occasioned a

new challenge for some lecturers, most of whom have suffered the same fate as those who perished for refusing to publish (Owan & Asuquo, 2022), even when they have produced several articles for non-mainstream journals. The value placed on Scopus and Web of Science databases by the academic community is also increasing rapidly owing to modern academic threats, such as: predatory publishing, journal cloning, and hijacking. Thus, journals indexed in Scopus and Web of Science are seen as havens of trustworthy and ethical publishing outlets. Nevertheless, publishing in journals indexed in such prestigious databases can be daunting, complicated, and difficult, especially in an era where papers are rapidly produced in overwhelming numbers.

The rapid production of scientific or scholarly knowledge presents a huge challenge to journal editors and reviewers, who must sieve through several submissions to identify high-quality articles for publication. In addition, the heavy reliance on metrics, such as: journal impact factor, h-index, citescore, citation counts, and altmetrics has ushered in a gaming system where papers of excellent quality are now being rejected because of the editors' perceptions of their probability of making an immediate impact (Owan & Owan, 2021; Wagner, 2011). Today, journals with high rates of rejecting submissions are regarded as "difficult-to-publish", with rejection rates being misconstrued as an indicator of the journal's quality. These and many other contemporary issues have resulted in a high rate of rejection among leading journals; making publication in Scopus-indexed journals a Herculean task. The short narrative above suggests that to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, a considerable amount of time must be allocated, and researchers must be persistent in waiting patiently for the process to complete.

However, the researcher has observed, through interaction with lecturers that some academic staff at the University of Calabar are not persistent when attempting to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. For instance, the researcher has observed that many lecturers bother about publications only when their promotions are around the corner. Owing to the

urgent need for papers to be published, they are impatient, seeking outlets that can publish their works in a few weeks or months. The desire for rapid publication has also made some academics in the University of Calabar susceptible to predatory journals masquerading as Scopus-indexed journals, promising fast publication. Consequently, many lecturers have published works that ultimately led to their professional downfall, especially when these articles are disregarded during promotion evaluations. Due to their lack of persistence and a series of rejections, many lecturers have encountered obstacles to their academic career progression, as they cannot provide evidence of publishing the minimum number of papers required in Scopus-indexed journals at their respective levels. Moreover, because many lecturers tend to favour non-mainstream and predatory journals, their publication metrics, such as: citation counts, h-indices, and i-10 indices, remain low. This further contributes to their limited international recognition, reduced potential for winning grants, and poor university ranking.

Undeniably, publishing in Scopus-indexed journals can be time-consuming, involving various stages, such as: manuscript preparation, submission, initial editorial assessment, peer review, revisions/resubmissions, and final editorial decisions. However, due to a sense of urgency to publish, some academic staff members appear to neglect the submission guidelines provided by journals when preparing their manuscripts. They often submit their papers hastily to any journal they consider to be indexed in Scopus without taking sufficient time to assess the suitability of the journal for their work. Furthermore, many academic staff members in the University of Calabar fail to prioritise writing comprehensive cover letters before submitting their articles to Scopus-indexed journals. As a result, many of these articles are swiftly rejected by the editors without being sent out for peer review.

During the peer review process, it has been observed by the researcher that some lecturers display reluctance to revise their articles in response to important comments from

reviewers that could enhance the quality of their work. Some appear to resist constructive criticism and are unwilling to reconsider aspects of their manuscript where reviewers have provided suggestions for improvement(s). In certain cases, lecturers tend to withdraw their papers from Scopus-indexed journals or abandon the entire publication process when they perceive reviewers' comments as challenging to address. In other instances, some lecturers appear to rush to meet resubmission deadlines without fully addressing all the reviewers' comments and implementing the necessary changes to their manuscripts. Consequently, the articles of these academics are rejected by peer reviewers, or the publication process is delayed or truncated. Consequently, many lecturers tend to display a lack of optimism regarding the publication of their papers in Scopus-indexed journals, especially after facing rejection from another journal. This results in their being unwilling to resubmit their revised manuscripts to alternative journals. Furthermore, some lecturers expressed anguish when resubmitting their rejected works to another journal for fear of another rejection. This fear has led many to question their intellectual capabilities in producing articles of publishable quality for Scopus-indexed journals, resulting in a sense of inferiority complex. Consequently, some lecturers resort to seeking assistance from other scholars within or outside their fields, adopting a ‘put my name’ approach, where they rely on the involvement of established researchers to facilitate the publication process.

However, while some lecturers have experienced setbacks in terms of non-persistence, others have achieved significant success in publishing numerous articles in Scopus-indexed journals. For instance, in the University of Calabar, a research team published more than 50 articles in Scopus-indexed journals in 2022. In 2023, the same team published over 60 research papers in the first five months of the year. Although it has been found that field-related variations give some lecturers an absolute advantage in publishing over others (Krukowski, Jagsi & Cardel, 2021), not all scholars in the same discipline publish at the same pace or rate, giving rise to the following questions: why do

disparities exist in Scopus publication output and publication probability among academic staff in the University of Calabar? Why are some lecturers achieving publication success in Scopus-indexed journals, while others face promotion challenges due to lack of papers in this qualifying database? These and similar questions continuously occupy the researcher's thoughts. Based on this backdrop, the researcher proposed the hypothesis that, in addition to knowledge, skills, and field-specific differences, factors like the emotional intelligence and job contentment of lecturers may have a notable impact, particularly in a three-way connection where job satisfaction serves as a mediator linking emotional intelligence and the persistence of lecturers to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

"Emotional intelligence (EI) is the ability to recognise, understand, and manage one's own emotions and those of others" (Valente, Monteiro & Lourenço, 2019, p. 743). It encompasses "self-awareness, self-regulation, social awareness, and relationship management" (Goleman, 1998, p. 10). The EI of academic staff can influence their job satisfaction and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. For instance, academic staff with higher EI levels may exhibit better self-awareness, emotional regulation, and interpersonal skills (Toprak & Savaş, 2020). These qualities may enable them to handle workplace challenges effectively, manage conflicts, and establish positive relationships with colleagues and students. Thus, academic staff with higher EI may experience better job satisfaction because they can navigate stress, maintain positive emotions, and establish a supportive work environment (Miao, Humphrey & Qian, 2017; Sharp, Bourke & Rickard, 2020). Similarly, lecturers with higher EI may possess greater motivation, resilience, and adaptability (Trigueros, Aguilar-Parra, Cangas, Bermejo, Ferrandiz & López-Liria, 2019), allowing them to overcome obstacles such as handling rejections, criticism, and setbacks in a constructive manner, which enables them to persist in the publication process. Furthermore, lecturers with high EI may possess better self-management skills, enabling them to prioritise tasks, manage time effectively, and

maintain focus on research goals (Sharma & Pillai, 2023). Job satisfaction may act as a mediator between EI and the persistence to publish. When academic staff members have higher levels of EI, they are more likely to experience positive emotions, fulfilment, and job satisfaction (Suleman, Syed, Mahmood & Hussain, 2020). Job satisfaction, in turn, can fuel their intrinsic motivation, job engagement, and commitment to academic productivity. Consequently, individuals who are satisfied with their work may be more likely to persist in publishing research in Scopus-indexed journals as they may find fulfilment in their scholarly endeavours and perceive value in contributing to the scientific community.

This study considered five dimensions of EI: 'self-awareness', 'self-regulation', 'social awareness', 'internal motivation', and 'empathy'. These variables were carefully selected from previous studies (e.g., Goleman, 1998; Fernandez-Perez & Martin-Rojas, 2022; Price, 2021; Zafar & Akhtar, 2023). Self-awareness involves "recognising and comprehending one's triggers, strengths, emotions, values and weaknesses (Goleman, 1995). Self-awareness can be crucial in predicting lecturers' persistence in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals. For example, academic staff members with higher levels of self-awareness may be better equipped to identify their strengths and areas of improvement in research and scholarly work. This self-awareness could allow them to set realistic goals, seek appropriate resources and support, and make necessary adjustments to their research strategies, ultimately enhancing their persistence in pursuing publication opportunities in reputable journals, such as Scopus-indexed ones.

Self-regulation entails effective management and control of emotions, impulses, and behaviours (Goleman, 1998). Self-regulation is another important factor that can predict the persistence of lecturers in Scopus-indexed journals. It has been shown that individuals with strong self-regulation skills can effectively manage their emotions, impulses, and behaviours (Chin & Stanton, 2020; Gagne, Liew & Nwadinobi, 2021). This suggests that self-regulation can enable lecturers to focus on their research goals,

overcome challenges and setbacks, and remain motivated and disciplined throughout the publishing process. Their capacity to regulate their actions and emotions can contribute to their persistence in pursuing publication opportunities and meeting the rigorous standards required by Scopus-indexed journals.

Social awareness encompasses perceiving, understanding, and empathising with the emotions and perspectives of others (Mayer & Salovey, 1997). Social awareness can be a key predictor of lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. For instance, lecturers with high social awareness can be more adept at recognising emerging research trends, identifying potential collaborators, and establishing valuable networks within their scholarly communities. This awareness can allow them to access relevant resources, receive feedback and support, and engage in fruitful collaborations, ultimately enhancing their persistence in pursuing publication opportunities in reputable journals such as Scopus-indexed ones.

Internal or intrinsic motivation refers to an individual's innate desire and drive to engage in a particular activity or pursue a goal. It is characterised by genuine interest, enjoyment, and satisfaction derived from the activity itself, rather than relying on external rewards or pressures. Internal motivation arises from an individual's inherent needs for autonomy, competence, and relatedness and is associated with increased persistence, creativity, and overall well-being in pursuing goals. Internal motivation may be associated with lecturers' persistence in publish in Scopus-indexed journals. For instance, lecturers with strong internal motivation can be fuelled by their genuine passion for research and their intrinsic satisfaction from scholarly pursuits. This internal drive could push them to consistently pursue publication opportunities, overcome obstacles, and maintain a steadfast commitment to produce high-quality research that meets the rigorous standards of Scopus-indexed journals. Thus, their internal motivation can be a constant source of

inspiration, propelling their persistence and unwavering dedication toward advancing knowledge through publication.

Empathy refers to the capacity to comprehend and share the emotions, perspectives, and experiences of others. It involves the capacity to put oneself in someone else's shoe, imagine and comprehend their emotions and thoughts, and respond with care, compassion, and understanding (Morris, 2019). Empathy is crucial for fostering effective communication, resolving conflicts, and promoting empathy-driven actions that contribute to positive social interactions and a more compassionate society (Shepherd, Seyb & Williams, 2023). Empathy is believed to influence lecturers' persistence in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals. Empathetic researchers may demonstrate a better understanding of the needs and interests of their target audience, enabling them to craft research that resonates with readers and addresses relevant concerns. Furthermore, their empathetic perspective on the challenges others face in the field might contribute to their determination to overcome setbacks, seek diverse perspectives, and commit to producing impactful research. While the relationship between empathy and persistence in publishing is a subject of interest, further research is needed to establish a conclusive link in the context of Scopus-indexed journals.

Therefore, understanding the link between each dimension of EI, job satisfaction, and the persistence in publishing can be useful for academic institutions and policymakers. As stated earlier, some scholars at the University of Calabar have enjoyed publication success. However, others have faced rejections, with some appearing to have given up their hopes of publishing in Scopus-indexed journals. It is arguable and a common knowledge that lecturers in the same field, rank, marital status, educational qualification, or other demographic characteristics do not persist in publishing equally. Therefore, it is important to understand how the persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals varies with the demographic characteristics of lecturers. In line with this background, this study

was undertaken to model how job satisfaction acts as a mediator in the relationship between emotional intelligence and the persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals and moderating the association using the demographic characteristics of lecturers in the University of Calabar, Nigeria.

1.2. Statement of the problem

Publishing in Scopus-indexed journals requires scholars to do their best to ensure that research works are communicated in the appropriate venues. Ideally, lecturers should diligently prepare their manuscripts by formatting them according to journal templates and reading through targeted journals' guidelines and other relevant instructions before submitting them for consideration. Furthermore, lecturers are expected to wait patiently for the peer review process to complete and be willing to attend to all reviewers' comments in revising their articles for further consideration.

However, the researcher has observed that many lecturers in the University of Calabar do not seem to maintain the right attitude or follow acceptable practices in the publication process. For instance, some lecturers believe that the formatting requirements of most Scopus journals are time-consuming or too complex to follow and are unwilling to devote adequate time to the process. Some lecturers wait until promotion is around the corner before hastily submitting their works, imposing additional pressure on themselves to publish in Scopus-indexed journals as quickly as possible. As a result, when there is any form of delay in the editorial or peer-review process, it breaks their heart. It has been observed that some lecturers become uncooperative and confrontational when communicating with the editor at the slightest delay in the publication schedule. What follows is a rejection due to their unwillingness to wait for the usually long process to complete. Furthermore, some lecturers tend to give up too easily once their article is rejected by an editor, failing to recognise that a paper rejected somewhere can be accepted

elsewhere. As a result, some tend to withdraw their papers and avoid resubmitting them to other Scopus journals without or after revisions.

More surprisingly, there have been several instances where the researcher has observed lecturers submitting their rejected papers by Scopus journals to non-mainstream or predatory journals for fast publication. The need for fast publication has also pushed some academics in the university to become victims of clone journals, disguising to be indexed in Scopus and promising fast publications. Consequently, many lecturers have published and perished in cases where their articles were sieved out during promotion appraisals. Due to the lack of persistence, culminating in a series of rejections, some lecturers in the university have hindered their academic career progress. This is so because they cannot tender evidence of having published the minimum number of papers required at their levels in Scopus-indexed journals. Moreover, because many lecturers in the University of Calabar seem to patronise non-mainstream and predatory journals heavily, their publication metrics (such as citation counts, h- and i-10 indices) are low. This has further contributed to their seeming poor international reputation, reduced grant-winning potentials and the poor ranking of their universities.

To enhance lecturers' persistence in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals, the University of Calabar have implemented proactive measures. For instance, the university, as part of its promotion requirements, has mandated that lecturers publish a specified number of journal articles in Scopus-indexed journals, with the weightage determined by rank dynamics. This initiative was undertaken with the expectation of improving the reputation of scholars and enhancing the institution's image and position in global and national rankings. However, this measure does not seem to have fully addressed the issue of non-persistence among lecturers, particularly, as many academics perceive it as a political agenda to hinder them from advancing in their academic careers. As a result, some lecturers heavily rely on the "put my name" approach to secure publications in Scopus-

indexed journals. In doing so, some scholars have been observed disregarding their research areas and seeking assistance from well-established researchers in unrelated fields, often without meeting the criteria for authorship solely to fulfil promotion requirements. While interdisciplinary research collaboration is highly encouraged in tackling complex issues that transcends a single discipline, it is inappropriate for people for to leave their fields entirely to meet promotion criteria.

This practice has several implications for fostering a quality research culture among lecturers. Firstly, it suggests that many lecturers are unwilling to enhance their research capacities by conducting independent research and disseminating their findings in prestigious outlets. Secondly, it implies that most lecturers are unprepared and unable to contribute to developing the next generation of researchers to advance knowledge in universities. To address this issue, the University of Calabar, have further adjusted their promotion criteria by stipulating that lecturers maintain a certain proportion of lead authorship in their overall publications in Scopus-indexed journals. To enable lecturers to rise to the challenge, it is crucial to understand the factors that contribute to their non-persistence in publishing, particularly as universities continue to tighten their promotion requirements related to Scopus publications. Sadly, no previous study has examined these factors, limiting knowledge regarding the barriers and motivations that influence lecturers' non-persistence in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals. This research gap hampers our understanding of lecturers' specific challenges and the factors that impede their efforts to publish in prestigious journals, such as those indexed in Scopus. To address this knowledge gap, further research is needed to identify the factors contributing to lecturers' non-persistence in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals. Along these lines, this study was conceived to understand the link between EI and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals and job satisfaction's role in the nexus.

1.3. Purpose of the study

The main purpose of this study was to determine the extent to which job satisfaction mediates the relationship between EI and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals in the University of Calabar, Nigeria. Specifically, the study sought to:

1. determine the extent to which job satisfaction variables jointly and partially mediate the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, in terms of manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays;
2. investigate the joint and partial mediation of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals;
3. examine how job satisfaction variables jointly and partially mediates the connection between social awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals;
4. estimate the effect of job satisfaction variables in jointly and partially mediating the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals;
5. find the extent to which job satisfaction variables jointly and partially serve as mediators in the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals;
6. estimate the composite second-order mediation effect of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals;

7. verify whether the extent to which job satisfaction variables jointly and partially mediates the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, vary with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status;
8. cross-examine whether the joint and partial mediation of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, vary with their sex, education level and marital status;
9. re-examine the role of job satisfaction variables in jointly and partially mediating the relationship between social awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, based on lecturers' sex, education level and marital status;
10. find out whether the effect of job satisfaction variables in jointly and partially mediating the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, vary with their sex, education level and marital status;
11. assess whether the role of job satisfaction variables in partially and jointly mediating the relationship between empathy and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, vary with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status;
12. Evaluate whether the composite second-order mediation effect of job satisfaction in the nexus between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, vary with their sex, education level and marital status.

1.4. Research questions

The following research questions were posed to guide the study:

1. To what extent do job satisfaction variables jointly and partially mediate the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, in terms of manuscript preparation, manuscripts submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays?

2. What is the joint and partial effect of job satisfaction variables in mediating the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals?
3. In what ways do job satisfaction variables jointly and partially mediate the connection between social awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals?
4. How much do job satisfaction variables jointly and partially mediate the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals?
5. What is the extent to which job satisfaction variables jointly and partially mediate the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals?
6. What is the extent of the composite second-order mediation effect of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals?
7. To what extent does the joint and partial mediation of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, vary with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status?
8. How does the joint and partial effect of job satisfaction variables in mediating the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, vary with their sex, education level and marital status?
9. In what ways does the joint and partial mediation of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between social awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, vary with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status?

10. To what extent does the joint and partial mediation of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between internal motivation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, vary with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status?
11. How does the joint and partial mediation of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between empathy and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, vary with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status?
12. What is the extent to which the composite second-order mediation effect of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, vary with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status?

1.5. Statement of hypotheses

The study tested the following null hypotheses:

1. Job satisfaction variables have no significant joint and partial mediation effects on the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, in terms of manuscript preparation, manuscripts submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays.
2. There is no significant joint and partial effects of job satisfaction variables in mediating the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.
3. Job satisfaction variables have no significant joint and partial mediation effects in the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.
4. There is no significant joint and partial mediation of job variables in the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

5. There is no significant joint and partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.
6. There is no significant composite second-order mediation effect of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.
7. There is no significant variation in the extent to which job satisfaction variables jointly and partially mediate the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, based on lecturers' sex, education level and marital status.
8. There is no significant variation in the joint and partial mediation of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, based on their sex, education level and marital status.
9. The joint and partial mediation of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between social awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, does not vary significantly with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status.
10. The effect of job satisfaction variables in jointly and partially mediating the relationship between internal motivation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, does not vary significantly with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status.
11. The role of job satisfaction variables in jointly and partially mediating the relationship between empathy and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, does not significantly vary with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status.

12. The composite second-order mediation effect of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, does not significantly vary with their sex, education level and marital status.

1.6. Significance of the study

This study is anticipated to be useful to universities, lecturers, publishers, journal editors, postgraduate students, the National University Commission, the government, society and researchers. The findings of this study can provide universities with a better understanding of the factors that contribute to lecturers' persistence in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals. This understanding can inform the development of targeted support programmes, training initiatives, and resources aimed at enhancing research productivity among lecturers. Universities can utilise this study's findings to identify areas where improvements can be made in providing better work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support, which can ultimately attract and retain talented researchers. Furthermore, the study can assist universities in evaluating and refining their promotion criteria, ensuring that they align with the desired goals of increasing publication output and enhancing the institution's reputation. The researcher will make sure that different universities get to see the findings of this study by presenting the findings in conferences, seminars and making blog and social media posts to promote the work.

The researcher will publish the findings of different aspects of this work in different online journals making it accessible to any lecturer with an Internet connection. Therefore, lecturers stand to benefit significantly from the study's findings. Understanding the relationship between emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and persistence to publish can help lecturers gain insights into their behaviours, attitudes, and motivations. They can become aware of the factors influencing their research productivity and publication

success, enabling them to make informed decisions and take appropriate actions. For example, lecturers can identify areas for improvement in enhancing their emotional intelligence skills, managing job-related stress, seeking support and resources, and finding strategies to deal with setbacks in the publication process. The study's findings can empower lecturers to develop effective coping mechanisms, improve their time management skills, and seek appropriate mentorship and collaboration opportunities, ultimately enhancing their persistence and success in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals. The study's focus on the Scopus database, can serve as a useful resource to enable lecturers avoid predatory journal publishers. By publishing in Scopus-indexed journals, lecturers can enhance their research reputation and credibility, ensure quality assurance, increase research visibility and impact, advance their careers, and access networking and collaboration opportunities.

This study can provide meaningful information to publishers regarding the factors that influence lecturers' persistence in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals. Publishers can better understand lecturers' challenges throughout the publication, such as manuscript preparation, submission, revisions, rejections, and publication delays. This knowledge can help publishers tailor their guidelines, policies, and processes to meet authors' needs better, streamline the publication workflow, and improve the overall publishing experience. Publishers can also leverage the study's findings to develop targeted resources, workshops, or support mechanisms that assist authors, especially lecturers, in navigating the publication journey in Scopus-indexed journals. Publishers can easily find this work because different reports from this thesis will be published across various electronic journals with a high visibility.

Journal editors play a crucial role in the publication process, including manuscript evaluation, peer review coordination, and publication decision-making. The finding of this study can provide significant perspectives to journal editors about the factors that influence

lecturers' persistence in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals. Editors, especially those of Scopus-indexed journals, can better understand authors' challenges and tailor their editorial processes and policies to address these challenges effectively. This study can also highlight areas where editors can provide additional guidance, support, or resources to authors during the manuscript preparation, review, and revision stages. Moreover, editors can utilise the results of this study to promote a positive and supportive publishing environment, improve communication with authors, and enhance the overall publication experience within their respective journals. Furthermore, editors of non-mainstream journals can learn from this study to promote quality culture to enable their journals to gain access to Scopus indexation for wider visibility.

The researcher plans on organising at least two workshops session to postgraduate students where the findings of this study will be presented. Therefore, postgraduate students can benefit from this study in various ways. By understanding the role of emotional intelligence and job satisfaction in publication, they can proactively develop these skills during their research journey. The findings can guide postgraduate students in selecting appropriate supervisors who can provide support and create conducive work environments. The study can also help them set realistic expectations about the challenges in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals, such as: manuscript preparation, dealing with revisions and rejections, and handling publication delays. With this knowledge, postgraduate students can better navigate the publication process, make informed decisions, and develop effective strategies to enhance their success.

The findings of this study can inform the National University Commission and government policymakers about the factors influencing lecturers' persistence in publishing. This information can guide the development of policies, initiatives, and funding schemes to promote research productivity and publication success in Nigerian universities. For example, the study can highlight the importance of providing adequate

research support, improving work conditions, and offering career advancement opportunities to lecturers. The findings can also inform the review and refinement of promotion criteria, ensuring they align with international standards and encourage high-quality research output. Ultimately, the study can strengthen the research culture, foster innovation, and position Nigerian universities as knowledge generation and dissemination hubs.

The study can be relevant to society in general. By enhancing lecturers' research productivity and publication success, the study can contribute to generating and disseminating knowledge. This knowledge can positively address societal challenges, drive innovation, and foster socioeconomic development(s). Society can benefit from the outcomes of the research conducted by lecturers and the potential applications of their findings in various fields, such as healthcare, technology, agriculture, and social sciences. Thus, this study's findings can contribute to advancements in these areas, leading to improved practices, policies, and solutions that benefit society.

This study can be valuable for researchers as it can serve as a reference and foundation for further research in the areas such as: emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and academic publication. Researchers can build upon this study to delve deeper into specific aspects of emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and their impact on persistence in publishing. They can explore additional factors that may influence the relationship, investigate different contexts or populations, and employ various research methodologies to expand their understanding of the topic. The study can also inspire researchers to investigate interventions, programs, and strategies that can enhance emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and research productivity among academics. By building a robust body of knowledge in this area, researchers can contribute to developing evidence-based practices and recommendations for improving publication outcomes and fostering a culture of quality research.

1.7. Assumptions of the study

The following are the underlying assumptions of this study:

1. This study's variables (such as emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and persistence to publish) are measurable.
2. There is a normal distribution of the variables in the population.
3. The sample of this study is represents the population.
4. The cost of publication is not a determining factor in lecturers' persistence to publish.
5. The sample of this study is unbiased.
6. Self-report measures such as a questionnaire can assess emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and persistence to publish.
7. The respondents are familiar with the selected variables of this study.
8. The information derived from respondents represents their honest opinions.

1.8. Scope of the study

This study investigated how job satisfaction mediates the relationship between EI and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals in the University of Calabar, Nigeria. Geographically, the study covered only the University of Calabar. The researcher did not consider other universities in the state since, from available evidence, only the University of Calabar have integrated Scopus-indexed journals in its promotion assessment criteria.

The study was delimited to three central variables – an exogenous variable (emotional intelligence), a mediator (job satisfaction), with an endogenous variable (persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals). The exogenous variable (emotional intelligence) comprised five sub-variables: self-awareness, self-regulation, social awareness, internal motivation, and empathy. The mediating variable (job satisfaction) comprised five dimensions: satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload

allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support. Similarly, the endogenous variable (persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals) was operationalised into five dimensions: persistence in manuscript preparation, submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays. Three demographic variables, such as sex, education level and marital status, were introduced to moderate all the relationships among the exogenous, mediating, and endogenous variables for a deeper understanding.

Regarding population, only lecturers in the University of Calabar were considered, ranging from assistant lecturer to Professor. To be eligible for this study, a participant must be at least an assistant lecturer in the University of Calabar, with at least one publication in Scopus-indexed journals. Therefore, lecturers not fulfilling all the inclusion criteria were excluded from the study. As an example, a lecturer without publication in a Scopus-indexed journal was not eligible to participate in this study, regardless of their rank or other social status. Similarly, lecturers in other universities were excluded and ineligible to participate in this study regardless of their rank or number of publications in Scopus-indexed journals.

Methodologically, this study followed the quantitative research method because it is the most suitable approach for testing hypotheses and examining the relationships between variables systematically and statistically. The quantitative research method allowed the researcher to collect and analyse numerical data to draw objective and generalisable conclusions. In this study, data was collected through a survey composed of three questionnaires administered to lecturers, focusing on their emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. Data were collected using both physical and electronic administration of the survey. The electronic survey was designed using Google Forms because it is free, user-friendly, and easily accessible.

The gathered data underwent analysis through descriptive statistics, including frequency counts, mean, and standard deviation. This study did not directly address the research questions, as they were transformed into hypotheses. Nevertheless, all hypotheses underwent testing at a significance level of 0.05 using "Multigroup Analysis (MGA)" within the framework of "Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modeling (PLS-SEM)." The “PLS-SEM” approach was chosen over the “Covariance-Based Structural Equation Modelling (CB-SEM)” because the former is more robust in estimating model parameters, even with small sample sizes, reducing the risk of parameter estimation issues (Rigdon, Sarstedt & Ringle, 2017). Secondly, PLS-SEM does not require the assumption of multivariate normality and is suitable for analysing data that may violate normality assumptions, such as: skewed or non-parametric data (Civelek, 2018; Owan, Emanghe, Denwigwe, Etudor-Eyo, Usoro, Ebuara, Effiong, Ogar & Bassey, 2022). Moreover, PLS-SEM is well-suited for complex models with higher-order constructs or reflective-formative measurement models and is advantageous for exploratory research and theory development (Basco, Hair, Ringle, & Sarstedt, 2022; Nitzl, 2016; Hair, Hollingsworth, Randolph & Chong, 2017).

1.9. Limitations of the study

Several constraints exist in this study that should be considered when interpreting the results and drawing general conclusions. Firstly, the research adopted a cross-sectional survey design, which inherently restrains the ability to establish causal relationships among the variables studied. To address this limitation, future studies could utilise longitudinal or experimental designs, enabling a more thorough exploration of the cause-and-effect connections among emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and the persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

Secondly, the data were collected solely from a single university in Nigeria, the University of Calabar, which may limit the generalizability of the findings to other institutions or academic contexts. Expanding the study to include multiple universities across Nigeria or other countries could provide a more wholistic understanding of the factors that influence research productivity among academics, accounting for potential contextual variations.

Thirdly, the reliance on self-report questionnaires in this study introduces potential limitations related to the accuracy and honesty of participants' responses. While the study attempted to minimize social desirability bias, participants may not always provide completely candid responses or may not have a full awareness of their emotional intelligence or job satisfaction levels. Respondents may have been inclined to provide socially desirable responses or may not have accurately represented their feelings and behaviours. These limitations could be addressed by future studies by employing mixed methods approaches, combining surveys with qualitative interviews or observations to triangulate data and provide a more comprehensive understanding of the factors at play.

Despite these limitations, this study provides a foundational understanding of the interplay between emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and persistence to publish. By addressing these limitations in future research, we can further refine our understanding of the dynamics at play and offer more targeted recommendations to enhance research productivity in the academic realm.

1.10. Definition of terms

The following terms, which will feature prominently in this study, are defined to ease understanding.

Covariance-Based Structural Equation Modeling (CB-SEM): CB-SEM is a statistical method used to analyse the relationships among observed and latent variables. It involves

estimating the covariance structure of a set of variables to test and validate complex theoretical models.

Indexing: Indexing refers to the process of including journals, articles, or other scholarly works in a database or index. It helps categorise and organise publications based on subject, relevance, and quality, making them easily searchable and accessible.

Journal: A journal is a periodical publication that publishes scholarly articles on specific subjects. Journals serve as a platform for researchers to share their findings, theories, and analyses with the academic community. They often undergo a peer-review process to ensure the quality and validity of the published work.

Lecturer: A lecturer is an academic position in higher education institutions. Lecturers deliver lectures and conduct educational activities, primarily in universities and colleges. They often hold expertise in specific subject areas and play a crucial role in teaching, research, and mentorship of students.

Mainstream journals: Mainstream journals refer to established and widely recognised academic journals in a particular field. These journals typically have a rigorous peer-review process, high editorial standards, and a broad readership within the academic community. They are considered reputable and influential in their respective disciplines.

Mediation: Mediation refers to the process through which a third variable (mediator) explains or accounts for the relationship between two other variables. It helps to understand the underlying mechanisms or processes by which one variable influences another.

Modelling: Modelling involves creating a representation or conceptual framework that describes the relationships and interactions between variables or phenomena. In research,

modelling helps to test hypotheses, analyse data, and make predictions about the behaviour or outcomes of a system.

Moderator: In statistical analysis, a moderator is a variable that affects the relationship between two other variables. It influences the strength or direction of the relationship, indicating that the relationship may vary depending on different levels or conditions of the moderator variable.

Multigroup analysis (MGA): Multigroup analysis is a statistical technique used to compare and analyse data from multiple groups or subgroups. It examines whether the relationships or parameters of a model differ significantly across different groups, providing insights into group differences and potential moderating effects.

Multigroup mediation modelling (MMM): MMM is an extension of mediation analysis that investigates whether the mediating effect of a variable differed across different groups. It explores whether the mediating process operates differently in distinct subgroups or contexts.

Non-mainstream journals: Non-mainstream journals refer to journals not widely recognised or established within a particular field. These journals may have lower editorial standards, limited readership, and a higher risk of publishing low-quality research.

Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modelling (PLS-SEM): PLS-SEM is a statistical approach for analysing structural equation models. It is particularly useful for complex models with small sample sizes and non-normal data.

Predatory journals: Predatory journals are unethical and low-quality publications that exploit the academic publishing system for financial gain. They often have poor peer-review processes, lack editorial standards, and charge exorbitant publication fees.

Structural equation modelling (SEM): Structural equation modelling is a statistical technique used to analyse complex relationships between observed and latent variables. It allows researchers to simultaneously test and estimate the relationships among multiple variables, incorporating measurement error and specifying direct and indirect effects within a comprehensive model.

CHAPTER TWO

LITERATURE REVIEW

This chapter discusses the main concepts underlying this study. The chapter also reviews relevant theories and empirical studies related to this study. The chapter is organised under the following sub-headings:

2.1. Conceptual framework

2.2. Theoretical background

2.3. Empirical review

2.3.1. Self-awareness, job satisfaction and persistence to publish

2.3.2. Self-regulation, job satisfaction and persistence to publish

2.3.3. Social awareness, job satisfaction and persistence to publish

2.3.4. Internal motivation, job satisfaction and persistence to publish

2.3.5. Empathy, job satisfaction and persistence to publish

2.3.6. Emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and persistence to publish

2.3.7. Studies on the moderating role of demographic variables

2.4. Appraisal of literature reviewed

2.1. Conceptual framework

This chapter clarifies three important concepts: emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and persistence to publish. A detailed conceptual overview and relevant framework were developed and presented across various sub-sections.

2.1.1. Concept of emotional intelligence

The concept of “emotional intelligence” (EI) has a long history. The phrase is indirectly traceable to the work of Charles Darwin in 1872 on expressing emotions in humans and animals, where the universality of emotional expressions and their significance in social interactions was explored (Darwin, 1872). In the early stages of

studying emotional intelligence, Thorndike (1920) introduced a novel perspective called "social intelligence," which expanded the understanding of intelligence beyond traditional cognitive abilities. Thorndike defined social intelligence as "the ability to understand and manage men and women, boys and girls, to act wisely in human relations" (p. 228).

Salovey and Mayer formally introduced the concept of EI in 1990, where it was defined as "the ability to monitor one's own and other's feelings and emotions, to discriminate among them, and to use this information to guide one's thinking and actions" (Salovey & Mayer, 1990; p.189). They expanded on the concept, highlighting its relevance to various domains, including decision-making, problem-solving, and interpersonal relationships. Subsequently, Salovey and Mayer proposed a more simplified definition of EI, as "the ability to perceive and understand emotions, allowing for better cognitive processes and the capacity to regulate emotions to foster personal growth" (Mayer & Salovey, 1997).

Another prominent researcher in the field of emotional intelligence is Reuven Bar-On (Bar-On, 1997), who coined the term "emotional quotient." According to Bar-On, "EI encompasses noncognitive capabilities, competencies, and skills that influence an individual's ability to cope effectively with environmental demands and pressures." Bar-On holds a slightly different perspective on EI, viewing it as understanding oneself and others, establishing meaningful connections with people, and adapting and coping with the immediate surroundings to enhance success in managing environmental demands (Bar-On, 2004). When an individual can assess their level of EI within their personality, they can execute their duties in a superior manner compared to others, as they not only rely on intellectual abilities but also tap into the emotional aspects required by the job (John & Niyogi, 2019).

However, Daniel Goleman brought the concept of EI to the mainstream in his book "Emotional Intelligence: Why It Can Matter More Than IQ" (Goleman, 1995). Goleman

popularised the idea and presented extensive research on how EI influences success in personal and professional life. Goleman defines EI as a collection of skills and attributes that empower individuals to identify, comprehend, and regulate their own emotions, while also adeptly navigating and influencing the emotions of others. To Goleman, EI includes five aspects, such as: (1) self-awareness – "The ability to recognise and understand one's own emotions, strengths, weaknesses, and values"; (2) self-regulation – "the capacity to manage and regulate one's own emotions, impulses, and reactions, allowing for thoughtful and appropriate responses"; (3) motivation – "the drive and passion for achieving personal and professional goals, as well as the ability to persevere in the face of challenges and setbacks"; (4) empathy – "the skill to understand and share the feelings and perspectives of others, demonstrating compassion and the ability to connect emotionally"; (5) social skills – "the proficiency in building and maintaining positive relationships, effective communication, conflict resolution, and collaboration."

Since gaining popularity in psychology literature, EI has been defined variedly by the authors who have attempted it across different times, places and contexts. For example, Fteiha and Awwad (2020) defined it as an individual's ability to control, manage and regulate negative emotions like anger, low self-esteem, and anxiety and instead cultivate positive emotions such as confidence, empathy, and friendship. Similarly, it has been viewed as an individual's capacity to recognise, manage and assess emotions (Moreno-Fernandez, Ochoa, Lopez-Aliaga, Alferez, Gomez-Guzman, Lopez-Ortega & Diaz-Castro, 2020). Some scholars have also defined EI as a collection of interconnected skills individuals possess, enabling them to effectively navigate and manage their emotions (Rodrigues, Jorge, Pires & António, 2019). From the foregoing, EI can be characterised as the convergence of emotions and intelligence, which plays a crucial role in comprehending both the emotions of others and one's feelings.

EI involves the adept processing of emotional information about oneself and others, serving as a guide for thoughtful thinking and behaviour (Mayer, Salovey & Caruso, 2008). Mayer, Caruso and Salovey (2016) presented four key aspects of EI that individuals must demonstrate. They are: accurate emotional perception, utilising emotions to enhance cognitive processes, comprehending the nature of emotions and their significance and effectively managing emotions internally and concerning others. According to Zeidner (2017), EI can be divided into two types – EI as a cognitive ability measured using performance tests and trait EI measured using self-assessment reports. However, a literature review by Kanesan and Fauzan (2019) shows three EI models: ability, trait and mixed.

Ability models of emotional intelligence (EI) emphasise the belief that individuals possess specific abilities to manage emotions to achieve specific goals effectively. The ability model views EI as a cognitive ability or intelligence involving accurate perception, understanding, and regulation of emotions. It emphasises the capacity to process and use emotional information effectively to navigate social and emotional situations. This model parallels other cognitive abilities like problem-solving and reasoning and posits that EI can be measured through objective assessments. These ability models focus on the practical skills and competencies necessary for effectively navigating and utilising emotions in various contexts, emphasising the importance of emotional self-awareness and understanding and navigating emotional experiences. Scholars in this school of thought mostly utilise the four-branch model proposed by Mayer et al. (2008). These include (1) emotional management – “The ability to regulate and manage one's own emotions in order to respond appropriately to different situations”; (2) emotional Understanding – “the capacity to comprehend emotions, emotional language, and the messages conveyed by emotions”; (3) emotional facilitation of thinking – “the skill to utilise emotions to enhance cognitive processes such as problem-solving, decision-making, and creativity”; (4)

emotional perception – “the aptitude to accurately perceive and recognise emotions, both in oneself and in others.”

Trait emotional intelligence (EI) pertains to a set of behavioural inclinations and self-perceptions associated with an individual's ability to identify, process, and proficiently utilise information infused with emotions (Petrides & Furnham, 2003). The trait model focuses on EI as a set of stable, enduring personality traits or dispositions that influence how individuals perceive, manage, and express their emotions. According to this model, EI is considered a personality trait that varies across individuals and remains relatively consistent over time. The trait emotional intelligence (EI) model incorporates numerous personality traits and socio-emotional abilities. This amalgamation forms the basis of the model, which is trait EI. Trait EI encompasses an individual's disposition towards understanding and managing emotions in various situations, such as anger, disgust, fear, happiness, sadness and surprise. Other variables of trait EI include adaptability; emotion expression, perception, management, regulation; empathy, impulsiveness, optimism, relationship skills, self-esteem and motivation; social competence and stress management (Petrides & Furnham, 2003).

The mixed model integrates elements of both trait and ability perspectives. It acknowledges the importance of enduring traits and cognitive abilities in emotional intelligence. Mixed models encompass a wide range of noncognitive capabilities, competencies, and skills that collectively influence an individual's capacity to adeptly manage and navigate environmental demands and pressures (Bar-On, 1997). This model recognises that individuals may possess certain emotional traits but also emphasises the role of developing emotional competencies and skills through learning and training interventions. Within this framework, in addition to emotion-related traits like emotional empathy and self-awareness, other attributes such as assertiveness, self-regard, reality testing and self-actualisation were incorporated (Mayer et al., 2008). Including both related

and unrelated attributes in these models led to their classification as mixed models of EI (Mayer, Salovey & Caruso, 2000).

The measurement of emotional intelligence (EI) is a topic of ongoing debate. Due to the disparity in the view of EI by different scholars, the concept has been measured differently over the years. For instance, researchers following the ability model tend to measure EI using performance-based tests or assessments that evaluate an individual's cognitive abilities related to emotional processing. These tests often require individuals to accurately perceive, understand, and manage emotions in themselves and others. On the other hand, the trait model involves gathering dispositional information through self- or peer-report measures such as questionnaires or inventories that assess an individual's emotional traits and dispositions. These instruments ask individuals to rate themselves or others on various dimensions of EI, such as self-awareness, self-regulation, empathy, and social skills. The mixed model of EI combines elements of both the trait and ability perspectives and utilises a range of measures. In addition to self-report questionnaires and performance-based tests, the mixed model may also include measures that assess emotional competencies and skills developed through training and interventions. These measures focus on assessing an individual's ability to apply emotional knowledge and regulate emotions effectively in real-world contexts. Several instruments and data collection tools have been developed to measure EI using one of the three popular models.

Even though several instruments have been developed to measure EI, using different theoretical underpinnings, only a few of these have been developed specifically with teachers in mind, such as “the Nine Layer Pyramid Model Questionnaire of Emotional Intelligence” (Drigas & Papoutsi, 2021) and “the emotional competence assessment questionnaire” (Bartroli et al., 2022) which were developed for high school teachers. However, there is a lack of specific instruments available to measure the emotional intelligence of higher education instructors, including university lecturers. There appear to

be limited or no tools specifically designed for assessing emotional intelligence in this population. Developing an instrument to measure the emotional intelligence of higher education instructors, such as university lecturers, is important for several reasons. Firstly, emotional intelligence is crucial in teaching and learning environments (Sekreter, 2019; Valente, Veiga-Branco, Rebelo, Lourenço & Cristóvão, 2020). Instructors with high emotional intelligence are better equipped to understand and respond to the emotional need(s) of their students (Kaur, Shri, & Mital, 2019), establish positive relationships, and create an inclusive and supportive classroom climate (Rajendran, Athira & Elavarasi, 2020).

This created the need for the Academic Staff Emotional Intelligence Questionnaire (ASEIQ) to be developed in the present study. This was done according to the trait model, which holds that EI is comprised of stable and enduring personal traits related to emotions. These traits include self-awareness, self-regulation, empathy, social skills, and motivation (Goleman, 1995). The trait model measures and assesses an individual's emotional dispositions and tendencies through self-report questionnaires or inventories (Petrides, Pita, & Kokkinaki, 2007).

This study was centred on five emotional intelligence variables derived from Goleman's work: self-awareness, social awareness, self-regulation, empathy and internal motivation. Along these lines, the conceptual model of emotional intelligence is developed for this study in Figure 1. Figure 1 illustrates the division of emotional intelligence into interpersonal and intrapersonal factors to visually represent how different aspects of emotional intelligence can be categorised and understood. Figure 1 shows that individuals' emotional intelligence can be broadly grouped into interpersonal and intrapersonal factors. Interpersonal factors focus on emotional intelligence in relation to others. They involve understanding and managing emotions in social interactions, such as empathy, social skills, social awareness, and building and maintaining relationships.

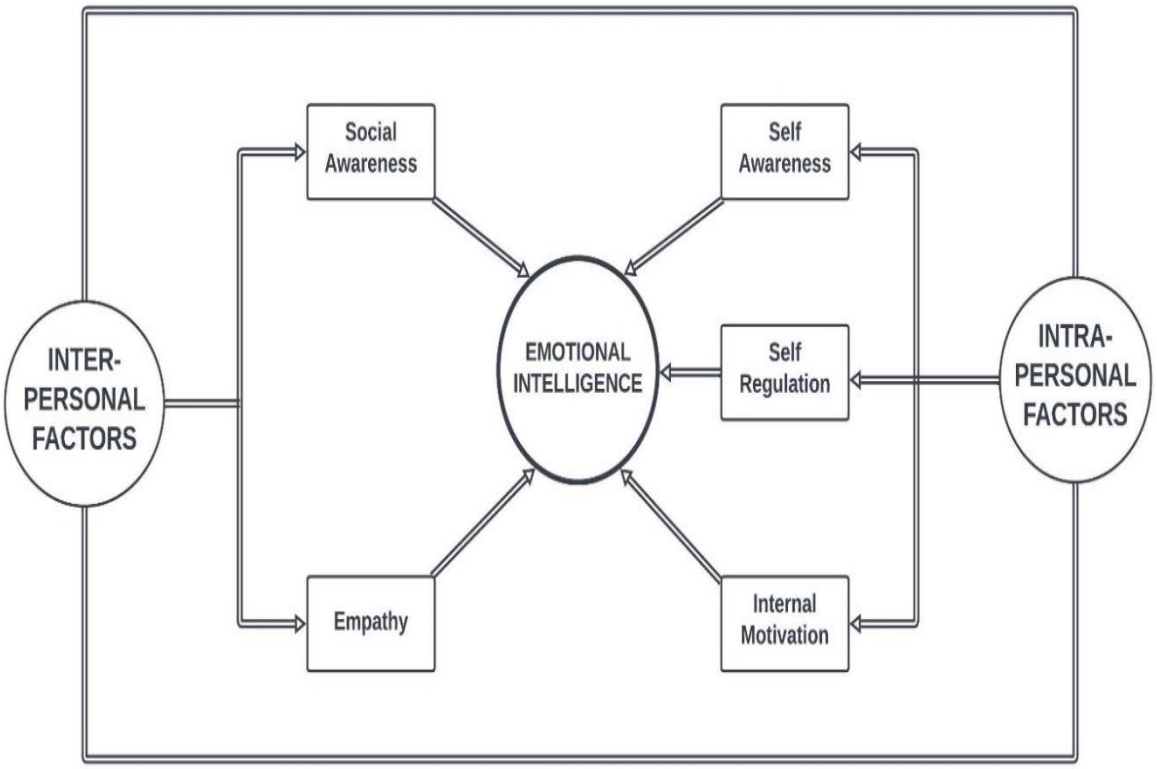


FIGURE 1: Trait emotional intelligence conceptual model developed for this study.

Source: The researcher's elaboration

Individuals with strong interpersonal skills can accurately perceive the emotions of others, respond effectively to those emotions, and navigate social situations with tact and empathy. On the other hand, intrapersonal factors pertain to emotional intelligence within oneself. They involve self-awareness, self-regulation, and self-motivation. Individuals with strong intrapersonal skills know their emotions, can regulate and manage them effectively, and are motivated to achieve personal goals. They understand their strengths and weaknesses well, can reflect on their own emotions, and possess a strong sense of self-confidence. Figure 1 further shows that emotional intelligence is a multifaceted construct, and these two groups of factors are not mutually exclusive but complementary. Interpersonal and intrapersonal factors contribute to an individual's overall emotional intelligence, and their relative importance may vary depending on the context and specific emotional challenges. This explains why in Figure 1, both factors are linked to form a complete sense of the constituents of EI.

2.1.2. Concept of job satisfaction

The concept of job satisfaction has been extensively discussed in the literature for over a century (Castaneda & Scanlan, 2014). Researchers have devoted significant attention to studying job satisfaction, making it one of workplace psychology's most extensively examined variables (Lu, Barriball, Zhang & While, 2012). However, due to the absence of a universally accepted definition, job satisfaction carries different meanings for various scholars, leading to diverse definitions. Nevertheless, some of the earliest definitions of job satisfaction suggest that it is connected to how joyful, comfortable, relaxed, happy or fulfilled workers feel about their work and its activities.

For example, Hoppock (1935) defines job satisfaction as a person's genuine contentment with their job, which can be influenced by various factors such as their psychological well-being, physical comfort, and the overall work environment. Vroom

(1964) further explains that job satisfaction relates to how individuals feel about their specific roles and responsibilities within their workplace. Locke provided a well-known and widely recognised definition of job satisfaction in the international literature. In his influential works on the subject, specifically the article "What is job satisfaction," Locke argues that job satisfaction refers to the favourable emotional reaction experienced by individuals when their work aligns with their professional values (Locke, 1969). According to Locke, job satisfaction arises when individuals feel positive about their work and perceive that their professional values are being fulfilled. Similarly, Spector (1997) defines job satisfaction as the level of happiness and fulfilment that workers experience.

Some contemporary clarification of the concept has emerged. For example, job satisfaction has been described as encompassing an individual's overall feelings, attitudes, and emotions towards their work (Thangaswamy & Thiyagaraj, 2017). Job satisfaction can be defined as the assessment of an individual's contentment with their job, which is influenced by the perceived alignment or discrepancy between their expected and actual performance and the corresponding rewards received (Singh & Onahring, 2019). In other words, it is the evaluation of the difference between the number of rewards an employee believes they should receive and the actual amount they receive, ultimately impacting their level of satisfaction with their job. According to Mérida-López, Extremera, Quintana-Orts and Rey (2019), job satisfaction is described as an evaluative state that encompasses both satisfaction with the job and positive emotions associated with it. In other words, it is a subjective assessment of how content an individual feels with their job. It encompasses their overall satisfaction with the job and specific elements, such as: the nature of the work and supervision (Hulin & Judge, 2003). On the other hand, Fan, Moen, Kelly, Hammer and Berkman (2019) view job satisfaction as a broader employee evaluation regarding their jobs. They suggest that job satisfaction is closely related to mental health and employee turnover (rotation), implying that higher levels of job satisfaction are associated

with better mental well-being and decreased likelihood of leaving the job. Job satisfaction is a theoretical construct that encompasses an individual's assessment of their job, incorporating both the workplace climate and the economic aspects of the job (Gutiérrez-Banegas, 2019).

It has been argued that job satisfaction is not solely based on objective factors, such as salary or job title, but also incorporates subjective perceptions and individual preferences (Dhir, Dutta & Ghosh, 2020). Different people may derive satisfaction from different aspects of their work, and what constitutes job satisfaction can vary from person to person. For example, job satisfaction can arise from various factors, including the nature of the job itself, achievement, responsibility, the work environment, relationships with colleagues and supervisors, work conditions, compensation and benefits, opportunities for growth and development, job interest, the alignment of personal values with organisational values, quality of supervision (Alzubi, Alkhateeb & Hiyassat, 2023; Bulińska-Stangrecka & Bagieńska, 2021). Other factors affecting job satisfaction advanced in the literature are social capital, leadership, adequate orientation, and self-perceived efficacy (Aloisio, Baumbusch, Estabrooks, Bostrom, Chamberlain, Cummings, Thompson & Squires, 2019). When these factors align positively, individuals are more likely to experience job satisfaction (De Clercq, Haq & Azeem, 2019).

Researchers have taken diverse approaches to measuring job satisfaction, but there is consensus that it is a multidimensional concept with numerous components. For example, it has been contended that job satisfaction can be measured through cognitive (evaluative), affective (emotional), and behavioural components (Thompson & Phua, 2012). Therefore, measures of job satisfaction can focus either on individuals' feelings about the job (affective) or their thoughts and evaluations of the different activities in the workplace (cognitive) or their attitudes/behaviours towards work itself (behavioural). The behavioural aspect of job satisfaction manifests individuals' inherent mental and affective

thought processes about their job. This thinking is not out of place since people behave based on how they think, perceive, process, and analyse information and the meanings they make out of them.

Nevertheless, other scholars have argued that job satisfaction can be measured globally, reflecting overall satisfaction with the job, or on a facet level, assessing satisfaction with various aspects of the job (Dicke, Marsh, Parker, Guo, Riley & Waldeyer, 2020). Some commonly identified facets of job satisfaction include appreciation, communication, promotion opportunities, coworkers, fringe benefits, organisation, job conditions, personal growth, recognition, supervision, policies and procedures, security and the nature of the work (Spector, 1997). This means that measures of job satisfaction must focus on different dimensions of the concept. In line with this thinking, the conceptual framework of the study was formulated and is depicted in Figure 2.

The conceptual model in Figure 2 suggests that job satisfaction is a multidimensional concept with three core dimensions. This position derives from the seminal works of Richard and Porter (1975), conceiving job satisfaction as a complex construct that encompasses not only individuals' emotional or affective responses but also their cognitive evaluations and behavioural outcomes related to their work. Some scholars have recognised that job satisfaction is not solely based on emotional experiences but also involves cognitive assessments of various aspects of the job and observable behaviours exhibited in the workplace (Richard & Porter, 1975). In this context, the affective satisfaction refers to an individual's emotional experiences, feelings, and affective states associated with their job (Hu, Guo, Duffy, Ren & Yue, 2020). Cognitive satisfaction involves an individual's cognitive evaluations, beliefs, and thoughts about their job, including perceptions of fairness, autonomy, and recognition (Petcu, Sobolevschi-David, Anica-Popa, Curea, Motofei & Popescu, 2021).

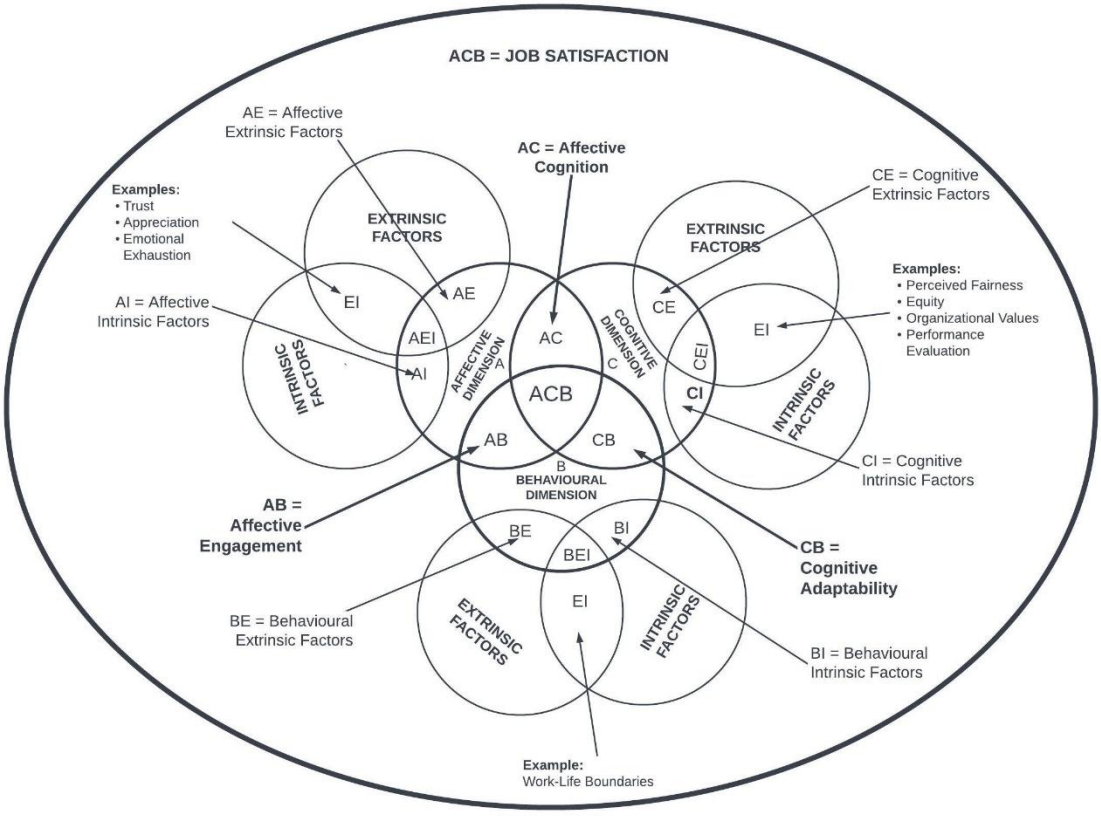


FIGURE 2: Conceptual model of job satisfaction developed for this study.

Source: The researcher's elaboration

Behavioural satisfaction pertains to the observable behaviours and actions exhibited by individuals in the workplace, such as job performance, motivation, and commitment (Argan, Argan & Dursun, 2022). Furthermore, job satisfaction is further conceived to have two crucial sources – extrinsic and intrinsic. This aligns with the early ideas of Wernimont (1966). In Figure 2, a complex Venn diagram was created intersecting the three dimensions with the two sources of job satisfaction. These led to the creation of second-order dimensions of job satisfaction, such as: affective-extrinsic, affective-intrinsic, cognitive-extrinsic, cognitive-intrinsic, behavioural-extrinsic and behaviour-extrinsic factors.

Affective-extrinsic factors refer to external influences or factors that impact an individual's emotional experiences and affective states related to their job. These factors are external to the individual and the job itself but can significantly influence job satisfaction's affective or emotional component. Examples of affective-extrinsic factors include interpersonal relationships, organisational culture, work-life balance, recognition and rewards, and the nature of the work environment (Ghafoor, 2014). On the other hand, affective-intrinsic factors refer to internal or personal factors inherent to the individual that contribute to their emotional experiences and affective states related to their job. These factors are intrinsic to the individual and their characteristics, attitudes, or values and directly impact the affective component of job satisfaction. Examples of affective-intrinsic factors are: personal values alignment, a sense of purpose and meaning, personal growth and development opportunities, internal motivation, work enjoyment, passion or interest, and work-life alignment (Manuel, Dutton & Carter, 2019).

Cognitive-extrinsic factors are external or environmental influences that impact cognitive processes, thinking patterns, or mental operations of workers. These factors are external to the individual's cognitive system but can significantly influence their cognitive functioning and performance. Cognitive-extrinsic factors include: organisational policies

and practices, leadership and management style, work environment and culture, compensation and benefits, and career advancement opportunities (Hampton & Welsh, 2019). However, cognitive-intrinsic factors reflect individuals' internal cognitive processes and evaluations when assessing their satisfaction with their job. Cognitive-intrinsic factors of job satisfaction include job fit, job meaningfulness, task autonomy, learning and growth opportunities, and self-efficacy (Lopez, 2017).

Behavioural-extrinsic factors exert external influences that impact an individual's behaviours and actions in the workplace. These factors are external to the individual but can significantly influence their behavioural outcomes or expressions related to job satisfaction. Some behavioural-extrinsic factors of job satisfaction are: organisational policies and procedures, leadership style and behaviour, reward and recognition systems, team dynamics and collaboration, work environment and physical conditions (Palinkas & Suedfeld, 2021). On the other hand, behavioural-intrinsic factors of job satisfaction refer to internal or personal factors that are inherent to the individual and influence their behaviours and actions in the workplace. These factors arise from within the individual and directly impact their behavioural outcomes. Behavioural-intrinsic factors in job satisfaction include internal drive, engagement, autonomy, personal values, and job crafting.

Furthermore, the Venn diagram (Figure 2) further shows other intersections that yielded other forms of job satisfaction, notably the affective-cognitive (AC) connection, the cognitive-behavioural (CB) connection and the affective-behavioural (AB) connection. The AC, CB and AB intersections were labelled affective cognition, cognitive adaptability and affective engagement, respectively. Affective cognition refers to the interplay between emotions and cognitive processes, highlighting how emotions influence and interact with cognitive functions such as perception, attention, memory, and decision-making. It acknowledges the role of affective states in shaping cognitive processes and how cognitive

processes, in turn, influence emotional experiences (Preti, Siddi, Marzola & Abbate, 2022; Zhang, 2022). Affective cognition focuses on the subjective experience of individuals, acknowledging that emotions are not solely separate from cognitive processes but are intertwined in the interpretation and evaluation of information and experiences. Factors promoting affective cognition include: happiness, fulfilment, enthusiasm, positive emotions, job enjoyment, a sense of meaning and pride.

Cognitive adaptability refers to the capacity and willingness of individuals to adjust their cognitive processes, thinking patterns, and problem-solving strategies in response to changing circumstances, challenges, or demands. It involves being open-minded, flexible, and effectively modifying cognitive strategies or approaches to meet new or complex situations (Botha & Morallane, 2019; Dheer & Castrogiovanni, 2023). Factors that can strengthen cognitive adaptation include: trust, appreciation, recognition, career development, decision-making authority, feedback, performance evaluation, job clarity, leadership style, decision-making involvement and training and development.

Affective engagement refers to an individual's emotional or affective investment in their work, reflected in their behaviours, actions, and level of involvement. It encompasses the positive emotions, enthusiasm, and commitment that individuals bring to their job tasks and interactions with others (Cho & Castañeda, 2019). Affective recognises that emotions significantly shape individuals' attitudes, behaviours, and overall satisfaction with their work (Tay, 2020; Zhang, Tian, Yao, Duan, Sun & Niu, 2023). Factors that can promote or hinder workers' affective job engagement are proactive behaviour, job involvement, collaboration, absenteeism, creativity, job crafting, work engagement, prosocial behaviour and job rotation.

Despite the series of relationships established in the conceptual model (Figure 2), as discussed earlier, the ACB connection is considered the most important in this study. The ACB is the point where the affective, behavioural and cognitive dimensions of job

satisfaction intersect. According to this study's conceptualisation, the ACB is where workers' overall job satisfaction lies. At the point of intersection (ACB), it is assumed that the organisation has done enough to ensure that workers are emotionally, cognitively and behaviourally satisfied, creating a balance in the overall satisfaction of workers. Strengthening one or two of A, C or B and leaving one or more of these dimensions unstrengthened may still lead to job dissatisfaction. This is because factors promote different satisfaction levels among employees, and strengthening some dimensions without others may create imbalances and inconsistencies in overall job satisfaction. As an illustration, suppose an organisation solely emphasises creating a positive affective environment without addressing cognitive or behavioural aspects. In that case, employees may feel good emotionally but still experience dissatisfaction due to a lack of clarity in job roles or insufficient opportunities for growth and development. Similarly, focusing solely on cognitive aspects, such as fair procedures and recognition, without considering affective or behavioural factors may lead to employees perceiving a lack of emotional support or experiencing disengagement.

In line with the ACB arguments and the conceptual framework presented in Figure 2, five specific aspects of job satisfaction were considered in this study. These include: satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support. Two of these five aspects were derived from the cognitive dimension of job satisfaction: satisfaction with work conditions and satisfaction with remuneration. However, satisfaction with workload allocation was derived from the affective dimension. Satisfaction with career advancement opportunities and satisfaction with research support were considered from the behavioural dimension of job satisfaction.

2.1.3. Concept of persistence to publish

The concept of persistence to publish is relatively new and has not been as extensively defined in the literature as this study's other two main concepts. Nevertheless, an attempt to conceptualise "persistence to publish" was made in this chapter. However, to understand the phrase "persistence to publish", it is important to get an overview of the word "persistence." "Persistence" is derived from the root word "persist." Various definitions of persistence have been proposed, including McDougall's (1908) perspective that it is an objective characteristic of purposeful behaviour. Persistence can be defined as the dedication of time and the unwillingness to settle for an easier alternative when faced with challenging situations (Howells, 1933). According to Ryans (1939), persistence is the capacity to withstand challenges, persevere, and keep striving towards success, even in the face of exhaustion and discouragement. Hebb (1949) portrayed the term "persistence" as goal-directed action. To Feather (1962), persistence arises when an individual is faced with a highly challenging or insoluble task and is unrestricted in terms of both time and the number of attempts made.

The concept of persistence has since been recognised as a significant aspect of life (Fernald, 1912). Consequently, scholars in the field of motivation theory incorporated persistence into their theoretical frameworks (e.g., Danner & Lonky, 1981; McCaugham & McKinlay, 1981). On the other hand, persistence has been defined as the trait of enduring or continuing to do something despite being fatigued (Cloninger, Svrakic & Przybeck, 1993). To persist means maintaining a strong and unwavering commitment to a particular objective or duty (McGiboney & Carter, 1993). Similarly, Sandler (2000) defines persistence as the opposite of attrition and is associated with factors, such as: career decision-making self-efficacy, perceived stress, financial attitudes, locus of control, and academic and social integration.

More recent definitions of the concept have emerged where persistence has been conceived as the quality of consistently maintaining one's determination and motivation to achieve goals, refusing to give up even in the face of potential challenges or obstacles (Quintana, Barriopedro & Ruiz-Perez, 2022). It involves a resolute commitment to continue striving towards the desired outcomes and a willingness to overcome difficulties that may arise along the way. In a relatively more recent definition, Styk, Zmorzynski and Samardakiewicz (2023) conceive persistence as the capacity to embrace and persevere in the face of challenges and overcome obstacles to attain predetermined or self-established objectives.

Various related concepts, such as perseverance, grit, and tenacity, underscore individuals' unwavering commitment to achieving their goals (Williams & DeSteno, 2008). These concepts highlight the depth of individuals' engagement in pursuing their objectives, with some considering it an inherent aspect of their character (Constantin, Holman & Hojbotă, 2011). The cited authors argued that persistence should be distinguished based on whether the goal is short-term or long-term, as this distinction can impact the level of effort required. When pursuing short-term goals, individuals must focus on sustaining their attention, enduring boredom, stress, and setbacks, as well as overcoming distractions or obstacles that may arise. In contrast, pursuing long-term goals demands a sustained commitment, necessitating significant resources and an extended investment of time. Furthermore, the concept of persistence has been the subject of numerous studies, leading to various conceptualisations and associated terms, such as: goal pursuit, commitment, self-control, courage, drive, diligence, and conscientiousness (Khindri & Rangnekar, 2022; Styk & Klinkosz, 2020).

In the past, one common method used to assess adult persistence involved placing individuals in challenging situations requiring endurance (Lufi & Cohen, 1987). This was achieved through physical endurance tests (Cleeton & Knight, 1924) or by assigning them

lengthy and almost unsolvable intellectual tasks (Morgan & Hall, 1926). Another approach, widely employed in educational settings, involved observing individuals in real-life situations and comparing dropouts to graduates in specific activities such as schools or educational programs (Wood, 1968). Furthermore, questionnaires have been utilised as a method of measuring persistence. Wang (1932) developed a self-appraisal schedule, a 111-item questionnaire to assess persistence. Lufi (1979) devised a 67-item scale to evaluate persistence in the academic domain. However, these scales have not gained significant popularity, potentially due to inadequate validation. The lack of existing instruments urged Hart (2014) to develop and validate an instrument with acceptable psychometric properties that could measure persistence among higher education students. Since then, a number of instruments have been developed to measure persistence in different populations. For example, Kozlowski and Fouad (2022) developed a scale to measure academic persistence among college students following psychometric procedures. Similarly, Lockhart, Kwok, Yoon and Wong (2022) constructed and established the validity and reliability of a questionnaire to measure persistence among students in Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM) programmes. In the same year, Quintana et al. (2022) validated the Spanish version of the "motivational persistence scale"; a scale previously developed in English by Constantin et al. (2011).

Recently, Styk et al. (2023) considered persistence to be a multidimensional construct and developed a scale to measure persistence, perseverance and perfectionism scale. Similarly, other researchers have also approached persistence as a multidimensional construct. For instance, one dimension of persistence can be understood as the ability to persevere despite challenges, another as the ability to persist in the face of fear, and yet another as the capacity to maintain persistence despite inadequate circumstances (Howard & Crayne, 2019). Although these scales were all developed to measure persistence across

different populations and contexts, none was developed to measure the concept of "persistence to publish", and none of the existing scales was developed in Africa.

With the concept of persistence clarified; it is important to attempt to define and conceptualise "persistence to publish" by deriving ideas from the meaning of persistence. "Persistence to publish" can be defined as the sustained and determined effort of an academic staff or researcher to pursue the publication of their scholarly work consistently. It involves the commitment and dedication to overcome challenges, setbacks, and obstacles throughout the publication process. Persistence to publish reflects the continuous drive to contribute to the body of knowledge in a specific field or discipline by submitting research reports or scholarly articles to reputable journals or publishing outlets. This concept encompasses the resilience, perseverance, and tenacity required to navigate the rigorous and competitive publishing landscape, including manuscript preparation, submission, peer review, revisions, delays, rejections or eventual acceptance and dissemination of the research.

In this study, persistence to publish is viewed as a multidimensional concept that encapsulates the determination, passion, resilience, commitment to quality, and effective time management required to successfully navigate the process of sharing research findings with the wider academic community. Furthermore, due to the series of activities and potential setbacks researchers face in the publication process, persistence is required at every stage, further contributing to the multidimensionality of the concept. For instance, researchers must demonstrate persistence from their research project's initial idea and conceptualisation to the final publication and dissemination. At the outset, persistence is needed to formulate a research question, design a study, and obtain ethical approvals and funding. Researchers must overcome challenges in recruiting participants, collecting data, and ensuring the quality and validity of their research. Persistence is crucial in crafting an adequately developed and coherent manuscript during the writing phase. Researchers must

invest time and effort in conducting thorough literature reviews, analysing and interpreting data, and effectively communicating their findings. This process may involve numerous revisions, addressing feedback from co-authors, mentors, and reviewers. The peer review process often presents additional hurdles that require persistence. Researchers may face rejection or receive critical feedback on their work. Persistence is essential in responding to reviewer comments, revising the manuscript, and resubmitting it for consideration. It may take multiple rounds of revision and re-submission before achieving publication.

Persistence is necessary to deal with potential delays, waiting periods, and uncertainties inherent in the publication process. Researchers may experience extended review timelines, unexpected editorial decisions, or changes in journal requirements. Maintaining perseverance and motivation throughout these challenges is vital. Additionally, persistence extends beyond the publication itself. Researchers must engage in ongoing scholarly discussions, present their work at conferences, and actively contribute to their field. They must demonstrate continuous dedication to knowledge dissemination and build a track record of publications over time. Thus, the conceptual model in Figure 3 was developed to show these processes with persistence at the centre of the activities. The PPQ developed in this study followed the model in Figure 3.

Figure 3 shows that persistence to publish can be demonstrated across five crucial activities, including: manuscript preparation, submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays. In each of these activities, there are specific challenges that academic staff will face; requiring only persistence to overcome them. These challenges are presented as a bulleted list in the bigger boxes in the model (Figure 3). As shown in the conceptual model, the challenges vary with each activity. Single-headed arrows are used in the model to show the next activity/challenge that an academic staff will face after completing the previous activity.

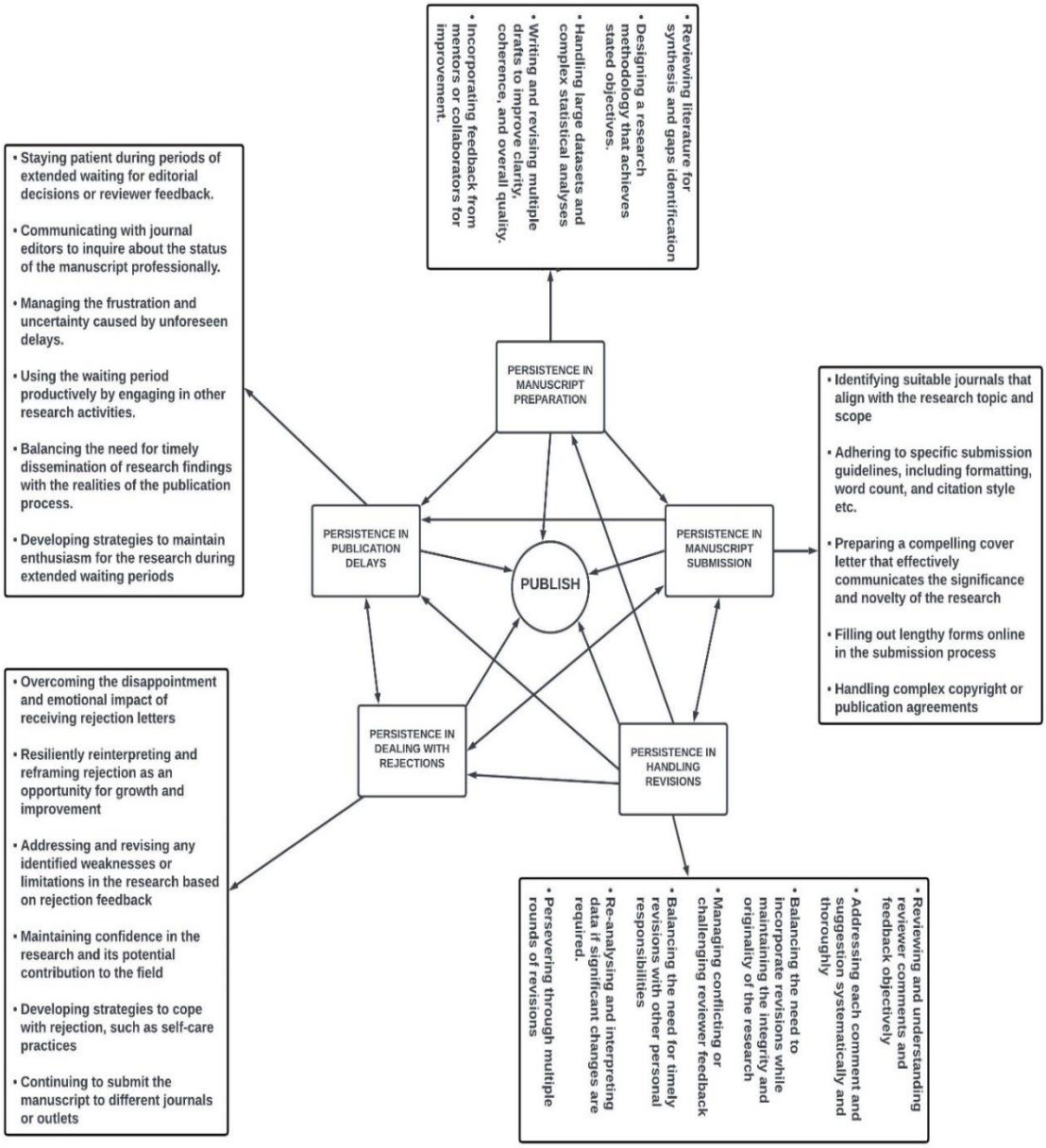


FIGURE 3: Conceptual model of academic staff persistence to publish developed for the study.

Source: The researcher's elaboration

To cite an instance, an academic staff must demonstrate persistence in manuscript preparation before progressing to demonstrate persistence in manuscript submission or publication delays. Similarly, an academic staff must demonstrate persistence in manuscript submission before persisting during publication delays. Moreover, persistence in handling revisions must be developed before expressing persistence in dealing with rejections. On the other hand, double-headed arrows show two-way activities, implying that fulfilling one and moving to the next activity could return you to the previous activity. For example, after submitting manuscripts and there is a revision, an academic staff must demonstrate persistence in preparing their manuscripts.

In cases of rejections, an academic staff will need to reprepare their manuscripts before resubmitting them to another journal, hence the double arrow linking persistence in manuscript preparation to persistence in dealing with rejections. The double arrow linking persistence in dealing with rejections and persistence in publication delays shows that waiting for some time only for a submitted paper to be eventually rejected by a journal is already a form of delay, and academics must learn to show persistence in such a situation.

2.2. Theoretical background

The following theories underpinned this study

a. Emotional Intelligence Theory by Daniel Goleman (1995)
b. Two-Factor Theory by Frederick Hertzberg (1968)
c. Expectancy-Value Theory by Martin Fishbein and Icek Ajzen (1975)

2.2.1. Emotional Intelligence Theory by Daniel Goleman (1995)

Goleman's theory of emotional intelligence (EI) proposes that emotional intelligence is critical in determining an individual's success and well-being, sometimes even more so than intellectual intelligence. Goleman defines emotional intelligence as a

set of skills and competencies that involve the ability to perceive, understand, manage, and utilize emotions effectively (Goleman, 1995). Goleman argues that emotional intelligence is vital to personal and professional success. The theory suggests that while intellectual intelligence (IQ) is important; emotional intelligence enables individuals to effectively navigate the complexities of human interactions and manage their own emotions (Goleman, 1998). Goleman proposes that emotional intelligence is crucial in leadership, influencing teamwork, and promoting overall well-being.

Goleman highlights that emotional intelligence and intellectual intelligence are distinct but interconnected. In contrast, IQ measures cognitive abilities, and emotional intelligence complements and enhances these abilities by providing individuals with emotional competencies supporting effective decision-making, problem-solving, and interpersonal skills. Goleman's theory asserts that emotional intelligence is not fixed but can be developed and improved throughout a person's lifetime (Goleman, 1995). The theory emphasizes the importance of self-reflection, self-awareness, and continuous learning. By actively working on developing emotional intelligence, individuals can enhance their abilities in self-awareness, self-regulation, empathy, motivation, and social skills. The theory assumes that emotional intelligence encompasses these components.

1. Self-Awareness: Self-awareness is the foundation of emotional intelligence. It refers to the ability to accurately recognize and understand one's emotions and their impact on thoughts, behaviour, and relationships. This component involves being in tune with one's feelings and accurately assessing one's strengths and weaknesses.
2. Self-Regulation: Self-regulation is managing and controlling one's emotions, impulses, and behaviours. It involves emotional self-control, adaptability, and composure in challenging situations. Individuals with high self-regulation can effectively handle stress, delay gratification, and make well-thought-out decisions.

3. Empathy: Empathy is the capacity to understand and share the emotions of others. It involves putting oneself in someone else's shoes, perceiving their feelings, and responding sensitively. Empathy allows individuals to build deeper connections, foster better relationships, and show compassion towards others.
4. Motivation: In emotional intelligence, motivation refers to the ability to harness emotions to drive oneself towards achieving goals. It involves being self-motivated, having a sense of purpose, and demonstrating resilience in the face of setbacks. Motivated individuals with high emotional intelligence often have a clear vision, set challenging goals, and exhibit perseverance.
5. Social Skills: Social skills encompass a range of abilities that facilitate effective interaction and communication with others. It includes verbal and non-verbal communication, active listening, conflict resolution, collaboration, and influencing others positively. Strong social skills enable individuals to navigate social situations, build networks, and establish successful relationships.

Goleman's emotional intelligence theory has practical applications in various domains (Fteiha & Awwad, 2020). In the workplace, emotional intelligence is valued for its role in effective leadership, teamwork, conflict resolution, and communication (Alheet & Hamdan, 2021). In education, it has implications for social-emotional learning, promoting emotional well-being, and enhancing academic performance (Cejudo, Losada & Feltrero, 2020). In personal relationships, emotional intelligence contributes to healthier and more satisfying connections with others (Munir, Shakeel & Waheed, 2023). Despite the popularity gathered by Goleman's theory and its influence in many fields, including psychology, leadership, and education, it has also faced criticism and ongoing debates about its measurement and scientific validity (e.g., Locke, 2005; Salovey, Caruso & Mayer, 2004; Waterhouse, 2006). A response to some of these critiques has been provided

(see Cherniss, Extein, Goleman & Weissberg, 2006; Mikolajczak, 2009). Nevertheless, the theory has contributed significantly to understanding emotions, interpersonal dynamics, and the role of emotional intelligence in human behaviour and success.

Goleman's theory is very relevant to this study focusing on emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals among university academic staff. First, the theory formed the basis for selecting the sub-variables of the predictor variables. These sub-variables include self-awareness, self-regulation, empathy, social awareness, and internal motivation. According to the theory, self-awareness can influence job satisfaction and persistence to publish by helping individuals align their research interests and goals with their values and motivations. Self-regulation involves managing and controlling one's emotions, impulses, and behaviours. For academic staff, self-regulation can contribute to job satisfaction and persistence to publish by enabling them to handle stress, setbacks, and time management effectively. It can also aid in maintaining focus, motivation, and work-life balance. Moreover, the theory suggests that academic staff with empathy are more likely to establish positive relationships with colleagues, students, and collaborators. This can enhance job satisfaction through effective communication, teamwork, and support networks.

Empathy can also impact persistence to publish by fostering collaborative research efforts and understanding the needs and perspectives of journal reviewers and editors. The social awareness dimension involves perceiving and understanding social dynamics and cues. In academia, social awareness can contribute to job satisfaction by facilitating positive interactions and fostering a supportive and inclusive work environment. It can also aid in building professional networks and collaborations, enhancing persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals by providing access to resources, opportunities, and co-authorship possibilities. Internal motivation refers to an individual's drive and passion for their work. Therefore, internal motivation can impact both job satisfaction and

persistence to publish. For instance, academic staff with high internal motivation are more likely to find fulfilment in their research and teaching, leading to higher job satisfaction. Their intrinsic drive can fuel their persistence to publish by maintaining their commitment to research productivity and overcoming challenges. Generally, these dimensions provide a comprehensive framework for assessing and understanding emotional intelligence among academic staff. Secondly, the academic staff emotional intelligence questionnaire (ASEIQ) was developed following the framework of Goleman's theory.

Another relevance of the theory to this study is that it suggests that emotional intelligence can influence job satisfaction by facilitating effective emotion management, interpersonal skills, and work-life balance. Consequently, higher job satisfaction is likely to result in increased motivation, engagement, and persistence to publish among academic staff. Lastly, the persistence to publish is the key outcome variable in this study, indicating the academic staff's commitment to producing scholarly work. Goleman's theory provides insights into how emotional intelligence dimensions can contribute to this outcome variable. Academic staff with higher levels of emotional intelligence are better equipped to manage setbacks, handle rejections, and maintain motivation in the face of challenges. They can also establish strong collaborations, communicate their research effectively, and adapt to changing publishing norms, positively impacting their persistence to publish.

2.2.2. Two-Factor Theory by Frederick Hertzberg (1968)

Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory, also known as the Motivation-Hygiene Theory or the Dual-Factor Theory, is a widely recognized theory of workplace motivation and job satisfaction, proposed by Frederick Hertzberg in 1968. This theory aimed to explain the factors influencing employee motivation and job satisfaction. The theory suggests that two sets of factors impact employees' experiences and attitudes in the workplace: motivators and hygiene factors (Hertzberg, 1968). Motivators (Intrinsic Factors) are inherent to the

work itself and directly impact job satisfaction and intrinsic motivation (Thant & Chang, 2021). These factors are related to the nature of the work and the opportunities it provides for personal growth, achievement, and fulfilment. According to Herzberg, motivators include:

- Achievement: sense of accomplishment and progress from performing challenging tasks and meeting goals. Opportunities for advancement, recognition, and personal growth contribute to the sense of achievement.
- Recognition: Feeling appreciated and acknowledged for one's efforts and contributions. Recognizing and rewarding employees for their achievements and contributions enhances job satisfaction.
- Responsibility: Having autonomy and decision-making authority in one's role. Providing employees with a sense of ownership and control over their work increases motivation and job satisfaction.
- Advancement: The opportunity for career development and growth within the organization. Clear pathways for promotion and professional advancement are important motivators for employees.
- Personal Growth: The chance to learn new skills, acquire knowledge, and expand one's capabilities through job tasks and responsibilities. Providing opportunities for continuous learning and skill development enhances job satisfaction.

The second factor is the hygiene Factors (extrinsic factors). Hygiene factors are external to the work and are primarily related to the work environment and conditions. When absent or inadequate, these factors can lead to job dissatisfaction, but their presence alone does not necessarily increase job satisfaction (Hertzberg, 1968). Hygiene factors include:

- Company Policies: The organization's rules, procedures, and administrative practices. Fair and well-communicated policies contribute to a positive work environment.
- Salary and Benefits: The level of compensation, fringe benefits, and other financial rewards. While essential for meeting basic needs, they do not provide long-term satisfaction unless perceived as fair and competitive.
- Supervision: The quality of leadership, support, and guidance supervisors provide. Effective management and supportive leadership positively impact job satisfaction.
- Working Conditions: The physical environment, equipment, and resources available for performing the job. A safe, comfortable, and well-equipped workspace is essential for job satisfaction.
- Interpersonal Relationships: The quality of relationships with colleagues, superiors, and subordinates. Positive and supportive relationships contribute to job satisfaction, while conflict and poor interpersonal dynamics can lead to dissatisfaction.

The key assumptions of the two-factor theory are:

1. Job Satisfaction and Dissatisfaction: Herzberg argued that job satisfaction and dissatisfaction are not opposite ends of the same continuum but separate dimensions. Factors that lead to job satisfaction (motivators) are distinct from those that lead to job dissatisfaction (hygiene factors). The absence of dissatisfaction does not automatically mean satisfaction, and the absence of satisfaction does not necessarily imply dissatisfaction.
2. Intrinsic Motivation and Extrinsic Factors: The theory emphasizes the importance of intrinsic motivation derived from the work itself, including personal growth, achievement, and recognition. Extrinsic factors, such as salary and working conditions, primarily address employees' basic needs and can prevent job dissatisfaction but have a limited impact on long-term motivation and satisfaction.

3. The Dual-Effect of Factors: Motivators have the potential to influence job satisfaction and motivation positively. When present, motivators can enhance job satisfaction and intrinsic motivation. On the other hand, the absence or inadequacy of hygiene factors can lead to job dissatisfaction. Hygiene factors can prevent dissatisfaction, but their presence alone does not significantly increase satisfaction.
4. Job Enrichment and Job Redesign: The Two-Factor Theory suggests that organizations should provide job enrichment and redesign opportunities to enhance motivation and job satisfaction. This includes offering challenging and meaningful work, promoting autonomy and responsibility, recognizing and rewarding achievements, providing opportunities for personal and professional growth, and improving working conditions and interpersonal relationships.

The two-factor theory is highly relevant to the present study on emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals among university academic staff. The theory provides useful interpretations into the factors contributing to job satisfaction, which can help explain the relationship between emotional intelligence and the outcome variable – persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. According to the two-factor theory, two factors influence job satisfaction: motivators and hygiene. In this study, emotional intelligence is the predictor variable with five dimensions: self-awareness, self-regulation, empathy, social awareness, and internal motivation. These dimensions of emotional intelligence can be seen as motivators that directly impact job satisfaction among university academic staff. Furthermore, this study considered five dimensions of job satisfaction: satisfaction with workload allocation, remuneration, career advancement opportunities, research support, and work conditions. These dimensions align well with the two-factor theory's intrinsic and hygiene factors.

Satisfaction with workload allocation can be associated with both motivators and hygiene factors. From a motivator perspective, academic staff may find satisfaction in having a manageable workload that allows them to engage in meaningful and challenging work, aligning with achievement and personal growth. On the other hand, excessive workload or unbalanced allocations can lead to job dissatisfaction, aligning with hygiene factors related to working conditions and company policies.

Satisfaction with remuneration is primarily considered a hygiene factor in the two-factor theory. Fair and competitive compensation is essential to prevent job dissatisfaction. While insufficient remuneration can lead to dissatisfaction, it does not necessarily contribute significantly to long-term job satisfaction. However, higher remuneration levels can provide a sense of achievement and recognition, aligning with motivators.

Satisfaction with career advancement opportunities is often seen as a motivator in the two-factor theory. Academic staff who perceive growth opportunities, such as promotions, professional development programs, or the chance to take on challenging projects, are more likely to experience job satisfaction. These opportunities align with personal growth, achievement, and recognition motivators.

Satisfaction with research support can be both a motivator and a hygiene factor. Adequate support regarding resources, funding, facilities, and collaboration opportunities can enhance job satisfaction by enabling academic staff to engage in meaningful research and contribute to their field. On the other hand, insufficient research support may lead to job dissatisfaction, particularly if it hinders productivity and progress.

Satisfaction with work conditions, such as the physical environment, equipment, and resources, are considered hygiene factors in the two-factor theory. Pleasant and conducive work conditions are essential to prevent job dissatisfaction. While they may not be strong motivators, unsatisfactory work conditions can negatively impact job satisfaction and impede academic staff's abilities to perform their tasks effectively.

Moreover, the study proposes job satisfaction as a mediator linking emotional intelligence and the persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals among university academic staff. The two-factor theory can provide insights into the mediating role of job satisfaction. If academic staff have higher levels of job satisfaction due to their emotional intelligence, it may positively impact their persistence to publish. This can be attributed to the motivational aspect of emotional intelligence, which promotes personal growth, achievement, and intrinsic motivation, as identified by the two-factor theory. By considering the Two-Factor Theory, the study can examine how emotional intelligence, as a motivator, influences job satisfaction among academic staff. It can also explore the role of various dimensions of job satisfaction as mediating variables between emotional intelligence and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. This comprehensive approach allows a deeper understanding of the factors contributing to academic staff' job satisfaction and their subsequent persistence in publishing research.

2.2.3. Expectancy-Value Theory by Martin Fishbein and Icek Ajzen (1975)

The expectancy-value theory, proposed by Martin Fishbein and Icek Ajzen in 1975, is a psychological theory that aims to explain and predict human decision-making and behaviour based on the interaction between individuals' beliefs, attitudes, and behavioural intentions. The theory suggests that an individual's decision to engage in a particular behaviour is influenced by two primary factors: their expectations about the outcomes of the behaviour and the subjective value they attach to those outcomes (Fishbein & Ajzen, 1975). The expectancy-value theory posits that individuals are more likely to engage in a behaviour if they believe it will lead to desirable outcomes and have a high expectation of success (Nagle, 2021). Furthermore, the theory suggests that the strength of an individual's intention to perform a behaviour is directly related to their overall attitude towards that behaviour. A positive attitude, indicating a favourable

evaluation and expectation, increases the likelihood of performing the behaviour. There are some key components of the value-expectancy theory where the assumptions of the theory are anchored. These are:

1. Attitudes and Behaviour: The theory assumes that individuals' attitudes towards a specific behaviour significantly influence their likelihood of engaging in that behaviour. Attitudes are shaped by individuals' beliefs about the behaviour and the subjective values they assign to its outcomes.
2. Behavioural Beliefs: The theory assumes that individuals hold behavioural beliefs, which are their subjective assessments of the likely outcomes and consequences of performing a particular behaviour. Personal experiences, cultural factors, and social norms can influence these beliefs.
3. Outcome Evaluations: The theory posits that individuals make outcome evaluations, the subjective values or attitudes they attach to the expected behaviour outcomes. These evaluations are based on the individual's beliefs about the desirability or importance of the anticipated outcomes.
4. Expectancy: The theory assumes that individuals have expectancies, which refer to their subjective assessments of the likelihood that a specific behaviour will lead to the desired outcome. Expectancies reflect the perceived relationship between the behaviour and the expected outcome.
5. Subjective Value: The theory acknowledges that individuals assign subjective values or significances to specific outcomes. These values reflect their priorities, preferences, and values and can vary among individuals based on their unique circumstances and beliefs.
6. Behavioural Intention: The theory suggests that individuals form behavioural intentions based on the combination of their beliefs about the outcomes of the

behaviour and their expectations of achieving those outcomes. Stronger intentions are more likely to result in the performance of the behaviour.

7. Attitude Strength: The theory assumes that the strength of an individual's attitude towards a behaviour is directly related to their overall evaluation. Attitude strength is calculated by multiplying the subjective value of an outcome by the expectancy of achieving that outcome and summing these products across all relevant outcomes.
8. Behaviour Prediction: The theory posits that attitudes and behavioural intentions are reliable predictors of actual behaviour. While other factors, such as external constraints or situational influences, may also play a role, the theory suggests that individuals are more likely to engage in a behaviour if they hold positive attitudes towards it and have a high expectation of success.

The expectancy-value theory is highly relevant to the present study on emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals among university academic staff. This theory provides a framework for understanding the motivational factors influencing academic staff's behaviours and decisions about publishing in prestigious journals. In the current study, emotional intelligence served as the predictor variable, consisting of five dimensions: self-awareness, self-regulation, empathy, social awareness, and internal motivation. Emotional intelligence may likely influence academic staff's beliefs about their ability to publish in Scopus-indexed journals and their expectations of success. According to the expectancy-value theory, individuals' expectations of achieving desired outcomes are key to their behavioural intentions. Therefore, through this theory, it may be discovered that academic staff members with higher emotional intelligence, particularly in self-awareness, self-regulation, and internal motivation, may have greater confidence in their ability to produce high-quality research

and navigate the publication process effectively. As a result, they may have higher expectations of successfully publishing in Scopus-indexed journals.

Job satisfaction serve as a mediator variable in the current study. Job satisfaction was assessed through five dimensions: satisfaction with workload allocation, remuneration, career advancement opportunities, research support, and work conditions. Emotional intelligence may influence job satisfaction, as individuals with higher emotional intelligence may have better self-regulation and coping strategies, leading to higher satisfaction with the workload, remuneration, and work conditions. The expectancy-value theory suggests that job satisfaction can be crucial in the relationship between emotional intelligence and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. Job satisfaction can mediate the impact of emotional intelligence on persistence by influencing individuals' motivation and commitment to their work. When academic staff members are satisfied with their job, they are more likely to be intrinsically motivated, exhibit higher levels of persistence, and put in the necessary effort to publish in prestigious journals.

Persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals was the outcome variable in this study. It consisted of five dimensions: persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and handling delays. Each dimension of persistence is expected to be influenced by the corresponding dimensions of emotional intelligence and job satisfaction. For instance, academic staff members with higher self-awareness may be more persistent in manuscript preparation, as they can better identify their strengths and weaknesses in their research work. Higher satisfaction with workload allocation and research support may also contribute to greater persistence in manuscript preparation. Similarly, self-regulation and empathy may influence persistence in handling revisions, while satisfaction with career advancement opportunities and remuneration may influence persistence in manuscript submissions. The expectancy-value theory provides a comprehensive framework for understanding the motivational factors

influencing academic staff's persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. It highlights the importance of emotional intelligence in shaping individuals' expectations and beliefs about their ability to publish while recognizing the mediating role of job satisfaction in translating emotional intelligence into persistence. By examining the specific dimensions of emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and persistence, the study can provide a nuanced understanding of the factors that drive academic staff's success in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals.

2.3. Empirical review

This section presents a review of empirical literature related to the different aspects of this study. The section aims to identify what other researchers have done, their methods, contexts and findings. After that, key gaps arising from the studies reviewed were identified, and a discussion provided on how the present study addressed such gaps. Literature reviewed in this section was specifically those published between 2013 and 2023. The researcher decided to streamline the review to studies in the last decade to obtain a more recent view of the findings, debates, methods and tools that could be considered more contemporary. Various literature search strategies were used, including Boolean operators, to ensure that a large pool of materials is mined from electronic databases. For this study, the literature search was conducted using Google Scholar, PubMed and Semantic Scholar databases. These databases were used because they were free of subscription charges, and Google Scholar is particularly the world’s largest database containing scholarly documents in different languages (Gusenbauer, 2019; Owan, 2022). Thus, the empirical review of existing literature was based on the following sub-headings:

2.3.1. Self-awareness, job satisfaction and persistence to publish

A number of literature has focused on self-awareness as a component of emotional intelligence in the last decade, following Goleman's theory. Different dependent variables have been studied, with self-awareness as the antecedent. Studies have linked self-awareness to employees' job commitment (e.g., Mustafa, Nordin, Razzaq & bin Ibrahim, 2020; Vasudevan, 2013). There is a general agreement among the studies regarding the positive influence that self-awareness has on employee job commitment. For instance, Mustafa et al. (2020) conducted a study in Malaysia involving 264 vocational college teachers, where it was discovered that self-awareness positively influences vocational college teachers' job commitment. Similarly, Vasudevan (2013) conducted a study in Malaysia involving employees in private organisations. The study had a sample size of 300 participants. The research design was quantitative and predictive correlational. The author used simple and multiple linear regression to analyse the data. The study found that self-awareness has a significant positive influence on employees' work commitment and performance. Although these studies relate to the present research through self-awareness, their focus on job commitment and their context in Malaysia makes them different from the current study.

A growing body of literature has focused on the relationship between self-awareness and job satisfaction (Masrek, Osman, Khamis & Paiman, 2014; Mohamad & Jais, 2016; Mohammad et al., 2018; Seyal & Afzaal, 2013; Tabatabaei & Farazmehr, 2015; Tabiat, 2022; Varma & Singh, 2022; Yamani, Shahabi & Haghani, 2014). However, there are disagreements in the results of various studies regarding the role that self-awareness plays in the job satisfaction of different populations. Some studies have documented that self-awareness significantly predicts job satisfaction among university academic staff (Tabiat, 2022; Yamani et al., 2014) and Bank workers. However, some studies have shown, on the contrary, that self-awareness is inversely related to job satisfaction. In particular,

Seyal and Afzaal (2013) studied the relationship between both variables using a sample of 90 staff in a technical university. They discovered that self-awareness has a significant inverse relationship with job satisfaction. Similarly, Yamani et al. (2014) found that self-awareness had a significant inverse relationship with job satisfaction among faculty members in Iran. In addition to this, it has been reported by another study that self-awareness has a negative but insignificant correlation with present pay satisfaction (Tabatabaei & Farazmehr, 2015).

Furthermore, other studies have revealed that the relationship between self-awareness and job satisfaction is positively significant. For instance, Tabatabaei and Farazmehr (2015) studied a sample of 100 language institute teachers in Iran, following the Bar-on model. Using Pearson correlation analysis, the scholars discovered that self-Awareness has no significant correlation with general job satisfaction, present job satisfaction, supervision satisfaction, and co-worker satisfaction. Similarly, two other studies revealed a positive but insignificant relationship between self-awareness and job satisfaction among primary school teachers in India (Varma & Singh, 2022) and information technology professionals in Malaysia (Masrek et al., 2014). The literature review suggests an ongoing debate among the findings of different studies, creating an evidence gap. Therefore, further studies need to be conducted to examine the link between self-awareness and job satisfaction to contribute to the debate and better understand the situation across different contexts. The present study was conducted along these lines.

In terms of staff professional development, the role of self-awareness as a predictor has been established. For instance, Mustaffa, Nasir, Aziz and Mahmood (2013) conducted a study to determine how much self-awareness predicts secondary school counsellors' professional development. The quantitative correlational study adopted Goleman's emotional intelligence theory, relying on a self-reported questionnaire as the tool for data collection from 60 respondents in Malaysia. Pearson correlation analysis was performed,

and it was revealed that self-awareness has a moderate positive relationship with skills competency and a strong significant positive relationship with the personal development of counsellors. There is a relationship between the cited and present studies since both focused on job satisfaction. However, there are several discrepancies in the focus of the cited and present studies in that the cited focused on the professional development of counsellors in Malaysia. The present study focused on job satisfaction and persistence to publish among lecturers in Nigeria.

Another area that has sparked considerable attention in the literature in relation to self-awareness is teachers' job performance. There is a universal agreement among studies reviewed that self-awareness is a significant positive predictor of job performance across different populations. For instance, among primary and secondary school teachers, a significant impact of self-awareness on job performance has been documented by two previous studies in Sri Lanka (Marino et al., 2019; Vijitharan, Harikaran & Nanthagopa, 2019), Malaysia (Ismail et al., 2020) and Nigeria (Mohammed & Andow, 2019). Similarly, some studies on formal organisation employees have consistently shown that self-awareness significantly predicts employee job performance. For example, Chughtai and Lateef (2015) used data collected from 230 customer service employees in Pakistan. Through a multiple linear regression analysis, they discovered that self-awareness positively predicts employees' job performance. Using the same statistical approach, a study conducted by Gontur and Dekom (2017) used data from 240 local government workers in Nigeria. It documented that self-awareness positively and significantly predicted employees' performance.

Other studies were conducted in Kenya (Maloba & Wamwayi, 2021) and Nigeria (Joe-Akunne, Oguegbe & Okonkwo, 2015) using a sample of 218 senior staff of insurance companies and 237 local government employees, respectively, also reported that self-awareness significantly predicted employees' work performance and counterproductive

behaviours among employees. Moreover, Oyeboade (2016) discovered that self-awareness significantly and positively correlates with library workers' productivity in Nigeria. Despite the consistency in the results, only two previous studies were found to have focused on lecturers or academic staff as their population (Madani, Bamdad & Ghorbani, 2014; Oyeboade, 2016). This creates a population gap and suggests that the lecturer population has not received substantial attention in the literature, a reason why the current research focused on lecturers.

Nevertheless, the results of the two studies align with those of other studies focusing on other populations. For instance, the study of Madani et al. (2014) was conducted in Iran, using 230 university staff, where it was found that self-awareness significantly predicted the level of job involvement of university staff. Similarly, Asrar-ul-Haq, Anwar, and Hassan (2017) studied 166 university lecturers in Pakistan and found that emotional awareness has a significant positive relationship with teachers' job performance. The scholars recommended that future researchers consider other dependent variables and introduce the effect of any mediator variable. For this reason, the current study treated job satisfaction as the mediator in the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. No previous study has examined the tripartite relationships among these variables, creating a further knowledge gap that was addressed by the present study.

The literature review also revealed that self-awareness had been associated with employee self-efficacy. Specifically, two studies conducted in Iran have reported a significant positive relationship between self-awareness and self-efficacy among university teachers (Sarkhosh & Rezaee, 2014) and small trading employees (Ahmadi, 2014). The positive relationship suggests that increments in individuals' self-awareness are associated with increments in their self-efficacy. However, the literature on self-awareness and self-efficacy is not straightforward regarding the findings because some studies have

reported counter-findings to the positive and significant relationship reported above. In India, a quantitative study was conducted by Chikkanarti and Jattennavar (2018) following the Bar-on model and using 130 physical education teachers who answered a self-reported questionnaire. Results obtained from a Pearson correlation and multiple linear regression analyses revealed that self-awareness is an insignificant inverse predictor of self-efficacy in research. This result further differed from the one obtained by a Nigerian study, which found, among a sample of 279 polytechnic staff, that self-awareness does not have a significant relationship with employee performance. The review of the relationship between self-awareness and self-efficacy suggests three contending views. The contention among the three groups of studies has created an evidence gap, suggesting the need for further studies (such as the present one) to clarify the arguments and contribute to the advancement. Apart from the evidence gap, only one Nigerian study was observed in the debate, indicating the need for more Nigerian-based studies to clear the contextual gap.

Another important factor linked with employee self-awareness is career-related variables such as career performance, entrepreneurial career behaviour, and teachers' career advancement. For example, Ajayi (2020) studied a sample of 217 academic staff in public colleges of education in Nigeria. The study adopted the quantitative research method and correlational research design. Multiple linear regression analysis established that the relationship between self-awareness and career performance is significantly positive. Similarly, a study was conducted by Hejazi (2019) in Iran using the quantitative method and correlational design. The sample of the study comprised 400 secondary school teachers. A questionnaire was used for data collection, while Structural Equation Modelling (SEM) was used for data analysis. The study found a significant positive effect of self-awareness on teachers' career advancement.

Contrary to the results of other studies, research conducted by Othman and Muda (2018) in Malaysia, using a sample of 369 university students, discovered that self-

awareness has an insignificant negative prediction on entrepreneurial career behaviour. Further research is plausible since the results regarding the relationship between self-awareness and career variables are inconclusive. Although the present study did not address the gap (directly), it did so indirectly. It must be stated that the persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals is important in the career advancement of academics in many universities. Therefore, if self-awareness has some form of relationship (as documented by previous studies) with some career-related variables, then it will not be surprising if this study finds a relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

Studies on self-awareness and teachers' job effectiveness have also yielded mixed findings. Some studies have found that the relationship between self-awareness and teachers' job effectiveness is positive and significant. For example, Kanwal et al. (2018) found among a Pakistan population of 260 lecturers working at public universities that there is a significant relationship between self-awareness skills and teachers' effectiveness generally and in teaching and pedagogy, classroom management and relationship management. Similarly, Martin and Gracious (2019) discovered, through a mixed-methods study, that there is a significant relationship between self-awareness and teachers' effectiveness in India. However, contrary to these studies, an insignificant positive relationship between self-awareness and teachers' effectiveness has been documented. For instance, Shah, Saad, Mohan, and Poniran (2018) discovered that self-awareness does not significantly impact private university teachers' job effectiveness in Malaysia. Revealingly, it is very glaring that there is a disagreement in the literature on self-awareness and teachers' job effectiveness. The debate on the strength of the relationship between self-awareness and teachers' job effectiveness needs further clarification, placing a call for further research. Even though teachers' job effectiveness differed from the persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, the cited works laid the groundwork for

the current study which explored other teacher-related variables that were impacted by self-awareness.

Studies on employee work-family life have revealed contrasting evidence on self-awareness's role. In fact, Hosseini, Sayadi, Samimi and Darikandeh (2020) conducted a study in Iran, where it was discovered that self-awareness is significantly associated with the power structure in the family life of female schoolteachers. In disagreement, another study conducted in Jordan by Bakir (2018) revealed that self-awareness is a positive but insignificant predictor of employees' work-life balance. The variation in the results of both studies is understandable since the study of Hosseini et al. focused on the power structure in the family using a biased sample of female teachers. In contrast, Bakir focused on hospital employees' work-life balance regardless of sex. Nevertheless, no African study has assessed the relationship between self-awareness and work-family variables, particularly in Nigeria. This implies that further research, especially from Africa, was necessary to understand self-awareness's role in employees' work-family situations.

The literature review also featured how self-awareness predicts employee stress conditions. There is a general agreement among the studies reviewed that self-awareness has a significant inverse correlation with occupational stress among workers. To prove this point, Khaniyan, Foroughan, Hosseini and Biglarian (2013) found among 169 rehabilitation staff in training hospitals in Iran that self-awareness has a significant inverse correlation with occupational stress. Similarly, Easa (2021) discovered in Egypt that self-awareness has a significant negative prediction on workplace stress among nurses. The similarity in the results may be attributed to the fact that both studies focused on a medical population. No previous study was found to have examined the relationship between self-awareness and occupational stress among teachers as the population.

Regarding leadership styles, there is a general agreement that self-awareness is a significant predictor. Different studies on leadership styles or administrative behaviour

across contexts support a favourable connection between the variables. For example, Baba et al. (2021) found that self-awareness positively and significantly predicts transformational leadership among university lecturers in India. In Bangladesh, Biswas and Rahman (2021) discovered that self-awareness has a significant positive relationship with charismatic leadership among bankers. The study suggested that moderating or mediating variables can be considered to test this relationship. The current study addressed the gap by examining job satisfaction's role in the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. The demographic variables of lecturers, such as sex, education level and marital status, were further used to moderate the relationship. In another study, Wolle (2022) assessed the link between the two variables (self-awareness and leadership styles) in a sample of 137 university leaders. The results of a multiple linear regression model showed that self-awareness significantly predicts leaders' leadership effectiveness in universities. In a cross-sectional study conducted in Pakistan, Masood et al. (2015) discovered that self-awareness has a significant positive relationship with transformational leadership, communication patterns and job satisfaction among college principals. The only Nigerian study found was conducted by Adekunle and Oke (2022), where it was also discovered that the administrative effectiveness of heads of departments is positively and significantly linked to self-awareness.

A handful of studies in the literature have associated self-awareness with employees' innovative work behaviour (Shojaei & Siuki, 2014), burnout (Lee, 2018) and creativity (Ala'eddin, Nusairat, Abuhashesh, Rawashdeh & Al-Gasawneh, 2021). Specifically, Shojaei and Siuki (2014) used Goleman's theory and a quantitative correlational approach to assess the relationship between self-awareness and innovative work behaviours of 100 private bank managers in Iran. After collecting data through a questionnaire and analysing them using Pearson Correlation and regression analyses, it was discovered that self-awareness significantly predicted managers' innovative work

behaviour. In another development, Lee (2018) studied a sample of 167 public servants in the United States, using the lens of Golemans' theory and quantitative research methods. It was discovered that self-awareness positively and significantly predicted job satisfaction but negatively predicted burnout to an insignificant extent. Similarly, a study conducted in Jordan, using a questionnaire for data collection and based on a sample of 280 respondents, found through multiple linear and hierarchical regression analyses that self-awareness significantly predicted creativity among business entrepreneurs (Ala'eddin et al., 2021). These studies were all conducted outside Africa, and their results might not apply to Nigeria. Besides, even though the three studies had self-awareness as their predictor variable, which is the same as the current study, their outcome variables differed from that of the current study – persistence to publish. Moreover, no mediation effect was performed, whereas in the current study job satisfaction was the mediating variable.

The review of related studies further identified other outcome variables scantily used in relation to employees' self-awareness. These include knowledge sharing (Biwott, Limo & Maru, 2019), marital adjustment (Kalsoom & Kamal, 2018), suicidal behaviour (Okafor & Oyana, 2022) and conflict management (Elsayed et al., 2017). The study of Biwott et al. (2019) used social exchange theory to examine the association between self-regulation and knowledge-sharing behaviour. The quantitative study used a sample of 376 university academic staff, with the analysis performed using Pearson correlation and multiple regression statistics. The result revealed a significant positive effect of self-awareness on knowledge-sharing behaviour among university academic staff. In another study, Kalsoom and Kamal (2018) discovered that emotional self-awareness is a positive and significant predictor of marital adjustment, dyadic satisfaction and affectional expression among working married individuals. Other studies have shown that self-awareness is negatively and significantly related to suicidal behaviour among

undergraduates in Nigeria (Okafor & Oyana, 2022) and conflict management among academic staff in Egypt (Elsayed et al., 2017).

2.3.2. Self-regulation, job satisfaction and persistence to publish

Self-regulation is a key predictor that has attracted the attention of many previous studies that have linked it to different outcome variables across different times and contexts. A long list of previous studies has linked self-regulation to employee job performance (Chughtai & Lateef, 2015; Gontur & Dekom, 2017; Hanzaee & Mirvaisi, 2013; Ismail et al., 2020; Madani et al., 2014; Maloba & Wamwayi, 2021; Marino et al., 2019; Mohamad & Jais, 2016; Mohammed & Andow, 2019; Trad, Alayoubi, Abdul-Khalek & Khaddage-Soboh, 2022; Vijitharan et al., 2019). All the studies on the relationship between self-regulation and job performance found a significant positive relationship between the two variables. Among primary and secondary school teachers, a significant positive correlation has been documented between self-regulation and job performance in Sri Lanka (Marino et al., 2019; Vijitharan et al., 2019), Malaysia (Ismail et al., 2020; Mohamad & Jais, 2016), and Nigeria (Mohammed & Andow, 2019). Besides, a positive and significant relationship has been reported in other studies between self-regulation and job performance among customer service employees in Pakistan (Chughtai & Lateef, 2015), local government employees in Nigeria (Gontur & Dekom, 2017), hotel employees in Iran (Hanzaee & Mirvaisi, 2013) and senior staff of insurance companies in Kenya (Maloba & Wamwayi, 2021). Nevertheless, only two studies have assessed the link between self-regulation and job performance among university lecturers. Notably, there is an agreement between the two studies that self-regulation is a significant positive predictor of lecturers' job performance in Lebanon (Trad et al., 2022) and Iran (Madani et al., 2014), respectively. These studies are related to the present study due to their focus on self-regulation as an aspect of emotional intelligence. However, the outcome variable – job

performance- differed from persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. The present study seems to be the first study correlating self-regulation with lecturers' persistence to publish.

Despite this, previous studies have also associated self-regulation with teachers' job effectiveness and work behaviour. Specifically, there is an agreement among scholars that self-regulation has a significant relationship with teachers' teaching effectiveness. For example, in a quantitative correlational study conducted by Kanwal et al. (2018), 260 lecturers working at public universities in Pakistan were assessed. The researchers discovered a significant relationship between emotional self-regulation and teachers' effectiveness, both generally and in teaching and pedagogy, classroom management, and relationship management. In a mixed-method study by Martin and Gracious (2019) with 1000 high school teachers in India, it was established that a significant relationship exists between self-management and teachers' effectiveness. In another quantitative cross-sectional survey conducted by Shah et al. (2018) with 127 university teachers in Malaysia, it was found that self-regulation significantly impacted the job effectiveness of private university teachers. The study suggested that further research explore the impact of emotional intelligence on other factors, such as service quality, efficiency, or job performance. This call formed the basis for the present study, which linked self-regulation to lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

There are also consistent results obtained by studies linking self-regulation to employee work behaviours. Another quantitative correlational study by Shojaei and Siuki (2014) in Iran revealed that self-management significantly predicted managers' innovative work behaviour. Similarly, Joe-Akunne et al. (2015) discovered that self-control significantly predicted counterproductive behaviours among local government employees. These two studies collectively demonstrate the predictive power of emotional intelligence, particularly self-management and self-control, in different professional contexts.

However, none of the two studies focused on persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals as an outcome variable. In the previous studies, the outcomes of interest were teachers' effectiveness, managers' innovative work behaviour, and employees' counterproductive behaviours. In the current study, the outcome of interest is the persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, incorporating job satisfaction as a mediator. This has added an extra layer of understanding to the relationship between emotional intelligence and persistence to publish.

The relationship between self-regulation and job satisfaction has been a topic of interest among scholars, but the results across different studies are mixed. To illustrate this, various Asian studies have found a significant positive predictive relationship between self-regulation and job satisfaction among secondary school teachers in Malaysia (Mohamad & Jais, 2016), staff of a technical university in Brunei Darussalam (Seyal & Afzaal, 2013), bank workers in Pakistan (Mohammad et al., 2018) and academic staff in universities in Lebanon (Tabiat, 2022). In contrast, a study has shown that the relationship between self-regulation and job satisfaction generally and in specific areas such as: satisfaction with supervisors, upgrades and salaries, nature of work and colleagues is positive but statistically insignificant in Iran (Hamidi & Amiri, 2013). Moreover, other studies differed in their results, showing a significant inverse relationship between self-regulation and job satisfaction (Masrek et al., 2014; Yamani et al., 2014). The varying results across these studies indicate an inconclusive debate regarding the relationship between self-regulation and job satisfaction, necessitating further research across different contexts. Notably, the existing literature on self-regulation and job satisfaction has primarily focused on Asian countries, with limited attention given to countries in Africa, Europe, America, and Australia. Therefore, there is a need for more studies in these underrepresented regions to contribute to the debate. While previous research has explored the relationship between self-regulation and job satisfaction, there is a lack of empirical

evidence, specifically within the Nigerian academic setting. The current study addressed this evidence gap by focusing on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, with job satisfaction as the mediating variable in the Nigerian context.

Related studies have also explored the relationship between self-regulation and career-related outcomes, particularly in the context of academic staff, secondary school teachers, and university students. These studies shed light on how self-regulation influences career performance (Ajayi, 2020), career advancement (Hejazi, 2019) and entrepreneurship career behaviour (Othman & Muda, 2018). Specifically, Ajayi (2020) conducted a study among academic staff in public colleges of education in Nigeria and found a significant correlation between self-management and career performance. Hejazi (2019) focused on secondary school teachers in Iran and employed structural equation modelling to examine the impact of self-management on teachers' career advancement. The study revealed a significant positive effect, indicating that self-management is crucial in fostering teachers' career progression and professional growth. Othman and Muda (2018) investigated the relationship between self-regulation, specifically emotion management, and entrepreneurial career behaviour among public university students in Malaysia. Their findings indicated a significant positive prediction, suggesting that effective emotion management skills can contribute to developing entrepreneurial behaviour and mindset among students. These studies contribute to understanding how self-regulation influences career-related outcomes in various educational contexts. However, it is important to note that these studies were conducted in different cultural and educational settings, such as Nigeria, Iran, and Malaysia. Therefore, contextual differences may influence the relationship between self-regulation and career outcomes. Therefore, the present study further contributed to the existing body of knowledge by examining this

relationship within the context of the University of Calabar, Nigeria, thereby, contributing to the contextual diversity in the literature.

The existing studies have explored the relationship between self-regulation and various aspects of individuals' lives within different contexts. For instance, a study conducted in Iran by Hosseini et al. (2020) revealed a significant association between self-management and power structure in the family life of female schoolteachers. Similarly, Kappagoda (2013b) found an inverse relationship between self-management and work-family conflict among schoolteachers in Sri Lanka. In a Nigerian context, Awosusi, Olusesi and Zakariya (2020) identified a significant relationship between work-life balance and self-regulation among university staff. However, Bakir's (2018) study on hospital employees in Jordan showed an inverse but insignificant relationship between self-management and employees' work-life balance. These findings demonstrate the diverse outcomes and context-dependent nature of the relationship between self-regulation and different aspects of individuals' lives. The reviewed studies exhibited inconsistent findings regarding the relationship between self-regulation and outcomes such as power structure, work-family conflict, and work-life balance. This evidence gap highlights the need for further research to clarify and understand these associations. To address this gap, the current study explored the mediating role of job satisfaction in the relationship between self-regulation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

In another development, previous studies have yielded mixed results regarding the relationship between self-regulation and creativity. While the study by Al-Tarawneh, Battah and Al-Tarawneh (2018) found a significant positive relationship between self-regulation and administrative creativity among teachers and principals in Pakistan, the study conducted by Ala'eddin et al. (2021) with business entrepreneurs in Jordan did not find a significant prediction of self-regulation on creativity. Additionally, the study by Nosike et al. (2022) with secondary school teachers in Nigeria demonstrated a positive and

statistically significant correlation between self-control and teachers' creativity in Anambra State. These findings highlight the need for further research to understand better the relationship between self-regulation and creativity, particularly in different contexts and populations.

The literature review also showed that previous studies had provided insights into the relationship between self-regulation and various leadership and administrative outcomes across different contexts. For instance, Biswas and Rahman (2021) found a significant relationship between self-regulation and charismatic leadership among bankers in Bangladesh, suggesting the potential for further exploration of moderating or mediating variables. Wolle (2022) demonstrated that self-management is a significant positive predictor of leaders' effectiveness in universities in Ethiopia. Adekunle and Oke (2022) found a significant positive correlation between self-management and the administrative effectiveness of Heads of Departments in Nigerian polytechnics. In contrast, Laborde et al. (2020) found that the regulation of emotions had no significant relationship with human talent management and other personnel-related factors among university professors in Ecuador. Masood et al. (2015) found that emotional management was significantly correlated with transformational leadership, communication patterns, and job satisfaction among college principals in Pakistan. Elsayed et al. (2017) found a significant relationship between self-regulation and conflict management practice among academic staff in Egypt. These studies collectively highlight the importance of self-regulation in various leadership and administrative contexts. However, there are variations in the findings, suggesting the need for further research to understand better the underlying mechanisms and contextual factors that influence these relationships. The current study has contributed to filling these gaps by examining how self-regulation relates to persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals and how job satisfaction mediates this relationship.

The literature has also featured variables such as career adaptability and job commitment as self-regulation outcomes. For example, Sony and Mekoth (2016) conducted a study with frontline employees in the power sector in India. Using Wong and Law's theoretical framework, they found that emotion regulation was a significant positive predictor of frontline employee adaptability. Similarly, Pong and Leung (2023) focused on university students in China and investigated the relationship between self-regulation and career adaptability. Their study, also based on Wong and Law's framework, revealed that students who demonstrated better proficiency in managing and regulating their emotions displayed elevated levels of career adaptability across various aspects. These two students-based findings are aligned despite the different populations and contexts. However, no study in Nigeria, particularly in Cross River State, has been conducted to examine the link between self-regulation and career adaptability, creating a knowledge gap. Secondly, the population of university lecturers has not also been considered by previous studies in discussing the relationship between self-regulation and career adaptability, creating a population gap. The current addressed this related gap by focusing on lecturers in the University of Calabar, Cross River State, Nigeria. By including this specific population, the study has provided a unique perspective on how self-regulation relates to their persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, which is a form of career adaptability since it is a new normal to publish in such journals or perish, within the context (Owan & Asuquo, 2022).

Regarding job commitment, Aigbodion and Uye (2022) conducted research among university staff in Nigeria, examining the relationship between self-control and time management behaviour. Their study, utilising a predictive correlational design, found that self-control significantly predicted the time management behaviour of university staff. In Vasudevan's study (2013) involving employees in private organisations in Malaysia, the researcher focused on the impact of self-management on work commitment and

performance. Their study, based on Goleman's Emotional Intelligence Theory, demonstrated a significant positive impact of self-management on employees' work commitment and performance. These studies collectively contribute to understanding self-regulation's influence on outcomes such as: time management behaviour, work commitment, and performance. They highlight the importance of self-regulation in enhancing students' career readiness and staff members' time management skills, ultimately influencing their overall job commitment and performance levels.

Other response variables that self-regulation has been linked to include: personality traits (Kappagoda, 2013a), psychological needs (Spehrianazar, Ghasemi, Carvalho, Branquinho, Molina & de Matos, 2017), life satisfaction (Anjum, Shoukat, Muazzam & Ejaz, 2020), burnout (Fiorilli, Benevene, Stasio, Buonomo, Romano, Pepe & Addimando, 2019; Lee, 2018) and self-efficacy (Ahmadi, 2014). Kappagoda's study (2013a) with English teachers in Sri Lanka found positive and significant relationships between self-management and extraversion, agreeableness, and openness to experience. However, the study also found positive but insignificant relationships between self-management, conscientiousness, and neuroticism. Spehrianazar et al. (2017) conducted a study with primary and secondary school teachers in Iran, indicating a weak positive relationship between impulse control and psychological needs, generally and specifically, autonomy, competence, and relatedness. Anjum et al. (2020) conducted a study with special education teachers in Pakistan and reported a moderate-positive significant relationship between emotional self-awareness and special education teachers' life satisfaction. Lee (2018) found that emotion regulation positively and insignificantly predicted job satisfaction but negatively predicted burnout to a significant extent. The study conducted by Fiorilli et al. (2019) revealed a high level of trait emotional intelligence among teachers. It was discovered that self-control was associated with low burnout levels across personal, work-related, and student-related domains. Ahmadi (2014) found a positive and statistically

significant association between self-regulation and self-efficacy. While these studies explored emotional intelligence and its impact on various professional outcomes, they differ regarding the specific variables examined, the populations studied, and the research methods employed. However, they collectively contribute to understanding emotional intelligence's role in different professional contexts, providing a foundation for the current study on self-regulation, persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, and job satisfaction mediation.

Further review of the literature revealed that employee self-regulation had been studied as a predictor of job motivation (Hassanzadeh & Babaei, 2014), change management (Dhingra & Punia, 2016), knowledge-sharing (Biwott et al., 2019), marital adjustment (Kalsoom & Kamal, 2018), suicidal behaviour (Okafor & Oyana, 2022) and work productivity (Oyeboade, 2016). Specifically, Hassanzadeh and Babaei (2014) found an insignificant inverse relationship between self-management and job motivation, both overall and across specific aspects such as: the amount of work, concentration, enjoyment, development, and volunteering. Additionally, the study found a significant inverse relationship between self-management and effort but an insignificant positive correlation with intention. Dhingra and Punia (2016) revealed a significant positive relationship between self-management and change management. Biwott et al. (2019) discovered that self-awareness had a significant positive effect on knowledge-sharing behaviour among university academic staff. The findings of Kalsoom and Kamal (2018) indicated that self-regulation had a significant positive prediction on marital adjustment, dyadic consensus, and dyadic satisfaction. Okafor and Oyana (2022) reported a weak direct association between self-regulation and the students' suicidal behaviours. Oyeboade (2016) conducted a study with library personnel in Nigeria using Goleman's Emotional Intelligence Theory. The study revealed a positive correlation between self-management and library work productivity, although the correlation was relatively weak. These studies collectively

contribute to understanding emotional intelligence's role in different professional contexts. The current study, focusing on self-regulation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, with job satisfaction as a mediator, builds upon this existing knowledge in the literature.

2.3.3. Social awareness, job satisfaction and persistence to publish

The review of extant literature reveals that different outcome variables have been linked to social awareness as a component of emotional intelligence under Goleman's framework. These outcome variables include job commitment, job satisfaction, personal development, job performance, work behaviours, psychological needs, personality traits, general health, self-efficacy, career performance, job effectiveness, job motivation, work-family variables, organisational citizenship behaviour, change management, creativity, stress, leadership behaviour, burnout and work productivity.

Social awareness and job commitment studies agree that the predictor positively relates to the outcome variable. For instance, Mustafa et al. (2020) studied a sample of 264 vocational college Teachers in Malaysia, adopting the quantitative correlational research method. The results from a structural equation modelling revealed that social awareness influences teachers' commitment to the organisation. Similarly, Vasudevan (2013) adopted the predictive correlational approach to examine the relationship between social awareness and job commitment through Goleman's Emotional Intelligence Theory. It was discovered that social awareness significantly and positively affects employees' work commitment and performance. Despite the agreement in the results of both studies, there is a need for similar studies to be conducted in other contexts. The two cited studies were conducted in Malaysia, which may have been the reason for the agreement in the findings.

Several studies have examined the relationship between social awareness and job satisfaction among professional groups. However, the findings of studies investigating the

relationship between emotional intelligence and job satisfaction vary, leading to some disagreements. Some studies reported significant positive relationships between social skills, social responsibility and social awareness, with job satisfaction. For instance, some studies have documented a significant positive relationship between social skills and job satisfaction among secondary school teachers in Malaysia (Mohamad & Jais, 2016), bank workers in Pakistan (Mohammad et al., 2018) and academic staff in Lebanese universities (Tabiat, 2022). Similarly, Tabatabaei and Farazmehr (2015) discovered a positive relationship between social responsibility and job satisfaction among language institute teachers in Iran. Varma and Singh (2022) found that social competence predicted job satisfaction among primary school instructors in India, and Masrek et al. (2014) reported a positive relationship between social awareness and job satisfaction among information technology professionals in Malaysia. However, Hamidi and Amiri (2013) revealed mixed results, with social intelligence showing some positive correlations with job satisfaction dimensions but an insignificant relationship among high school teachers in Iran. These inconsistent findings highlighted the need for further research to understand the relationship between social awareness and job satisfaction. In this context, the current study investigated the relationship between social awareness and job satisfaction among university lecturers in Nigeria and the mediating role of job satisfaction in the link between social awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. Furthermore, the study explored the moderating effects of demographic variables on the relationship between social awareness, job satisfaction, and persistence to publish. This integrated approach has contributed to bridging gaps in the existing literature and advancing knowledge in the field.

The literature provides several studies exploring the relationship between emotional intelligence, specifically social skills and social awareness, and job performance among different populations and occupational contexts. Trad et al. (2022) investigated

teachers in private higher institutions in Lebanon and found that social skills positively and significantly influenced teacher performance. Similarly, Marino et al. (2019) examined primary and secondary school teachers in Sri Lanka and reported that social skills significantly impacted teachers' job performance in these schools. Gontur and Dekom (2017) studied local government employees in Nigeria and found a positive and significant predictor of social awareness on employees' performance. Moreover, Chughtai and Lateef (2015) focused on customer service employees in Pakistan and revealed that social awareness positively predicted employees' job performance. Ismail et al. (2020) researched vocational teachers in Malaysia and discovered that social skills had a significant relationship with work performance, indicating the importance of emotional intelligence in vocational teaching contexts. Madani, Bamdad, and Ghorbani (2014) examined university staff in Iran and found that social awareness significantly predicted job involvement, emphasising the role of emotional intelligence in academic settings.

However, while these studies shed light on the positive impact of social skills and social awareness on job performance in various professions and countries, there are still some gaps in the literature. One evident gap is the lack of research on the mediating or moderating factors that may explain the specific mechanisms through which emotional intelligence affects job performance. Additionally, there is limited research exploring the impact of emotional intelligence on job performance in specific geographic regions or sectors, which may yield important viewpoints into cultural and contextual differences. The present study addressed these gaps by providing insights into emotional intelligence's role in the academic setting. Furthermore, by investigating the mediating role of job satisfaction and the potential moderating effects of demographic variables, the study has contributed to a deeper understanding of the underlying processes that link emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and academic performance (in this case, persistence to publish).

In the literature, self-efficacy and job effectiveness have been examined as key variables in relation to social awareness across different populations. However, studies on self-efficacy are misaligned regarding the role of social awareness as a predictor. For instance, Ahmadi (2014) researched 254 employees of a small trading company in Iran. The findings revealed a significant and positive correlation between social skills and self-efficacy, suggesting that individuals with higher social skills also demonstrated higher levels of self-efficacy. However, in another study by Chikkanarti and Jattennavar (2018) involving 130 physical education teachers in India, the researchers found a non-significant negative prediction of self-efficacy concerning social responsibility. Among the two studies on teachers' job effectiveness, there are also disagreements in the results obtained. Shah et al. (2018) investigated the impact of social awareness on job effectiveness among 127 university teachers in Malaysia. Through multiple linear regression analysis, the researchers found that social awareness did not significantly impact job effectiveness among private university teachers. In contrast, Martin and Gracious (2019) conducted a study involving 1000 high school teachers in India. The researchers revealed a significant relationship between social skills and teacher effectiveness, indicating that higher levels of social skills were associated with increased effectiveness in the teaching profession. These inconsistent results underscore the importance of conducting research that explores the role of social awareness as a predictor of self-efficacy across diverse contexts and populations. Thus, the present study filled a population gap by focusing on this specific group. Moreover, by exploring the mediating role of job satisfaction and the moderating effects of demographic variables, the present study addressed gaps in the evidence regarding the mechanisms and contextual factors influencing this relationship.

The existing body of literature encompasses diverse studies investigating the nexus between emotional intelligence, particularly social skills and social awareness, and leadership effectiveness across various professional domains and countries. Alsalminy and

Baxodirovna (2023) conducted a qualitative case study on leaders of industrial companies in Iraq and emphasised the pivotal role of relationship management in facilitating effective organisational oversight by leaders. They underscored the importance of expanding future research horizons by exploring additional facets of emotional intelligence, social/soft skills, and leadership to advance understanding in this domain. Biswas and Rahman (2021) undertook an exploratory correlational study to examine the relationship between social skills and charismatic leadership among bankers in Bangladesh. Their findings revealed a statistically significant positive association between social skills and charismatic leadership. They recommended that future research endeavours incorporate moderating or mediating variables to elucidate this relationship's complexities further. They suggested the inclusion of larger sample sizes to enhance the generalizability of research outcomes.

Elsayed et al. (2017) investigated the relationship between social skills and conflict management practices among academic staff in Egypt. Their study established a significant correlation between social skills and the level of conflict management practices employed by academic staff. Wolle (2022) examined the leadership effectiveness of university leaders in Ethiopia and found that although social awareness demonstrated a positive association with leadership effectiveness, it did not emerge as a statistically significant predictor. This study prompts further exploration into the underlying factors that may influence the impact of social awareness on leadership effectiveness within university settings. Adekunle and Oke (2022) investigated the administrative effectiveness of heads of departments in Nigerian polytechnics and unveiled a significant positive influence of social awareness on administrative effectiveness. This study underscores the relevance of emotional intelligence, particularly social awareness, in enhancing administrative performance.

While these studies have contributed thoughtful analyses, notable gaps persist within the literature. One such gap pertains to the need for comprehensive research that

encompasses additional dimensions of emotional intelligence and social skills in relation to leadership effectiveness. Moreover, there is a dearth of studies exploring potential mediating or moderating factors that could influence the association between emotional intelligence and leadership effectiveness. The current addressed these gaps by investigating potential mediating factors or alternative emotional intelligence components.

Other studies have examined the relationship between social awareness, work-family-related variables, and employee occupational stress. In a study conducted by Kappagoda (2013b) among 325 schoolteachers in Sri Lanka, it was found that social awareness is significantly inversely correlated with work-family conflict, indicating that higher levels of social awareness are associated with lower work-family conflict. Similarly, Bakir (2018) examined hospital employees in Jordan and found that social skills significantly predict employees' work-life balance. This suggests that individuals with better social skills are more likely to balance work and personal life better. Among rehabilitation staff in training hospitals in Iran, Khaniyan et al. (2013) found that social skills negatively and significantly predict occupational stress, suggesting that higher levels of social skills are associated with lower stress levels in this professional context. Similarly, Easa (2021) conducted a study on nurses in Egypt and found that social awareness has a significant negative prediction on workplace stress, indicating that nurses with higher social-awareness experience lower stress levels in the workplace. While these studies provide important findings, there is still a lack of comprehensive understanding of the specific mechanisms and contextual factors involved in these relationships.

Several studies have examined the relationship between social awareness and various outcomes among different professional groups. Mustaffa et al. (2013) conducted a study with 60 secondary school counsellors in Malaysia. They found a moderate positive relationship between social skills and skills competency and a strong significant positive relationship with personal development. Shojaei and Siuki (2014) focused on managers of

private bank branches (n = 100) in Iran and discovered that social awareness significantly predicted managers' innovative work behaviour. In a study by Kappagoda (2013a) with 470 English teachers in Sri Lanka, social awareness was positively and significantly related to extraversion and openness to experience. However, the relationship with agreeableness, conscientiousness, and neuroticism was positive but insignificant. Spehrianazar et al. (2017) examined primary and secondary school teachers (n = 365) in Iran. They found that social responsibility had a weak, positive relationship with psychological needs such as autonomy, competence, and relatedness. Kia and Heidari (2014) conducted a study with 70 teachers in Tajikistan and Iran. They found a significant positive correlation between social awareness and teachers' general health, including physical symptoms, anxiety and insomnia, social disorder, and severe depression. These studies contribute to understanding the relationship between social awareness and various outcomes in different professional contexts. However, there are still gaps to be addressed. Future research could explore potential mediators and moderators of the relationship, as Kappagoda (2013a) and Spehrianazar et al. (2017) suggested.

Additionally, conducting similar studies in different geographic regions and cultures, as recommended by Spehrianazar et al. (2017), can provide a broader perspective on the factors influencing the relationship between social awareness and outcomes. This current study examined the relationship between social awareness and persistence to publish among university lecturers in Nigeria, and explored how job satisfaction mediated the relationship with the moderating effects of demographic variables on this relationship. These aspects align with suggestions from previous studies (Kappagoda, 2013b; Spehrianazar et al., 2017).

Different studies have also explored the association between social awareness and different outcomes across diverse professional domains. For example, Ajayi (2020) examined academic staff in public colleges of education in Nigeria and uncovered a

noteworthy positive correlation between self-management and career performance. In contrast, Hassanzadeh and Babaei Kafaki (2014) focused on high school teachers in Iran. They revealed that while social awareness showed no significant positive relationship with overall job motivation, it had a notable positive association with specific aspects of motivation such as workload, effort, and willingness to volunteer. Hanzaee and Mirvaisi (2013) found an intriguing inverse relationship between social awareness and organisational citizenship behaviour (OCB) and job satisfaction in Iran's hospitality industry. Dhingra and Punia (2016) discovered a significant positive relationship by shifting the focus to manufacturing and service organisations in India.

In the realm of entrepreneurship, Ala'eddin et al. (2021) examined business entrepreneurs in Jordan and observed that social awareness significantly and positively predicted creativity. These studies offer diverse perspectives on the relationship between social awareness and various outcomes in different professional contexts. However, there is a gap in the context of the research. While studies have examined the relationship between social awareness and various outcomes in different countries such as: Malaysia, Iran, India, and Jordan, there is a lack of research in the context of Nigeria, specifically among university lecturers. Most studies have focused on professional groups such as secondary school teachers, high school teachers, hotel employees, manufacturing and service organisation employees, and business entrepreneurs. However, there is a lack of research specifically targeting university lecturers. The current study addressed these contextual and population gaps by focusing on university lecturers in Nigeria, thereby, providing valuable perspectives into the factors influencing their job satisfaction and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

Furthermore, the existing literature provides information on the relationship between social awareness and its impact on various outcomes. For instance, Yadav and Lata (2019) conducted a study with 50 teachers in India to explore the correlation between

social awareness and emotional intelligence. Surprisingly, their findings revealed no statistically significant correlation between social awareness and emotional intelligence in this sample. In another study by Fiorilli et al. (2019) involving 318 in-service Italian teachers, the results demonstrated that teachers with higher levels of trait emotional intelligence, including sociability, experienced lower levels of burnout. This finding suggests that social awareness is crucial in mitigating burnout among teachers. Turning our attention to Nigeria, Oyeboade (2016) conducted research among 186 library personnel to examine the impact of social awareness on work productivity. The study found a significant positive correlation between social awareness and library workers' productivity. This indicates that higher levels of social awareness were associated with increased productivity in this specific professional context. These studies highlight the diverse findings regarding the relationship between social awareness and its outcomes. While Yadav and Lata (2019) did not find a significant correlation, Fiorilli et al. (2019) and Oyeboade (2016) revealed meaningful associations between social awareness and burnout levels or work productivity, respectively. However, it is important to note that the sample sizes in these studies varied, ranging from 50 to 318 participants. Therefore, conducting further research with a larger sample size and considering Nigerian university lecturers can help fill the existing research gaps.

2.3.4. Internal motivation, job satisfaction and persistence to publish

Internal motivation or self-motivation is a dimension of emotional intelligence that has been extensively researched in the last decade. Scholars have linked internal motivation to various predictors, mediators, outcomes or moderators. These variables popularly linked to internal motivation include job satisfaction, personal development, job performance, general health, self-efficacy, job effectiveness, creativity, work behaviours, stress, leadership effectiveness, emotional intelligence and remuneration.

Several studies have investigated the relationship between emotional intelligence and job satisfaction, revealing varying results across professional groups. For instance, Mohamad and Jais (2016) examined the relationship between self-motivation and job satisfaction among secondary school teachers in Malaysia and found a significant positive association between these variables. Similarly, Mohammad et al. (2018) conducted a study with bank workers in Pakistan and discovered a moderately positive and significant relationship between self-motivation and job satisfaction. Furthermore, Tabiat (2022) explored the relationship between self-motivation and job satisfaction among academic staff in Lebanese universities and found self-motivation to be a significant positive predictor of job satisfaction. These findings highlight the importance of self-motivation in influencing job satisfaction outcomes across different professional settings. In contrast, Hamidi and Amiri (2013) observed mixed results, notably, a positive but insignificant association between self-motivation and overall job satisfaction. However, the relationship between self-motivation and specific dimensions of job satisfaction, such as satisfaction with the nature of work, colleagues, upgrade, and salary, was positive but insignificant. Interestingly, they found a negative but insignificant relationship between self-motivation and job satisfaction with supervisors.

Numerous studies have examined how self-motivation relates to personal development in different professional groups. Mustaffa et al. (2013) conducted a quantitative correlational study involving secondary school counsellors in Malaysia. They found that self-motivation had a moderate positive correlation with skills competency and a strong and significant positive correlation with personal development. Similarly, Sharma and Yadav (2014) conducted a quantitative correlational study with public secondary school teachers in India. Their results also showed a moderate positive relationship between self-motivation and professional development among teachers in secondary schools. The consistent findings across these studies underscore the significance of self-

motivation in fostering skill enhancement and personal growth in education. Given the consistent results, the present study on the relationship between internal motivation, job satisfaction, and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals among University of Calabar lecturers in Cross River State, Nigeria, expanded on this existing knowledge.

Different studies have consistently shown significant associations between internal motivation and job performance. For example, Ringelhan, Wollersheim, Welpe, Fiedler, and Spörrle (2013) discovered that intrinsic work motivation is directly connected to job satisfaction and research performance for doctoral students and postdoctoral junior faculty members. In Malaysia, Mohamad and Jais (2016) identified a significant relationship between self-motivation and job performance among secondary school teachers. Similarly, Marino et al. (2019) observed a significant influence of self-motivation on job performance among primary and secondary school teachers in Sri Lanka. Moreover, Vijitharan et al. (2019) found a significant impact of self-motivation on job performance among primary and secondary school teachers in the Jaffna Zone of Sri Lanka. The significance of the relationship between motivation and work performance was also evident in another survey of vocational teachers in Malaysia (Ismail et al., 2020). Trad et al. (2022) further reinforced these findings by demonstrating the significant positive effect of internal motivation on job performance among teachers in private higher institutions in Lebanon. These consistent results emphasize the crucial role of self-motivation in influencing job performance across various professional contexts.

Several studies have explored the relationship between self-motivation and job effectiveness, yielding varied findings. For instance, Shah et al. (2018) conducted a study with university teachers in Malaysia. They found that self-motivation did not significantly impact job effectiveness among private university teachers. However, they suggested that future research could investigate the influence of emotional intelligence on other factors, such as service quality, efficiency, or job performance. In contrast, Martin and Gracious

(2019) conducted a mixed-method study with high school teachers in India and identified a significant relationship between self-motivation and teachers' effectiveness. Similarly, Öznacar, Yilmaz, and Güven (2017) examined elementary school teachers in Turkey and discovered a noteworthy positive correlation between teachers' emotional intelligence and their teaching styles across various sub-scales. These studies highlight the complex relationship between self-motivation and job effectiveness, with some studies reporting significant associations while others show no significant effects. The discrepancies in findings could be attributed to various factors such as sample characteristics, measurement tools, and contextual differences. Given the mixed findings in the existing literature, there is an evidence gap, suggesting that further studies are needed for clarification.

Studies investigating the relationship between self-motivation and creativity have shown consistent findings. Al-Tarawneh et al. (2018) found that motivation had a significant positive relationship with administrative creativity in Pakistan. This relationship was observed across various dimensions, including originality, volubility/flexibility, improvement of managerial operations, and educational outcomes. Similarly, Ala'eddin et al. (2021) examined business entrepreneurs in Jordan and found that self-motivation significantly predicted employee creativity. Another study by Fidan and Oztürk (2015) focused on teachers working in different educational settings in Turkey. They found that intrinsic motivation was positively related to teacher creativity. The consistent findings from previous studies regarding the positive association between self-motivation and creativity in different contexts, such as education and business, provide a strong foundation for further exploration. Building upon this knowledge, the present study investigated the relationship between internal motivation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals among University of Calabar lecturers in Cross River State, Nigeria.

The studies investigating the relationship between self-motivation and leadership offer notable analyses into the impact of emotional intelligence on leadership effectiveness. While there are variations in the findings, certain consistent patterns can be identified. Biswas and Rahman (2021) conducted a study with bankers in Bangladesh and discovered a significant and positive correlation between motivation and charismatic leadership. They suggested exploring moderating or mediating variables to examine the relationship further and stressed the importance of larger sample sizes for generalizability. Likewise, Baba et al. (2021) revealed a positive and significant prediction, indicating that self-motivation contributes to the display of transformational leadership behaviours. Another study by Elsayed, Elsayed, and Hamed (2017) focused on academic staff in Egypt and discovered a significant relationship, suggesting that motivation plays a role in the level of conflict management exhibited by academic staff. However, Laborde et al. (2020) conducted a study on university professors in Ecuador. They found no significant relationship between motivation and various aspects of human talent management, including personnel selection, training and development, maintenance, and performance measurement. This discrepancy suggests that the impact of motivation on these specific aspects of leadership may vary across different contexts or populations. The current research has contributed to this body of knowledge by exploring the mediating role of job satisfaction and the moderating effects of demographic variables in the relationship between internal motivation and publication persistence among University of Calabar lecturers in Cross River State, Nigeria.

Several studies have explored the relationship between internal motivation as a component of emotional intelligence and various outcomes in different domains. For instance, in a study by Yadav and Lata (2019) conducted among teachers in India, a statistically significant positive correlation was found between motivation and emotional intelligence. This suggests that highly motivated individuals have higher levels of

emotional intelligence. Remuneration, or the financial compensation received for work, has also been investigated in relation to self-motivation. Branscum, Haider, Brown, and Sharma (2016) revealed that self-motivation and managing relationships were significant predictors of receiving merit pay increases. Work behaviours, including counterproductive behaviours, have also been associated with self-motivation. For instance, Joe-Akunne et al. (2015) revealed through hierarchical multiple regression analysis that self-motivation significantly predicted counterproductive behaviours. In the context of stress, Khaniyan et al. (2013) discovered an inverse but insignificant relationship between motivation and occupational stress among rehabilitation staff. Although the relationship was not statistically significant, the inverse direction suggests that higher motivation levels may be associated with lower levels of occupational stress among rehabilitation staff. The findings suggest that self-motivation plays a significant role in these domains, influencing individuals' emotional intelligence, financial rewards, work behaviours, and stress levels.

Previous studies have explored the impact of self-motivation on various factors such as leadership, remuneration, work behaviours, stress, general health, and self-efficacy. For instance, Kia and Heidari (2014) conducted a descriptive correlational study among teachers in Tajikistan and Iran using Goleman's Emotional Intelligence Theory. They found that self-motivation had no significant relationship with the general health of teachers, including specific areas such as physical symptoms, anxiety and insomnia, social disorder, and severe depression. Regarding self-efficacy, Ahmadi (2014) investigated small trading company employees in Iran. The study revealed a significant and positive correlation between motivation and self-efficacy. Klaeijsen, Vermeulen, and Martens (2017) also examined the relationship between basic psychological need satisfaction, intrinsic motivation, and occupational self-efficacy among teachers in the Netherlands using Self-Determination Theory. Their study, conducted through a quantitative survey and employing Structural Equation Modeling, found that basic psychological need

satisfaction influenced intrinsic motivation and occupational self-efficacy. Despite these findings, further exploration is needed to understand the specific impact of self-motivation on general health and self-efficacy in different contexts and populations. Therefore, this study investigated the relationship between self-motivation and the persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals among University of Calabar lecturers in Cross River State, Nigeria. By focusing on this specific context, the study filled some key gaps existing in the literature and has contributed to the understanding of the effects of self-motivation on these important outcomes.

2.3.5. Empathy, job satisfaction and persistence to publish

In the past decade, research has established a connection between empathy, as a component of emotional intelligence, and various variables, considering them as antecedents, consequences, moderators, or mediators. These variables include personal development, work behaviour, self-efficacy, job satisfaction, psychological needs, leadership behaviour, creativity, job performance, mental health, stress, emotional intelligence, teachers' effectiveness, burnout, job commitment and work-family factors.

The studies conducted on personal development, with a focus on empathy as a component of emotional intelligence, have revealed valued considerations. Mustaffa et al. (2013) examined the relationship between empathy and personal development among secondary school counselors in Malaysia. Their quantitative correlational study with 60 participants found that empathy has a moderate positive relationship with skills competency and a strong significant positive relationship with personal development. Similarly, Sharma and Yadav (2014) investigated empathy's impact on professional development among public secondary school teachers in India. The study involved 600 teachers and employed Pearson correlation analysis. They found a moderate positive relationship between empathy and teachers' professional development. In Iran, Hejazi

(2019) explored empathy's direct effect on teachers' career advancement among secondary school teachers.

Through a quantitative correlational study with 400 participants and Structural Equation Modeling, the research revealed a significant positive effect of empathy on teachers' career advancement. On the other hand, Othman and Muda (2018) conducted a predictive correlational study with 369 public university students in Malaysia. They used multiple linear regression to explore empathy's prediction on entrepreneurial career behaviour. Surprisingly, the study found that empathy had an insignificant negative prediction on entrepreneurial career behaviour, suggesting that higher levels of empathy were not directly associated with entrepreneurial pursuits in this context. The studies on personal development and empathy within the realm of emotional intelligence have provided a basis for further research on the relationships between empathy, skills competency, and career advancement. However, some variations in findings among previous studies exist, such as empathy's influence on entrepreneurial career behaviour. To further expand the understanding of these relationships and their implications, there was a need for future research to consider exploring other variables and diverse populations, giving rise to the present study.

The relationship between empathy and self-efficacy has been explored in several studies, providing insights into this important connection. Sarkhosh and Rezaee (2014) conducted a quantitative correlational study with 105 university teachers in Iran, using the Bar-on model. Through Pearson correlation analysis, they found that empathy has a weak positive and significant relationship with instructors' self-efficacy. However, it is important to note that the study primarily focused on younger and less experienced instructors. In a study conducted by Ahmadi (2014) in Iran, using Goleman's Emotional Intelligence Theory, a quantitative correlational approach was taken with small trading company employees. The study included 254 participants and employed Pearson correlation

analysis. The findings indicated a strong and statistically significant relationship between empathy and self-efficacy. Another study by Chikkanarti and Jattennavar (2018) examined the relationship between empathy and self-efficacy among physical education teachers in India. The study involved 130 participants and utilised Pearson correlation and multiple regression analyses. However, the results showed that empathy had an insignificant positive prediction on self-efficacy in research. The existing studies on empathy and self-efficacy have provided mixed findings. While some studies have found a significant positive relationship, others have shown insignificant results, creating an evidence gap. Therefore, further research is needed to gain a deeper understanding of this relationship and to explore the influence of different factors.

The synthesis of studies conducted on leadership behavior and empathy reveals both similarities and disparities in their findings. Empathy consistently emerges as a key factor in promoting effective leadership across various contexts (Alsalminy & Baxodirovna, 2023; Baba et al., 2021; Biswas & Rahman, 2021). For instance, Alsalminy and Baxodirovna's (2023) qualitative case study on leaders of industrial companies in Iraq found that empathy played a crucial role in developing good social leaders. This aligns with the findings of other studies which reported a significant and positive correlation between empathy and leadership styles such as charismatic leadership among bankers in Bangladesh (Biswas & Rahman, 2021), and transformational leadership among university lecturers in India (Baba et al. 2021). Similarly, Masood et al. (2015) found that empathy is significantly related to transformational, transactional, and passive-avoidant leadership, as well as communication patterns and job satisfaction among college principals in Pakistan. Furthermore, the impact of empathy on leadership extends beyond specific leadership styles. For example, Laborde et al. (2020) found that empathy had a significant positive relationship with human talent management, personnel selection, and personnel maintenance among university professors in Ecuador. Contrary to the results of other

studies Elsayed et al. (2017) found no significant relationship between empathy and conflict management practices among academic staff in Egypt. This disparity in results creates an evidence gap and suggests that the impact of empathy on conflict resolution may vary across different professional contexts and requires further investigation. To bridge the gaps in the literature, the current study was necessary since it explored the mediating role of job satisfaction and considered the moderating effects of demographic variables in the relationship between emotional intelligence and the persistence to publish. Furthermore, the present study addressed a population gap by focusing on Nigerian university lecturers, an underrepresented population in the literature.

The studies on job performance and empathy consistently show a positive relationship between the two factors. Ismail et al. (2020) found a significant link between empathy and work performance among vocational teachers in Malaysia. Similarly, Widayati, Arijanto, Magita and Septiana (2022) observed a positive correlation between empathy and employee performance in Indonesia. Ogunsanwo and Omojaro (2019) reported a significant relationship between empathy and employee job performance among polytechnic staff in Nigeria. Martin and Gracious (2019) identified a significant association between empathy and teachers' effectiveness in India. Moreover, Nosike, Kekeocha, and Okeke (2022) discovered a positive and statistically significant relationship between empathy and teachers' commitment in Nigerian secondary schools. These consistent findings suggest that empathy plays a vital role in enhancing job performance and effectiveness across various professional contexts. The current study on the relationship between emotional intelligence, including empathy, and the persistence to publish (an aspect of job performance) among University of Calabar lecturers in Cross River State, Nigeria, was essential to further our understanding in this specific context.

Other studies have consistently demonstrated a positive link between empathy and job satisfaction across various professional contexts. For example, Tabatabaei and

Farazmehr (2015) found that empathy had a significant positive correlation with general job satisfaction, present job satisfaction, supervision satisfaction, and co-worker satisfaction among language institute teachers in Iran. Similarly, Varma and Singh (2022) observed a positive relationship between empathy and job satisfaction among primary school instructors in India. Mohammad et al. (2018) examined bank workers in Pakistan and identified a weak but statistically significant positive correlation between empathy and job satisfaction. They cited authors suggested that future studies explore other variables and employ diverse research methods for a more comprehensive understanding of this relationship. In a study conducted with academic staff in Lebanese private universities, Tabiat (2022) confirmed that empathy was a significant positive predictor of job satisfaction among university lecturers. Taken together, these findings indicate a consistent pattern of empathy positively influencing job satisfaction across different professional domains, including language institutes, banks, primary schools, and universities. Therefore, the present study on the relationship between emotional intelligence, including empathy, and job satisfaction among University of Calabar lecturers in Cross River State, Nigeria, has contributed to this growing body of knowledge, especially with persistence to publish as the outcome variable.

In the realm of mental health, Huang, Liu, and Su (2020) conducted a study with preschool teachers in China, utilizing various models of empathy. They found that empathy played both protective and risk roles in the mental health of preschool teachers, with the specific roles influenced by teaching experience. As teaching experience increased, different patterns emerged in the four dimensions of empathy: fantasy remained stable, empathic concern and perspective-taking showed a slow decreasing trend, and personal distress showed an increasing trend. In the context of stress, Khaniyan et al. (2013) examined rehabilitation staff in training hospitals in Iran. Their findings revealed a significant positive relationship between empathy and occupational stress among

rehabilitation staff. Regarding emotional intelligence, Yadav and Lata (2019) found a statistically significant positive correlation between empathy and emotional intelligence in India. The results suggested that individuals capable of taking others' perspectives tend to have higher emotional intelligence. In the domain of burnout, Fiorilli et al. (2019) demonstrated that a high level of trait emotional intelligence, which includes emotionality, was associated with lower levels of burnout among teachers in terms of personal, work-related, and student-related factors. These studies collectively highlight the importance of empathy and emotional intelligence in various aspects of mental health, stress, and burnout among professionals such as preschool teachers, rehabilitation staff, and teachers.

Empathy has been found to have a significant positive impact on various work-family factors and outcomes. Bakir (2018) demonstrated that empathy positively influences employees' work-life balance among hospital employees in Jordan. Al-Tarawneh, Battah, and Al-Tarawneh (2018) discovered a significant positive relationship between empathy and administrative creativity among teachers and principals in Pakistan, specifically in terms of originality, volubility/flexibility, and improvements in managerial operations and educational outcomes. Spehrianazar et al. (2017) discovered a weak but positive and significant relationship between empathy and psychological needs for competence and relatedness. However, empathy showed a significant inverse relationship with teachers' need for autonomy. Furthermore, Joe-Akunne et al. (2015) investigated the relationship between empathy and work behavior among local government employees in Nigeria. Their findings indicated that empathy did not significantly predict counterproductive behaviors in this context. In terms of mediating roles, Wang, Pan, Yu, and Song (2023) found that empathy acted as a mediator in the relationship between trait mindfulness and the quality of teacher-child interactions. Moreover, both emotional intelligence and empathy played a sequential mediating role in the relationship between trait mindfulness and the quality of parent-teacher interactions. Regarding the

effectiveness of training programs, Hen and Sharabi-Nov (2014) implemented a 56-hour "Emotional Intelligence" training program and observed improvements in teachers' emotional intelligence and empathic concern over the course duration. The expression and regulation of emotions were found to significantly predict empathy at the end of the program. Taken together, these studies highlight the positive influence of empathy on work-family factors, creativity, mediating roles, and psychological needs, while also emphasizing the potential benefits of training programs to enhance empathy and related outcomes.

2.3.6. Emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and persistence to publish

Emotional intelligence as a generic construct or trait-emotional or global emotional intelligence, as some studies refer to it, has been widely researched on, in the last decade across different times and contexts. Many studies have used it as a predictor of several outcome variables (e.g., Akomolafe & Ogunmakin, 2014; Amirian, Amirian, & Kouhsari, 2023; Bukhari, 2018; Hamidi & Amiri, 2013; Ismail, Nopiah & Rasul, 2020; Jung & Yoon, 2014; Marino, Harikaran, & Nanthagopan, 2019; Mohammad, Akhtar, Ur Rahman & Haleem, 2018; Tabatabaei & Farazmehr, 2015; Teli & Baba, 2017; Vasudevan, 2013). Others have used it as a mediator linking different predictors to various outcome variables (e.g., Alsughayir, 2021). Furthermore, it has served as the outcome or dependent variable in different studies (e.g., Ahad, Mustafa, Mohamad, Abdullah & Nordin, 2021; Sánchez-Pujalte, Mateu, Etchezahar & Gómez, 2021). Notably, most studies have used emotional intelligence as an antecedent of several outcomes. The outcomes variables that have been used in response to emotional intelligence include job commitment, self-awareness, work performance, job satisfaction, personality, professional competencies, general health, self-efficacy, burnout, work-family life, adaptability, life satisfaction, knowledge sharing, job effectiveness, suicidal behaviour, and leadership effectiveness.

Studies on emotional intelligence and work commitment have produced mixed findings. Ahad et al. (2021) found a significant positive relationship between emotional intelligence, organizational commitment constructs, and work attitude among vocational college teachers in Malaysia. Vasudevan (2013) reported similar results among employees in private organizations, supporting Goleman's Emotional Intelligence Theory. In contrast, Bukhari's (2018) study on permanent university faculty in Pakistan did not find a predictive influence of emotional intelligence on job commitment. These disparities highlight the need for further research. This study on emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals among lecturers in the University of Calabar, Nigeria, contributed to the debate by examining a specific context and considering mediating and moderating factors.

Multiple studies have consistently shown a positive relationship between emotional intelligence (EI) and work performance across various professional settings. Ismail et al. (2020) found significant predictive effects of EI on vocational teachers' work performance in Malaysia. Similarly, Marino et al. (2019) demonstrated the significant impact of EI on job performance among primary and secondary school teachers in Sri Lanka. Amirian et al. (2023) reported similar findings, highlighting the significant positive relationship between emotional intelligence and teachers' performance in primary schools in Iran. Additionally, Jung and Yoon (2014) identified the influence of emotional intelligence on emotional labour among hotel employees in Korea. While these studies provide consistent evidence supporting the link between emotional intelligence and work performance, gaps remain to be addressed. Most of the studies cited were conducted in foreign nations and due to contextual variations, these results may not be applicable to Nigeria. Therefore, the current study addressed the contextual gap by being specific in focus on the University of Calabar, Nigeria, contributing to the existing literature by providing findings from an underrepresented cultural and regional context.

Several studies have examined the relationship between emotional intelligence (EI) and various outcomes in different contexts. Dolev and Leshem (2017) found that training enhanced EI competencies among secondary school teachers in Israel, which were integrated into their professional practice. Kappagoda (2013a) discovered positive and significant associations between EI and extraversion, agreeableness, and openness to experience among English teachers in Sri Lanka. Kia and Heidari (2014) reported a significant positive relationship between EI and teachers' general health in Tajikistan and Iran. Ahmadi (2014) observed a statistically significant and positive connection between EI and self-efficacy among employees in an Iranian trading company. Lastly, Sánchez-Pujalte et al. (2021) found negative relationships between EI and burnout levels, as well as associations with socioemotional competencies, among high school teachers in Spain. These studies collectively contributed to the understanding of the impact of EI on professional practice, personality traits, health, self-efficacy, and burnout. However, further research was needed to explore these relationships in diverse settings and investigate potential moderators or mediators.

Studies on emotional intelligence and job satisfaction have consistently found positive relationships. Tabatabaei and Farazmehr (2015) reported significant correlations between emotional intelligence and various aspects of job satisfaction among language institute teachers in Iran. Hamidi and Amiri (2013) found a positive relationship between emotional intelligence and job satisfaction among high school teachers, with specific aspects showing varying levels of significance. Teli and Baba (2017) demonstrated that emotional intelligence significantly predicted intrinsic and extrinsic job satisfaction among teachers in undergraduate colleges in India. Akomolafe and Ogunmakin (2014) found a significant prediction of job satisfaction by emotional intelligence among secondary school teachers in Nigeria. Mohammad et al. (2018) reported a moderate-positive relationship between emotional intelligence and job satisfaction among bank workers in

Pakistan. Additionally, Alsughayir (2021) found that job satisfaction mediated the relationship between emotional intelligence and organizational commitment among bank employees in Saudi Arabia. These findings highlight the consistently positive impact of emotional intelligence on job satisfaction across different contexts and professions. However, further research was recommended by most of the cited studies, to explore potential moderators, consider longitudinal or qualitative approaches, and investigate the generalizability of the results to diverse populations and educational institutions. The current study responded to these calls and extended the existing literature by investigating the mediating role of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and persistence to publish among university lecturers. Additionally, it considered some lecturers' demographic variables as potential moderators, the research can provide insights into how these factors influence the relationship.

Some researchers have studied the relationship between emotional intelligence (EI) and various outcomes, including professional competencies and life satisfaction. In a study conducted by Rahayu, Ulfatin, Wiyono, Imron and Wajdi (2018) among elementary school teachers in Indonesia, it was found that EI significantly predicted teachers' professional competencies and these competencies mediated the relationship between EI and school effectiveness. Similarly, Sharma and Yadav (2014) conducted a study with public secondary school teachers in India and found a moderate positive relationship between EI and teachers' professional development. Turning to life satisfaction, Kong and Zhao (2013) conducted a cross-sectional survey among Chinese-speaking undergraduates and found a significant relationship between EI and life satisfaction. They also discovered that positive and negative affect were complete mediators in the link between trait EI and life satisfaction. This suggests that individuals with higher levels of trait EI tend to experience more positive and less negative affect, leading to increased life satisfaction. Additionally, Kong and Zhao (2013) revealed that males scored significantly higher than females in trait

EI. A longitudinal study by Sánchez-Álvarez, Extremera, and Fernandez-Berrocal (2015) with high school students in Spain confirmed previous research findings regarding the mediating role of affect in the association between EI and life satisfaction. The study showed that students with high levels of EI tended to experience more positive and fewer negative emotions, contributing to higher levels of life satisfaction. While the existing studies provided useful findings into the relationship between emotional intelligence, professional competencies, and life satisfaction, some gaps can still be addressed. For instance, considering the mediating role of job satisfaction and the potential moderating effects of demographic variables can further enrich the understanding of this relationship.

Several studies have investigated the relationship between emotional intelligence (EI) and job effectiveness across different occupations. Kanwal, Sohail, and Muhammad (2018) conducted a quantitative correlational study among lecturers at public universities in Pakistan and found a significant relationship between EI and overall job effectiveness, including teaching and pedagogy, classroom management, and relationship management. This study provides evidence of the positive impact of EI on job effectiveness in the academic context. In a study by Oyeboade (2016) focusing on library personnel in Nigeria, a significant but relatively weak positive relationship was found between EI and library work productivity. This suggests that EI may have a limited influence on job effectiveness in this particular occupational group. However, a study conducted by Aigbodion and Uye (2022) among university staff in Nigeria found no significant relationship between EI and time management behaviour, indicating that EI may not be a strong predictor of job effectiveness in terms of time management. These studies reveal agreements and disagreements regarding the relationship between EI and job effectiveness across different occupational groups. Key knowledge and evidence gaps include the need for more research specifically focused on university lecturers, to understand the impact of EI on job effectiveness in the specific context of the University of Calabar. To bridge these gaps, the

present study extended existing research by incorporating a mediating variable and considering moderators, such as age, sex, and education level.

Leadership effectiveness is a multifaceted concept that can be influenced by various factors, including emotional intelligence (EI). The studies on leadership effectiveness provide insights into the relationship between EI and leadership behaviours in different contexts. For instance, Elsayed, Elsayed, and Hamed (2017) examined the relationship between EI and conflict management practices among academic staff in Egypt. They found a significant relationship between EI and the level of conflict management practised by academic staff. Wolle (2022) focused on university leaders in Ethiopia and investigated the impact of leaders' EI on their effectiveness. The study revealed that leaders' EI significantly predicted their leadership effectiveness in universities.

Baba, Makhdoomi and Siddiqi (2021) conducted research among university lecturers in India to explore the relationship between EI and transformational leadership. The findings indicated that EI is a significant positive predictor of transformational leadership among university lecturers. Laborde, Pizarro, Herrera, and Cadena (2020) investigated the relationship between EI and various aspects of human resource management among university professors in Ecuador. They found a significant positive relationship between EI and human talent management and training and development. However, the relationship with other aspects, such as personal selection, personnel maintenance, and performance measurement, was positive but insignificant. Similarly, Masood, Mussarat, and Mazahir (2015) studied college principals in Pakistan and examined the association between EI and leadership behaviours. They discovered a significant negative correlation between EI and passive-avoidant leadership, while a significant positive relationship was found between communication patterns and job satisfaction. The studies show a general agreement regarding the positive influence of EI

on leadership effectiveness and related factors such as conflict management, transformational leadership, and certain aspects of human resource management. However, there are some discrepancies in findings, particularly in the relationship between EI and specific leadership behaviours. This creates an evidence gap, necessitating further research, especially from less represented areas such as Africa.

Other researchers have investigated the role that emotional intelligence play in outcome variables such as: work-family conflict, adaptability, knowledge sharing, and suicidal behaviour. Specifically, Kappagoda (2013b) found in Sri Lanka that emotional intelligence has a significant inverse correlation with work-to-family conflict, family-to-work conflict and work-family conflict, respectively. Also, Sony and Mekoth (2016) found in India that there is a positive correlation between emotional intelligence and adaptability among frontline employees. Furthermore, Malik (2021) discovered, using a sample of 245 employees of global IT companies in India, that emotional intelligence has a more pronounced positive impact on tacit knowledge sharing than explicit knowledge sharing. In Nigeria, the study conducted by Okafor and Oyana (2022) discovered a weak positive and insignificant relationship between emotional intelligence and students' suicidal behaviour.

Sex differences in emotional intelligence (EI) has been explored in previous studies, revealing variations in EI levels between males and females. Notably, Toor (2013) examined the EI levels of secondary school teachers in India and found a significant mean difference, with male teachers exhibiting higher emotional intelligence than female teachers. The study also highlighted that government secondary school teachers had higher EI levels than their private school counterparts. Similarly, Arshad, Ahmed, and Zeeshan (2021) investigated the emotional intelligence of Pakistan's primary school leaders and teachers. The results indicated that both male and female school leaders demonstrated moderate emotional intelligence, but male leaders exhibited a comparatively higher level.

However, to extend these studies and contribute to the existing literature, it was essential to examine sex differences in emotional intelligence within a specific context and population. The present study provided evidence into how sex influences emotional intelligence and its relationship with persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. By considering the moderating effects of demographic variables such as: sex, education level and marital status, this study has extended the bivariate findings reported in previous studies.

Research in the last decade has featured job satisfaction prominently across different roles. Studies have treated job satisfaction as a predictor of different mediating and dependent variables (e.g., Bangun, Pritasari, Widjaja, Wirawan, Wisesa & Ginting, 2021; Djaelani, Sanusi & Triatmanto, 2021; Gessesse & Premanandam, 2023; Goswami, 2022; Indarti, Fernandes & Hakim, 2017). Other studies have treated job satisfaction as an outcome variable responding to other predictor variables (e.g., Ateş & Ünal, 2021; Alanoğlu & Demirtaş, 2021; Fikri & Juariyah, 2020; Lee, 2018; Lu, Lee, Yang & Song, 2020; Liu, Yi & Siwatu, 2023; Mahzan & Nordin, 2021; Masum, Azad & Beh, 2015; Yıldız & Şimşek, 2016; Zhang, Fu & Li, 2020). Nevertheless, a longer list of studies has used job satisfaction as the mediator to link different independent variables to other outcome variables (e.g., Aboramadan, Dahleez & Hamad, 2020; Ali, Dahie & Ali, 2016; Ali, Panatik & Badri, 2020; Akhtar, Shakeela-Shah & Tatlah, 2023; Awais, Malik & Qaisar, 2015; Keçeci, Küçükelçi & Allaham, 2022; Kristanti, Prasetio, Indiyati & Madiawati, 2021; Singh & Ryhal, 2021; Suryo, Romadloni & Respati, 2019). This suggests that job satisfaction is a very versatile variable predicting, mediating, moderating or responding to other variables; hence the decision to use it as mediating variable in this study.

Among studies that have treated job satisfaction as an outcome variable, most of them have been conducted to shed light on the factors that influence individuals' contentment in their work environments. One prominent pattern that emerged from the

studies is the role of emotional factors in determining job satisfaction. Studies by Lee (2018) and Lu et al. (2020) highlight the significance of emotion regulation and emotional self-awareness in influencing job satisfaction. Lee (2018) found a positive, yet insignificant, relationship between emotion regulation and job satisfaction. Lu et al. (2020) demonstrated that emotional self-regulation was crucial to mediating deep acting and job satisfaction among public service officers in Korea and China. Another consistent finding is the impact of work-related stressors on job satisfaction. Fikri and Juariyah (2020) discovered a negative association between workload and job satisfaction among university lecturers in Indonesia. Similarly, Rahman and Ali (2020) revealed the detrimental effect of work-family conflict on job satisfaction among academicians in private universities in Bangladesh. These studies emphasize the significance of managing stress and work-life balance to enhance job satisfaction.

Leadership and organizational support also emerged as crucial determinants of job satisfaction. Yıldız and Şimşek (2016) demonstrated that transformational leadership positively influenced job satisfaction, with trust and self-efficacy acting as mediators among academic personnel in Turkish universities. Ateş and Ünal (2021) found that perceived organizational support partially mediated the relationship between diversity management and job satisfaction among secondary school teachers in Turkey. Subarto, Solihin and Qurbani (2021) revealed that leadership style, organizational climate, and work environment significantly predicted job satisfaction among university lecturers in Indonesia. Alanoğlu and Demirtaş (2021) found a weak connection between bureaucratic school structure and job satisfaction among high school teachers in Turkey, with organizational justice mediating the impact of enabling bureaucracy on job satisfaction.

Contextual factors and cultural differences were evident in some findings. Lu et al. (2020) observed that the impact of emotional self-awareness on job satisfaction was significant exclusively in the Chinese sample, suggesting the influence of cultural norms.

Additionally, Zhang, Fu and Li (2020) identified academics' perceptions of their work environment as a significant predictor of job dissatisfaction in Hong Kong, underscoring the importance of considering the context in understanding job satisfaction. One recurring pattern is the positive effect of career commitment and workload on job satisfaction. Janib, Rasdi and Zaremohzzabieh (2022) found that career commitment had a significant positive influence on job satisfaction among university faculty in Malaysia. Similarly, Ghasemy, Mohajer, Cepeda-Carrión and Roldán (2020) discovered a significant positive effect of workload on job satisfaction among university and college academics in Malaysia. These findings highlight the importance of commitment to one's career and managing workload in fostering job satisfaction.

Another consistent finding is the role of social identification in job satisfaction. Jeanson and Michinov (2018) found that social identification, including workgroup identification, professional identification, and organizational identification, significantly contributed to researchers' job satisfaction in a research institute in France. The impact of affective states on job satisfaction is another notable finding. Ghasemy et al. (2020) revealed that positive affect had a significant positive effect on job satisfaction, while negative affect had a significant negative effect among university and college academics in Malaysia. However, the mediating effect of job performance on the relationship between affect and job satisfaction was small. Additionally, various factors were identified as significant contributors to job satisfaction. Masum et al. (2015) found that compensation packages, job security, and working conditions were particularly influential among private university lecturers in Bangladesh. Liu et al. (2023) demonstrated that college teaching self-efficacy mediated and alleviated the negative relationship between job stress and job satisfaction among university lecturers in China. Lastly, Sony and Mekoth (2016) highlighted the mediating role of frontline employee adaptability in the relationship between emotional intelligence and job satisfaction among frontline employees in the

power sector in India. This suggests that adaptability is crucial in translating emotional intelligence into job satisfaction.

However, despite the valuable insights these studies provide, there are still knowledge gaps that the proposed study addressed in extending the previous literature. Firstly, most studies focused on specific occupational groups, such as: public servants, university academics, and secondary school teachers. Secondly, many studies were conducted in specific countries, such as the United States, Korea, China, and Turkey. None of the cited studies was conducted in Nigeria, creating a contextual population gap where Nigeria and the population of its university academic staff have been underrepresented. Therefore, the results reported by studies in other contexts may be inapplicable to Nigeria. Secondly, of the predictors found in previous studies, emotional intelligence has rarely been used as an antecedent of job satisfaction, creating a knowledge gap since little or nothing is known about the link between EI and job satisfaction.

Job satisfaction has been extensively studied as a predictor of various outcomes across different occupational contexts. Synthesizing the findings from these studies provides relevant information into the predictive power of job satisfaction. One consistent finding is the significant direct effect of job satisfaction on job performance (Indarti et al., 2017; Goswami, 2022). These studies emphasize the importance of job satisfaction in influencing individuals' performance and commitment to their work roles. Another prominent pattern is the mediating role of organizational factors in the relationship between job satisfaction and several outcomes. For example, job satisfaction has been found to mediate the relationship between emotional intelligence and turnover intentions (Feyerabend, Herd & Choi, 2018) and between job satisfaction and organizational citizenship behaviour (Djaelani et al., 2021). Another key finding is the relationship between job satisfaction and turnover intention (Gessesse & Premanandam, 2023). Higher job satisfaction is associated with lower turnover intention due to stronger affective

commitment. Job satisfaction is also a significant predictor of quality assurance, teaching effectiveness (Huang, Huang, Chang, Chang & Kao, 2013), and job performance (Bangun et al., 2021). These studies showcased the predictive power of job satisfaction on various outcomes, including: job performance, job commitment, organizational citizenship behaviour, turnover intention, teaching effectiveness, and happiness.

Similarly, several studies have investigated the mediating role of job satisfaction in different contexts. For instance, job satisfaction has been found to mediate the relationship between emotional intelligence and job performance (Suryo et al., 2019), between terminal work values and organizational citizenship behaviour (Ali, Panatik & Badri, 2020), and between workload and intention to stay (Keçeci et al., 2022). Job satisfaction has also been identified as a mediator between employee motivation and organizational performance (Ali, Dahie & Ali, 2016) and organizational commitment and spiritual intelligence (Awais et al., 2015).

The influence of job satisfaction on other related constructs has also been explored. Job satisfaction has been found to predict organizational commitment (Helmi, Suyanto, Efendi, Hidayat, Mustafa, Istanto & Susanto, 2022), work engagement (Aboramadan, Dahleez & Hamad, 2020), and affective commitment (Kristanti et al., 2021). It has also been identified as a mediator in the relationships between internal marketing and job satisfaction (Helmi et al., 2022), servant leadership and work engagement (Aboramadan et al., 2020), and financial rewards and turnover intention (Kristanti et al., 2021). Furthermore, job satisfaction has been found to mediate the relationship between emotional intelligence and students' academic achievement (Singh & Ryhal, 2021), between perceived organizational support and organizational commitment (Donald, Hlanganipai & Shambare, 2016), and between psychological empowerment and performance (Putra & Rahyuda, 2019). Job satisfaction has also been identified as a mediator in the relationships between work-family conflict and organizational

commitment (Karya, Zahara, Anshori & Herlambang, 2021), work-life balance and turnover intention (Nair, Jayabalan, Perumal & Subramaniam, 2021), and job insecurity and exit, voice, loyalty, and neglect responses (Tayfur, Bayhan, Metin, Ozsoy & Kumbul, 2021). Moreover, other studies have explored the mediating role of job satisfaction in the relationships between workplace ostracism and knowledge-sharing behaviours (Wang, Li, Liu & Zaggia, 2023), between surface acting and job satisfaction (Khetjenkarn & Agmapisarn, 2020), and between intrinsic work motivation and research performance (Ringelhan et al., 2013).

Numerous studies have explored the correlation between job satisfaction and various factors in different settings and populations. Wang, Chu, Wang, Pan, Sun, Yan, Jiao, Zhan, and Zhang (2020) uncovered that job stress had a negative impact on job satisfaction, especially among university teachers in provincial and municipal universities. Similarly, job burnout had a detrimental effect across all types of universities. In contrast, Akhtar et al. (2023) found that job satisfaction played a mediating role between turnover intention and procedural and interactive justice among university teacher educators in Pakistan. Examining high school teachers in Bangladesh, Rahman (2017) identified several factors positively associated with job satisfaction, such as: training and development, discipline, reward systems, compensation and benefits, industrial relations, and work environment. The study further revealed that job satisfaction mediated the relationship between these HRM practices and operational performance. Likewise, Žnidaršič and Marič (2021) observed that work-life balance significantly influenced job satisfaction and life satisfaction among higher education lecturers, although job satisfaction itself did not directly impact work engagement.

In Greece, Trivellas and Santouridis (2016) found that both the quality of teaching and administration positively affected job satisfaction among university lecturers and staff. Subsequently, job satisfaction predicted organizational commitment. Sudibjo and

Manihuruk (2022), investigating teachers in Indonesia, discovered that happiness at work predicted job satisfaction, while perceived organizational support influenced job satisfaction without mediating the relationship between happiness at work and mental health. Ağalday (2022) concentrated on university academics in Turkey and highlighted the significant impact of alienation from the academic profession on job satisfaction, subsequently influencing organizational deviance. Furthermore, Alsughayir (2021) determined that emotional intelligence positively affected job satisfaction among bank employees in Saudi Arabia, and job satisfaction mediated the relationship between emotional intelligence and organizational commitment.

In summary, job satisfaction is crucial in shaping individuals' attitudes, behaviours, and overall well-being in the workplace. It predicts various outcomes, mediates the relationships between different factors, and influences important constructs including job performance, job commitment, and turnover intention. However, several gaps in the literature still need to be filled. First, most cited studies were conducted in Asian countries, with just a handful of African studies. Specifically, no Nigerian study was found to have used job satisfaction as a mediator in the relationship between two variables. The current study seems to be the first to have linked emotional intelligence and its sub-components to lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, with job satisfaction as the mediator. The present study also seems to be the first to have moderated the tripartite relationship involving emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and persistence to publish with demographic variables such as: sex, education level and marital status.

Persistence to publish appears to be a relatively new term in the literature. From the review of extant literature, no previous study in the last decade has examined the variable, although related terms or phrases have been used. Even though the intention was to review studies on persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed, the literature has rather featured variables such as research motivation (e.g., Allen, Brown, Ginther, Graham,

Mercurio & Smith, 2021; Awan, 2022; Heuritsch, 2023; Kumar & Israel, 2013; Lambovska & Yordanov, 2020; Li, 2023; Lu, 2022; Mayer & Rathmann, 2018; Mustofa, Riani & Wardani, 2019; Nguyen, 2015; Stupnisky, Larivière, Hall & Omojiba, 2023), resilience (e.g., Kutlu & Yavuz, 2016; McCray & Joseph-Richard, 2020; Yang, Shu & Yin, 2021), compliance with research norms (Aprile, Ellem & Lole, 2021), self-efficacy (e.g., Ananda, Abbas & Yasin, 2022; Eam, 2015; Harsasi, Hutagaol, Baga & Sailah, 2021; Hemmings & Kay, 2010; Kuo, Woo & Bang, 2017), research productivity (Horodnic & Zaiţ, 2015; Okon, Owan & Owan, 2022; Owan, Ameh & Anam, 2023; Santos, Horta, & Li, 2022; Stupnisky, BrckaLorenz & Laird, 2019; Truong, Le, Do, Le, Nguyen & Nguyen, 2021), publication quality (Shibayama & Baba, 2014) and research ability (Nguyen, Bui, Nguyen, Tran & Tran, 2021). Others have studied the factors influencing the publication of papers in different journals (Getahun, Hammad & Robinson-Pant, 2021; Kalra, Seetharaman, Maddulety & Bakhshi, 2022; Purwanto, Ardiyanto & Sudargini, 2021; Suhartono, Rahmawati, Atok, Prastyo & Ahmad, 2016).

Quantitative studies on the motivation to publish have yielded consistent results where a positive relationship has been reported. For example, Awan (2022) conducted a quantitative study among university lecturers in Pakistan and found that supportive leadership was positively correlated with research motivation. The study also revealed that workload mediated the relationship between leadership support and research motivation. In contrast, Allen et al. (2021) found no significant mediating role of belonging or science research motivation in the relationship between the perceived communal value of scientific research and persistence on research tasks. Kumar and Israel (2013) identified self-motivation, extrinsic rewards (such as research grants and job security), and peer pressure as important drivers of research productivity among university faculty members in India. The study emphasized the need for a stronger "publish or perish" culture in Indian academia to increase research publications (Kumar & Israel, 2013).

Heuritsch (2023) revealed an "evaluation gap" between academic expectations, such as publishing papers, and the autonomous motivational factors driving astronomers' research conduct. It also found that enhancing controlled motivation through incentives, such as publication rates, negatively affected perceptions of fairness and approach to research (Heuritsch, 2023). Mustofa et al. (2019) found that policy perception and socioeconomic status directly influenced the motivation to publish and the types of publications in Indonesia. Motivation to publish played a mediating role in linking policy perception and socioeconomic status to types of publications. Similarly, Stupnisky et al. (2023) identified autonomous motivation as the most influential predictor of research productivity among university academics in the USA. Other factors, such as occupational and social-environmental background and controlled motivation, had relatively limited predictive effects on research productivity. In a different study, Mayer and Rathmann (2018) investigated sex differences in publication output among psychology professors in Germany. They found that men published more in top and ordinary journals than women. Collaboration patterns and opportunities were identified as factors contributing to sex differences in publication output (Mayer & Rathmann, 2018).

Mixed methods studies have also provided consistent evidence that motivation is important in different research outcomes. For instance, Nguyen (2015) identified factors such as heavy teaching loads, low salaries, inadequate resources, and dissatisfaction with research policies as hindrances to research motivation among university lecturers in Vietnam. Specifically, higher salaries, involvement in research groups, and engagement in postgraduate supervision were identified as factors that could enhance research motivation and subsequent research behaviours (Nguyen, 2015). Lastly, Li (2023) found that extrinsic motivation had a negative effect, while institutional support positively impacted the research engagement of Chinese EFL teachers.

Also, a literature review by Lambovska and Yordanov (2020) identified both extrinsic factors (such as: collaboration opportunities, financial rewards, and promotion prospects) and intrinsic motivations (such as contributing to society and personal development) as factors driving researchers to publish in Scopus and WoS journals. Similarly, a qualitative study by Lu (2022) found that extrinsic motivators, particularly the desire to meet university assessment requirements, played a significant role in publishing in international journals among university academics in China.

Previous studies have shed light on various factors in research productivity and the motivation to publish, yet important gaps remain. While some studies focused on factors like leadership support, workload, self-motivation, and extrinsic rewards, there is a limited exploration of emotional intelligence and its sub-dimensions. Additionally, the role of job satisfaction as a mediator and the influence of demographic variables have not been extensively examined. This provided the basis for the present study to investigate the relationship between emotional intelligence and the persistence to publish, with job satisfaction as a mediating factor, among University of Calabar lecturers in Cross River State, Nigeria.

Previous studies have shed light on various factors influencing researchers' productivity and output. Santos, Horta, and Li (2022) conducted a meta-analysis and revealed that research agendas focused on publishing and collaboration positively impact research productivity and visibility in the long term. Stupnisky et al. (2019) found that autonomous motivation, specifically enjoyment and value, was positively associated with self-reported research productivity and the number of publications among university academics. Owan et al. (2023) explored the impact of mentorship, institutional support, and collaboration on research productivity among university lecturers in Nigeria. They found that mentorship enhanced research productivity when accompanied by positive institutional culture and collaboration, whereas institutional support did not directly affect

it. Okon et al. (2022) examined the influence of mentorship practices on early career researchers and found that cloning and apprenticeship approaches significantly contributed to their research productivity. Horodnic and Zaiţ (2015) observed a positive correlation between intrinsic motivation and research productivity, indicating that genuine interest and passion in work enhance productivity, while extrinsic motivation showed a negative correlation. Truong et al. (2021) investigated the predictors of research outputs among university lecturers in Vietnam and found that leadership, policies, resources, and support for scientific research significantly predicted research outputs.

However, it is important to note that certain gaps exist in these studies. For instance, Owan et al. (2023) did not consider potential factors that could influence research productivity, such as: personal characteristics of researchers, funding availability, and infrastructure, even though the study was conducted in the same context as the current study. Therefore, it is important to incorporate these variables for a more comprehensive understanding of the topic. Additionally, Truong et al. (2021) found that decentralization had an insignificant positive prediction on research outputs, suggesting a need for further exploration of this relationship. The present study further contributed to the literature by focusing on the relationship between emotional intelligence and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals among University of Calabar lecturers in Cross River State, Nigeria, as well as examining the mediating role of job satisfaction. Furthermore, by exploring the moderating effects of demographic variables on this relationship, the study has provided useful information on how emotional intelligence and job satisfaction interact with individual characteristics to influence research productivity.

Previous research has provided evidence concerning the various factors that are useful predictors of scholars' research performance. Ryan's (2014) quantitative survey among research scientists in the UK revealed that internal self-concept motivation positively influenced research performance, while instrumental motivation had a negative

impact. Interestingly, younger scientists displayed higher levels of external self-concept motivation, and age and sex were influential factors in research performance (Ryan, 2014). In Gunawan's (2020) study of university lecturers in Indonesia, academic rank, highest education level, and university degree attainment were identified as significant positive factors for publication performance. Sex and administrative positions also played a role in research performance over 3 years, whereas age and years of work experience did not show a significant influence (Gunawan, 2020). Fuentes (2021) employed a qualitative approach and discovered that a conducive research atmosphere, encompassing factors such as: funding support, publication incentives, technical support services, a manageable workload, research opportunities, peer influence, and a positive attitude toward publication, contributed to high publication performance among university lecturers in the Philippines.

Similarly, Nguyen, Klopper, and Smith (2016) conducted semi-structured interviews with university lecturers in Vietnam and found that institutional factors, including financial support, teaching load, research collaboration, and research policy settings and practices, hindered research engagement and productivity, despite the respondents' acknowledgement of research's significance. Nevertheless, previous research has largely overlooked the influence of emotional intelligence, with its sub-dimensions, on persistence to publish. Additionally, the mediating role of job satisfaction, specifically in the link between emotional intelligence and publication persistence, has received limited attention.

Various studies have contributed to the relationship between self-efficacy and research performance among academic professionals. Hemmings and Kay (2010) found that early career researchers with high self-efficacy were more likely to engage in a wide range of research activities, including: paper submission, conference participation, and research project leadership among university lecturers in Australia. Building upon this,

Ananda et al. (2022) revealed that knowledge self-efficacy positively predicted knowledge sharing, and the mediating role of knowledge sharing linked knowledge self-efficacy and work spirituality to research productivity among university lecturers in Hungary. Shifting the focus to doctoral students in the USA, a study discovered that research self-efficacy and motivation significantly influenced publication outcomes. At the same time, the advisory relationship played a less significant role (Kuo et al., 2017). Harsasi et al. (2021) also identified motivation, self-efficacy, research skills, research time, and training as positive influencers of publication performance among private university lecturers in Indonesia. However, the teaching workload had a negative impact, while supporting resources did not show a significant influence (Harsasi et al., 2021). Finally, Eam (2015) highlighted the importance of factors such as obtaining degrees abroad, full-time employment, and high research self-efficacy in stimulating research engagement among academic staff in Cambodia. Furthermore, institutional factors like faculty size and research funding availability also play a role in stimulating research engagement (Eam, 2015). Despite these useful findings, the present study addressed several gaps in the literature. Firstly, the cited studies primarily focused on specific aspects of self-efficacy, such as knowledge self-efficacy or research self-efficacy, without considering the comprehensive construct of emotional intelligence and its sub-dimensions. Secondly, while some studies have explored the mediating role of factors like knowledge sharing or work spirituality, the mediating role of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and persistence to publish has not been examined. Lastly, the cited studies were conducted in various contexts and populations, but there is a lack of research specifically focused on university lecturers in Nigeria and Africa.

Reviewing the studies on research rejections, resilience, and compliance with research norms provides ample evidence into the experiences and factors that impact academics' research journey. For example, the study by Chan, Mazzucchelli, and Rees

(2021) revealed that rejection and criticism of research significantly impact academics' emotional responses. Factors such as the academic setting, years of experience, and personal interpretation of feedback all shape these emotional reactions. On the other hand, McCray and Joseph-Richard (2020) found that a combination of personal responses, environmental factors, social connections, and institutional processes fosters resilience among doctoral students. These interconnected elements work together to support doctoral students in overcoming challenges and completing their research. Similarly, Kutlu and Yavuz (2016) explored resilience among university lecturers. They found that internal factors like self-esteem, decisiveness, curiosity, and external factors such as family support, competent teachers, and positive peer relationships, play a crucial role in helping lecturers navigate and overcome challenges. Moreover, Yang et al. (2021) conducted in-depth interviews with university college English teachers and identified various factors that test their emotional resilience. These factors included the performativity culture, publish or perish pressure, publishing bias, workload, institutional support, research policy, collegial pressure, leadership support, and personal aspirations. Based on their emotional resilience status, four categories of academics emerged: disheartened performer, miserable follower, strenuous accommodator, and fulfilled integrator (Yang et al., 2021).

In another study, Aprile et al. (2021) examined the experiences of early career academics. They found that they acknowledged and complied with managerial imperatives while striving to maintain autonomy in their educational and research contributions. These academics aimed to conduct impactful research, meet performance targets and enhance their institution's reputation while pursuing personal fulfilment and academic integrity (Aprile et al., 2021). Despite the findings of existing research, there are still several gaps in the literature that the current study addressed. Firstly, previous studies have focused primarily on isolated aspects of the research journey, such as: emotional reactions to rejections, factors contributing to resilience, or adherence to research norms. Thus, this

study explored the interconnectedness of emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and the persistence to publish in high-ranking journals such as those indexed in Scopus to plug the gap. Secondly, while various studies have been conducted in different global contexts, such as Australia, Turkey, and China, a noticeable lack of research specifically centred on university lecturers' experiences in Africa.

Previous studies have also been interested in identifying the factors influencing the publication practices of academics. The study by Getahun et al. (2021) found that local institutional values and global hierarchies in knowledge construction influence the publication decisions of academic staff. Additionally, factors such as identity, languages, and disciplinary cultures play a role in how academics position themselves concerning local and international journals, highlighting the contextual and cultural influences on publication practices. Kalra et al. (2022) conducted a literature review. They identified performance-based research funding, promotion systems, publication pressure, scientific research capabilities, and government policies as the factors contributing to the rapid increase in publishing. However, the study also highlighted the potential negative consequence of this rapid increase, namely the dissemination of low-quality content within the scholarly community (Kalra et al., 2022). Similarly, Purwanto et al. (2021) conducted a mixed methods study with doctoral students in Indonesia and identified numerous obstacles they face when publishing in internationally reputable journals. These obstacles included dealing with negative results, insufficient funding, lengthy response times from journals, limited English language proficiency, inadequate time and writing skills, limitations in manuscript submission, high publication costs, inadequate facilities and access to references, and limited technology skills (Purwanto et al., 2021). Lastly, Suhartono et al. (2016) focused on factors influencing the authorship of publications in Scopus by university lecturers in Indonesia. They found that age, functional position, educational level, and the country where lecturers obtained their highest education

significantly affected authorship. Furthermore, when considering the authorship of publications as the first author, age, sex, educational level, and the country of the highest education were determinant factors (Suhartono et al., 2016).

Other studies have further explored the factors affecting research publication and productivity. The study by Shibayama and Baba (2014) investigated the impact of multiple missions on research publication quality among principal investigators of research labs in Japan. The findings revealed that engagement in applied research had a negative effect on high-quality publications but a positive influence on low-quality publications. On the other hand, industry collaboration tended to decrease low-quality publications. The study also highlighted that high-quality publication was more likely when students from highly ranked universities first-authored papers, while student-led papers from low-ranked universities exhibited significantly lower quality. The allocation of more time for research had a positive effect on high-quality publications but not on low-quality publications, indicating that greater research time focused academics on producing high-quality research rather than engaging in numerous projects. Additionally, factors such as career and norms were found to influence publication quality, with the number of years since obtaining the first degree positively associated with low-quality publication and negatively associated with high-quality publication. Returnees with foreign experience tended to avoid low-quality research. They chose not to submit such papers for publication while inbreeding negatively impacted high-quality and weakly positive effects on low-quality publications. The study also examined the effects of resource input, showing that the number of staff, per-staff PhDs, and per-member budget positively influenced publication count and citation count. However, when a laboratory accepted more PhD students than it could effectively oversee, the positive effect of PhD students on high-quality research diminished, likely due to overcapacity for training. Excessive research budget also appeared to compromise quality.

The study by Nguyen et al. (2021), which focused on university lecturers in Vietnam, found a strong interrelationship between lecturers' research ability and motivation. Lecturers with higher expectations of their research capabilities exhibited higher research motivation, while those with lower expectations showed lower motivation. Perceived organizational support played a significant role, directly enhancing research motivation and indirectly influencing it by increasing expectations. These results highlight the intertwined nature of research ability, motivation, and organizational support in shaping lecturers' research productivity. A Uganda-based study by Kaguhangire-Barifaijo, Kyohairwe, and Komakech (2022) explored factors influencing academic research enthusiasm. The factors were categorized into international, national, institutional, and personal. National and institutional factors, such as: distorted benchmarking and complex roles and workload, played a significant role. Personal factors like procrastination, perfectionism, and self-pity had a negative impact on enthusiasm, while intellectual curiosity, career growth motivation, inquiry skills, and self-fulfilment positively influenced it. The presence of a dual reward system, where publishers are recognized and promoted while non-publishers feel demoralized, affects enthusiasm. Self-determination and intellectual curiosity were identified as major contributors to academics' research enthusiasm, alongside the institutional factors that affect all academics.

In a study conducted by Harvey, Barker, and Tynan (2020) with allied health practitioners in Australia, participants acknowledged experiencing improvement in their writing skills. Factors such as organized preparation, mentorship, training in academic writing, dedicated writing time, and external accountability facilitated the successful completion of manuscripts for publication. However, participants also faced challenges, including difficulties knowing how and where to begin, competing demands and distractions, insufficient proficiency in academic writing, and losing momentum. Despite

these obstacles, some participants managed to submit their manuscripts for publication by the end of the study.

The study by Roro et al. (2021) focused on university lecturers in Ethiopia and examined demographic differences in publication. The results showed a significantly higher proportion of male academics than female academics who published articles in peer-reviewed journals. Male faculty members, assistant professors and above, those with a PhD as their highest degree, and those affiliated with other institutions were more likely to publish in peer-reviewed journals than their counterparts. Nevertheless, these studies spanned various countries, such as Japan, Vietnam, Uganda, and Ethiopia. There is a gap in the literature regarding the specific context of Cross River State, Nigeria, which the present study can address. Previous studies focused on different populations, including academic staff, researchers, university lecturers, principal investigators of research labs, and allied health practitioners. However, the academic population in Nigeria, particularly Cross River State, is underrepresented. For inclusiveness, the present study narrowed the population to University of Calabar lecturers in Cross River State, Nigeria.

2.3.7. Studies on the moderating role of demographic variables

Demographic variables have been studied as moderators in the link between different predictors and outcome variables. Chief on the list is sex, age, education, experience and rank. Few studies have also considered the field of study, marital status, personality traits and location. The empirical literature review on the moderating role of sex has revealed mixed results. Several studies have investigated the role of sex as a significant moderator in various work-related contexts. These studies have examined the influence of sex on different outcomes, such as: job satisfaction, research motivation, task performance, emotional labour, knowledge sharing, and organisational excellence.

For instance, in the banking sector, Mohammad et al. (2018) found that sex significantly moderated the relationship between emotional intelligence (EI) and job satisfaction among bank workers in Pakistan. They suggested that future studies consider additional variables aside from age, sex, and education level as moderators in the relationship between EI and job satisfaction. Awan (2022) surveyed university lecturers in Pakistan and discovered that sex moderated the relationship between leadership support, workload, and research motivation. Workload significantly impacted the connection between leadership support and research motivation for females more than for males. However, both sexes showed a strong association between leadership support and self-efficacy, with self-efficacy mediating the relationship between leadership support and research motivation more strongly for females. Ghasemy et al. (2020) conducted a cross-sectional survey among university and college academics in Malaysia. They found that the extent of the connection between positive affect and job satisfaction varied significantly between males and females. The impact of positive affect on job satisfaction was stronger among male academics than the female group. Similarly, Allen et al. (2021) found that sex significantly moderated this relationship. Higher science research motivation was linked to increased persistence for women but not for men. The researchers also observed sex differences in the mediation effects, where science research motivation significantly mediated the relationship between perceptions of the communal value of scientific research and persistence for women but not men.

Furthermore, Truong et al. (2021) surveyed university lecturers in Vietnam and found significant sex differences in scientific research output. Male lecturers had higher research output compared to female lecturers. Petrović, Jovanović, Marković, Armenski and Marković (2014) conducted a study among hotel employees in Serbia and identified sex differences in two out of three factors related to service orientation, including organisational support and customer focus. Men attributed greater importance to

organisational support, emphasising structured labour and service procedures, while women expressed a higher level of significance towards customer focus and fostering positive relationships with guests. Other studies have also demonstrated the moderating effect of sex in different contexts. Gabal and Elhussiney (2020) found that sex significantly influenced emotional intelligence levels among university lecturers in Egypt. Walsh and Bartikowski (2013) discovered that the impact of emotional labour on job satisfaction and quitting intentions differed between male and female service employees in Germany. Usman, Kowalski, Andiappan and Parayitam (2022) highlighted the influence of sex on the relationships between knowledge sharing, psychological capital, emotional intelligence, trust, and organisational excellence among university lecturers in India. Karakuş (2013) found sex-related differences in the relationships between age, emotional intelligence, stress, anxiety, burnout, and depression among primary school instructors in Turkey. Jung and Yoon (2014) identified sex differences in predicting surface acting and deep acting based on others' emotion appraisal, self-emotion appraisal, and use of emotions among hotel employees in Korea.

In contrast, other studies have shown that the effects of their predictor variables on different outcomes do not differ by sex, suggesting that sex does not play a role in moderating such relationships. For instance, Varma and Singh (2022) and Biswas & Rahman (2021) conducted separate studies involving primary school instructors in India and bankers in Bangladesh, respectively, and both found no significant moderating effect of sex on job satisfaction. Similarly, Rahman (2017) examined high school teachers in Bangladesh and reported that sex does not moderate the relationships between independent variables, mediators and predicted variables regarding operational performance and job satisfaction. These results suggest that the impact of EI on job satisfaction remains consistent across sexes in these professional contexts. In the banking sector, Biswas and Rahman (2021) also found that sex had an insignificant moderating role in the

relationships between self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, social skills, and charismatic leadership. This implies that sex does not play a substantial role in influencing these relationships among bankers in Bangladesh.

Likewise, Liu et al. (2023) investigated the relationship between job stress, job satisfaction, and teaching self-efficacy among university lecturers in China. Their findings indicated that the mediation effect of teaching self-efficacy in the relationship between job stress and job satisfaction did not significantly differ by sex and workload. This suggests that sex and workload do not moderate the mediation process. In the context of bank tellers in Ghana, Dartey-Baah, Quartey, and Osafo (2020) observed that sex does not strongly influence the relationships between occupational stress and job satisfaction. Both male and female tellers reported comparable stress levels and similar experiences, implying that individuals of both sexes can achieve job satisfaction in this occupation. Examining the relationship between trait EI and teacher effectiveness, Anwar et al. (2021) found that sex does not moderate this relationship among ESL teachers in Pakistan. Therefore, the impact of trait EI on teacher effectiveness is consistent across sexes in this context. Furthermore, Burić and Kim (2021) conducted a longitudinal study involving teachers and school leaders in Croatia. They found no significant differences in the degree to which teacher self-efficacy predicts job satisfaction across sub-groups, including sex. This suggests that the association between teacher self-efficacy and job satisfaction remains consistent irrespective of sex.

Additional studies support the notion that sex does not significantly moderate certain relationships. Kong and Zhao (2013) investigated the affective mediator role between trait EI and life satisfaction among Chinese-speaking undergraduates and found no significant group differences between males and females. Similarly, Sánchez-Álvarez et al. (2015) conducted a longitudinal study with high school students in Spain. They found that positive and negative affect mediate EI and life satisfaction, with no differences

observed between males and females. A cross-sectional survey conducted by Demeijer (2020) with organisational employees in the Netherlands found that job satisfaction had a significant predictive influence on Organizational Citizenship Behavior (OCB). Surprisingly, sex did not moderate this relationship, indicating that the impact of job satisfaction on OCB was consistent regardless of sex. Interestingly, age interacted with sex, resulting in a significant three-way interaction between age, sex, and job satisfaction in predicting OCB. Similarly, Nijhawan, Gujral & Singh (2022) conducted a descriptive survey among employees in the IT industry in India. The study demonstrated that emotional intelligence significantly influenced Organizational Citizenship Behavior (OCB). Notably, when examining the impact of demographic variables, it was found that sex did not have a significant moderating effect on emotional intelligence skills in this context. However, the results suggested that the impact of emotional intelligence on OCB was more pronounced among females than males.

Moving to the impact of emotional intelligence on academic performance, Somaa, Asghar, and Hamid (2021) conducted a meta-analysis of existing literature. Their findings revealed a positive and significant correlation between emotional intelligence and academic performance. Moreover, the results indicated that sex partially moderated the relationship between emotional intelligence and academic performance, suggesting that the influence of emotional intelligence on academic outcomes may vary between sexes. Similarly, Amirian et al. (2023) conducted a cross-sectional survey with primary school instructors in Iran. The study revealed that teachers' emotional intelligence and increasing job demands behaviour significantly predicted teacher performance, irrespective of sex. Additionally, increasing job demand behaviour was found to have a stronger mediating effect than subjective well-being in the relationship between emotional intelligence and teachers' performance, regardless of sex.

Examining the cultural aspect of emotional intelligence, Pérez-Díaz, Perazzo, Chiesi, Marunic, Granville-Garcia, Paiva, and Petrides (2020) conducted a cross-sectional survey involving participants from various occupations across Brazil, Chile, Italy, and the UK. Their study uncovered significant differences in global trait emotional intelligence across countries for different sociodemographic variables. Nevertheless, the measurement invariance analysis indicated that trait emotional intelligence was consistent and comparable between sexes, ensuring the reliability of assessing emotional intelligence across different groups. Further investigating trait emotional intelligence across countries, Pérez-Díaz, Manrique-Millones, García-Gómez, Vásquez-Suyo, Millones-Rivalles, Fernández-Ríos, Pérez-González and Petrides (2022) conducted a study with mental healthcare patients in Spanish-speaking countries, including Chile, Peru, and Spain. The findings suggested significant differences in trait emotional intelligence across these countries, considering sociodemographic variables and their interactions. Importantly, measurement invariance analysis revealed that the measurement of trait emotional intelligence was consistent and comparable between sexes.

The empirical literature review on the moderating role of sex in various work-related contexts has revealed mixed results. While some studies have found significant sex differences in the relationships between predictor and outcome variables, others have shown that sex does not play a substantial role in moderating such relationships. These findings suggest a gap in understanding the consistent role of sex as a moderator in these contexts. The proposed study can be useful in bridging this knowledge gap by examining the moderating effects of sex, along with other demographic variables, on the relationship between emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals among University of Calabar lecturers in Cross River State, Nigeria. By focusing on a specific population and context, the study can provide insights into how sex influences the publication persistence of university lecturers in Nigeria, contributing to a

more comprehensive understanding of the role of sex as a moderator in academic publishing.

Another demographic variable assessed in terms of its moderating role in the relationship between two variables (predictors and outcomes) is age. Several studies have provided support for age as a moderator in different contexts. Biswas and Rahman (2021) explored the relationships between self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, social skills, and charismatic leadership among bankers in Bangladesh. They found that age had insignificant moderating roles in these relationships. However, the study suggested considering moderating or mediating variables to investigate these relationships further. Similarly, Truong et al. (2021) surveyed university lecturers in Vietnam and found that age significantly moderated scientific research output. Male lecturers had higher research output than female lecturers, and research output decreased with age, with the highest output observed in the 22-30 age group and the lowest in the over-50 age group. In the context of emotional intelligence (EI), Gabal and Elhussiney (2020) conducted a cross-sectional survey among university lecturers in Egypt. They found that age significantly influenced the levels of EI, with older individuals having different EI scores compared to younger ones. Additionally, they observed a noteworthy correlation between EI level and various factors, including total job satisfaction score, job performance, normative commitment, and affective commitment. Similarly, Nijhawan et al. (2022) conducted a descriptive survey among employees in the IT industry in India. They found that age moderated the relationship between EI skills and promoting better citizenship behaviour. The impact of EI on OCB was more pronounced among older employees than younger ones. The role of age as a moderator has also been investigated in the relationship between emotional labour and outcomes. Walsh and Bartikowski (2013) surveyed German service employees and found that age moderated the relationship between deep acting (a type of emotional labour) and job satisfaction. The connection between deep acting and job

satisfaction was stronger among younger service workers than older ones. Khetjenkarn (2018) conducted a cross-sectional survey among frontline employees in the hospitality industry in Thailand and identified the moderating roles of age and manager emotional intelligence in the relationship between emotional labour and organisational outcomes.

However, several studies provide opposing findings regarding the moderating role of age. For instance, Nasir et al. (2011) conducted a correlational study among employees in Iran and did not find age to moderate the relationship between job satisfaction and task performance. This suggests that age does not influence the strength or direction of the relationship between job satisfaction and task performance. Somaa et al. (2021) examined existing literature on the relationship between emotional intelligence and academic performance. They found that age did not moderate this relationship. This implies that the impact of emotional intelligence on academic performance is consistent across different age groups. Demeijer (2020) conducted a cross-sectional survey among organisational employees in the Netherlands. They found that age interacted with sex, leading to significant three-way interaction with job satisfaction in predicting organisational citizenship behaviour (OCB). Older men who were more satisfied with their jobs engaged in more OCB, whereas older women who were more satisfied with their jobs engaged in less OCB. However, age did not have a direct effect on OCB. Pérez-Díaz et al. (2020) found significant differences in global trait emotional intelligence (EI) across countries, occupations, educational attainment, and age. However, they determined that the measurement of trait EI was consistent and reliable across different age groups, suggesting acceptable measurement invariance. Again, Pérez-Díaz et al. (2022) conducted a study among mental healthcare patients in Spanish-speaking countries. They found significant differences in trait emotional intelligence across countries, including interactions with sociodemographic variables. However, when analysing age, they did not find measurement

invariance, suggesting that the measurement of trait emotional intelligence may vary across age groups.

The literature review on age as a moderating variable highlights the contrasting findings among previous studies, creating an evidence gap. While some studies did not find age to moderate specific relationships, others found age to interact with other variables, influencing the outcomes of interest. The complex nature of age as a moderator suggests that its influence may vary depending on the context and variables under investigation. Nevertheless, none of the previous studies has considered age as a moderating variable in the relationship between job satisfaction and persistence to publish. Similarly, none of the previous studies considered the moderating role of age in the relationship between emotional intelligence and persistence. However, there have been studies on the moderating effect of age on the relationship between emotional intelligence and job satisfaction. These are the knowledge gaps that the present study was able in the context of Cross River State, Nigeria.

Education level is the next demographic variable considered in terms of moderating function in several relationships. Nevertheless, there is a disagreement in the results of previous studies on the moderating role education plays in various relationships. Some studies have documented that education level significantly moderates the relationship between variables. For example, Truong et al. (2021) focused on university lecturers in Vietnam and explored the impact of academic degrees on scientific research output. Their study found significant differences in research output among different lecturer groups based on their degrees. Specifically, higher academic degrees corresponded to higher research output. Similarly, Anwar et al. (2021) surveyed ESL teachers in Pakistan to examine the relationship between trait emotional intelligence (EI) and teacher effectiveness. They discovered that the impact of trait EI on teacher effectiveness varied depending on the academic qualification of the individuals. The relationship was

moderated by the academic qualification, with differences observed between graduate/postgraduate degrees and PhD or similar degrees. Furthermore, Nasir et al. (2011) investigated the relationship between job satisfaction, task performance, and education among employees in Iran. Their findings indicated a significant correlation between job satisfaction and task performance, and they further revealed that the connection between job satisfaction and task performance was moderated by education. This suggests that the influence of job satisfaction on task performance varies depending on the level of education.

However, opposing studies have shown, on the contrary, that education does not play a significant mediation role in the relationship between different variables. For example, Biswas and Rahman (2021) investigated the moderating role of education in the relationship between self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, social skills, and charismatic leadership among bankers in Bangladesh. Their findings revealed that education had an insignificant moderating effect on these relationships. However, they suggested that considering other moderating or mediating variables and employing larger sample sizes would help generalise the research results. Similarly, Burić and Kim (2021) conducted a longitudinal study involving teachers and school leaders in Croatia. They explored the association between teacher self-efficacy (TSE) and job satisfaction across educational levels. Their results indicated that the association between TSE and job satisfaction remained consistent across educational levels, suggesting no significant differences in the degree to which TSE predicts job satisfaction among sub-groups. Moreover, Pérez-Díaz et al. (2020) examined the impact of education on global trait emotional intelligence (EI) across countries, including Brazil, Chile, Italy, and the UK. Their findings revealed significant differences in global trait EI based on educational attainment. However, the measurement invariance analysis demonstrated that the instrument used to measure trait EI was consistent and reliable across different educational

groups. Again, Pérez-Díaz et al. (2022) conducted a study involving mental healthcare patients in Spanish-speaking countries (Chile, Peru, and Spain) to assess the differences in trait emotional intelligence across countries and educational levels. Their results indicated significant differences in trait EI considering sociodemographic variables and their interactions. Measurement invariance analysis demonstrated that trait EI measurement was consistent and comparable between educational levels up to the scalar level.

Overall, the studies reveal mixed findings regarding the moderating role of education. While some studies found significant effects of education on specific relationships (such as job satisfaction and task performance and the relationship between trait EI and teacher effectiveness), others did not find significant moderation effects of education (such as the relationships between emotional intelligence and charismatic leadership, and teacher self-efficacy and job satisfaction). The variations in findings may be attributed to differences in the study samples, contexts, and methodologies employed. Nevertheless, the disagreement presents an opportunity for further studies to clarify the arguments. Most importantly, none of the cited studies was conducted in Africa, suggesting a gap in knowledge and context of the moderating role of age on emotional intelligence and different outcomes. The present study bridged these gaps by focusing on Cross River State, Nigeria as the context and university lecturers as the population. Besides, the study investigated the relationship between emotional intelligence (including its sub-dimensions) and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. Furthermore, the study explored the mediating role of job satisfaction and the moderating effects of demographic variables such as sex, education level and marital status.

Academic rank is the next demographic variable considered in the literature as a moderator in various relationships. The studies present mixed findings regarding the moderating role of position or rank on various relationships and outcomes. Some studies found insignificant moderating effects of position on relationships, such as self-awareness,

self-regulation, motivation, empathy, and social skills with charismatic leadership. For instance, Truong et al. (2021) found that higher academic titles were associated with higher scientific research output among university lecturers in Vietnam. Similarly, Gabal and Elhussiney (2020) observed that academic rank significantly influenced emotional intelligence levels among university lecturers in Egypt, which in turn correlated with job satisfaction, job performance, and commitment.

However, some studies did not find significant moderation effects based on rank or position. Liu et al. (2023) found that the mediation effect of teaching self-efficacy in the relationship between job stress and job satisfaction did not differ significantly based on lecturers' ranks in China. Nasir et al. (2011) also reported that tenure among employees in Iran did not moderate the connection between job satisfaction and task performance. The variations in findings can be attributed to differences in study samples, contexts, and methodologies used. Most of these studies were conducted in different countries with diverse cultural and organisational settings, which might influence the moderating effects of position on emotional intelligence-related outcomes.

Research on the influence of experience on different outcome variables presents a mix of findings. Some studies have found that experience does not significantly moderate relationships between self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, social skills, and charismatic leadership. For instance, a study by Liu et al. (2023) found that the mediation effect of teaching self-efficacy in the relationship between job stress and job satisfaction was stronger for more experienced university lecturers in China. Similarly, Nijhawan et al. (2022) demonstrated that the impact of emotional intelligence on organisational citizenship behaviour was more pronounced among less experienced employees in the IT industry in India. In addition, Truong et al. (2021) observed that lecturer experience positively influenced scientific research output among university lecturers in Vietnam.

Conversely, Sony and Mekoth (2016) found that the impact of self-emotion appraisal and others' emotion appraisal on frontline employee adaptability was greater for the high-experience group than the low-experience group in the power sector in India. Furthermore, Malik (2021) revealed that the influence of emotional intelligence on tacit knowledge sharing was stronger for individuals with high experience compared to those with low experience in global IT companies in India. These differing findings may be attributed to variations in study samples, contexts, and methodologies employed. Factors such as specific outcome measures, industries, and cultural contexts can contribute to the differences in how experience moderates the effects of emotional intelligence on various outcomes. Despite the existing research, there is a lack of studies specifically examining the moderating role of experience among university lecturers in Nigeria, particularly with a focus on emotional intelligence and persistence in publishing Scopus-indexed journals.

Other studies have examined the moderating role of different factors on the relationship between emotional intelligence and various outcomes. Regarding the field of study, Truong et al. (2021) found significant differences in scientific research output among university lecturers in Vietnam based on their scientific research area. Lecturers in the field of natural sciences had higher research output than those in social sciences. Additionally, the study found that lecturers without managerial positions had higher research output, possibly due to their busier schedules. Furthermore, lecturers who graduated abroad exhibited higher research output. These findings highlight the importance of considering the field of study and other contextual factors in understanding research productivity among university lecturers.

Regarding marital status, Gabal and Elhussiney (2020) reported that marital status significantly influenced the levels of emotional intelligence among university lecturers in Egypt. This suggests that marital status may affect emotional intelligence development and expression, potentially affecting lecturers' job performance and well-being. Similarly,

Nijhawan, Gujral, and Singh (2022) found that marital status did not moderate the relationship between emotional intelligence and organisational citizenship behaviour (OCB) among employees in the IT industry in India. However, their study indicated that the impact of emotional intelligence on OCB was more pronounced among unmarried employees than married employees. These findings highlight the complex interplay between marital status and emotional intelligence in different contexts. Regarding location, Kong and Zhao (2013) investigated the relationship between trait emotional intelligence, affective mediator, and life satisfaction among Chinese-speaking undergraduates. They found no significant group differences between rural and urban adults regarding the affective mediator in the relationship between trait emotional intelligence and life satisfaction. This suggests that the relationship between emotional intelligence and life satisfaction may be consistent across rural and urban populations.

2.4. Appraisal of the literature reviewed

This chapter reviewed existing literature on various sub-headings. The chapter discussed the concepts of emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and the persistence to publish. Existing instruments used in measuring these concepts were reviewed. The chapter also examined three theories such as emotional Intelligence theory by Goleman (1995), two-factor theory by Hertzberg (1968) and expectancy-value theory by Fishbein and Ajzen (1975). Thereafter, 195 unique empirical studies were reviewed and cited across the various themes underlying the study.

The literature synthesis revealed that four studies were conducted in Australia. Countries in the Asian continent made the most cumulative contributions, with a total of 98 of the 195 studies reviewed. The specific country contributions in Asia are as follows: Bangladesh (4 studies), Brunei Darussalam (1 study), Cambodia (1 study), China (10 studies), Hong Kong (1 study), India (17 studies), Indonesia (18 studies), Iran (15 studies),

Iraq (1 study), Israel (2 studies), Japan (1 study), Jordan (2 studies), Korea (1 study), Lebanon (2 studies), Malaysia (16 studies), Palestine (1 study), Pakistan (14 studies), Philippines (1 study), Saudi Arabia (1 study), Sri Lanka (3 studies), Taiwan (1 study), Thailand (2 studies), Turkey (10 studies), and Vietnam (4 studies). A total of 25 studies were conducted in Africa and distributed as follows: Egypt (3 studies), Ethiopia (3 studies), Ghana (1 study), Kenya (2 studies), Nigeria (14 studies), Somalia (1 study), South Africa (1 study), and Uganda (1 study). A total of 16 studies were conducted in Europe, with Croatia (1 study), France (1 study), Germany (3 studies), Greece (1 study), Hungary (1 study), Italy (1 study), Netherlands (2 studies), Romania (1 study), Serbia (1 study), Spain (3 studies), and the UK (1 study), all representing. Cross-country studies (7 studies) explored research across multiple nations, while one study did not specify a country. The few studies in Africa relative to Asia suggest the need for further research in this subject matter to consider the context of Africa.

In terms of research methods, quantitative studies were the most prevalent, with 174 studies utilising this data-driven approach. Qualitative methods were employed in 11 studies to delve into subjective understanding and interpretation. Additionally, six studies used mixed methods to combine quantitative and qualitative elements, while four focused on systematic reviews and meta-analyses. Adopting the quantitative research method in the current study is feasible and in line with the existing method employed by others. Regarding research design, correlational studies were the most prevalent, with 90 studies examining relationships between variables. Cross-sectional studies, capturing data at a single point in time, were also prominent, comprising 29 studies. Action research was employed in one study, while case studies provided in-depth insights in two studies. Ex-post facto studies, which explore cause-effect relationships after the fact, were conducted in six studies. Descriptive-explanatory studies accounted for seven, while descriptive surveys were employed in 13. Researchers also conducted literature reviews and meta-

analyses in four studies to synthesise existing knowledge. Other designs used included explanatory studies (3), exploratory studies (2), grounded theory (3), integrative synthesis (1), longitudinal studies (1), narrative inquiry (2), pre-post quasi-experimental designs (1), screening patterns (1), surveys (28), and two-phase-sequential designs (1).

Previous research has examined a diverse population. The largest population studied was academic staff in Higher Education Institutions (81 studies), followed by primary and secondary school teachers (44 studies). Other populations investigated included bank employees (5 studies), business entrepreneurs (1 study), corporate organisation employees (16 studies), doctoral studies (5 studies), early career researchers (2 studies), ESL (English as a Second Language) teachers (2 studies), expatriate university academics (1 study), health educators (1 study), hotel employees (5 studies), library personnel (1 study), existing literature (3 studies), local government employees (2 studies), medical personnel (5 studies), principal investigators of research labs (1 study), public servants (3 studies), researchers (4 studies), school counsellors (1 study), special education teachers (1 study), university undergraduates (5 studies), university leaders (1 study), vocational teachers (4 studies), and married individuals with at least one child (1 study). This suggests that the focus of the proposed study on university lecturers is not out of place, as this constitutes a part of the largest group studied.

In terms of the data collection method, the most prevalent was the questionnaire (172 studies), allowing for large-scale data collection and quantitative analysis. Interviews were conducted in 10 studies, providing in-depth qualitative insights into participants' perspectives and experiences. Literature reviews and bibliometric data analysis played a significant role in 5 studies, synthesising existing knowledge and identifying research trends. Mixed methods, combining questionnaires and interviews, were used in four studies to obtain a comprehensive understanding. Other methods, such as content analysis

(1 study), focus group discussions (1 study), pre-and post-programme data collection (1 study), and secondary data (1 study), have also been employed by previous studies.

In terms of data analysis, the most used method was Structural Equation Modelling (SEM), with a total of 75 studies grouped into three (Covariance-Based Structural Equation Modelling, 44 studies; Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modelling; 16 studies; Multigroup Analysis, 15 studies). Regression was the second most employed approach with a total of 71 studies, grouped as follows: Linear regression (Simple and Multiple) with 51 studies; Ordinary Least Squares Regression with two studies; Hierarchical regression with 12 studies; Tobit regression with one study and Logistic regression with 5 studies. Pearson correlation analysis (20 studies), one-way Analysis of Variance (2 studies) and thematic analysis (11 studies) also featured in the literature. Additionally, two studies adopted two-way ANOVA, MANOVA (Multivariate Analysis of Variance), meta-analysis, and content analysis, respectively. Furthermore, the following methods were employed in a smaller number of studies: T-test (3 studies), chi-square (1 study), Spearman correlation (1 study), canonical correlation (1 study), inductive and deductive coding (1 study). However, in one study, the analytical method was not applicable. The current study proposes to use Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modelling (PLS-SEM) and Multigroup Analysis (MGA) as the method of data analysis.

Generally, reviewing the existing body of knowledge has helped the researcher gain valuable insights into the topic and the methods and tools used by others in tackling similar or related problems. Nevertheless, several gaps exist in the literature based on the context, population, variables studied, and statistical techniques employed in these studies. First, no previous study worldwide has examined emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and the persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals by treating job satisfaction as a mediator and using demographic variables – sex, education level and marital status to moderate the tripartite nexus. Contextually, even though 25 studies were reviewed from

Africa, only 14 were conducted in Nigeria. The contextual gap arises due to the limited number of studies conducted in Cross River State, Nigeria, and the lack of focus on the variables used in the study. Out of the 14 Nigerian studies, only three were conducted in Cross River State, which indicates a scarcity of research specific to this region. Furthermore, none of these studies has utilised robust statistical techniques such as PLS-SEM or MGA for analysis, suggesting a gap in applying advanced analytical methods in this context. As a result, there is a need for research that specifically addresses the variables of interest within Cross River State, employing rigorous statistical techniques to enhance the depth and reliability of the findings. Closing this contextual gap would contribute to a more comprehensive understanding of the region and provide evidence for informed decision-making and policy development.

The previous studies conducted in various populations have yielded findings regarding the factors related to publication quality, research ability, research enthusiasm, and demographic differences in publication. However, Nigeria's academic population has been underrepresented, particularly in Cross River State, creating a population gap. This focused on University of Calabar lecturers in Cross River State, Nigeria, to address this gap and ensure inclusiveness. While previous studies have explored various aspects of research and publication, none of them has specifically considered "persistence to publish" as an outcome variable. This creates a knowledge gap in the literature, as the relationship between emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and the persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals remains unexplored. The most closely related variables to persistence to publish are "motivation to publish" and "research productivity". Motivation to publish refers to the internal drive to publish research works. In contrast, research productivity refers to the amount of research work a person has been able to publish over time. Thus, the persistence to publish can serve as the link between motivation to publish and research productivity. This is because merely having the intentions to publish without the ability to

persist through all the challenges might hinder productivity. Thus, the three variables, "motivation to publish", "research productivity", and "persistence to publish" (newly introduced in this study), are not the same. Recognising the distinction between these variables, the current study addressed the existing knowledge gap by investigating the relationship between emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and the newly introduced construct (persistence to publish). By examining how these factors influence the ability of researchers to persist in publishing their work in Scopus-indexed journals, the study has contributed to a more extensive understanding of the research process.

CHAPTER THREE

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter provides a comprehensive overview of the methods, procedures and tools adopted and followed during this study. The chapter describes the research design, data collection methods, and data analysis techniques utilised to address the research objectives. The chapter was organised in line with the following sub-headings:

3.1 Research design

3.2 Area of the study

3.3 Population of the study

3.4 Sampling techniques

3.5 Sample

3.6 Instrumentation

3.6.1 Validity of the instrument

3.6.2 Reliability of the instrument

3.7 Procedure for data collection

3.8 Procedure for data preparation

3.9 Procedure for data analysis

3.10. Operational definition of research variables

3.11. Ethical considerations

3.1 Research design

This study adopted the cross-sectional survey research design. According to Lavrakas (2008) “A cross-sectional survey collects data to make inferences about a population of interest (universe) at one point in time” (p.32). Where the researcher needs to test several variables at the same time, the cross-sectional survey design is used (Howitt & Cramer, 2011). This design was considered appropriate for this study because the study

examined the relationships between emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and the persistence to publish within the targeted population using data collected from a single administration of the instruments. The design further facilitated the simultaneous examination of multiple variables, encompassing the dimensions of emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and persistence to publish and the demographic attributes of lecturers. Moreover, the utilisation of a cross-sectional approach is particularly aligned with the exploratory nature of the study, as it offers a platform for hypothesis generation and identification of emerging trends within the data. Furthermore, the stratification of the results based on the demographic variables (such as sex, education level and marital status) of lecturers, holds promise for uncovering potential differentials within the investigated relationships. While the inherent limitations of establishing causality and tracking temporal developments characterize cross-sectional designs, the outcomes are anticipated to serve as a foundational reference for subsequent research endeavours.

3.2 Area of the study

The study was carried out at the University of Calabar, located in Calabar, Cross River State, Nigeria. This university, situated at Etta Agbor with an address of PMB 1115 Calabar, Cross River State, was formally established as a campus in 1975. The current Vice Chancellor of the institution is Prof. Florence Banku Obi. The university is positioned centrally within Calabar and features two distinct gates. The smaller gate directly faces EcoBank, while the main gate is positioned opposite Fidelity Bank PLC, both situated at Etta Agbor, Calabar. Geographically, the University of Calabar shares boundaries with the University of Cross River State (UNICROSS) formerly known as the Cross River University of Technology (CRUTECH) to the South, is bordered by the Qua River to the West, faces the University of Calabar Teaching Hospital to the North, and is adjacent to the aforementioned banks (EcoBank and Fidelity Bank) to the East.

The operational base of the institution is within Cross River State, situated in the South-South Geo-political zone of Nigeria. Established on May 27, 1967, it is named after the Cross River, which runs through the state. The state is situated in the Niger Delta region and covers an area of 21,019 square kilometres. Its geographical coordinates are approximately 5.8702° N latitude and 8.5988° E longitude. Cross River State shares borders with Benue State to the north, Ebonyi and Abia States to the west, the Cameroon Republic to the east, and Akwa-Ibom State and the Atlantic Ocean to the south.

According to the 2006 census, the state had a population of 2,892,988. However, current population projections for 2022 estimate that there are 4,406,200 people residing in Cross River State, making it the 29th most populous state in Nigeria. The state is divided into 18 local government areas (LGAs) with names arranged in alphabetical order: "Abi, Akamkpa, Akpabuyo, Bakassi, Bekwara, Biase, Boki, Calabar Municipal, Calabar South, Etung, Ikom, Obanliku, Obubra, Obudu, Odukpani, Ogoja, Yakurr, and Yala."

In terms of education, Cross River State is home to the University of Calabar (a federal university) and the University of Cross River State (UNICROSS), which is a state-owned university with campuses in Calabar, Obubra, Ogoja, and Okuku. Arthur Jarvis University, Akpabuyo and Havilla University Nde-Ikom are private universities in the area. There is a federal college of education in Obudu, Cross River College of Education in Akamkpa, and other institutions, such as: schools of health technology, nursing, and midwifery. The state is divided into three education zones: Ogoja, Calabar, and Ikom, with 81, 84, and 87 public secondary schools, respectively.

Politically, Cross River State is divided into three senatorial districts: southern, central, and northern. The primary languages spoken in the state are Efik, Bekwarra, and Ejagham. The main occupations in the state are farming, government service, and business. While most of the population practices Christianity, there are also followers of traditional religions, pagans, and Muslims.

Cross River State offers diverse eco-tourism attractions, including the impressive mountain plateaus of Obanliku, the lush rainforests of Afi, the captivating waterfalls of Agbokim and Kwa, and the scenic Calabar River. Visitors can explore notable sights like the Tinapa Business Resort, Calabar Marina, Calabar Residency Museum, and Calabar Slave Park. Other popular tourist destinations include the Ikom Monoliths, Mary Slessor Tomb, Calabar Drill Monkey Sanctuary, Cross River National Park, Afi Mountain walkway canopy, Kwa Falls, Tinapa Business Resort, Mono railway, and the annual Calabar Carnival, which takes place during the Christmas season. Access to Cross River State is possible through the Margaret Ekpo International Airport in Calabar, which offers daily flights from Lagos and Abuja operated by airlines, such as: Air Peace and Ibom Air. Previously, Cally Air provided flights but suspended operations in 2022 for unknown reasons.

The university of Calabar was specifically chosen as the context for the current study because it is among the institutions in Nigeria that have mandated academic staff to publish a certain proportion of their work in Scopus-indexed journals as a part of their promotion requirements. As earlier noted, the new policy has made some lecturers with several publications fail promotion, suffering the same fate as those who perished for refusing to publish (Owan & Asuquo, 2022). The policy has further stirred unrest among some lecturers, who are devising several strategies to meet the minimum requirements. Notably to the researcher, while some lecturers have navigated the process of publishing in Scopus-indexed journals and consequently gained promotion, others have struggled to publish in such journals, leading to promotion delays, whereas others are still struggling to record breakthrough. Thus, it became pertinent to understand why some lecturers could publish in Scopus-indexed journals while others are having difficulty doing the same in the institution.

3.3 Population of the study

The population of this study comprised all university lecturers from the rank of assistant lecturer to Professor in the University of Calabar, Nigeria, with at least one publication in the Scopus database. According to data gathered from Scopus, 1253 lecturers in the University of Calabar have at least one document in the Scopus database (Scopus Database, 2023). The eligibility criteria of the study are as follows: (1) The person is a lecturer in a public university in Cross River State, and their rank is within the range of assistant lecturer to Professor; (2) In addition to (1), the person has at least one publication in Scopus database. Therefore, individuals, such as: students or graduate assistants in the University of Calabar with one or more publications in the Scopus database are excluded from the study. Similarly, lecturers from the rank of assistant lecturer to Professor in the University of Calabar, without any publication in the Scopus database, are ineligible for the study. Furthermore, lecturers in other institutions other than the University of Calabar are excluded from the study regardless of their rank or number of publications in the Scopus database.

3.4 Sampling techniques

A priori power analysis was performed to determine the minimum sample size required to achieve an effect size of d = 0.25 or higher in correctly rejecting the null hypotheses of this study if they are false or retaining them if they are true; thereby reducing the chances of type I or II errors. The power analysis was performed using Soper's online a priori sample size calculator for structural equation models (Soper, 2023). In the calculator, the anticipated effect size is 0.25, considered a small effect size by experts (such as Cohen, 1988; Westland, 2010). The desired statistical power was set at 0.95 (95%), the number of variables was set at 15 (since the independent, mediator and outcome variables each have five dimensions), and the number of observed variables (items) was set at 76

(representing the total number of items in the questionnaire), with the probability level kept at the default 0.05 level. The result of the power analysis indicated that a sample of 454 lecturers is required to achieve the desired power. However, since lecturers are often very busy people, the chance of attrition is likely to be high. Thus, the required sample size was increased by 50% to account for a possible attrition, as recommended by some authorities (e.g., Burmeister & Aitken, 2012; Heo, 2014; Nayak, 2010). This increased the minimum sample size required from 454 to 681. Thus, a sample of 681 lecturers in the University of Calabar, that meets this study's eligibility criteria were recruited, representing 54.35% of the population.

However, the researcher adopted a systematic random sampling technique to select 54.35% of the population of this study as the sample for the study. The systematic random sampling technique was employed to select the actual participants of the study. This technique was adopted since the researcher has a list obtained from the Scopus database, of all lecturers in the University of Calabar, with at least one publication in the Scopus database. The researcher started selection from the second person on the list and skipped one author between selections. For example, while holding the list, the researcher selected the second person on the list, skipped the third, selected the fourth, skipped the fifth, then selected the sixth, and so on until the required number of lecturers for each school was reached.

3.5 Sample

The sample of this study comprised 681 lecturers in the University of Calabar, from the rank of assistant lecturer to Professor, with at least one publication in the Scopus database.

3.6 Instrumentation

Three sets of questionnaires were used for data collection such as: “Academic Staff Emotional Intelligence Questionnaire (ASEIQ),” “Lecturers’ Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (LJSQ),” and the “Persistence to Publish Questionnaire (PPQ).” The researcher developed the ASEIQ because the literature review of previous instruments showed an absence of previously developed and psychometrically sound instruments in Nigeria measuring emotional intelligence. Existing instruments developed in other contexts focused more on the medical population with a little focus on higher education lecturers. Nevertheless, the items in the ASEIQ were adapted and modified from previous instruments, such as: "The Emotional Intelligence Scale (Schutte, Malouff, Hall, Haggerty, Cooper, Golden & Dornheim, 1998), “the Emotional Competence Inventory 2.0” (Boyatzis, Goleman & Rhee, 2000), “the Workgroup Emotional Intelligence Profile-3” (Jordan, Ashkanasy, Härtel & Hooper, 2002), “the Multidimensional Emotional Intelligence Assessment” (Tett, Fox & Wang, 2005), "the Emotional Intelligence Appraisal” (Bradberry & Greaves, 2009), and “Emotional Self-Awareness Questionnaire” (Killian, 2011) to suit peculiarities of the academic staff in Nigeria. The ASEIQ has two sections – A and B. Section A was developed to contain information on the demographic characteristics of the respondents such as sex, age, education level, rank, marital status, and years of work experience. Section B contained five sub-scales: self-awareness (five items), self-regulation (six items), social awareness (five items), internal motivation (five items), and empathy (five items). There was a total of 26 items in section B of the ASIEQ,

with response options on a four-point Likert scale format, such as "Strongly Agree," "Agree," "Disagree", and "Strongly Disagree."

The Lecturers' Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (LJSQ) was developed to by the researcher to measure job satisfaction among lecturers due to the lack of an existing instrument, with acceptable psychometric properties, in Nigeria and, specifically, Cross River State. There was, therefore, a need to develop an instrument that can be used to assess job satisfaction among Nigerian lecturers. The items in the LJSQ were adapted and modified from previous instruments such as "Job Satisfaction Questionnaire" (Johnson, 1955), "Job Satisfaction of Industrial Salesmen Scale (Churchill, Ford, & Walker, 1974), "The Warr-Cook-Wall Scale" (Warr, Cook & Wall, 1979), "Job Satisfaction Survey" (Spector, 1985), "Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire" (Lester, 1987), "Academic Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (Al-Rubaish, Rahim, Abumadini & Wosornu, 2011), "Job Satisfaction Scale for Different Sectors" (Nanjundeswaraswamy, 2019). There was only one section in the LJSQ, with items organised into five sub-scales: satisfaction with work conditions (four items), satisfaction with remuneration (five items), satisfaction with workload allocation (five items), satisfaction with career advancement opportunities (six items) and satisfaction with research support (four items). There was a total of 24 items in the LJSQ, organised on a five-point Likert-type scale of satisfaction. Response options included the following: "Very Satisfied," "Satisfied," "Neutral," "Dissatisfied" and "Very Dissatisfied". The five-point Likert scale was preferred to align with most previous instruments measuring employee satisfaction and to control for common method response bias (see Kock, Berbekova & Assaf, 2021).

The "Persistence to Publish Questionnaire (PPQ)" was developed to measure lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. The researcher developed and validated the instrument due to the lack of a previously developed instrument measuring the construct. Some of the items included in the PPQ were adapted and modified from the

"Self-Appraisal Schedule" (Wang, 1932), and Persistence in the Academic Domain Questionnaire (Lufi, 1979). However, most of the items in the PPQ were based on the researcher's experiences with the publication processes and dynamics in Scopus-indexed journals. The PPQ has only one section subdivided into five sub-scales: persistence with manuscript preparation (six items), persistence with manuscript submission (four items), persistence in handling revisions (five items), persistence in dealing with rejections (five items), and persistence in publication delays (six items). There was a total of 26 items in the PPQ arranged on a six-point Likert scale format, with response options such as "Very Strongly Disagree," "Strongly Disagree," "Disagree," "Agree," "Strongly Agree," and "Very Strongly Agree." As earlier stated, the researcher varied the response options across the three questionnaires to minimise response bias due to common methods. Besides, it has been argued that a six points Likert scale offers advantages for measuring attitudes and opinions compared to traditional five-point scales. The additional point allows for finer differentiation and reduced neutral bias (Harland, Dawkin & Martin, 2015). It provides a balanced midpoint, increased sensitivity, better discrimination, and can enhance statistical analysis (Leung, 2011).

3.6.1 Validity of the instrument

A physical copy of the Emotional Intelligence, Job Satisfaction and the Persistence to Publish Survey (EIJSPPS) was submitted to nine independent experts for face and content validity. The experts were in Research, Measurement and Evaluation (n = 5) and Educational Psychology (n = 4). The seven assessors independently went through the questionnaire and rated the extent to which items were relevant, clear, simple and unambiguous in measuring the variables of this study. The rating was done on a scale of four, with higher values, such as: three and four indicating that the item is relevant, clear, simple and/or unambiguous in measuring intended constructs. Conversely, ratings of one

and two indicated that an item is irrelevant, unclear, difficult and/or ambiguous item. Their independent ratings were collated and scored, following the quantitative approach to content validity suggested by some scholars (Hadi, Omar, Osman, Ibrahim & Hussaini, 2020; Lawshe, 1975; Zamanzadeh, Rassouli, Abbaszadeh, Majd, Nikanfar & Ghahramanian, 2014). More specifically, the experts' ratings were converted into binary data (with zero used to denote items with ratings of either 1 or 2 and 1 used to denote ratings of 3 and 4). Thus, a value of one suggests that the item is relevant, clear, simple and/or unambiguous, and a value of zero suggests that the item is not relevant, clear, simple and/or unambiguous in measuring the variable. However, in deciding which items should be retained, revised or deleted, the average proportion of experts' agreement was computed to determine the Item Content Validity Index (I-CVI) and Scale Content Validity Index (S-CVI). The analysis results are summarised in Table 1.

The results in Table 1 suggested that the I-CVIs for most variables across relevance, clarity, simplicity and ambiguity were acceptable. However, the researcher examined the I-CVIs of individual items to identify those with values lower than 0.70. Items SOA3 and INM7 both had I-CVIs of 0.67 for relevance. Similarly, items, such as: SAW2, SRE3, SRE6, SOA2, SOA4, INM7, EMP5, EMP8, MPR1, MPR2, MPR3, MPR4, MPR5, MSU4, MSU5, and MSU8 had I-CV value of 0.67, respectively for clarity. Again, items, such as: SAW2, SRE2, SRE3, INM5, MPR1, MPR2, MPR6, MSU1 and HRE1 had an I-CVI value of 0.67 for simplicity, respectively. Furthermore, items, such as: SAW5, SRE4, SRE6, INM4, EMP5, MSU1 and MSU5 had an I-CVI value of .67, respectively for ambiguity. All the items listed above were revised for improved relevance, clarity, simplicity and unambiguity, where applicable, following the experts' suggestions.

TABLE 1

Item- and Scale-content validity indices for the three questionnaires

ASEIQ	Basis	Self-awareness	Self-regulation	Social awareness	Internal motivation	Empathy
I-CVIs	Relevance	.83 – .99	.83 – .99	.67 – .99	.67 – .99	.83 – .99
	Clarity	.67 – .99	.67 – .99	.67 – .99	.67 – .99	.67 – .99
	Simplicity	.67 – .99	.67 – .99	.83 – .99	.67 – .83	.67 – .99
	Ambiguity	.67 – .99	.67 – .99	.83 – .99	.67 – .99	.67 – .99
S-CVIs	Relevance	.93	.96	.85	.94	.91
	Clarity	.89	.83	.81	.92	.83
	Simplicity	.90	.81	.85	.88	.85
	Ambiguity	.88	.81	.90	.88	.88
LJSQ	Basis	Work conditions	Remuneration	Workload	Career Advancement	Research Support
I-CVIs	Relevance	.83 – .99	.83 – .99	.83 – .99	.99 (all items)	.99 (all items)
	Clarity	.83 – .99	.99 (all items)	.83 – .99	.99 (all items)	.99 (all items)
	Simplicity	.83 – .99	99 (all items)	.83 – .99	.99 (all items)	.99 (all items)
	Ambiguity	.83 – .99	99 (all items)	.83 – .99	.99 (all items)	.99 (all items)
S-CVIs	Relevance	.95	.91	.95	.99	.99
	Clarity	.96	.99	.98	.99	.99
	Simplicity	.94	.99	.96	.99	.99
	Ambiguity	.96	.99	.96	.99	.99
PPQ	Basis	Manuscript preparation	Manuscript submission	Handling revisions	Dealing with rejections	Publication delays
I-CVIs	Relevance	.83 (all items)	.83 – .99	.99 (all items)	.99 (all items)	.83 – .99
	Clarity	.67 – .83	.67 – .83	.99 (all items)	99 (all items)	.83 – .99
	Simplicity	.67 – .83	.67 – .99	.67 – .99	.99 (all items)	.83 – .99
	Ambiguity	.83 (all items)	.67 – .99	.67 – .99	.83 – .99	.83 – .99
S-CVIs	Relevance	.83	.85	.99	.99	.98
	Clarity	.73	.79	.99	.99	.98
	Simplicity	.77	.83	.96	.99	.98
	Ambiguity	.83	.81	.85	.90	.92

Note: I-CVIs of .70 or above suggest that the item has an acceptable rating (with 70% or more of the experts' agreement). Values between 0.50 to .69 suggest that the items need revisions; values below .50 indicate that less than 50% of experts agree, suggesting that such items should be discarded (Hadi et al., 2020; Lawshe, 1975; Zamanzadeh et al., 2014)

The researcher conducted a Focus Group Session with 10 university of Calabar lecturers who had published at least an article in Scopus-indexed journals but were not selected as a part of the main study. The essence of the session was to gather qualitative views and opinions regarding the items in the survey. The lecturers' opinions and views on the survey items were analysed, focusing on the measured construct and suggestions for improvement. Further revisions were made to the survey items to address concerns in line with the recommendations raised by the lecturers. This included refining item wording, clarifying ambiguous items, and considering the shortening of the overall scale length, among others.

The next step was to conduct a pilot study. Before conducting the pilot study, it was important to consider the sample size of respondents in the pilot sample required to obtain reliable results. While there are no universally agreed-upon rules for determining sample size, several scholars have proposed rules of thumb to guide this process. For instance, some scholars have recommended a sample of 300 respondents as the minimum sample size for factor analysis (e.g., Clark & Watson, 2016; Tabachnick, Fidell & Ullman, 2013). Similarly, Kline (2015) suggested a ratio of 20 to 1, meaning 20 observations for each estimated parameter. However, others have proposed lower ratios, such as 10 to 1 (Schreiber, Nora, Stage, Barlow & King, 2006) or 5 to 1 (Bentler & Chou, 1987). Nevertheless, a smaller sample size may be sufficient, while in other cases, a larger sample size may be required (Kline, 2015).

Thus, a sample of 330 lecturers was targeted for the pilot study. These lecturers have at least a publication in Scopus-indexed journals and differ from those selected for the main study. The researcher administered physical and electronic copies of the survey to the 330 lecturers but gathered responses from 285, suggesting attrition of 45 lecturers. Nevertheless, the researcher considers the 285 responses relatively large enough for the data to be subjected to factor analysis or structural equation modelling techniques since it

is closer to 300 by a difference of 15 responses. Besides, the graded scale provided by Comrey and Lee suggests that sample sizes of 100 are considered poor, 200 as fair, 300 as good, 500 as very good, and sample sizes of 1,000 or more are regarded as excellent for SEM (Comrey & Lee, 1992). This suggests that the responses gathered from the sample of 285 respondents are fair enough.

The quality of the data collected from the pilot sample was assessed through various preliminary tests to ensure its reliability and validity. First, the data was assessed for missingness. The data were assessed for normality using histograms, Shapiro-Wilk's, Kolmogorov-Smirnov, and Q-Q plots. Outliers were assessed first by inspecting the dataset for out-of-range values that may have been erroneously introduced during the data imputation stage. However, no outlier was detected. Boxplots were also used to examine the data for potential outliers across all the items. No outliers were detected from the boxplots because the boxplots did not show any data points that fell beyond the whiskers. Data were assessed for multivariate outliers using a Mahalanobis Distance Test (Tabachnick & Fidell, 2013). A total of 23 multivariate outliers were identified and removed. Removing the multivariate outliers further reduced the number of cases from 285 to 262.

Exploratory Factor Analysis (EFA) was performed on the pilot data obtained for the items in the three questionnaires (ASEIQ, LJSQ and PPQ). Principal Axis Factoring (PAF) was the extraction method, with a varimax rotation, used to identify the factorial structure of the scale. The analysis was set to extract factors with Eigenvalues greater than one, while items with loadings below .50 were suppressed. The results obtained for each of the questionnaires are discussed hereunder. For the ASEIQ, 11 factors were initially extracted and cumulatively explained 55.47% of the variance. However, an examination of the rotated factor matrix revealed several dysfunctional items. These include items that did not load unto any factor, such as SOA6, EMP5, SOA3, INM6, INM4, SOA7, SRE4,

EMP6, INM2, SAW4, and SAW2. It also included items that loaded solely to individual factors, such as: EMP5, SPE8, EMP1, and SAW7. Five factors emerged after dropping the above dysfunctional items, cumulatively explaining 74.12% of the total variance. Specifically, Factors 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5 explained 21.13, 16.25, 14.85, 11.95 and 9.96% of the total variance, respectively. The KMO value of .87 indicated that the sample size of 262 respondents in the pilot sample was adequate to do an EFA test. Bartlett's test of sphericity yielded a significant value, $\chi^2(351) = 7544.95$, $p < .05$. Examining the rotated factor matrix aided in naming the factors after assessing the items loaded unto them. Thus, factor 1 was named: self-regulation; factor 2 = empathy; factor 3 = self-awareness; factor 4 = social awareness; factor 5 = internal motivation. The specific factor loadings of each retained item can be found in Appendix VI.

For the LJSQ, the analysis initially extracted 11 factors with eigenvalues greater than one. The 11 factors cumulatively explained 58.9% of the total variance. However, it was discovered from the rotated factor matrix that three factors were empty since no items were loaded unto them. Furthermore, the following items did not load to any factor; WLO2, RSU7, WCON1, CAO6, WLO8, WCON6, CAO1, REM3, REM5, WLO4, RSU6, and RSU3. Some solitary items also loaded on three factors: WCON2, REM6 and RSU2. After removing the problematic items, the analysis was re-run, and this time, a KMO of 0.88 was obtained with a significant value of Bartlett's test of sphericity $\chi^2(276) = 7140.61$, $p < .05$. Five factors emerged with Eigenvalues greater than one. The factors cumulatively explained 80.54% of the variance. Individually, factor 1 explained 23.61% of the variance, whereas factors 2, 3, 4 and 5 accounted for 18.43%, 15.15%, 13.15%, and 10.20% of the total variance, respectively. An examination of the rotated factor matrix aided in the naming of the factors. Consequently, factors 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5 were named satisfaction with career advancement opportunities, workload allocation, remuneration, research support, and work conditions. The full result of the EFA is presented in Appendix VII.

For the PPQ, an initial 11-factor solution was revealed. The 11 factors cumulatively explained 72.93% of the total variance. Nevertheless, examining the rotated factor matrix revealed several problematic and dysfunctional items. For instance, several items did not load unto any factor, such as PDE7, MPR4, DWR8, DWR5, MPR7, HRE8, MSU4, HRE4, DWR4 and MSU5. Thus, they were deleted. Two items (HRE2 and PDE6) were deleted because they did not correlate with other items in the analysis. Furthermore, two items (MSU3 and MSU6) loaded to factor 6. However, a minimum of three items are needed to retain a factor. As a result, the two items were further deleted. The analysis was reperformed without the problematic items using the same settings. The result extracted five factors with Eigenvalues greater than one. The five factors jointly explained 79.70% of the total variance. Relatively, factors 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5 explained 21.95, 19.73, 16.24, 11.49 and 10.29% of the total variance, respectively. The rotated factor matrix was examined for naming purposes. The factors were named “persistence in manuscript preparation (factor 1)”, “persistence in publication delays” (factor 2), “persistence in handling revisions” (factor 3), “persistence in dealing with rejections” (factor 4) and “persistence in manuscript submission” (factor 5). The KMO value of sampling adequacy was 0.87, while Bartlett’s test of sphericity was statistically significant, $\chi^2(325) = 8311.95$, $p < .05$. The summarised results can be found in Appendix VIII.

3.6.2 Reliability of the instrument

The reliability evidence for the three instruments was gathered a measure of internal consistency – Cronbach alpha (α). The reliability analysis was performed based on the data used for the dimensionality test, obtained from the pilot sample of 262 respondents. The Academic Staff Emotional Intelligence Questionnaire (ASEIQ) consisted of five sub-scales: self-regulation, empathy, self-awareness, social awareness, and internal motivation. The questionnaire demonstrates high internal consistency, with

Cronbach's α values for the factors ranging from .858 to .987, indicating good internal consistency (See Table 2). The Lecturers' Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (LJSQ) comprised five sub-scales: satisfaction with career advancement opportunities, workload allocation, remuneration, research support, and work conditions. According to Table 2, the LJSQ demonstrated good internal consistency, with Cronbach's α values ranging from .883 to .982, indicating high internal consistency for all factors. The Persistence to Publish Questionnaire (PPQ) consisted of five factors, such as persistence in: manuscript preparation, publication delays, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and manuscript submission. Table 2 shows that the questionnaire demonstrates strong internal consistency, with Cronbach's α values ranging from .885 to .989, across all factors.

3.7 Procedure for data collection

The researcher obtained a letter from the Head of the Department of Educational Foundations authorising him to administer the instruments. The signed and stamped letter of authorisation (See Appendix IX) was photocopied and fastened to each bundle of the physical survey and uploaded as the first page of the electronic survey. The authorisation letter served as the cover letter for respondents stating the main purpose of the research and soliciting their participation before seeking their informed-consent in the following page.

TABLE 2

Cronbach alpha reliability evidence for the three instruments (n = 262)

Instrument	Sub-scales	K	M	SD	α
ASEIQ	Self-Awareness	5	12.64	4.95	.950
	Self-Regulation	6	14.47	6.18	.987
	Social Awareness	5	12.36	4.70	.906
	Empathy	5	12.31	5.36	.970
	Internal Motivation	5	12.13	4.37	.858
LJSQ	Work Conditions	4	11.48	4.82	.883
	Remuneration	5	15.37	6.27	.926
	Workload Allocation	5	14.73	6.47	.971
	Career Advancement	6	18.19	7.96	.982
	Research Support	4	11.98	5.42	.945
PPQ	Manuscript Preparation	6	22.00	9.94	.989
	Manuscript Submission	4	14.33	5.81	.885
	Handling Revisions	5	17.91	7.88	.950
	Dealing with Rejections	5	16.75	6.91	.894
	Publication Delays	6	20.04	9.69	.973

Notes:
ASEIQ = Academic Staff Emotional Intelligence Questionnaire
LJSQ = Lecturers' Job Satisfaction Questionnaire
PPQ = Persistence to Publish Questionnaire
K = Number of items in a subscale
M = Mean
SD = Standard deviation
α = Cronbach alpha

Data was collected for this study using the physical and electronic administration of the instruments. The paper version of the instruments was physically administered to selected eligible lecturers in their respective offices. The researcher and five trained research assistants used the names and department information provided by Scopus databases to visit selected lecturers' offices physically. The lecturers were given copies of the instruments to fill out at their convenience. After one week, the researcher and his research assistants revisited the lecturers to retrieve physically administered copies of the instruments. However, lecturers willing to respond to the survey on the spot were granted the privilege to fill it out and return it immediately. The electronic survey version was created using Google Forms to complement the paper version. It was useful in reaching eligible and selected lecturers in distant locations (such as those outside the state or country), beyond the physical reach of the research team. However, physically present respondents had the freedom to decide whether to fill the paper of electronic versions of the instruments, depending on which they considered more convenient. Google Forms was specifically chosen over others such as SurveyMonkey, Poll Fish, Poll Everywhere and Survey CTO because it is free and easy to use. Upon completing the exercise, the researcher and the research assistants retrieved the administered copies of the survey for processing. Of the 681 participants targeted, complete and usable data were gathered from 644 respondents, suggesting that there was an attrition rate of 5.43% and a response rate of 94.57%. Since the attrition was low and the usable responses was from a sample larger than the minimum required to achieve a 95%, with a large effect size (d = .50), it was pertinent to proceed with the data for statistical analysis.

3.8 Procedure for data preparation

The responses to the electronic version of the survey were downloaded first in the .csv (comma-separated values) and converted to .xlsx (Microsoft Excel format). The were

was cleaned and recoded (where applicable) by converting all alphabetic responses to their quantitative equivalents (see the scoring pattern below). After that, the researcher manually scored the responses to the paper versions of the survey after serially numbering each completed questionnaire. The survey responses were scored differently for the ASEIQ, LJSQ and PPQ. For the ASEIQ, responses indicating strongly agree, agree, disagree and strongly disagree were assigned scores such as: 4 points, 3 points, 2 points, and 1 for all positively worded items. A reverse scoring approach was implemented for negatively worded items. Thus, 1 point, 2 points, 3 points, and 4 points were allocated to "Strongly Agree," "Agree," "Disagree," and "Strongly Disagree."

For the LJSQ, responses indicating "Very Satisfied," "Satisfied," "Neutral," "Dissatisfied", and "Very Dissatisfied" were awarded 5 points, 4 points, 3 points, 2 points, and 1 point, respectively. A reverse scoring was implemented for the same responses. For the PPQ, a score of 1 point, 2 points, 3 points, 4 points, 5 points and 6 points were allocated to responses indicating "Very Strongly Disagree," "Strongly Disagree," "Disagree," "Agree," "Strongly Agree," and "Very Strongly Agree" for positive items. On the contrary, 6 points, 5 points, 4 points, 3 points, 2 points and 1 point were allocated to responses indicating "Very Strongly Disagree," "Strongly Disagree," "Disagree," "Agree," "Strongly Agree," and "Very Strongly Agree" for negatively worded items. After scoring all the responses to the electronic and offline surveys, the data obtained from both sources were merged. The data were coded according to the coding schedule prepared for this study, as shown in Table 3.

TABLE 3

Schedule for coding the data according to the variables of the study

Variable	Role	Levels/Code	Column
Sex	Moderator	Male = 1 Female = 2	1
Age	None	Below 40 years = 1 40 – 49 years = 2 50 – 59 years = 3 60 years and above = 4	2
Education level	Moderator	Master's Degree = 1 Doctorate Degree = 2	3
Rank	None	Assistant Lecturer = 1 Lecturer II = 2 Lecturer I = 3 Senior Lecturer = 4 Associate Professor = 5 Professor = 6	4
Marital status	Moderator	Single = 1 Married = 2	5
Work experience	None	Less than 10 years = 1 10 to 19 years = 2 20 years and above = 3	6
Self-Awareness	Exogenous	Add scores of items 1 to 5 in section B of the ASEIQ	7
Self-Regulation	Exogenous	Add scores of items 6 to 11 in section B of the ASEIQ	9
Social Awareness	Exogenous	Add scores of items 12 to 16 in section B of the ASEIQ	10
Internal Motivation	Exogenous	Add scores of items 17 to 26 in section B of the ASEIQ	11
Empathy	Exogenous	Add scores of items 22 to 26 in section B of the ASEIQ	12
Work conditions	Mediator	Add scores of items 1 to 4 of the LJSQ	13
Remuneration	Mediator	Add scores of items 5 to 9 of the LJSQ	14
Workload allocation	Mediator	Add scores of items 10 to 14 of the LJSQ	15
Career advancement	Mediator	Add scores of items 15 to 20 of the LJSQ	16
Research support	Mediator	Add scores of items 21 to 24 of the LJSQ	17
Manuscript preparation	Endogenous	Add scores of items 1 to 6 of the PPQ	18
Manuscript submission	Endogenous	Add scores of items 9 to 16 of the PPQ	19
Handling revisions	Endogenous	Add scores of items 17 to 24 of the PPQ	20
Dealing with rejections	Endogenous	Add scores of items 25 to 32 of the PPQ	21
Publication delays	Endogenous	Add scores of items 33 to 40 of the PPQ	22

3.9 Procedure for data analysis

To analyse the prepared and coded data, the researcher revisited the hypotheses underlying the study. Each hypothesis was restated, the variables were identified and their roles, and the statistical technique suitable for testing each hypothesis. The decision rule is that a result is declared significant if the p-value associated with the statistical outcome is less than .05 alpha level. The research questions posed in introductory chapter of this study were not answered since they have been converted into the hypotheses that were tested. The procedures followed for data analysis are as follows:

Hypothesis One

Job satisfaction variables have no significant joint and partial mediation effects on the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, in terms of manuscript preparation, manuscripts submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays.Exogenous variable: Self-awareness

Mediators: Job satisfaction variables

Endogenous variable: Persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals

Statistical technique: Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modelling (PLS-SEM)

Hypothesis Two

There is no significant joint and partial effects of job satisfaction variables in mediating the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers’ persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

Exogenous variable: Self-regulation

Mediators: Job satisfaction variables

Endogenous variable: Persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals

Statistical technique: PLS-SEM

Hypothesis Three

Job satisfaction variables have no significant joint and partial mediation effects in the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

Exogenous variable: Social awareness

Mediators: Job satisfaction variables

Endogenous variable: Persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals

Statistical technique: PLS-SEM

Hypothesis Four

There is no significant joint and partial mediation of job variables in the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

Exogenous variable: Internal motivation

Mediators: Job satisfaction variables

Endogenous variable: Persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals

Statistical technique: PLS-SEM

Hypothesis Five

There is no significant joint and partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

Exogenous variable: Empathy

Mediators: Job satisfaction variables

Endogenous variable: Persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals

Statistical technique: PLS-SEM

Hypothesis Six

There is no significant composite second-order mediation effect of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

Exogenous variable: Emotional intelligence

Mediator: Job satisfaction

Endogenous variable: Persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals

Statistical technique: PLS-SEM

Hypothesis Seven

There is no significant variation in the extent to which job satisfaction variables jointly and partially mediate the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, based on lecturers' sex, education level and marital status.

Exogenous variable: Self-awareness

Mediators: Job satisfaction variables

Endogenous variable: Persistence to publish across the five dimensions

Moderators: Sex, education level and marital status

Statistical technique: Multigroup Analysis (MGA)

Hypothesis Eight

There is no significant variation in the joint and partial mediation of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, based on their sex, education level and marital status.

Exogenous variable: Self-regulation

Mediators: Job satisfaction variables

Endogenous variable: Persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals

Moderators: Sex, education level and marital status

Statistical technique: Multigroup Analysis (MGA)

Hypothesis Nine

The joint and partial mediation of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between social awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, does not vary significantly with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status.

Exogenous variable: Social Awareness

Mediators: Job satisfaction variables

Endogenous variable: Persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals

Moderators: Sex, education level and marital status

Statistical technique: Multigroup Analysis (MGA)

Hypothesis Ten

The effect of job satisfaction variables in jointly and partially mediating the relationship between internal motivation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, does not vary significantly with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status.

Exogenous variable: Internal motivation

Mediators: Job satisfaction variables

Endogenous variable: Persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals

Moderators: Sex, education level and marital status

Statistical technique: Multigroup Analysis (MGA)

Hypothesis Eleven

The role of job satisfaction variables in jointly and partially mediating the relationship between empathy and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, does not significantly vary with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status.

Exogenous variable: Empathy

Mediators: Job satisfaction variables

Endogenous variable: Persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals

Moderators: Sex, education level and marital status

Statistical technique: Multigroup Analysis (MGA)

Hypothesis Twelve

The composite second-order mediation effect of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, does not significantly vary with their sex, education level and marital status.

Exogenous variable: Emotional intelligence

Mediators: Job satisfaction

Endogenous variable: Persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals

Moderators: Sex, education level and marital status

Statistical technique: Second-order Multigroup Analysis (MGA)

3.10. Operational definition of research variables

The following variables were defined operationally based on their use and roles in the study.

Self-awareness: This refers to a lecturer’s ability to recognise their emotions, understand their causes, and how they affect their thoughts and behaviour. This study measured this exogenous variable using items 1 – 5 in section B of the ASEIQ.

Self-regulation: This refers to a lecturer’s ability to manage their emotions and impulses constructively. The variable will serve an exogenous function in this study and was measured using items 6 – 11 in section B of the ASEIQ.

Social awareness: This is the ability of a lecturer to understand and respond to the emotions of others. This exogenous variable was measured using items 12 – 16 in section B of the ASEIQ.

Internal motivation: This is a lecturer's inner drive to achieve their short- or longer-term goals. This exogenous variable was measured using items 17 – 21 in section B of the ASEIQ.

Empathy: This refers to a lecturer's ability to understand and share another person's feelings. The exogenous variable was measured using items 22 – 26 in section B of the ASEIQ.

Emotional intelligence: This is the ability of lecturers to perceive, understand, manage, and use their own emotions and the emotions of others. This was considered a second-order exogenous variable in this study and was determined by the composite score of self-awareness, self-regulation, social awareness, internal motivation and empathy.

Satisfaction with work conditions: This refers to how satisfied a lecturer is with the physical and environmental aspects of their job, such as the office space, the equipment they use, and the hours they work. This mediating variable was measured using items 1 – 4 of the LJSQ.

Satisfaction with remuneration: This refers to how satisfied a lecturer is with their salary, benefits, and other forms of compensation. This mediating variable was assessed using the LJSQ, specifically items 5 – 9.

Satisfaction with workload allocation: This refers to how satisfied a lecturer is with the amount of work they are assigned, the difficulty of the work, and the deadlines they must meet. The LJSQ measured the mediating variable with items 10 – 14.

Satisfaction with career advancement opportunities: This refers to how satisfied a lecturer is with the opportunities provided in the university to advance their career, such as promotions, training, and development programmes. Items 15 – 20 of the LJSQ was used to measure the mediating variable.

Satisfaction with research support: This refers to how satisfied a lecturer is with the resources available to conduct research, such as funding, equipment, and access to data. The mediating variable was measured using specific questions from the LJSQ, items 21 – 24.

Job satisfaction: This is a general measure of how satisfied lecturers are with their job overall. This is a second-order mediator variable in this study and was estimated using the composite loadings of the five dimensions, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support.

Persistence in manuscript preparation: The ability of lecturers to continue working on a manuscript despite challenges, such as lack of time, resources, or motivation. This endogenous variable was measured using items 1 – 6 of the PPQ.

Persistence in manuscript submission: The ability of lecturers to submit a manuscript to a journal despite the difficulty in journal formatting requirements, accessing relevant templates, filling out online forms or writing cover letters. The endogenous variable was measured using items 7– 10 of the PPQ.

Persistence in handling revisions: The ability of lecturers to revise a manuscript in response to reviewer(s) feedback and resubmit it to the same or other journals. The endogenous variable was measured using items 11 – 15 of the PPQ.

Persistence in dealing with rejections: The ability of lecturers to cope with the disappointment of manuscript rejections and continue the publication process by submitting manuscripts to journals. The endogenous variable was measured using items 16 – 20 of the PPQ.

Persistence in publication delays: The ability of lecturers to wait patiently for a manuscript to be published, even if it takes several months or even years. The endogenous variable was assessed using a subset of items from the PPQ, specifically items 21 – 26.

Persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals: This is the overall ability of lecturers to sustain motivation and continue pressing to publish manuscripts in Scopus-indexed journals, irrespective of the difficulties/challenges encountered in the process or the time (month/years) required to publish in these journals. In this study, this is a second-order endogenous variable and was estimated using the composite loadings of the five dimensions – persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays.

Age: This refers to the number of years a lecturer has lived on Earth from birth. This study will treat age as a categorical moderator variable with three ordinal levels: below 40 years, 40 – 49 years, 50 – 59 years and 60 years or above.

Sex: This is simply the biological attributes that distinguish lecturers as male or female. Sex is a categorical moderator variable with two nominal categories: “male" and "female."

Education level: This refers to the highest level of education a lecturer has attained. It is a categorical moderator variable with two ordinal levels, such as "master's" and "doctorate" degrees.

Marital status: Marital status refers to an individual's legal and social condition with respect to their marriage. In this study, it refers to whether an individual is single or married.

3.11. Ethical considerations

Ethical considerations were duly followed in conducting this study to uphold the ethical integrity of the research. First and foremost, the researcher recognised the significance of informed consent. Each participant was provided with a clear and detailed explanation of the study's purpose, procedures, potential risks, benefits, and measures to ensure confidentiality. Before participating, eligible lecturers were allowed to provide informed consent willingly. The researcher emphasised that participation in this study was entirely voluntary and that participants had the right to withdraw from the study at any time without facing any negative consequences.

Protecting the anonymity and confidentiality of the participants was also a top priority. The researcher assured the lecturers that their responses will be treated with the utmost confidentiality and that their identities will remain anonymous throughout the study. Personal or self-identifiable information such as name, email and phone numbers were not collected. The researcher employed secure data storage and transmission methods to safeguard participant information from unauthorised access. To ensure the security of the collected data, the researcher implemented appropriate measures such as: using secure servers, encrypted connections, strong passwords and firewalls to prevent unauthorised access.

Respecting the privacy of the participants was also of utmost importance. The researcher obtained explicit consent from the lecturers regarding the collection, storage, and use of their personal data following applicable privacy laws and regulations. The

lecturers were fully informed about how their data will be used, who will access it, and the potential risks involved.

Transparency was another fundamental principle that the researcher upheld. The researcher communicated the study's goals, methods, and outcomes appropriately to the respondents. The respondents were also informed that the findings of this study will be prepared as research reports for submission to the Graduate School of the University of Calabar and to peer-reviewed journals for a wider dissemination. The researcher ensured that participants' anonymity and confidentiality were maintained while sharing the findings, thus promoting transparency and contributing to the body of knowledge in the field.

However, the researcher did not seek approval from the institutional review board or ethics committee before commencing the study since it does not apply to this study, based on national regulations (See Federal Ministry of Health, 2007, pp. 13-14). Nevertheless, the study adhered to the guidelines and regulations provided by the University of Calabar regarding ethical conduct in research involving human participants, ensuring that the study met the required ethical research standards.

CHAPTER FOUR

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

This chapter is concerned with the presentation of the summarised results obtained from the process of data analysis. It is also in this chapter that the results are interpreted, and key findings are discussed, including their implications. Thus, this chapter has been organised under the following sub-headings:

4.1. General description of research variables

4.2. Presentation of results

4.3. Discussion of research findings

4.1. General description of research variables

This study was conceived to determine the extent to which job satisfaction mediates the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals at the University of Calabar, Nigeria. There are three sets of variables in this study: exogenous variable (emotional intelligence), mediating variable (job satisfaction) and endogenous variable (persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals). The exogenous variable is further divided into five sub-dimensions, such as self-awareness, self-regulation, social awareness, internal motivation and empathy. The mediating variable is also divided into five sub-dimensions, namely: satisfaction with work conditions, satisfaction with remuneration, satisfaction with workload allocation, satisfaction with career advancement opportunities, and satisfaction with research support. The endogenous variable also has five sub-variables, including persistence in manuscript preparation, persistence in manuscript submission, persistence in handling revisions, persistence in dealing with rejections and persistence in publication delays. After collecting data from the field, the responses obtained are used to describe each of these specific variables as shown in Table 4.

TABLE 4

Mean rating, standard deviation, skewness and kurtosis, describing the exogenous, mediating and endogenous variables of the study.

Variables	Mean	SD	Skew.	Kurt.	Remark
Self-Awareness	16.88	2.07	-0.46	0.21	High
Self-Regulation	16.32	2.88	-0.11	0.11	High
Social Awareness	15.96	1.98	-0.52	0.74	High
Internal Motivation	17.18	2.06	-0.31	-0.68	High
Empathy	16.53	1.76	-0.20	0.44	High
Work Conditions	7.40	2.36	0.48	0.48	Low
Remuneration	7.48	2.58	1.78	5.54	Low
Workload Allocation	10.22	3.80	-0.14	-0.09	Low
Career Advancement Opportunities	10.72	3.88	0.94	1.41	Low
Research Support	5.87	2.41	0.82	1.39	Low
Persistence in Manuscript Preparation	25.29	5.09	0.08	-0.31	High
Persistence in Manuscript Submission	16.20	3.36	0.04	-0.08	High
Persistence in Handling Revisions	20.91	4.17	-0.12	0.17	High
Persistence in Dealing with Rejections	21.41	4.06	-0.06	0.23	High
Persistence in Publication Delays	24.81	3.91	0.43	-0.07	High

Note: All the absolute values of skewness and kurtosis are below 3.0 providing evidence of an approximately normal distribution of responses across all the variables.
Criterion means:

For self-awareness, social awareness, internal motivation and empathy: < 12.50 (low); = 12.50 (moderate); > 12.50 (high). For self-regulation: < 15.00 (low); = 15.00 (moderate); > 15.00 (high).

For satisfaction with work conditions and research support: < 14.00 = low; = 14.00 (moderate); > 14.00 (high). For satisfaction with remuneration and workload allocation: < 17.50 (low); = 17.50 (moderate); > 17.50 (high). For satisfaction with career advancement opportunities: < 21.00 (low); = 21.00 (moderate); > 21.00 (high).

For persistence in manuscript preparation and publication delays: < 21.00 (low); = 21.00 (moderate); > 21.00 (high). For persistence in manuscript submission: < 14.00 (low); = 14.00 (moderate); > 14.00 (high). For persistence in handling revisions and dealing with rejections: < 17.50 (low); = 17.50 (moderate); > 17.50 (high).

Regarding emotional intelligence variables, Table 4 shows that the participants exhibited a high level of self-awareness, with a mean rating of 16.88 and a standard deviation of 2.07. Self-regulation had a high mean rating of 16.32, accompanied by a standard deviation of 2.88, indicating more variability in this variable. Social awareness had a high mean rating of 15.96 and a standard deviation of 1.98, suggesting that participants tended to cluster around a similar level of social awareness. Internal Motivation had a mean rating of 17.18 with a standard deviation of 2.06, indicating a relatively high level of internal motivation among participants. Empathy had a mean rating of 16.53 and a standard deviation of 1.76, indicating a high level of empathy by lecturers.

In terms of job satisfaction variables, lecturers reported a low extent ($\bar{x}$ = 7.40, SD = 2.36) in their satisfaction with work conditions. Participants also had a low mean rating ($\bar{x}$ = 7.48, SD = 2.58) for satisfaction with remuneration. The mean score for satisfaction with workload allocation is low ($\bar{x}$ = 10.22, SD = 3.80). Moreover, Participants had a low mean rating ($\bar{x}$ = 10.72, SD = 3.88) regarding their satisfaction with career advancement opportunities. The mean score for lecturers' satisfaction with research support is also very low ($\bar{x}$ = 5.87, SD = 2.41).

Regarding the endogenous variable (persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals), Table 4 shows that participants demonstrated a high persistence in manuscript preparation, with a mean of 25.29 and a standard deviation of 5.09. The mean rating for persistence in manuscript submission is also higher ($\bar{x}$ = 16.20, SD = 3.36) than criterion mean of 14.00. similarly, participants reported a high mean score ($\bar{x}$ = 20.91, SD = 4.17) for persistence in handling revisions than the criterion mean of 17.50. The mean score for persistence in dealing with rejections ($\bar{x}$ = 21.41, SD = 4.06) is higher than the criterion mean value of 17.50. Furthermore, participants reported a high level of persistence in dealing with publication delays, with the mean of 24.81 and a standard deviation of 3.91, being greater than the criterion mean value of 21.00.

It is worth reiterating, at this point, that aside from examining the tripartite relationship between emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, the study aimed to moderate the relationship with some of the demographic variables of the respondents, such as sex, education level and marital status. Consequently, the respondents of this study are described in terms of their demographic characteristics, as shown in Table 5.

Table 5 shows that the study's sample comprises 644 respondents, with a sex distribution showing that 61.5% were males (n = 396) while 38.5% were females (n = 248). In terms of age, 37.9% of the respondents (n = 244) were below 40 years old, 34.5% were between 40 and 49 years (n = 222), and 27.6% were 50 years and above (n = 178). Regarding education level, 30% of respondents (n = 193 lecturers) held a master's degree, while 70% held a doctorate degree (n = 451). For rank, Table 5 shows that 26.4% of the respondents (n = 170) were Assistant Lecturers, 19.9% were Lecturer II (n = 128), 14.6% were Lecturer I (n = 94), 17.5% were Senior Lecturers (n = 113), 12.7% were Associate Professors (n = 82), and 8.9% were Professors (n = 57). Table 5 shows, for marital status, that 23.8% of respondents (n = 153) were single, while the majority (n = 491), at 76.2%, were married. Years of work experience range from those with less than 10 years of experience (51.6% or 332 lecturers), 10 to 19 years of experience (32.9% or 212 lecturers), to those with 20 years and above of experience (15.5% or 100 lecturers).

TABLE 5

Demographic characteristics of the respondents of this study

Variables	Categories	Frequency	Percentage
Sex	Male	396	61.5
	Female	248	38.5
	Total	644	100
Age	Below 40 years	244	37.9
	40-49 Years	222	34.5
	50 Years and above	178	27.6
	Total	644	100
Education level	Master's	193	30
	Doctorate	451	70
	Total	644	100
Rank	Assistant Lecturer	170	26.4
	Lecturer II	128	19.9
	Lecturer I	94	14.6
	Senior Lecturer	113	17.5
	Associate Professor	82	12.7
	Professor	57	8.9
	Total	644	100
Marital Status	Single	153	23.8
	Married	491	76.2
	Total	644	100
Years of Work	Less than 10 years	332	51.6
Experience	10 to 19 years	212	32.9
	20 years and above	100	15.5
	Total	644	100

4.2. Presentation of results

The results of this study are presented in this section. Since the research questions were converted into hypotheses, they will not be answered to avoid redundancy. Thus, the results are presented in accordance with the hypotheses guiding the study as follows:

4.2.1. Hypothesis one

Job satisfaction variables have no significant joint and partial mediation effects on the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, in terms of manuscript preparation, manuscripts submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays. The exogenous variable in this hypothesis is self-awareness, whereas the job satisfaction variables (such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support) are the mediators. The endogenous variable of this hypothesis is persistence to publish to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, across the five dimensions. Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modelling (PLS-SEM) was used to test the hypothesis at .05 level of significance. The decision rule is that a path is significant if p-value is less than .05 alpha level. The results of the analysis are presented in Table 6 and Figure 4.

Table 6 shows that job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support, had an insignificant effect in jointly mediating the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in terms of manuscript preparation. However, the job satisfaction variables had a significant positive effect in mediating the relationship between self-awareness and dimensions of lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals such as persistence in manuscript submission ($\beta = -.140$, $t = 3.839$, $p < .05$), handling revisions ($\beta = .098$, $t = 3.262$, $p < .05$), dealing with rejections ($\beta = .099$, $t = 3.055$, $p < .05$) and publication delays ($\beta = .089$, $t = 2.342$, $p < .05$). Thus, the joint

mediation hypothesis is not accepted for persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals across dimensions such as manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publications. However, the hypothesis is accepted for persistence to publish in terms of manuscript preparation.

Regarding the partial mediation effects, Table 6 reveals that job satisfaction variables such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support did not significantly mediate the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals in terms of manuscript preparation, respectively. In terms of persistence in manuscript submission, the result in Table 6 shows that only satisfaction with work conditions (β = .067, t = 2.600, $p < .05$) significantly mediated the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. On the contrary, other job satisfaction variables such as satisfaction with career advancement opportunities, remuneration, workload allocation and research support did not partially mediate the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in terms of manuscript submission to a significant extent, respectively.

Table 6 also shows that there was no significant partial effect of all job satisfaction variables, on the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals in terms of handling revisions, respectively. Similarly, Table 6 reveals that job satisfaction variables such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation and career advancement opportunities are not significant partial mediators of the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in terms of dealing with rejections, respectively. However, satisfaction with research support was the only variable with a significant partial mediation effect (β = .058, t = 2.160, $p < .05$) on the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in dealing with rejections.

TABLE 6

Joint and partial mediation effects of job variables in the relationship between self-awareness and the dimensions of persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

Type	Paths	β	*M*	*SD*	*t*	*p*
Joint Mediation	SAW → PMP	-.027	-0.005	0.045	0.598	.550
	SAW → PMS	.140*	0.141	0.036	3.839	.000
	SAW → PHR	.098*	0.098	0.030	3.262	.001
	SAW → PDR	.099*	0.105	0.032	3.055	.002
	SAW → PPD	.089*	0.087	0.038	2.342	.019
Partial mediation	SAW → SWC → PMP	-.047	-0.033	0.029	1.621	.105
	SAW → REM → PMP	.030	0.034	0.019	1.586	.113
	SAW → SWA → PMP	.011	0.010	0.018	0.632	.528
	SAW → CAO → PMP	.023	0.026	0.024	0.950	.342
	SAW → SRS → PMP	-.044	-0.042	0.023	1.936	.053
	SAW → SWC → PMS	.067*	0.061	0.026	2.600	.009
	SAW → REM → PMS	.010	0.017	0.016	0.659	.510
	SAW → SWA → PMS	.021	0.018	0.021	0.972	.331
	SAW → CAO → PMS	.041	0.040	0.022	1.903	.057
	SAW → SRS → PMS	.001	0.004	0.021	0.038	.969
	SAW → SWC → PHR	.041	0.041	0.022	1.855	.064
	SAW → REM →PHR	-.004	-0.004	0.020	0.198	.843
	SAW → SWA → PHR	.013	0.009	0.018	0.686	.493
	SAW → CAO → PHR	.001	0.007	0.021	0.040	.968
	SAW → SRS → PHR	.047	0.045	0.024	1.922	.055
	SAW → SWC → PDR	.008	0.012	0.018	0.470	.638
	SAW → REM → PDR	.008	0.009	0.015	0.543	.587
	SAW → SWA → PDR	.017	0.016	0.020	0.870	.384
	SAW → CAO → PDR	.007	0.009	0.023	0.300	.764
	SAW → SRS → PDR	.058*	0.059	0.027	2.160	.031
	SAW → SWC → PPD	.018	0.014	0.017	1.013	.311
	SAW → REM → PPD	.057*	0.060	0.020	2.843	.004
	SAW → SWA → PPD	.022	0.022	0.026	0.859	.390
	SAW → CAO → PPD	.027	0.025	0.026	1.037	.300
	SAW → SRS → PPD	-.035	-0.034	0.026	1.329	.184

* Significant at .05 alpha level

CAO = Satisfaction with career advancement opportunities; REM = Satisfaction with remuneration; SAW = Self-awareness; SWC = Satisfaction with work conditions; SWA = Satisfaction with workload allocation; SRS = Satisfaction with research support; PDR = Persistence in dealing with rejections; PHR = Persistence in handling revisions; PMP = Persistence in manuscript preparation; PMS = Persistence in manuscript submission; PPD = Persistence in publication delays.

Furthermore, Table 6 shows that the partial mediation of effects of job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support was not statistically significant in the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in terms of publication delays. In contrast, only satisfaction with remuneration significantly mediated the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in terms of publication delays ($\beta = .057$, $t = 2.843$, $p < .05$).

In terms of the amount of variance explained, Figure 4 shows that 2.6% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .026$, $p > .05$), 1.6% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .016$, $p > .05$), 5.1% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .051$, $p < .05$), 5.6% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .056$, $p < .05$) and 4.3% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .043$, $p < .05$) of the variance in lecturers' satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support, respectively, is attributable to their self-awareness. Thus, other exogenous variables not included in the model might explain 97.4%, 98.4%, 94.9%, 94.4% and 95.7% of the variance in lecturers' satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support, respectively. Furthermore, Figure 4 shows that 26.3% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .263$, $p < .05$), 24.7% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .247$, $p < .05$), 30.1% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .301$, $p < .05$), 31.3% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .313$, $p < .05$) and 34.3% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .343$, $p < .05$) of the variance in lecturers' persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays, is attributable to the joint prediction of lecturers' self-awareness and job satisfaction variables. Therefore, other extraneous variables not included in the model can be held accountable for 73.7%, 75.3%, 69.9%, 68.7% and 65.7% of the variance in the five dimensions of the endogenous variables, respectively. Thus, the null hypothesis was rejected because there were some significant joint and partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

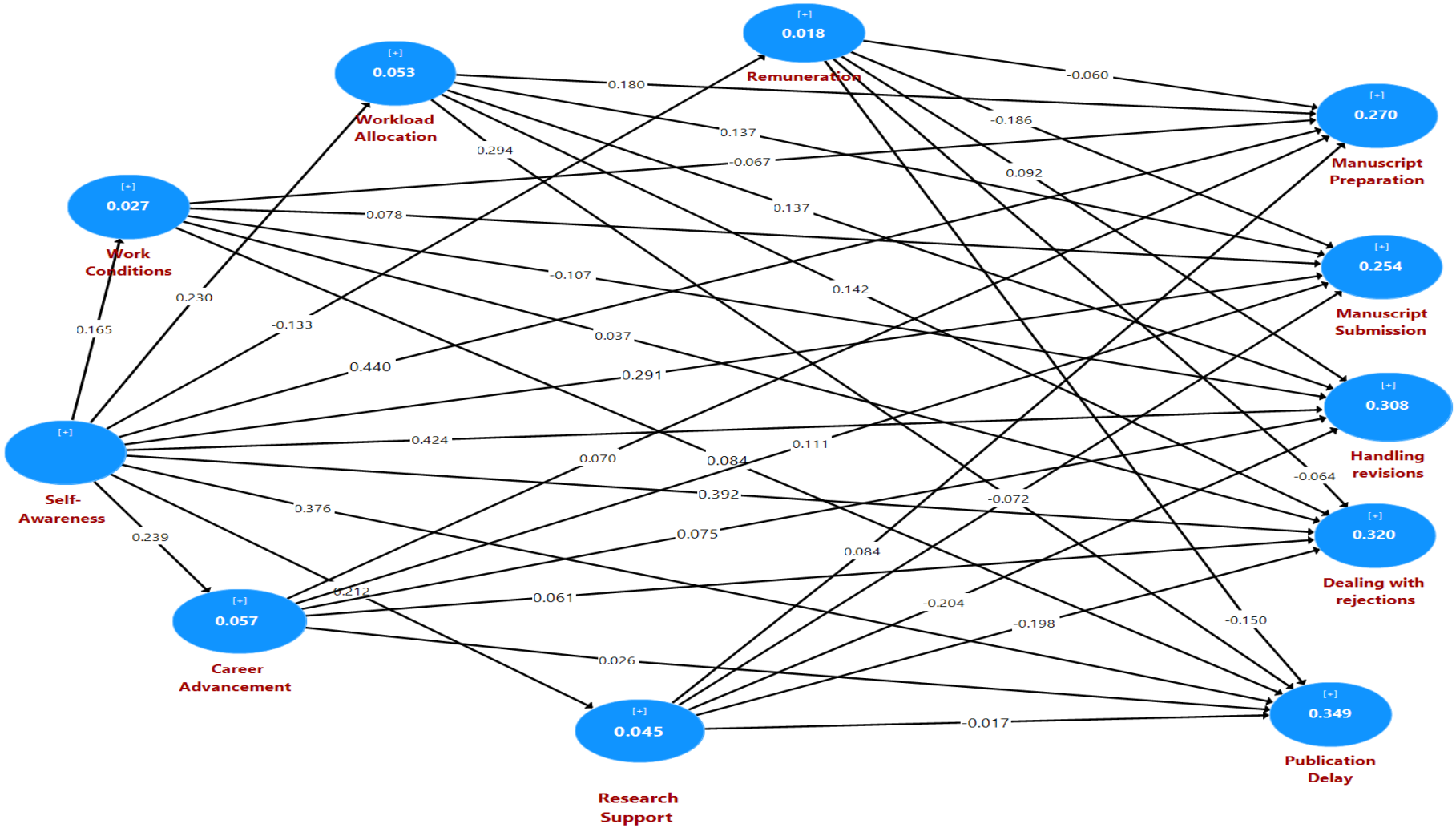


FIGURE 4: A model showing the mediation of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals using partial least squares structural equation modelling (PLS-SEM).

4.2.2. Hypothesis two

There is no significant joint and partial effects of job satisfaction variables in mediating the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. In this hypothesis, self-regulation serves as the exogenous variable, while the endogenous variable is persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, across five dimensions: persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays. The mediating variable in this hypothesis is job satisfaction variables, including satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support. To test this hypothesis at a significance level of .05, PLS-SEM was employed. The outcomes of this analysis can be found in Table 7 and Figure 5.

Table 7 illustrates that job satisfaction variables, including satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support, had a non-significant effect in jointly mediating in the relationship between self-regulation and the persistence to publish in terms of manuscript preparation. However, these job satisfaction variables had a notably positive and statistically significant joint mediation effect in the connection between self-regulation and other facets of lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. These facets encompassed persistence in manuscript submission ($\beta = .090$, $t = 3.754$, $p < .05$), handling revisions ($\beta = .050$, $t = 2.786$, $p < .05$), dealing with rejections ($\beta = .102$, $t = 4.365$, $p < .05$), and publication delays ($\beta = .083$, $t = 3.081$, $p < .05$). Consequently, the joint mediation hypothesis was not accepted for persistence in manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejection, and publication delays. Nonetheless, the hypothesis was accepted for persistence to publish in the dimension of manuscript preparation.

TABLE 7

Joint and partial mediation effects of job variables in the relationship between self-regulation and the dimensions of persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

Type	Paths	β	*M*	*SD*	*t*	*p*
Joint Mediation	SRE → PMP	.025	0.025	0.021	1.19	.234
	SRE → PMS	.090*	0.085	0.024	3.754	.000
	SRE → PHR	.054*	0.063	0.019	2.786	.005
	SRE → PDR	.102*	0.107	0.023	4.365	.000
	SRE → PPD	.083*	0.085	0.027	3.081	.002
Partial Mediation	SRE→ SWC → PMP	-.013	-0.011	0.009	1.393	.164
	SRE → REM → PMP	.006	0.004	0.008	0.698	.485
	SRE → SWA → PMP	.022*	0.025	0.011	2.055	.040
	SRE → CAO → PMP	.010	0.012	0.011	0.961	.336
	SRE → SRS → PMP	-.001	-0.004	0.013	0.089	.929
	SRE → SWC → PMS	.001	0.004	0.011	0.136	.892
	SRE → REM → PMS	.025	0.02	0.018	1.383	.167
	SRE → SWA → PMS	.014	0.017	0.009	1.634	.102
	SRE → CAO → PMS	.017	0.017	0.013	1.321	.186
	SRE → SRS → PMS	.032*	0.026	0.014	2.222	.026
	SRE → SWC → PHR	-.011	-0.011	0.008	1.301	.193
	SRE → REM → PHR	-.010	-0.007	0.009	1.142	.254
	SRE → SWA → PHR	.020*	0.021	0.010	2.008	.045
	SRE → CAO → PHR	.013	0.013	0.010	1.297	.195
	SRE → SRS → PHR	.042*	0.046	0.014	2.966	.003
	SRE → SWC → PDR	.011	0.011	0.011	0.985	.325
	SRE → REM → PDR	.018	0.019	0.013	1.428	.153
	SRE → SWA → PDR	.018	0.019	0.009	1.936	.053
	SRE → CAO → PDR	.012	0.012	0.010	1.207	.228
	SRE → SRS → PDR	.042*	0.045	0.016	2.638	.008
	SRE → SWC → PPD	.017*	0.018	0.009	2.01	.044
	SRE → REM → PPD	.026	0.025	0.014	1.863	.063
	SRE → SWA → PPD	.032*	0.034	0.015	2.107	.035
	SRE → CAO → PPD	.003	0.004	0.009	0.362	.717
	SRE → SRS → PPD	.005	0.004	0.011	0.457	.647

* Significant at .05 alpha level

Note: CAO = Satisfaction with career advancement opportunities; REM = Satisfaction with remuneration; SRE = Self-regulation; SWC = Satisfaction with work conditions; SWA = Satisfaction with workload allocation; SRS = Satisfaction with research support; PDR = Persistence in dealing with rejections; PHR = Persistence in handling revisions; PMP = Persistence in manuscript preparation; PMS = Persistence in manuscript submission; PPD = Persistence in publication delays.

Concerning the partial mediation effects, Table 7 uncovers that the job satisfaction variables, namely satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities, and research support, had no significant partial mediation effect in the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in terms of manuscript preparation. However, workload allocation had a significant partial mediation effect (β = .022, t = 2.055, p < .05) in the relationship between self-regulation and persistence to publish in terms of manuscript preparation.

Regarding persistence in manuscript submission, Table 7 indicates that only satisfaction with research support was a significantly partial mediator (β = .032, t = 2.222, p < .05) between self-regulation and the persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. Conversely, other job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation and career advancement opportunities, did not partially mediate the relationship between self-regulation and persistence to publish, specifically in terms of manuscript submission, to a statistically significant extent.

Table 7 also presents that only two job satisfaction variables, such as workload allocation (β = .020, t = 2.008, p < .05) and research support (β = .042, t = 2.966, p < .05) partially mediated the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in handling revisions, respectively. However, other job satisfaction variables, including satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration and career advancement opportunities, had insignificant partial mediation effects on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in handling revisions.

Similarly, Table 7 shows that variables of job satisfaction, including satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, and career advancement opportunities, did not partially mediate the connection between self-regulation and persistence in dealing with rejections to a significant extent. However, satisfaction with research support was the only job satisfaction variable with a significant partial mediation

effect (β = .042, t = 2.638, p < .05) on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in dealing with rejections.

Furthermore, Table 7 indicates that the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables such as satisfaction with work conditions (β = .017, t = 2.010, p < .05) and workload allocation (β = .032, t =2.107, p < .05), are statistically significant in the relationship between self-regulation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, in terms of publication delays. In contrast, job satisfaction variables such as satisfaction with remuneration, career advancement opportunities, and research support, did not significant partially mediate the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in publication delays to a significant extent.

Regarding the explained variance, Figure 5 illustrates that 1.7% (*Adj.* R^2 = .017, p > .05), 2.1% (*Adj.* R^2 = .021, p > .05), 0.6% (*Adj.* R^2 = .006, p > .05), 1.4% (*Adj.* R^2 = .014, p > .05), and 3% (*Adj.* R^2 = .030, p > .05) of the variance in lecturers' satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support, respectively, can be attributed to their self-regulation. This implies that other variables not considered in the model may account for 98.3%, 97.9%, 99.4%, 98.6%, and 97% of the variance in these aspects of lecturers' job satisfaction across the five dimensions, respectively. Furthermore, Figure 5 reveals that 24.1% (*Adj.* R^2 = .241, p < .05), 19.6% (*Adj.* R^2 = .196, p < .05), 25.7% (*Adj.* R^2 = .257, p < .05), 24.6% (*Adj.* R^2 = .246, p < .05), and 31.2% (*Adj.* R^2 = .312, p < .05) of the variance in lecturers' persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays, respectively, can be jointly predicted by lecturers' self-awareness and job satisfaction variables. Thus, other variables not enlisted in the model are accountable for 75.9%, 80.4%, 74.3%, 75.4% and 68.8% of the unexplained proportion of the variance in the five dimensions of the endogenous variable, respectively.

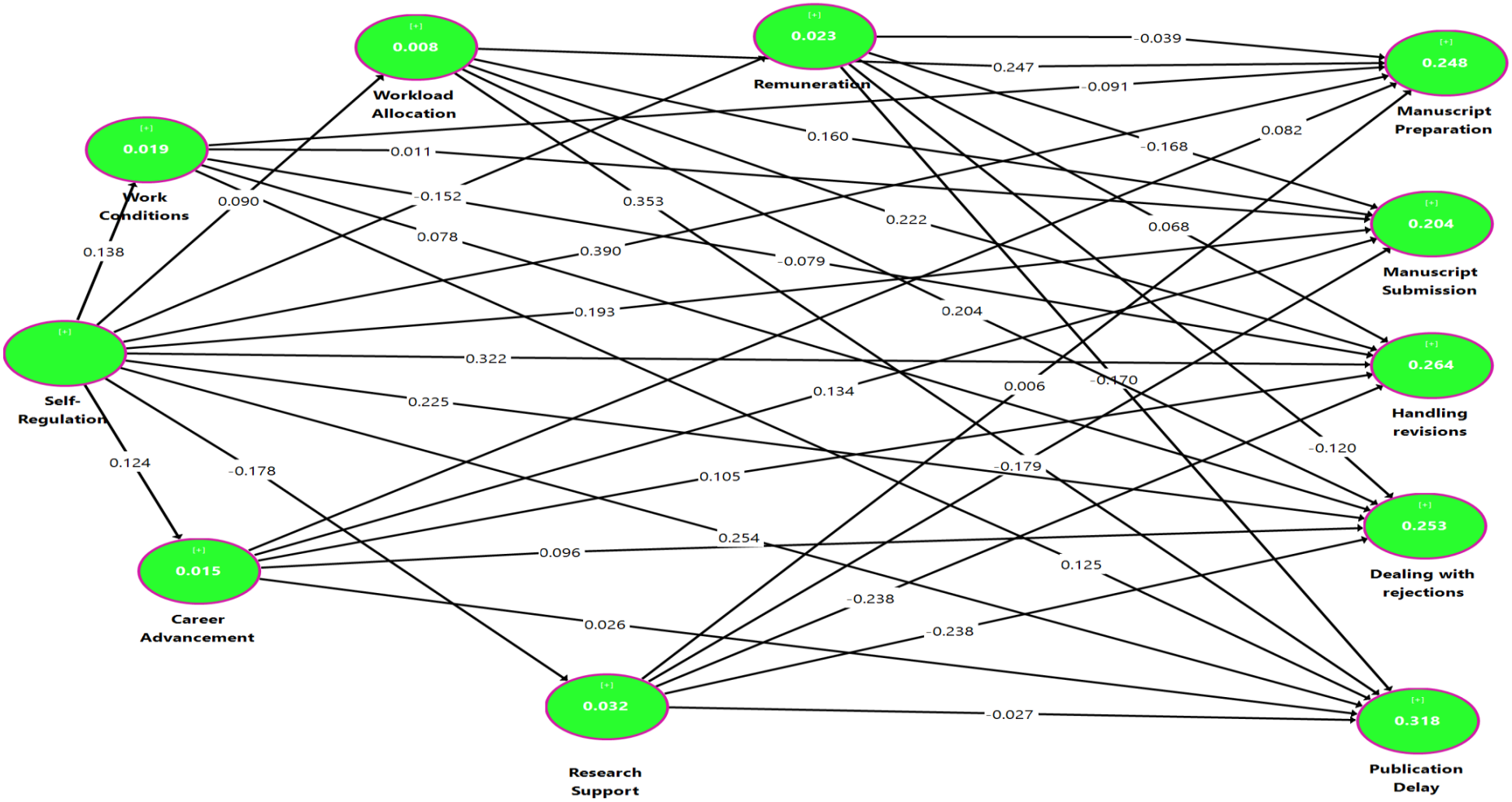


FIGURE 5: A model showing the direct and mediation effects of self-regulation and job satisfaction variables on persistence to Scopus-indexed journals using PLS-SEM

Based on the results in Table 7, the null hypothesis was rejected, since there are some significant joint and partial mediation effects in the model. Thus, it is concluded that job satisfaction variables jointly and significantly mediate the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, in terms of manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays. However, there is no significant joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence in manuscript preparation for Scopus-indexed journals.

4.2.3. Hypothesis three

Job satisfaction variables have no significant joint and partial mediation effects in the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. In this hypothesis, the exogenous variable is social awareness, whereas job satisfaction variables, such as: satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support, are the mediating variables. The endogenous variable is persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, across five dimensions: persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays. The hypothesis was tested at .05 alpha level using PLS-SEM, with the results summarised in Table 8 and Figure 6.

Table 8 shows that job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support had a statistically non-significant joint mediation effect on the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journal, in terms of manuscript preparation. However, the variables jointly had a significantly positive mediation effect on relationship between social awareness and other

dimensions of lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, such as: manuscript submission (β = .107, t = 3.837, $p < .05$), handling revisions (β = .081, t = 2.504, $p < .05$), dealing with rejections (β = .099, t = 2.647, $p < .05$), and publication delays (β = .114, t = 2.891, $p < .05$). Therefore, the joint mediation hypothesis is not accepted in the case of persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals across these dimensions, except for manuscript preparation.

Regarding partial mediation effects, job satisfaction variables, such as: satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities and research support did not significantly mediate the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript preparation. However, only satisfaction with workload allocation (β = .027, t = 2.273, $p < .05$) had a significant partial mediation effect on the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in terms of manuscript preparation. For manuscript submission, only satisfaction with workload allocation (β = .024, t = 2.700, $p < .05$) had a significant partial mediation effect on the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. Conversely, other job satisfaction variables, such as: satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities and research support, did not mediate this relationship to a statistically significant extent, respectively. In the dimension of handling revisions, only satisfaction with workload allocation (β = .026, t = 2.178, $p < .05$) and research support (β = .115, t = 3.521, $p < .05$) partially mediated to a significant extent, the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. In contrast, other job satisfaction variables, including satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration and career advancement opportunities, did not significantly mediate the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' persistence in handling revisions.

TABLE 8

Joint and partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between social awareness and dimensions of lecturers' persistence to publish.

Type	Paths	β	M	SD	t	p
Joint	SOA → PMP	.020	0.03	0.033	0.597	.551
Mediation	SOA → PMS	.107*	0.11	0.028	3.837	.000
	SOA → PHR	.081*	0.092	0.032	2.504	.012
	SOA → PDR	.099*	0.106	0.037	2.647	.008
	SOA → PPD	.114*	0.112	0.039	2.891	.004
Partial	SOA → SWC → PMP	-.015	-0.014	0.015	0.988	.323
Mediation	SOA → REM → PMP	.013	0.016	0.016	0.837	.402
	SOA → SWA→PMP	.027*	0.027	0.012	2.273	.023
	SOA → CAO → PMP	-.019	-0.011	0.032	0.59	.555
	SOA → SRS → PMP	.013	0.012	0.025	0.512	.608
	SOA → SWC → PMS	.012	0.012	0.013	0.892	.372
	SOA → REM → PMS	.033	0.033	0.019	1.767	.077
	SOA → SWA → PMS	.025*	0.024	0.009	2.7	.007
	SOA → CAO → PMS	.023	0.024	0.026	0.897	.370
	SOA → SRS → PMS	.015	0.017	0.025	0.598	.550
	SOA → SWC → PHR	-.008	-0.004	0.01	0.782	.434
	SOA → REM → PHR	-.027	-0.022	0.027	1.006	.315
	SOA → SWA → PHR	.026*	0.027	0.012	2.21	.027
	SOA → CAO → PHR	-.044	-0.038	0.038	1.158	.247
	SOA → SRS → PHR	.134*	0.129	0.034	3.888	.000
	SOA → SWC → PDR	-.001	-0.002	0.017	0.046	.963
	SOA→ REM → PDR	.003	0.006	0.02	0.162	.871
	SOA → SWA → PDR	.026*	0.025	0.012	2.178	.029
	SOA → CAO → PDR	-.044	-0.039	0.035	1.253	.210
	SOA → SRS → PDR	.115*	0.115	0.033	3.521	.000
	SOA → SWC → PPD	.019	0.013	0.013	1.412	.158
	SOA → REM → PPD	.012	0.014	0.026	0.484	.628
	SOA → SWA → PPD	.049*	0.047	0.019	2.654	.008
	SOA → CAO → PPD	.040	0.036	0.026	1.544	.123
	SOA → SRS → PPD	-.006	0.002	0.026	0.229	.819

* Significant at .05 alpha level

Note: CAO = Satisfaction with career advancement opportunities; REM = Satisfaction with remuneration; SOA = Social Awareness; SWC = Satisfaction with work conditions; SWA = Satisfaction with workload allocation; SRS = Satisfaction with research support; PDR = Persistence in dealing with rejections; PHR = Persistence in handling revisions; PMP = Persistence in manuscript preparation; PMS = Persistence in manuscript submission; PPD = Persistence in publication delays.

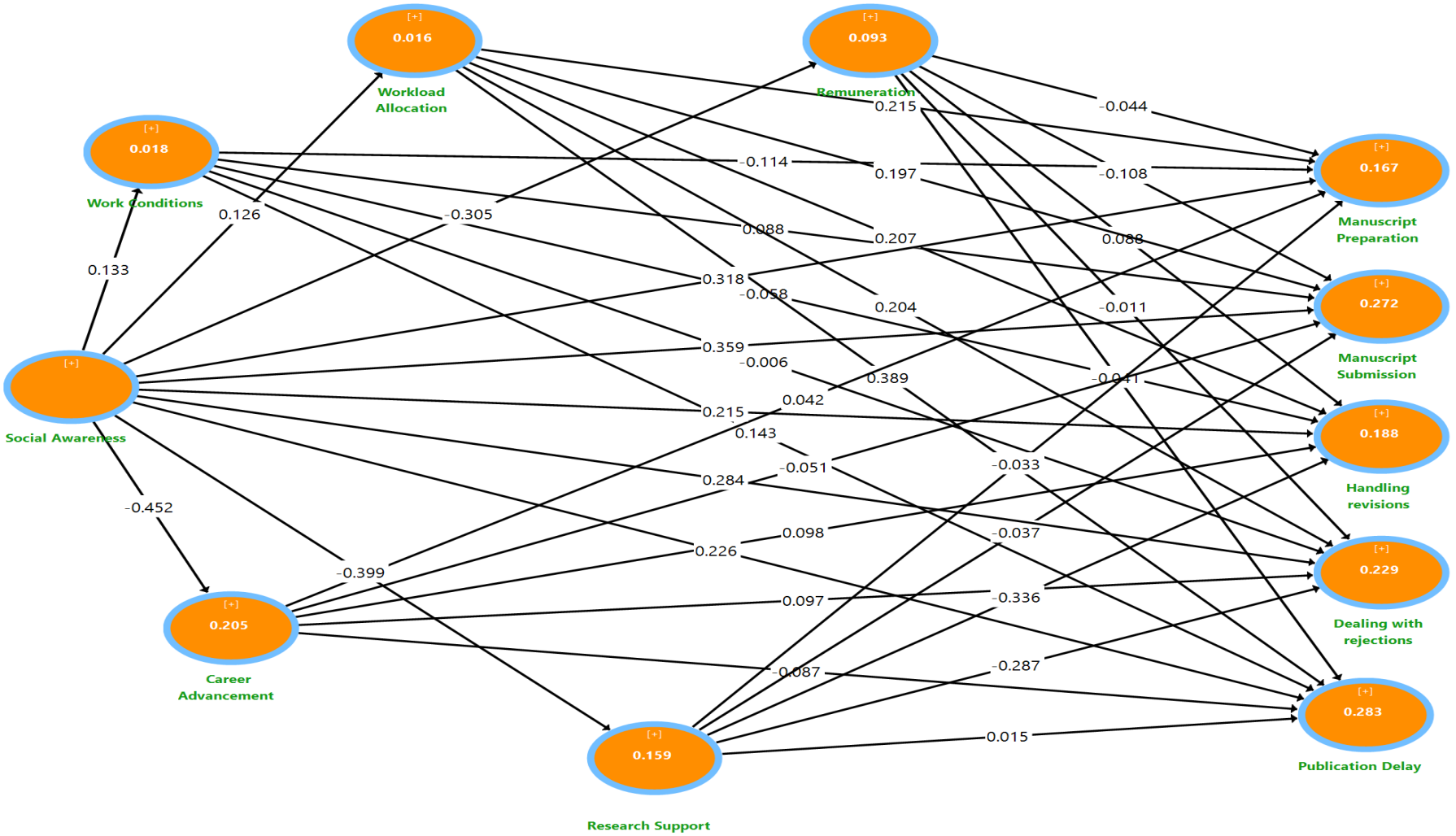


FIGURE 6: A model showing the direct and mediation effects of social awareness and job satisfaction variables on persistence to Scopus-indexed journals using PLS-SEM

In terms of the relationship between social awareness and persistence in dealing with rejections, Table 8 shows that lecturers' satisfaction with workload allocation (β = .026, $t = 2.178$, $p < .05$) and research support (β = .115, $t = 3.521$, $p < .05$) were statistically significant partial mediators. However, satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration and career advancement opportunities are not significant partial mediators in the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' persistence in dealing with rejections. Furthermore, Table 8 shows that only satisfaction with workload allocation (β = .049, $t = 2.654$, $p < .05$) had a significant partial mediation effect on the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in publication delays. On the contrary, other variables, such as: satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities and research support, had insignificant partial mediation effect on the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in terms of publication delays.

In terms of the variance explained, Figure 6 depicts that lecturers' social awareness contributes to 1.6% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .016$, $p > .05$), 9.2% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .092$, $p < .05$), 1.4% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .014$, $p > .05$), 20.3% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .203$, $p < .05$) and 15.8% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .158$) of the variability in their satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support, respectively. This suggests that factors not included in the model may account for much of the variance in these aspects of lecturers' job satisfaction, specifically 98.4%, 90.8%, 99.6%, 79.7%, and 84.2%. Additionally, Figure 6 indicates that a collective model involving lecturers' social awareness and job satisfaction variables explained 15.9% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .159$, $p < .05$), 26.5% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .265$, $p < .05$), 18.0% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .180$, $p < .05$), 22.2% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .222$, $p < .05$) and 27.7% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .277$, $p < .05$) of the variance in their persistence to publish in terms of manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays, respectively. Consequently, unaccounted variables not

included in the model could contribute to 84.1%, 73.5%, 82.0%, 77.8%, and 72.3% of the unexplained variability in these five dimensions of the endogenous variable.

4.2.4. Hypothesis four

There is no significant joint and partial mediation of job variables in the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. In this hypothesis, the exogenous variable is internal motivation, while the mediating variables encompass aspects of job satisfaction, such as: satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support. The endogenous variable under investigation is lecturers' persistence in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals, across five dimensions: persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays. The hypothesis underwent testing at a significance level of .05 using the PLS-SEM method, and the findings are presented in Table 9 and Figure 7.

Table 9 reveals that job satisfaction variables, such as: satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support had an insignificant combined mediation effect on the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in terms of manuscript preparation. Nevertheless, the variables jointly had a significant positive mediation effect in the connection between internal motivation and other dimensions of lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, such as: manuscript submission ($\beta = .084$, $t = 2.484$, $p < .05$), handling revisions ($\beta = .078$, $t = 2.387$, $p < .05$), dealing with rejections ($\beta = .115$, $t = 3.038$, $p < .05$), and publication delays ($\beta = .129$, $t = 4.038$, $p < .05$). Consequently, the null joint mediation hypothesis is not accepted for persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, across these dimensions, except for manuscript preparation.

TABLE 9

Joint and partial mediation effects of job variables in the relationship between internal motivation and the dimensions of persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

Type	Paths	β	*M*	*SD*	*t*	*p*
Joint	INM → PMP	.041	0.047	0.027	1.481	.139
Mediation	INM → PMS	.084*	0.089	0.034	2.484	.013
	INM → PHR	.078*	0.076	0.033	2.387	.017
	INM → PDR	.115*	0.120	0.038	3.038	.002
	INM → PPD	.129*	0.134	0.032	4.038	.000
Partial	INM → SWC → PMP	-.032	-0.031	0.020	1.595	.111
Mediation	INM → REM → PMP	-.006	-0.003	0.007	0.887	.375
	INM → SWA → PMP	.062*	0.063	0.016	3.956	.000
	INM → CAO → PMP	.020	0.019	0.019	1.040	.299
	INM → SRS → PMP	-.003	-0.001	0.014	0.244	.807
	INM → SWC → PMS	-.019	-0.020	0.022	0.832	.405
	INM → REM → PMS	-.012	-0.005	0.012	0.995	.320
	INM → SWA → PMS	.051*	0.052	0.019	2.687	.007
	INM → CAO → PMS	.042*	0.037	0.020	2.100	.036
	INM → SRS → PMS	.022	0.025	0.017	1.291	.197
	INM → SWC → PHR	-.043*	-0.043	0.021	2.025	.043
	INM → REM → PHR	.001	0.000	0.004	0.261	.794
	INM → SWA → PHR	.052*	0.054	0.017	3.032	.002
	INM → CAO → PHR	.023	0.020	0.020	1.119	.263
	INM → SRS → PHR	.046*	0.045	0.017	2.680	.007
	INM → SWC → PDR	.004	0.005	0.021	0.171	.864
	INM → REM → PDR	-.007	-0.003	0.009	0.809	.419
	INM → SWA → PDR	.051*	0.051	0.016	3.213	.001
	INM → CAO → PDR	.015	0.014	0.017	0.897	.370
	INM → SRS → PDR	.051*	0.053	0.020	2.524	.012
	INM → SWC → PPD	.021	0.014	0.020	1.042	.297
	INM → REM → PPD	-.009	-0.002	0.010	0.851	.395
	INM → SWA → PPD	.114*	0.111	0.020	5.637	.000
	INM → CAO → PPD	.000	0.004	0.016	0.024	.981
	INM → SRS → PPD	.004	0.007	0.011	0.360	.719

* Significant at .05 alpha level

Note: CAO = Satisfaction with career advancement opportunities; REM = Satisfaction with remuneration; INM = Internal Motivation; SWC = Satisfaction with work conditions; SWA = Satisfaction with workload allocation; SRS = Satisfaction with research support; PDR = Persistence in dealing with rejections; PHR = Persistence in handling revisions; PMP = Persistence in manuscript preparation; PMS = Persistence in manuscript submission; PPD = Persistence in publication delays.

Regarding the partial mediation effects, Table 9 shows that satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities, and research support, did not significantly mediate the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence in manuscript preparation. Nevertheless, satisfaction with workload allocation ($\beta = .062$, $t = 3.956$, $p < .05$) significantly and partially mediated the relationship between internal motivation and persistence to publish in terms of manuscript preparation. Similarly, only satisfaction with workload allocation ($\beta = .051$, $t = 2.687$, $p < .05$) and career advancement opportunities ($\beta = .042$, $t = 2.100$, $p < .05$) were significant partial mediators in the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, respectively. Conversely, other job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration and research support, respectively, did not mediate this relationship to a statistically significant extent. In terms of persistence in handling revisions, Table 9 shows that the following job satisfaction variables: satisfaction with work conditions ($\beta = -.043$, $t = 2.025$, $p < .05$), workload allocation ($\beta = .052$, $t = 3.032$, $p < .05$) and research support ($\beta = .046$, $t = 2.680$, $p < .05$) had significant partial mediation effects on the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. In contrast, other job satisfaction variables, including satisfaction with remuneration and career advancement opportunities did not significantly mediate the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence in handling revisions.

Furthermore, concerning the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in dealing with rejections, lecturers' satisfaction with workload allocation ($\beta = .051$, $t = 3.213$, $p < .05$) and research support ($\beta = .051$, $t = 2.524$, $p < .05$) were statistically significant partial mediators. However, satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration and career advancement opportunities were not significant partial mediators in the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence in dealing with

rejections. Moreover, Table 9 indicates that only satisfaction with workload allocation (β = .114, t = 5.637, p < .05) had a significant partial mediation effect on the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in terms of publication delays. On the contrary, satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities and research support did not significantly mediate the relationship between internal and lecturers' persistence to publish in terms of publication delays, respectively,

In Figure 7, the results indicate that lecturers' internal motivation contributed the following percentages of variance to their job satisfaction across different aspects: 8.1% (*Adj.* R^2 = .081, p < .05) for satisfaction with work conditions, 0.1% (*Adj.* R^2 = .001, p > .05) for remuneration, 12.1% (*Adj.* R^2 = .121, p < .05) for workload allocation, 8.6% (*Adj.* R^2 = .086, p < .05) for career advancement opportunities, and 4.0% (*Adj.* R^2 = .040, p > .05) for research support. This implies that a substantial portion of the variability in these facets of lecturers' job satisfaction, specifically 91.9%, 99.9%, 87.9%, 91.4%, and 96%, may be attributed to factors not enlisted in the model. Furthermore, Figure 7 also shows that lecturers' internal motivation and job satisfaction variables jointly accounts for a significant proportion of the variance in lecturers' persistence to publish to in Scopus-indexed journals. The joint contribution is as follows: 18.1% (*Adj.* R^2 = .181, p < .05) for persistence to publish in the dimension of manuscript preparation, 20.2% (A*dj.* R^2 = .202, p < .05) in manuscript submission, 21.8% (*Adj.* R^2 = .218, p < .05) in handling revisions, 21.1% (*Adj.* R^2 = .211, p < .05) in dealing with rejections, and 27.3% (*Adj.* R^2 = .273, p < .05) in publication delays. As a result, other variables that are not part of the model could potentially explain most of the unexplained variance in these five dimensions of the endogenous variable, amounting to 81.9%, 79.8%, 78.2%, 78.9%, and 72.7% respectively.

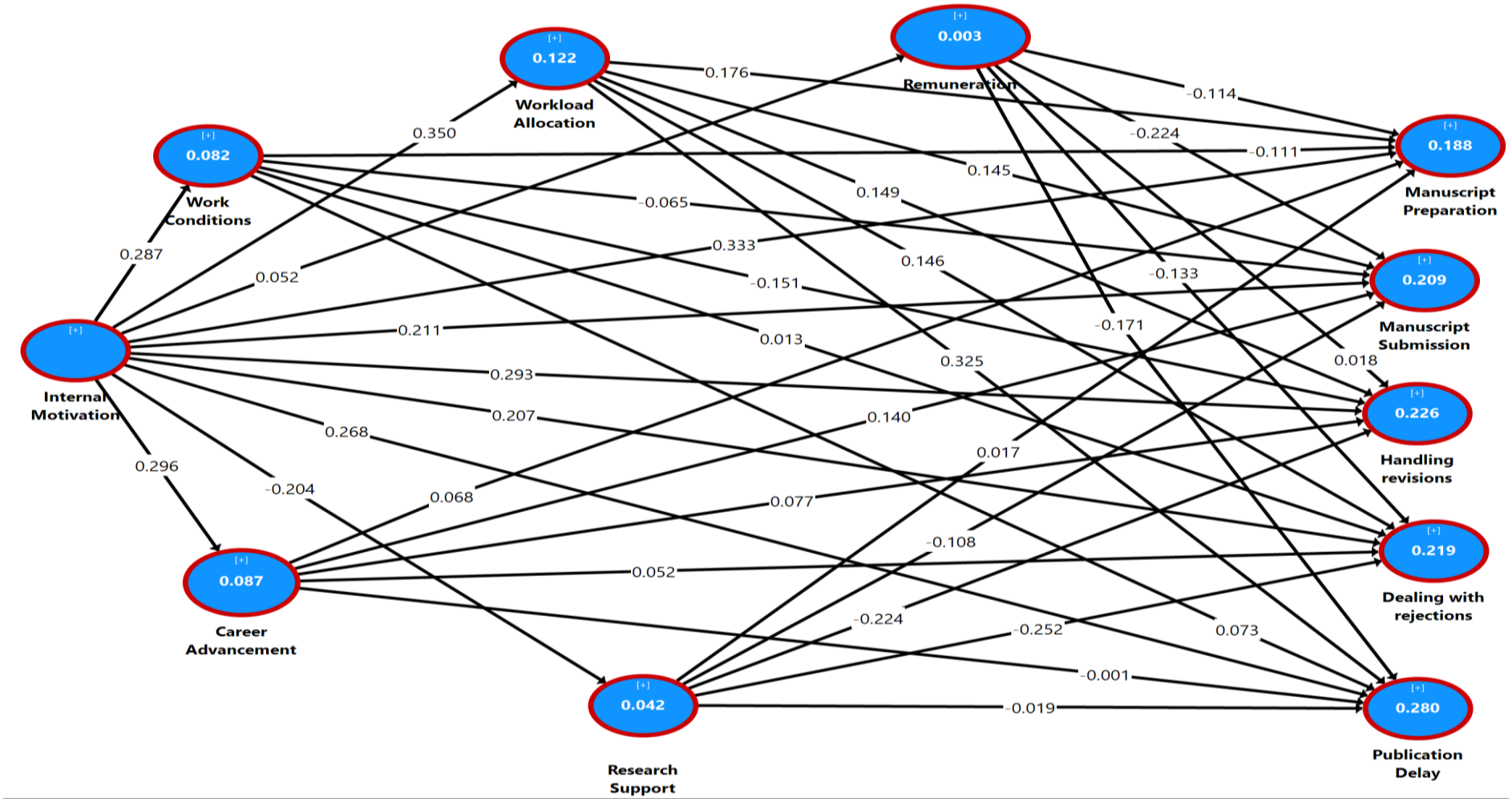


FIGURE 7: A model showing the direct and mediation effects of internal motivation and job satisfaction variables on persistence to Scopus-indexed journals using PLS-SEM

4.2.5. Hypothesis five

There is no significant joint and partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. In this hypothesis, the exogenous variable is empathy, while the mediating variable is job satisfaction, across different dimensions, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support. The focus of investigation is the endogenous variable – persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, across five distinct dimensions: persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, managing rejections, and publication delays. The testing of this hypothesis was done at a significance level of .05 utilising the PLS-SEM method, and the results are presented in Table 10 and Figure 8.

Regarding the combined mediation effect, Table 10 indicates that job satisfaction variables (comprising satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support), jointly had a significant positive mediation effect in the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence to publish in terms of manuscript preparation ($\beta = .061$, $t = 2.412$, $p < .05$), manuscript submission ($\beta = .107$, $t = 3.760$, $p < .05$), handling revisions ($\beta = .077$, $t = 3.027$, $p < .05$), dealing with rejections ($\beta = .090$, $t = 3.105$, $p < .05$). However, these variables had an insignificant joint mediation effect on the connection between empathy and lecturers' persistence to publish in terms of publication delays. Thus, the null mediation hypothesis was not accepted for persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, all the dimensions, except publication delays.

Regarding the partial mediation effects, satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities and research support did not significantly mediate the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript preparation, respectively. Nevertheless, only satisfaction with workload allocation ($\beta = .025$, $t = 2.040$,

$p < .05$) significantly served as a partial mediator in the relationship between empathy and persistence to publish in terms of manuscript preparation. For manuscript submission, only satisfaction with workload allocation ($\beta = .021$, $t = 1.999$, $p < .05$) and career advancement opportunities ($\beta = .047$, $t = 2.313$, $p < .05$) significantly and partially mediated the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, respectively. Conversely, other job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration and research support, did not mediate this relationship to a statistically significant extent.

In terms of persistence in handling revisions, Table 10 demonstrates that satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation and handling revisions, respectively, did not partially mediate the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals to a significant extent. In contrast, only satisfaction with research support ($\beta = .088$, $t = 3.168$, $p < .05$) partially and significantly mediated the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence in handling revisions. It is also displayed in Table 10 that satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation and career advancement opportunities did not significantly mediate the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence in dealing with rejections, respectively. Nevertheless, satisfaction with research support ($\beta = .077$, $t = 2.859$, $p < .05$) was a significant partial mediator in the relationship between empathy and persistence to publish in terms of dealing with rejections. Furthermore, Table 10 reveals that only satisfaction with career advancement opportunities ($\beta = .051$, $t = 2.046$, $p < .05$) had a significant partial mediation effect in the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence to publish in the context of publication delays. Conversely, when it comes to publication delays, satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation and research support, had insignificant mediating effect in the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence in publication delays.

TABLE 10

Joint and partial mediation effects of job variables in the relationship between empathy and the dimensions of persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

Type	Paths	β	*M*	*SD*	*t*	*p*
Joint Mediation	EMP → PMP	.061*	0.071	0.025	2.412	.016
	EMP → PMS	.107*	0.120	0.028	3.760	.000
	EMP → PHR	.077*	0.084	0.025	3.027	.002
	EMP → PDR	.090*	0.099	0.029	3.105	.002
	EMP → PPD	.060	0.070	0.034	1.763	.078
Partial Mediation	EMP → SWC → PMP	.004	0.005	0.008	0.504	.614
	EMP → REM → PMP	.003	0.007	0.015	0.226	.822
	EMP → SWA → PMP	.025*	0.026	0.012	2.040	.041
	EMP → CAO → PMP	.025	0.025	0.021	1.194	.232
	EMP → SRS → PMP	.003	0.007	0.023	0.109	.913
	EMP → SWC → PMS	-.015	-0.007	0.014	1.082	.279
	EMP → REM → PMS	.027	0.029	0.021	1.315	.189
	EMP → SWA → PMS	.021*	0.023	0.011	1.999	.046
	EMP → CAO → PMS	.047*	0.045	0.020	2.313	.021
	EMP → SRS → PMS	.026	0.030	0.022	1.181	.238
	EMP → SWC → PHR	.002	0.004	0.009	0.228	.819
	EMP → REM → PHR	-.032	-0.028	0.021	1.512	.131
	EMP → SWA → PHR	.020	0.021	0.011	1.848	.065
	EMP → CAO → PHR	.000	-0.001	0.023	0.012	.990
	EMP → SRS → PHR	.088*	0.087	0.028	3.168	.002
	EMP → SWC → PDR	-.006	-0.001	0.010	0.596	.551
	EMP → REM → PDR	.000	0.002	0.018	0.013	.989
	EMP → SWA → PDR	.018	0.019	0.010	1.855	.064
	EMP → CAO → PDR	.001	-0.002	0.024	0.035	.972
	EMP → SRS → PDR	.077*	0.082	0.027	2.859	.004
	EMP → SWC → PPD	-.018	-0.013	0.012	1.445	.148
	EMP → REM → PPD	.008	0.006	0.021	0.390	.696
	EMP → SWA → PPD	.030	0.032	0.017	1.788	.074
	EMP → CAO → PPD	.051*	0.047	0.025	2.046	.041
	EMP → SRS → PPD	-.012	-0.003	0.022	0.521	.602

* Significant at .05 alpha level

Note: CAO = Satisfaction with career advancement opportunities; REM = Satisfaction with remuneration; EMP = Empathy; SWC = Satisfaction with work conditions; SWA = Satisfaction with workload allocation; SRS = Satisfaction with research support; PDR = Persistence in dealing with rejections; PHR = Persistence in handling revisions; PMP = Persistence in manuscript preparation; PMS = Persistence in manuscript submission; PPD = Persistence in publication delays.

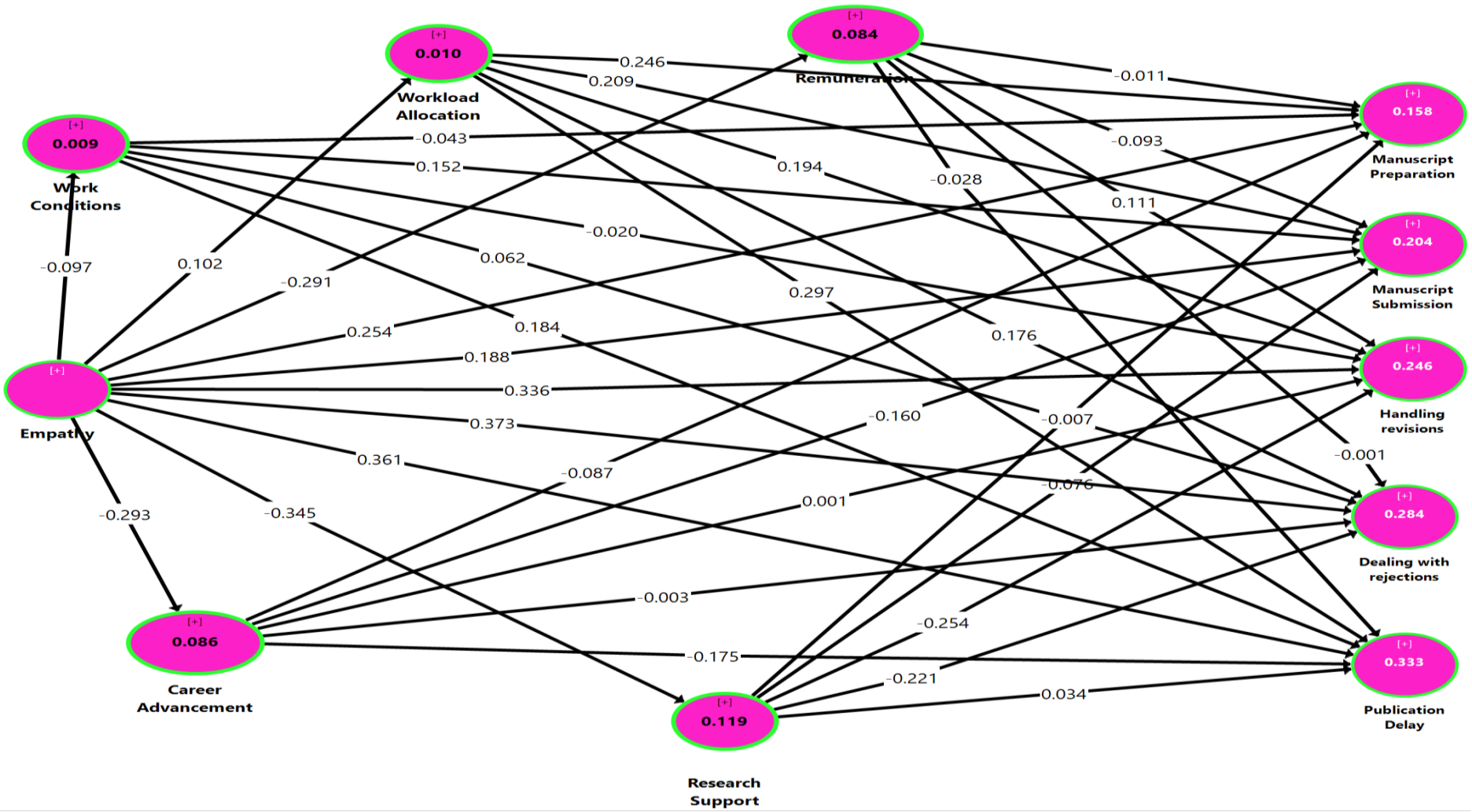


FIGURE 8: A model showing the direct and mediation effects of empathy and job satisfaction variables on persistence to Scopus-indexed journals using PLS-SEM

In Figure 8, the results suggest that lecturers' empathy contributes different percentages of variance to their job satisfaction across various aspects: 0.8% (*Adj.* R^2 = .008, $p > .05$) for satisfaction with work conditions, 8.3% (*Adj.* R^2 = .083, $p < .05$) for satisfaction with remuneration, 0.9% (*Adj.* R^2 = .009, $p > .05$) for satisfaction with workload allocation, 8.4% (*Adj.* R^2 = .084, $p < .05$) for career advancement opportunities, and 11.8% (*Adj.* R^2 = .118, $p < .05$) for research support. This implies that a significant portion of the variability in these facets of lecturers' job satisfaction, specifically 99.2%, 91.7%, 99.1%, 91.6%, and 89.2%, may be attributed to factors not included in the model. Furthermore, Figure 8 illustrates that the collective contributions of lecturers' empathy and job satisfaction variables plays a significant role in explaining a significant portion of the variability in lecturers' persistence to publish as follows: 15% (*Adj.* R^2 = .15, $p < .05$) for manuscript preparation, 19.7% (*Adj.* R^2 = .197, $p < .05$) for manuscript submission, 23.9% (Adj. R^2 = .239, $p < .05$) for handling revisions, 27.7% (*Adj.* R^2 = .277, $p < .05$) for dealing with rejections, and 32.7% (*Adj.* R^2 = .327, $p < .05$) for publication delays. Consequently, it is plausible that variables, not encompassed within the model, could explain a significant portion of the unexplained variance in these five dimensions of the endogenous variable, comprising 85%, 80.3%, 76.1%, 72.3%, and 67.3%, respectively.

4.2.6. Hypothesis six

There is no significant composite second-order mediation effect of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. The exogenous variable in this hypothesis is emotional intelligence, whereas the mediator variable is job satisfaction, and the endogenous variable is persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. The statistical technique used in testing the hypothesis at .05 level of significance is PLS-SEM. The second-order factors were created by summing the scores of individual items in each sub-variable of the second-

order variables. For instance, all the items measuring self-awareness, self-regulation, social awareness, internal motivation and empathy were summed for each of these sub-variables, respectively. The same was done for satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support, respectively. Similarly, items for persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals were summed for each dimension such as persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays. Thus, the various sub-scales were used as second-level factors in the outer model of the PLS structural equation model (see Figure 9). The result of the analysis is presented in Table 11.

Table 11 shows that job satisfaction positively and significantly mediated the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals ($\beta = .060$, $t = 4.161$, $p < .05$). In terms of direct effects among the variables, different predictions are reported in Table 11. The result in Table 11 shows that emotional intelligence has an insignificant prediction on lecturers' job satisfaction. Similarly, Table job satisfaction is an insignificant predictor of lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. However, emotional intelligence has a significant and positive direct effect on lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

Figure 9 indicates that 14.1% (*Adj.* $R^2 = .141$, $p < .05$) of the variance in lecturers' job satisfaction is accounted for by their emotional intelligence. This implies that 85.9% of the unaccounted proportion of the variance is attributable to other variables not included in the model. Furthermore, Figure 9 shows that 39.6% of the total variation in lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals is jointly explained by their emotional intelligence and job satisfaction. Therefore, exogenous variables outside the model are accountable for 60.4% of the unexplained proportion of the variance in lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-index journals.

TABLE 11

Second-order mediation of job satisfaction on the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals

Type	Paths	β	*M*	*SD*	*t*	*p*
Mediation	EI → JS → PP	.060*	0.060	0.014	4.161	.000
Direct effect	EI → JS	.378	0.326	0.195	1.935	.053
Direct effect	EI → PP	.553*	0.556	0.035	15.796	.000
Direct effect	JS → PP	.159	0.139	0.083	1.929	.054

*Significant at .05 level
EI = Emotional Intelligence; JS = Job Satisfaction; PP = Persistence to Publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

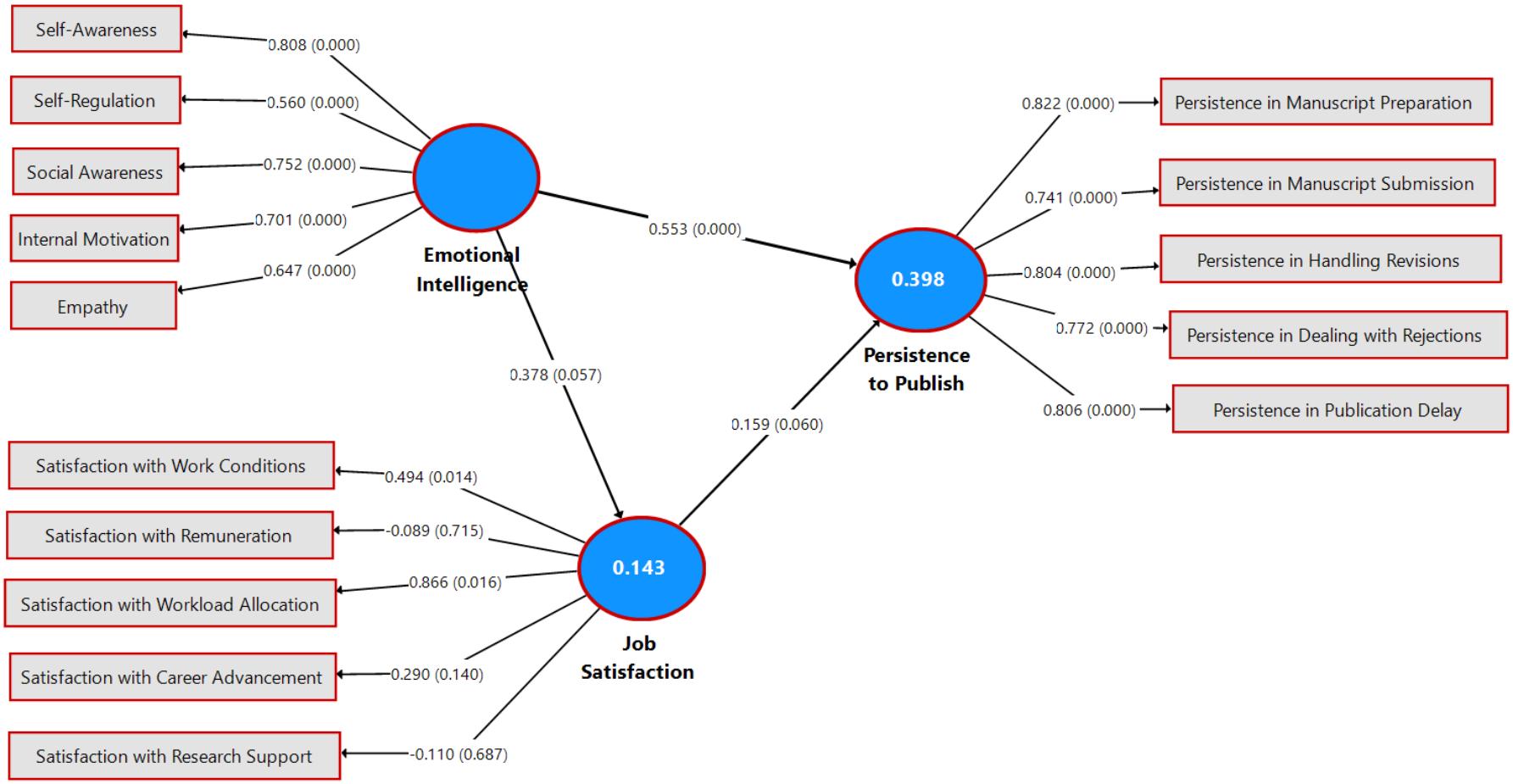


FIGURE 9: Second-order mediation model showing the direct and mediation effects among the exogenous, mediator and endogenous variables of the study, with their sub-scales as outer loadings.

4.2.7. Hypothesis seven

There is no significant variation in the extent to which job satisfaction variables jointly and partially mediate the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, based on lecturers' sex, education level and marital status. The exogenous variable in this hypothesis is self-awareness, the mediators are job satisfaction variables, whereas the endogenous variable is persistence to publish across five dimensions. The moderator variables in this hypothesis are sex, education level and marital status. A Multigroup Mediation Analysis (MGMA) was performed to compare the various paths coefficients across different demographic sub-groups for a more specific result. The result of the analysis is presented in Table 12.

Joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by sex

Table 12 shows that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables (Satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support) in the relationship between self-awareness and their persistence in manuscript preparation is significantly different (δ = -.247, $p < .05$) between male (β = -.027) and female (β = .221) lecturers. The effect is positive for females than males. In terms of manuscript submission, Table 12 shows that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish is both positive for males (β = 0.140) and females (β = 0.242), with the effect being significantly stronger for the latter than the former (δ = -.102, $p < .05$). The result of the analysis also shows that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in handling revisions is both positive for males (β = .098) and for females (β = .131), with no significant difference between both sexes. Regarding the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in dealing

with rejections, Table 12 shows that for both males (β = .099) and females (β = .248) the effect is positive, but it is significantly stronger for female than male lecturers (δ = -.149, $p < .05$). In reference to the joint mediation effect of the job satisfaction variables on the correlation between self-awareness and persistence in publication delays, Table 12 displays a positive influence for both male (β = .089) and female (β = .254) lecturers, with a significant difference (δ = -.165 at $p < .05$) in favour of the latter.

Joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by education level.

Table 12 shows, for manuscript preparation, that lecturers with a master's degree (β = .279) and those with a Ph.D. (β = .037) both experience a positive joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables. However, this effect is significantly stronger for those with a master's degree (δ = .242, $p < .05$). In other dimensions of lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, such as: persistence in manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays, the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables is not significantly different between lecturers with a master's degree and those with a Ph.D.

Joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by marital status.

Table 12 shows that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables, such as: satisfaction with work conditions (SWC), remuneration (REM), workload allocation (SWA), career advancement opportunities (CAO) and research support (SRS) on the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed across the five dimensions, stratified by marital status, has mixed findings. For dimensions, such as persistence in manuscript preparation and publication delays, there is no significant difference between single and married lecturers in the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables.

However, a significant difference was recorded in the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables. For instance, in manuscript submission, job satisfaction variables had a significantly stronger positive joint mediation effect ($\delta = .266$, $p < .05$) for single ($\beta = .389$) compared to married lecturers ($\beta = .123$). In the dimension of persistence in handling revisions, job satisfaction variables had a negative joint mediation effect for single ($\beta = -.229$) and positive joint mediation effect for married ($\beta = .045$) lecturers, with the effect being significantly stronger for single than married lecturers ($\delta = -.273$, $p < .05$). In dealing with rejections, both single ($\beta = .298$) and married ($\beta = .122$) lecturers experience a positive joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables. The difference between these effects is statistically significant ($\delta = .176$, $p < .05$), with the effect being stronger for single than married lecturers.

Partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by sex.

Table 12 shows that the partial mediation effect of job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration and career advancement opportunities, in the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in manuscript preparation, is not significantly different between male than female lecturers. On the contrary, the partial mediation effect of other job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with workload allocation and research support, on the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in manuscript preparation, had significant sex-specific variations. For workload allocation, the partial mediation effect was positive for both male ($\beta = .011$) and female ($\beta = .166$) lecturers, with a significant difference ($\delta = -.155$, $p < .05$), favour of females. For research support, the partial mediation effect was negative for males ($\beta = -.044$) but positive for female lecturers ($\beta = .032$), with a statistically significant sex difference ($\delta = -.76$, $p < .05$) in favour of the males.

TABLE 12

Joint and partial mediation of job satisfaction variables on the relationship self-awareness and persistence to publish across some demographic profiles of respondents.

Type	Paths	SEX				EDUCATION LEVEL				MARITAL STATUS			
		Males	Female	δ	p	Master's	Ph.D.	δ	p	Single	Married	δ	p
Joint Mediation	SAW→PMP	-.027	.221	-.247*	.000	.279	.037	.242*	.000	.084	.067	.017	.741
	SAW→PMS	.140	.242	-.102*	.021	-.016	.079	-.095	.057	.389	.123	.266*	.000
	SAW→PHR	.098	.131	-.034	.324	.172	.130	.043	.298	-.229	.045	-.273*	.000
	SAW→PDR	.099	.248	-.149*	.002	.138	.151	-.013	.781	.298	.122	.176*	.002
	SAW→PPD	.089	.254	-.165*	.003	.143	.135	.009	.887	.256	.152	.104	.126
Partial Mediation	SAW→SWC→PMP	-.047	-.027	-.021	.217	-.002	.006	-.008	.682	.001	-.010	.011	.593
	SAW→REM→PMP	.030	.041	-.011	.387	.004	.030	-.026	.070	.301	.016	.285*	.000
	SAW→SWA→PMP	.011	.166	-.155*	.000	.079	.037	.042	.070	-.221	.049	-.270*	.000
	SAW→CAO→PMP	.023	.008	.015	.571	.196	.001	.195*	.000	-.285	.021	-.306*	.000
	SAW→SRS→PMP	-.044	.032	-.076*	.005	.001	-.037	.038	.222	.288	-.009	.296*	.000
	SAW→SWC→PMS	.067	-.030	.098*	.000	.031	.030	.000	.991	.042	.013	.028	.334
	SAW→REM→PMS	.010	.117	-.106*	.000	.021	.030	-.009	.716	.259	.043	.217*	.000
	SAW→SWA→PMS	.021	.082	-.061*	.008	-.028	.025	-.054*	.022	-.138	.032	-.170*	.000
	SAW→CAO→PMS	.041	.016	.025	.351	-.031	.018	-.049	.102	-.197	.057	-.254*	.000
	SAW→SRS→PMS	.001	.058	-.058	.059	-.008	-.024	.016	.600	.422	-.023	.445*	.000
	SAW→SWC→PHR	.041	-.013	.054*	.010	-.021	.003	-.024	.324	.009	-.012	.020	.464
	SAW→REM→PHR	-.004	.029	-.033*	.035	-.022	-.044	.021	.195	-.079	-.019	-.060*	.008
	SAW→SWA→PHR	.013	.049	-.036	.074	-.023	.049	-.072*	.004	-.183	.032	-.214*	.000
	SAW→CAO→PHR	.001	-.006	.007	.818	.235	-.002	.237*	.000	-.049	.014	-.063	.062
	SAW → SRS →PHR	.047	.072	-.025	.386	.003	.124	-.120*	.002	.073	.029	.044	.204
	SAW→SWC→PDR	.008	.033	-.025	.161	.012	.024	-.012	.564	-.015	.021	-.036	.101
	SAW→REM→PDR	.008	.079	-.071*	.000	.019	.017	.002	.888	.089	.027	.062*	.005
	SAW→SWA→PDR	.017	.042	-.025	.188	.001	.036	-.035	.093	-.031	.041	-.072*	.004
	SAW→CAO→PDR	.007	.030	-.023	.367	.089	-.004	.093*	.003	-.172	.026	-.198*	.000
	SAW→SRS→PDR	.058	.064	-.006	.851	.017	.079	-.062	.077	.426	.006	.420*	.000
	SAW→SWC→PPD	.018	.015	.002	.891	.000	-.005	.005	.816	-.024	.026	-.050*	.041
	SAW→REM→PPD	.057	.105	-.048*	.009	.017	.012	.005	.798	-.095	.027	-.122*	.000
	SAW→CAO→PPD	.027	-.025	.053	.071	.034	.001	.033	.296	.252	.016	.236*	.000
	SAW→SWA→PPD	.022	.169	-.147*	.000	.077	.076	.001	.972	.296	.077	.218*	.000
	SAW→SRS→PPD	-.035	-.010	-.025	.263	.014	.050	-.036	.127	-.173	.006	-.179*	.000

*Significant difference at $p < .05$.

In the context of manuscript submission, the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration and workload allocation, in the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, is significantly different for male and female lecturers. Table 12 reveals that the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions is positive for male (β = .067) and negative for female (β = -.030) lecturers, with a statistically significant sex difference (δ = -.098, $p < .05$). Similarly, remuneration shows positive partial mediation effects for both males (β = .010) and females (β = .117), with a significant sex difference (δ = -.106, $p < .05$) in favour of the female lecturers. Moreover, satisfaction with workload allocation has a positive partial mediation effect for both male (β = .021) and female (β = .082) lecturers, with a significant sex difference (δ = -.061, $p < .05$) in favour of female lecturers. In contrast, there is no significant difference in the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with career advancement opportunities and research support satisfaction between male and female lecturers, in the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, in terms of manuscript submission.

In terms of handling revisions, Table 12 reveals that satisfaction with work conditions and remuneration are the only two aspects of job satisfaction with a significantly different partial mediation effect, for male and female lecturers, in the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. The partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions is positive for males (β = .041) and negative for females (β = -.013), with a significant sex difference (δ = -.054, $p < .05$), in favour of the latter. Also, the partial mediation effect of remuneration is negative for male (β = -.004) and positive for female (β = .029) lecturers, with a significant sex difference (δ= -.033, $p < .05$). However, there is no significant difference between male and female lecturers regarding the partial mediation effects of job

satisfaction variables, such as: satisfaction with workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support, in the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in handling revisions.

Table 12 further shows, in the dimension of dealing with rejections, that only the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration, in the relationship between self-awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, is significantly different between male and female lecturers. The partial mediation effect of remuneration was positive for both male (β = .008) and female (β = .079) lecturers, with a significant sex difference (δ = -.071, $p < .05$). However, the partial mediation effects of other job satisfaction variables (such as: satisfaction with work conditions, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support), in the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in dealing with rejections, does not vary with the sex of lecturers.

Table 12 indicates that job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with remuneration and workload allocation has significant differences for male and female lecturers, in their partial mediation effects on the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in publication delays. Specifically, remuneration has a positive partial mediation effect for both male (β = .057) and female (β = 0.105) lecturers, with a significant difference (δ = -.048, $p < .05$) in favour of females. Satisfaction with workload allocation also has a positive partial mediation effect for both male (β = .022) and female (β = .169) lecturers, with a significant difference (δ = -.147, $p < .05$), in favour of female lecturers. On the contrary, other job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, career advancement opportunities and research support had insignificant differences between male and female lecturers, in their partial mediations of the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in publication delays.

Partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by education level.

In terms of the partial mediation effects moderated by education level, the following results were obtained. In the dimension of manuscript preparation, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities in the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, is positive for both lecturers with master's and PhD degree, with a significantly stronger effect for master's degree holders ($\delta = .195$, $p < .05$). However, Table 12 shows that there is no significant difference between lecturers with master's and Ph.D degrees, in the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables (such as: satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation and research support) on the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in manuscript preparation.

Concerning the aspect of manuscript submission, the effect of satisfaction with workload allocation as a partial mediator in the connection between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals is negative for master's and positive for Ph.D. degree-holding lecturers. The effect is notably stronger for those with master's degrees ($\delta = -.054$, $p < .05$). On the other hand, Table 12 reveals that there is no statistically significant distinction between lecturers with master's degrees and those with Ph.D. degrees in the partially mediated effects of job satisfaction variables (such as satisfaction with working conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities, and research support), on the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in manuscript submission.

Table 12 shows that the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation in the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in handling revisions, is negative for master's degree holders, but positive for Ph.D. holders, with a significant difference ($\delta = -.072$, $p < .05$), in favour of PhD holders. Similarly, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities in the relationship between

self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in handling revisions, is significantly different between master's and doctoral degree holders (δ = 0.237, $p < .05$). The is positive and significantly stronger for master's degree holders (β = .235) than Ph.D. holders where the effect is negative (β = -.002). Moreover, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with research support in the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in handling revisions, is positive for both lecturers with master's and doctoral degrees, but significantly stronger for Ph.D. holders (δ = -.120, $p < .05$). On the contrary, the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions and remuneration on the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in handling revisions, does not significantly vary between lecturers with master's degree and those with Ph.D.

Table 12 further shows that the partial mediation effect of lecturers' satisfaction with career advancement on the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in dealing with rejections is positive for master's degree holders, but negative for Ph.D. holders, with a significant difference (δ = .093, $p < .05$), in favour of master's degree holders. However, the results indicate, on the contrary, that the partial mediation effects of other job satisfaction variables (such as, satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, and research support) on the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in dealing with rejections, is not significantly different between those with master's and doctoral degrees, respectively. Furthermore, Table 12 reveals that the partial mediation effects of all the job satisfaction variables (such as, satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support) on the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in publication delays, is not significantly different between those with master's and doctoral degrees, respectively.

Partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by marital status.

Table 12 shows that satisfaction with remuneration positively and significantly mediated the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in manuscript for both single and married lecturers, with a stronger partial mediation effect for single lecturers (δ = .285, $p < .05$). Similarly, satisfaction with workload allocation exhibited a negative mediation effect for single but a positive mediation effect for married lecturers, with a stronger effect for single lecturers (δ = -.270, p < .05). satisfaction with career advancement opportunities also had a negative mediation effect in the relationship for single but a positive mediation effect for married lecturers, with the effect being stronger for single than married lecturers (δ = -.306, $p < .05$). Satisfaction with research support has a positive mediation effect for single, and a negative effect for married lecturers, with a significant difference (δ = .296, $p < .05$), in favour of single lecturers. However, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in manuscript preparation is not significantly different between single and married lecturers.

Table 12 shows that satisfaction with remuneration positively mediated the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in manuscript preparation, for both single and married lecturers, with a stronger effect for single lecturers (δ = .217, $p < .05$). Satisfaction with workload allocation has a negative mediation effect for single, but a positive mediation effect for married lecturers, with a stronger effect for the former (δ = -.170, $p < .05$). Satisfaction with career advancement opportunities also mediated the relationship negatively for single and positively for married lecturers, with a stronger mediation effect for single lecturers (δ = -.254, $p < .05$). Satisfaction with research support significantly mediated the relationship positively for single and negatively for married lecturers, with a stronger mediation effect for single lecturers (δ = .445, $p < .05$). However, Table 12 indicates that the partial mediation effect of lecturers' satisfaction with work

conditions on the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in manuscript preparation, is not significantly different between single and married lecturers.

In terms of persistence in handling revisions, Table 12 depicts that satisfaction with remuneration significantly mediated the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in handling revisions, negatively for both groups, with a stronger mediation effect for single lecturers (δ = -.273, p < .05). Similarly, satisfaction with workload allocation has a negative mediation effect for both groups, with a stronger negative effect for single lecturers (δ = -.214, p < .05). However, there is no significant difference between single and married lecturers, regarding the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables, such as: satisfaction with work conditions, career advancement opportunities and research support, in the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in handling revisions, respectively.

Table 12 further shows that satisfaction with remuneration significantly mediated the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in dealing with rejections, with a stronger partial mediation effect for single than married lecturers (δ = .062, p < .05). Satisfaction with workload allocation has a negative mediation effect for single lecturers, but a positive mediation effect for married lecturers, with a significant difference (δ = -.072, p < .05), in favour of single lecturers. Similarly, satisfaction with career advancement opportunities has a partial mediation effect that is negative for single and positive for married lecturers, with a stronger mediation effect for single lecturers (δ = -.198, p < .05). Similarly, satisfaction with research support significantly mediated the relationship positively for both groups, with a significant difference in mediation strength (δ = .420, p < .05) in favour of single lecturers. However, the mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in dealing with rejections is not significantly different between single and married lecturers.

In terms of publication delays, the partial mediation effects of all the job satisfaction variables, in the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, are significantly different between master's degree and Ph.D holders. For instance, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions is significantly different between single and married lecturers ($\delta = -.050$, $p < .05$). Similarly, the partial mediation effect of remuneration in the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in publication delays is significantly different $\delta = -.122$, $p < .05$) between married and single lecturers, with a stronger mediation effect for single lecturers. There is a significant positive mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the relationship for both groups, with a stronger positive mediation effect for single lecturers ($\delta = .236$, $p < .05$). Similarly, the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with workload allocation ($\delta = .218$, $p < .05$) and research support ($\delta = -.179$, $p < .05$) are significantly different between single and married lecturers, respectively.

Hypothesis 8

There is no significant variation in the joint and partial mediation of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, based on their sex, education level and marital status. The exogenous variable in this hypothesis is self-regulation. The mediating variables are the five dimensions of job satisfaction, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support. The endogenous variable is persistence to publish across five dimensions (persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays). There are three moderating variables in this hypothesis – sex, education level and marital status. A Multigroup Analysis (MGA) was

performed to test the hypothesis at .05 alpha level. The result of the analysis is presented in Table 13.

Joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by sex

The results in Table 13 provides evidence regarding the joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. Table 13 indicates that there is a significant difference (δ = -.110, p < .05) in the mediation effect of job satisfaction variables between male (β = .027) and female (β = .137) lecturers on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in handling revisions, with the effect being stronger for females. Similarly, there is a significant difference (δ = -.190, p < .05) in the mediation effect of job satisfaction variables between male (β = .007) and female (β = .198) lecturers on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in publication delays, with the effect being stronger for females. On the contrary, Table 13 reveals that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between self-regulation and endogenous variables, such as persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission and dealing with rejections, is not significantly different between male and female lecturers.

Joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables moderated by education level.

The joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between self-regulation and persistence to publish across all the dimensions was examined, with lecturers' education level as the moderating variable. Table 13 shows that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript preparation differed significantly (δ = .100, p < .05) between lecturers with a master's degree (β = .111) and those with a Ph.D. (β = .011), with the effect being stronger for those with a master's degree.

TABLE 13

Joint and partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables in linking self-regulation to persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed across some demographic profiles of lecturers.

	SEX				EDUCATION LEVEL				MARITAL STATUS			
Paths	Male	Female	δ	p	Master's	Ph.D.	δ	p	Single	Married	δ	p
SRE→PMP	-.005	.045	-.050	.212	.111	.011	.100*	.021	.021	.048	-.027	.576
SRE→PMS	.041	.128	-.087	.065	-.020	.065	-.085	.091	.085	.114	-.029	.592
SRE→PHR	.027	.137	-.110*	.004	.073	.153	-.080	.053	.054	.048	.006	.905
SRE→PDR	.049	.137	-.088	.062	.148	.102	.046	.378	.144	.119	.026	.636
SRE→PPD	.007	.198	-.190*	.000	.133	.095	.038	.487	.030	.117	-.088	.183
SRE→SWC→PMP	.000	-.055	.055	.002	-.039	.004	-.044*	.031	-.009	.000	-.009	.705
SRE→REM→PMP	.012	-.017*	.028	.068	-.008	-.009	.001	.933	-.041	.001	-.042	.041
SRE→SWA→PMP	-.003	.162	-.165	.000	.027	.045	-.018	.451	.021	.037	-.016	.530
SRE→CAO→PMP	.013	-.019	.031	.105	.138	-.007	.145*	.000	.048	.005	.043	.106
SRE→SRS→PMP	-.027	-.026	-.001	.973	-.006	-.022	.016	.522	.001	.004	-.002	.936
SRE→SWC→PMS	-.003	-.066*	.064	.007	.045	-.002	.047*	.046	-.087	.004	-.091*	.004
SRE→REM→PMS	.005	.062	-.057	.099	-.118	-.010	-.107*	.002	-.035	.054	-.089*	.033
SRE→SWA→PMS	-.003	.072*	-.075	.000	.009	.026	-.017	.377	.014	.026	-.013	.531
SRE→CAO→PMS	.030	.042	-.012	.610	.108	.038	.070*	.016	.052	.019	.034	.237
SRE→SRS→PMS	.012	.018	-.006	.823	-.064	.013	-.077*	.016	.141	.010	.130*	.002
SRE→SWC→PHR	-.001	-.047*	.046	.006	-.085	-.002	-.083*	.000	-.016	.002	-.018	.362
SRE→REM→PHR	-.002	.042*	-.044	.013	-.023	.010	-.032	.085	-.020	-.029	.010	.633
SRE→SWA→PHR	-.003	.074*	-.077	.000	.013	.048	-.035	.109	.021	.034	-.013	.589
SRE→CAO→PHR	-.008	.019	-.027	.142	.163	.012	.150*	.000	.007	.009	-.002	.943
SRE→SRS→PHR	.041	.049	-.008	.751	.005	.085	-.080*	.016	.061	.033	.029	.369
SRE→SWC→PDR	-.001	.018	-.019	.326	.045	-.002	.047	.055	.002	.022	-.020	.403
SRE→REM→PDR	.005	.054*	-.049	.036	-.018	-.005	-.013	.671	-.022	.039	-.061*	.041
SRE→SWA→PDR	-.003	.029	-.032	.068	.017	.059	-.042*	.038	.008	.030	-.021	.339
SRE→CAO→PDR	.007	.030	-.023	.178	.089	.001	.088*	.000	-.008	.013	-.021	.282
SRE→SRS→PDR	.042	.006	.036	.239	.015	.048	-.034	.318	.164	.015	.149*	.002
SRE→SWC→PPD	-.002	-.014	.012	.479	-.010	.025	-.036	.069	-.012	.021	-.033	.118
SRE→REM→PPD	.014	.117*	-.104	.000	.025	-.003	.028	.355	.017	.037	-.020	.526
SRE→SWA→PPD	-.005	.124*	-.129	.000	.026	.061	-.035	.268	.019	.046	-.027	.448
SRE→CAO→PPD	.008	-.011	.019	.213	.066	-.002	.069*	.004	.001	.004	-.004	.829
SRE→SRS→PPD	-.007	-.019	.011	.515	.026	.013	.012	.526	.006	.009	-.003	.866

*Significant difference at $p < .05$.

On the contrary, Table 13 reveals that there is no significant difference in the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables between lecturers with a master's degree and those with a Ph.D. on the relationship between self-regulation and other dimensions of lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, such as: manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays.

Joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables moderated by marital status.

The joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between self-regulation and the persistence to publish in various dimensions was investigated, considering the marital status of lecturers as a moderating variable. Table 13 shows that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between self-regulation and all the dimensions of lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals (such as: persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays), does not significantly differ between single and married lecturers.

Partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by sex.

The partial mediation effects of each mediating variable in the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript preparation between male and female lecturers were examined. Table 13 shows that there is a significant difference ($\delta = .055$, $p < .05$) between male ($\beta = .000$) and female ($\beta = -.055$) lecturers, in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript preparation, with the effect being stronger for female lecturers. Similarly, the results showed a significant difference ($\delta = -.165$, $p < .05$) between male ($\beta = -.003$) and female ($\beta = .162$) lecturers in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in

manuscript preparation, with the effect being significantly stronger for female lecturers. However, Table 13 indicates no significant difference between male and female lecturers in the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with remuneration, career advancement opportunities, research support, on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript preparation.

The partial mediation effects of different job satisfaction variables were also examined on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript submission, with sex as the moderator variable. Table 13 reveals a significant difference ($\delta = .064$, $p < .05$) between male ($\beta = -.003$) and female ($\beta = -.066$) lecturers in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions, with the effect being stronger for female lecturers. Similarly, there is a significant difference ($\delta = -.075$, $p < .05$) between male ($\beta = -.003$) and female ($\beta = .072$) lecturers in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship, with the effect being notably stronger for female lecturers. Conversely, the results in Table 13 indicates no significant difference between male and female lecturers in the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with remuneration, career advancement opportunities and research support, on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript submission, suggesting similar mediation effects for both sexes.

The relationship between self-regulation and persistence in handling revisions was examined based on the partial mediation effects of different job satisfaction variables for male and female lecturers. Table 13 indicates a significant difference ($\delta = .046$, $p < .05$) between male ($\beta = -.001$) and female ($\beta = -.047$) lecturers in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in handling revisions, with the effect being stronger for male lecturers. Similarly, there is a significant difference ($\delta = -.077$, $p < .05$), between male ($\beta = -.003$) and female ($\beta = .074$) lecturers in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload

allocation on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in handling revisions, with the effect being significantly stronger for female lecturers. However, job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with remuneration, career advancement opportunities and research support had no significant differential partial mediation effects for male and female lecturers, on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in handling revisions, respectively.

The sex difference in the partial mediation effects of various job satisfaction variables in the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in dealing with rejections are also reported in Table 13. Table 13 indicates a significant difference (δ = -.049, $p < .05$) between male (β = .005) and female (β = .054) lecturers in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in dealing with rejections, with the effect being notably stronger for female lecturers. However, there is no significant difference in the partial mediation effect of job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support, on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in dealing with rejections between male and female lecturers.

Furthermore, Table 13 reveal a significant difference (δ = -.104, $p < .05$) between male (β = .014) and female (β = .117) lecturers in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in publication delays, with the effect being notably stronger for the female lecturers. Similarly, there is a significant difference (δ = -.129, $p < .05$) in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in publication delays between male (β = -.005) and female (β = .124) lecturers, indicating a stronger mediation effect for females. On the contrary, Table 13 indicate that there is no significant difference in the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction

variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, career advancement opportunities and research support on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in publication delays between male and female lecturers, implying similar mediation effects for both sexes.

Partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by education level.

The partial mediation effects of different job satisfaction variables are also examined in the relationship between self-regulation and different dimensions of the endogenous variables, moderated by education level. The results reveal that there is a significant difference (δ = -.044, p < .05) in the mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between self-regulation and PMP between lecturers with a master's degree (β = -.039) and those with a Ph.D. (β = .004), with the mediation effect being stronger for lecturers with a master's degree. There is also a significant difference in the mediation effect (δ = .145, p < *.05*) of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the relationship between self-regulation and PMP between lecturers with a master's degree (β = .138) and those with a Ph.D. (β = -.007). However, there is no significant difference in the mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration, satisfaction with workload allocation and SRS on the relationship between self-regulation and PMP between lecturers with a master's degree and those with a Ph.D.

For persistence in manuscript submission, Table 13 shows a significant difference (δ = .047, p < .05) in the mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript submission between lecturers with a master's degree (β = .045) and those with a Ph.D. (β = -.002), with the mediation effect being stronger for lecturers with a master's degree. There is a significant difference (δ = -.107, p < .05) in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript

submission among lecturers with a master's degree (β = -.118) and those with a Ph.D. (β = -.010), with the effect being stronger for lecturers with a master's degree. Similarly, there is a significant difference (δ = .070, $p < .05$) in the mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript submission between lecturers with a master's degree (β = .108) and those with a Ph.D. (β = .038) with a stronger effect for lecturers with a master's degree. Moreover, there is a significant difference (δ = -.077, p = .016) in the mediation effect of SRS on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript submission between lecturers with a master's degree (β = -.064) and those with a Ph.D. (β = .013), with the effect being stronger for master's degree holders. In contrast, there is no significant difference in the mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript submission between lecturers with a master's degree and those with a Ph.D, indicating similar mediation effects for both education levels.

The partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in handling revisions significantly differed (δ = -.083, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree (β = -.085) and those with a Ph.D. (β = -.002), with a stronger mediation effect observed for lecturers with a master's degree. Similarly, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in handling revisions significantly differed (δ = .150, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree (β = .163) and those with a Ph.D. (β = .05), with a significantly stronger effect observed for lecturers with a master's degree. Furthermore, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with research support on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in handling revisions significantly differed (δ = -.080, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree (β = .005) and those with a Ph.D. (β = .085), indicating a

stronger effect for lecturers with a Ph.D. On the contrary the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with remuneration and workload allocation on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in handling revisions is not significantly different between lecturers with a master's degree and those with a Ph.D.

The partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in dealing with rejections significantly differed significantly ($\delta = -.042$, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree ($\beta = .017$) and those with a Ph.D. ($\beta = .059$), with a stronger effect for lecturers with a Ph.D. Similarly, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in dealing with rejections significantly differed ($\delta = .088$, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree ($\beta = .089$) and those with a Ph.D. ($\beta = .001$), indicating a stronger effect for lecturers with a master's degree. However, the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration and research support on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in dealing with rejections does not significantly differ between lecturers with a master's degree and those with a Ph.D., respectively, suggesting similar effects for both education levels.

Table 13 further shows that only the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in publication delays, significantly differed ($\delta = .069$, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree ($\beta = .066$) and those with a Ph.D. ($\beta = -.002$), indicating a stronger effect for lecturers with a master's degree. On the contrary, the partial mediation effects of other job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation and research support, on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in publication delays does not significantly differ between

lecturers with a master's degree and those with a Ph.D., respectively, suggesting similar effects for both education levels.

Partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by marital status.

The partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables were examined on the relationship between self-regulation and different dimensions of lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals for single and married lecturers. Table 13 shows that there is a significant difference ($\delta = -.042$, $p < .05$) in the mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript preparation relationship between single ($\beta = -.041$) and married ($\beta = .001$) lecturers, with a stronger effect observed among single lecturers. However, the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with work conditions, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support did not significantly differ between single and married lecturers, suggesting a consistent effect regardless of marital status.

Table 13 also shows that there is a significant difference ($\delta = -.091$, $p < .05$) in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript submission, between single ($\beta = -.087$) and married ($\beta = .004$) lecturers, with a stronger effect for single lecturers. There is also a significant distinction ($\delta = -.089$, $p < .05$) in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript submission between single ($\beta = -.035$) and married ($\beta = .054$) lecturers, favouring married lecturers. Moreover, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with research support on the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence in manuscript submission, significantly differed ($\delta = .130$, $p < .05$) between single ($\beta = .141$) and married ($\beta = .010$) lecturers, with a stronger effect observed among single lecturers. Conversely, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation and career

advancement opportunities on the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence in manuscript submission is consistent between single and married lecturers.

Table 13 also shows that the partial mediation effects of all job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support, on the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence in handling revisions, did not significantly differ between single and married lecturers. This indicates a consistent effect for both groups. Similarly, Table 13 also shows that that the partial mediation effects of all job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support, on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in publication delays, did not significantly differ between single and married lecturers.

Furthermore, Table 13 reveals that there is a significant difference ($\delta = -.061$, $p < .05$) in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in dealing with rejections, between single lecturers ($\beta = -.022$) and those who are married ($\beta = .039$), with a more pronounced effect observed among those who are married. Similarly, there is a significant difference (($\delta = .149$, $p < .05$) in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with research support, on the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence in dealing with rejections, between single lecturers ($\beta = .164$) and those who are married ($\beta = .015$), with the effect being more pronounced among single lecturers. In contrast, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions, workload allocation and career advancement opportunities on the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence in dealing with rejections is consistent across both single and married lecturers, indicating a stable effect irrespective of marital status.

Hypothesis 9

The joint and partial mediation of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between social awareness and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, does not vary significantly with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status. The exogenous variable in this hypothesis is social awareness, whereas the mediators are job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement, and research support. The endogenous variable of this hypothesis is persistence to publish across five dimensions, such as persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays. There are three moderating variables in this hypothesis, including sex, education level and marital status. The statistical technique employed for hypothesis testing is Multigroup Analysis (MGA) at the .05 level of significance. The result of the analysis is presented in Table 14.

Joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by sex.

Table 14 reveals that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript preparation is stronger for female lecturers (β = .210) than for male lecturers (β = -.029), with the difference being statistically significant (δ = -.239, $p < .05$). Similarly, the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between social awareness and persistence in handling revisions is stronger for female lecturers (β = .314) than for male lecturers (β = .089), with the difference being statistically significant (δ = -.225, $p < .05$). Moreover, the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between social awareness and persistence in dealing with rejections is stronger for female lecturers (β = .369) than for male lecturers (β = .061), with the difference being statistically significant (δ = -.308, $p < .05$). The joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables in

linking social awareness to persistence in manuscript submission and publication delays, respectively, is not significantly different between female and male lecturers.

Joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by education level.

Table 14 shows, for the path from social awareness to persistence in handling revisions, that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables was stronger for Ph.D. degree holders (β = .129) compared to master's degree holders (β = -.158), and this difference was statistically significant (δ = -.287, $p < .05$). Likewise, for the path from social awareness to persistence in dealing with rejections, the joint mediation effect was stronger for Ph.D. degree holders (β = .176) compared to master's degree holders (β = -.067), and this difference was statistically significant (δ = -.244, $p < .05$). However, Table 14, shows on the contrary, that there was no significant difference between lecturers with master's and Ph.D. degrees, in the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables on the paths from social awareness to persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission and publication delays, respectively.

Joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by marital status.

The joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between social awareness and different dimensions of persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals was analysed with regards to the marital status of lecturers. For the path from social awareness to persistence in manuscript preparation, the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables was negative and stronger for single (β = -.088) than married lecturers (β = .080) and the difference was significant (δ = -.167, $p < .05$). Similarly, for the path from social awareness to persistence in publication delays, the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables was stronger for married lecturers (β = .205) than for single (β = -.141) lecturers, with a significant difference (δ = -.346, $p < .05$). On the

contrary, Table 14 shows, for the paths from social awareness to persistence in manuscript submission, handling revisions and dealing with rejections, that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables was not significantly different between married and single lecturers.

Partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by sex.

Table 14 shows that the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript preparation is significantly different (δ = -.060, p < .05) between male (β = -.080) and female (β = -.019) lecturers, with the effect being stronger for stronger for male lecturers than female. Similarly, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript preparation significantly differed (δ = -.094, p < .05) between male (β = .007) and female (β = .101) lecturers, with the effect being notably stronger for female lecturers. In contrast, there is no significant difference between male and female lecturers, in terms of the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with remuneration, career advancement opportunities and research support on the relationship between social awareness-persistence in manuscript preparation.

Table 14 shows that the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript submission is significantly different (δ = .081, p < .05) between male (β = .063) and female (β = -.019) lecturers, with the effect being stronger for male lecturers. Similarly, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript submission, significantly differed (δ = -.084, p < .05) between male (β = -.011) and female (β = .073) lecturers, with the effect being stronger for female lecturers. Furthermore, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with

workload allocation on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript submission is significantly different (δ = -.042, $p < .05$) between male (β = .014) and female (β = .057) lecturers; the effect is stronger for female lecturers compared to male. In contrast, there is no significant sex-based difference in the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities and research support between male (β = .044) and female (β = .007) lecturers for the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript submission.

The results in Table 14 discloses that the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in handling revisions is significantly different (δ = .062, $p < .05$) between male (β = .066) and female (β = .005) lecturers, with the effect being stronger for males. In the same vein, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in handling revisions is significantly different (δ = -.074, $p < .05$) between male (β = .010) and female (β = .084) lecturers, with the effect being stronger for females. In the opposite, Table 14 shows that the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with remuneration, career advancement opportunities and research support on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in handling revisions does not significantly vary between male and female lecturers.

In another dimension, Table 14 reveals that the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in dealing with rejections is significantly different (δ = -.079, $p < .05$) between male (β = -.010) and female (β = .069) lecturers, with the effect being stronger for female lecturers. Also, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in dealing with rejections is significantly different (δ = -.146, $p < .05$) between male (β = -.065) and female (β = .081) lecturers, with the effect being stronger for females. On the contrary, the partial

mediation effects of job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, workload allocation and research support on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in dealing with rejections, does not differ with regards to lecturers' sex to a significant extent.

It was also revealed in Table 14 that there are no significant sex-based differences in the partial mediation effects of all the five job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support, respectively, on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in publication delays, between male and female lecturers. This suggest that the mediation effects of the outlined variables are consistent for male and female lecturers.

Partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by education level.

The partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript preparation is significantly different ($\delta = .058$, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree ($\beta = .084$) and those with a Ph.D. ($\beta = .027$). The partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript preparation is significantly different ($\delta = -.167$, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree ($\beta = -.152$) and those with a Ph.D. ($\beta = .015$), with a stronger and negative effect for master's degree holders and a weaker positive effect for doctoral degree holders. Similarly, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript preparation is significantly different ($\delta = .282$, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree ($\beta = .246$) and those with a Ph.D. ($\beta = -.036$), with the effect being positive and stronger for the former, but negative and weaker for the latter. On the contrary, Table 14

shows that the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration and research support on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript preparation relationship is not significantly different between lecturers with a master's degree and those with a Ph.D.

The partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript submission is significantly different ($\delta = .090$, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree ($\beta = .099$) and those with a Ph.D. ($\beta = .009$), with a stronger effect observed for lecturers with a master's degree. The partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript submission is significantly different ($\delta = .086$, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree ($\beta = .118$) and those with a Ph.D. ($\beta = .033$), with a stronger effect for master's degree holders. Similarly, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript submission is significantly different ($\delta = -.185$, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree ($\beta = -.159$) and those with a Ph.D. ($\beta = .026$), with a stronger effect for lecturers with a Ph.D. The partial mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript submission is significantly different ($\delta = .113$, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree ($\beta = .126$) and those with a Ph.D. ($\beta = .013$), with a stronger effect for master's degree holders. However, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with research support on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript submission is not significantly different between lecturers with a master's degree and those with a Ph.D.

Table 14 further shows that the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in handling revisions is significantly different ($\delta = -.055$, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's

degree (β = -.054) and those with a Ph.D. (β = .001), with a negative and stronger effect observed for lecturers with a master's degree. Similarly, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in handling is significantly different (δ = -.289, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree (β = -.257) and those with a Ph.D. (β = .032), with a negative and stronger effect for lecturers with a master's degree. The mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in handling revisions is significantly different (δ = .317, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree (β = .222) and those with a Ph.D. (β = -.095), with a stronger effect for master's degree holders. The mediation effect of satisfaction with research support on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in handling revisions is significantly different (δ = -.341, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree (β = -.058) and those with a Ph.D. (β = .283), with a notably stronger effect for Ph.D. holders. However, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in handling revisions is not significantly different between lecturers with a master's degree and those with a Ph.D.

Partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by marital status.

The partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in dealing with rejections is significantly different (δ = -.065, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree (β = -.043) and those with a Ph.D. (β = .022), with a stronger effect observed for lecturers with a master's degree. Similarly, the mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in dealing with rejections is significantly different (δ = -.143, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree (β = -.111) and those with a Ph.D. (β = .032), with a notably stronger effect for lecturers with a master's degree.

Moreso, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in dealing with rejections is significantly different (δ = .154, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree (β = .043) and those with a Ph.D. (β = -.111), with a stronger effect for master's degree holders. Besides, the partial mediation of satisfaction with research support on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in dealing with rejections is significantly different (δ = -.233, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's degree (β = -.031) and those with a Ph.D. (β = .201), with a notably stronger effect for Ph.D. holders. In contrast, the partial mediation of satisfaction with remuneration on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in dealing with rejections is not significantly different between lecturers with a master's degree and those with a Ph.D.

Furthermore, Table 14 reveals that the partial mediation of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in publication delays is significantly different (δ = -.150, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's (β = -.176) and Ph.D. (β = -.026), with a stronger effect for master's degree holders. Also, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in publication delays is significantly different (δ = .087, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's (β = .139) and Ph.D. (β = 0.052) degrees, with a stronger effect for master's degree holders. Moreover, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in publication delays is significantly different (δ = -.120, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's (β = -.138) and Ph.D. (β = -.018) degrees, with a stronger effect for the former. On the contrary, there is no significant difference between lecturers with master’s and doctoral degrees in the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with remuneration and research support, respectively, on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in publication delays.

TABLE 14

Joint and partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables in linking social awareness to persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed across some demographic profiles of lecturers.

	SEX				EDUCATION LEVEL				MARITAL STATUS			
Paths	Male	Female	δ	p	Master's	Ph.D.	δ	p	Single	Married	δ	p
SOA→PMP	-.029	.210	-.239*	.000	.105	.055	.050	.474	-.088	.080	-.167	.032
SOA→PMS	.146	.193	-.047	.405	.180	.077	.102	.069	.165	.115*	.049	.452
SOA→PHR	.089	.314	-.225*	.000	-.158	.129	-.287*	.001	.037	.141	-.104	.151
SOA→PDR	.061	.369	-.308*	.001	-.067	.176	-.244*	.002	.126	.158*	-.031	.709
SOA→PPD	.132	.236	-.104	.168	-.059	.078	-.137	.097	-.141	.205	-.346	.001
SOA→SWC→PMP	-.080	-.019	-.060*	.026	.084	.027	.058*	.036	.011	-.005	.016	.646
SOA→REM→PMP	.068	.027	.041	.188	-.025	.003	-.028	.365	-.120	.026	-.147*	.002
SOA→SWA→PMP	.007	.101	-.094*	.000	-.152	.015	-.167*	.000	-.003	.044	-.047	.102
SOA→CAO→PMP	-.030	.013	-.043	.502	.246	-.036	.282*	.000	-.030	.036	-.066	.357
SOA→SRS→PMP	.005	.089	-.084	.096	-.049	.045	-.095	.066	.055	-.022	.077	.185
SOA→SWC→PMS	.063	-.019	.081*	.000	.099	.009	.090*	.001	.063	.005	.058*	.034
SOA→REM→PMS	-.011	.073	-.084*	.016	.118	.033	.086*	.017	-.051	.079	-.130*	.004
SOA→SWA→PMS	.014	.057	-.042*	.028	-.159	.026	-.185*	.000	.004	.037	-.033	.144
SOA→CAO→PMS	.044	.007	.037	.478	.126	.013	.113*	.038	-.037	.075	-.112	.060
SOA→SRS→PMS	.036	.075	-.039	.450	-.005	-.003	-.002	.969	.186	-.080	.266*	.000
SOA→SWC→PHR	.066	.005	.062*	.003	-.054	.001	-.055*	.009	.017	.001	.017	.453
SOA→REM→PHR	-.037	.038	-.076	.110	-.011	-.092	.081	.127	-.060	-.066	.006	.919
SOA→SWA→PHR	.010	.084	-.074*	.005	-.257	.032	-.289*	.000	-.007	.057	-.064*	.034
SOA→CAO→PHR	-.067	-.036	-.032	.685	.222	-.095	.317*	.000	-.014	-.025	.010	.903
SOA→SRS→PHR	.117	.222	-.105	.118	-.058	.283	-.341*	.000	.101	.173	-.072	.338
SOA→SWC→PDR	-.016	.034	-.050	.109	-.043	.022	-.065	.050	-.009	.015	-.024	.470
SOA→REM→PDR	-.010	.069	-.079*	.028	.075	.033	.042	.274	-.006	.045	-.051	.225
SOA→SWA→PDR	.012	.044	-.032	.186	-.111	.032	-.143*	.000	-.004	.049	-.053	.055
SOA→CAO→PDR	-.065	.081	-.146*	.025	.043	-.111	.154*	.017	-.002	.017	-.019	.813
SOA→SRS→PDR	.139	.140	-.002	.984	-.031	.201	-.233*	.002	.147	.032	.115	.115
SOA→SWC→PPD	.005	.010	-.006	.812	-.176	-.026	-.150*	.000	.002	.015	-.013	.657
SOA→REM→PPD	.085	.086	-.001	.983	.075	-.013	.087	.073	-.222	.056	-.278*	.000
SOA→SWA→PPD	.020	.088	-.068	.075	.139	.052	.087*	.036	-.007	.078	-.084*	.048
SOA→CAO→PPD	.027	.028	-.001	.986	-.138	-.018	-.120*	.014	.013	.081	-.067	.255
SOA→SRS→PPD	-.005	.024	-.029	.563	.041	.083	-.042	.420	.071	-.025	.097	.101

*Significant difference at $p < .05$

Hypothesis 10

The effect of job satisfaction variables in jointly and partially mediating the relationship between internal motivation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, does not vary significantly with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status. The exogenous variable of this hypothesis is internal motivation, where the mediators are job satisfaction variables (satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support). The endogenous variable is persistence to publish across five dimensions: persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays. The moderating variables in this hypothesis are sex, education level and marital status. A Multigroup Analysis (MGA) was performed to test the hypothesis at .05 level of significance. The results of the analysis are presented in Table 15.

Joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by lecturers' sex

Table 15 shows, in the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in manuscript preparation, that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables is significantly different between males and females (δ = -.213, $p < .05$). This suggests that the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in manuscript preparation is moderated by gender, with a weaker mediation effect observed for males (β = -.010) compared to females (β = .203). For the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in manuscript submission, the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables is also significantly different between males and females (δ = -.203, $p < .05$), being weaker for males (β = .021) than for females (β = .224). Like the previous paths, there is a significant difference between male and female (δ = -.203, $p < .05$) lecturers, in the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in handling revisions. The effect is weaker for males (β = .023)

compared to females (β = .226). For the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in dealing with rejections, there is a significant sex difference in the mediation effect (δ = -.290, p < .05), with the effect being more pronounced for females (β = .366) than males (β = .076). For the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in publication delays, there is a significant sex-based difference in the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables (δ = -.169, p < .05), being weaker for male (β = .038) compared to female (β = .207) lecturers.

Joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by education level.

Table 15 shows that job satisfaction variables had a significant difference (δ = -.163, p < .05) in jointly mediating the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in manuscript submission for both master's and Ph.D. holders. The mediation effect is weaker for lecturers with a master's degree (β = -.058) compared to those with a Ph.D. (β = .105). In the context of job satisfaction variables mediating the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in handling revisions, the effect is stronger for Ph.D. holders (β = .214) compared to those with a master's degree (β = .001), and this difference is statistically significant (δ = -.212, p < .05). However, there is no significant difference in the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables in linking internal motivation to lecturers' persistence in manuscript preparation, dealing with rejections and publication delays, respectively.

Joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by marital status.

The joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in manuscript preparation is notably weaker for married lecturers (β = .072) compared to singles (β = -.253), and this difference is statistically significant (δ = -.325, p < .05). Similarly, job satisfaction variables jointly

mediated the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in manuscript submission for both single and married lecturers, but the mediation effect is significantly weaker for married (β = .114) compared to single (β = -.136) lecturers, with a significant difference (δ = -.251, $p < .05$). Furthermore, the joint mediation effect of job variables in the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in publication delays, differed significantly (δ = -.395, $p < .05$) with the marital status of lecturers, being negative and stronger for singles (β = -.223) compared to married lecturers (β = .171). In the relationships between internal motivation and persistence in handling revisions, as well as internal motivation and persistence in dealing with rejections, there are no significant differences in the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables between single and married lecturers.

Partial mediation of job satisfaction variables moderated by sex

Table 15 shows that the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions, satisfaction with remuneration, satisfaction with workload allocation and satisfaction with research support on the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in manuscript preparation is weaker for male than female lecturers, with significant differences in the effect ($p < .05$), respectively. Although satisfaction with career advancement opportunities has a stronger partial mediation effect for females in the internal motivation-persistence in manuscript preparation relationship, the difference from male lecturers is not statistically significant ($p > .05$). Table 15 shows that the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables such as satisfaction with remuneration, satisfaction with career advancement opportunities, and satisfaction with research support are stronger for female than male lecturers with significant differences. However, there are no significant differences between male and female lecturers in the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with work conditions and workload allocation on the relationship

between internal motivation and persistence in manuscript submission ($p > .05$). The results in Table 15 also indicated that the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with remuneration, workload allocation and research support on the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in handling revisions is weaker for male than female lecturers, with a significant difference ($p < .05$), respectively. However, the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with work conditions and satisfaction with career advancement opportunities in the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in handling revisions does not differ between male and female lecturers ($p > .05$).

Table 15 also reveals that the extent to which job satisfaction variables like satisfaction with work conditions, and remuneration partially mediated the connection between internal motivation and persistence in dealing with rejections is less pronounced in male lecturers compared to their female counterparts. This difference is statistically significant with p-values below .05, respectively. However, there are no discernible disparities in the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support, respectively, on the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in dealing with rejections for male and female lecturers. Furthermore, Table 15 reveals that only the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration on the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in publication delays is significantly different between male and female lecturers, with the effect being stronger for female lecturers. In contrast, all other job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and satisfaction with research support did not mediate the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in publication delays differently for male and female lecturers to a significant extent.

TABLE 15

Joint and partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables in linking internal motivation to persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed across some demographic profiles of lecturers.

	SEX				EDUCATION LEVEL				MARITAL STATUS			
Paths	Male	Female	δ	p	Master's	Ph.D.	δ	p	Single	Married	δ	p
INM→PMP	-.010	.203	-.213*	.000	.101	.005	.096	.111	-.253	.072	-.325*	.000
INM→PMS	.021	.224	-.203*	.002	-.058	.105	-.163*	.018	-.136	.114	-.251*	.003
INM→PHR	.023	.226	-.203*	.001	.001	.214	-.212*	.001	.010	.096	-.086	.272
INM→PDR	.076	.366	-.290*	.000	.184	.103	.082	.293	.187	.158	.029	.733
INM→PPD	.038	.207	-.169*	.008	.140	.179	-.039	.586	-.223	.171	-.395*	.000
INM→SWC→PMP	.010	-.073	.083*	.022	-.085	.010	-.095*	.026	.022	-.038	.060	.210
INM→REM→PMP	-.002	.037	-.039*	.000	.005	-.007	.012	.351	-.096	.005	-.101*	.000
INM→SWA→PMP	.035	.142	-.108*	.000	.069	.060	.009	.766	.078	.081	-.003	.928
INM→CAO→PMP	-.018	.037	-.056	.094	.165	-.015	.180*	.000	-.210	.021	-.231*	.000
INM→SRS→PMP	-.034	.060	-.094*	.000	-.052	-.043	-.009	.721	-.046	.002	-.048	.134
INM→SWC→PMS	-.038	-.065	.027	.541	-.016	-.006	-.010	.839	-.105	-.015	-.091	.065
INM→REM→PMS	-.001	.077	-.078*	.001	.006	-.007	.013	.543	-.035	.012	-.046	.075
INM→SWA→PMS	.084	.090	-.006	.857	.003	.040	-.037	.336	-.112	.058	-.170*	.000
INM→CAO→PMS	-.028	.046	-.073*	.033	.008	.067	-.059	.137	.002	.060	-.058	.194
INM→SRS→PMS	.003	.076	-.073*	.025	-.060	.010	-.070*	.040	.114	-.001	.115*	.004
INM→SWC→PHR	-.039	-.013	-.026	.546	-.144	-.005	-.138*	.004	-.018	-.016	-.001	.982
INM→REM→PHR	-.001	.037	-.038*	.002	.004	.007	-.003	.521	.007	-.002	.009	.235
INM→SWA→PHR	.032	.102	-.069*	.038	-.015	.092	-.107*	.006	.009	.072	-.063	.124
INM→CAO→PHR	.007	-.003	.010	.789	.192	.003	.189*	.000	-.028	.017	-.045	.281
INM→SRS→PHR	.024	.103	-.079*	.019	-.036	.117	-.153*	.000	.039	.026	.014	.745
INM→SWC→PDR	-.015	.081	-.095*	.014	.016	-.021	.037	.428	.053	.039	.014	.757
INM→REM→PDR	-.002	.065	-.066*	.000	.005	-.004	.009	.581	-.001	.009	-.009	.597
INM→SWA→PDR	.060	.085	-.025	.442	.026	.086	-.060	.092	.077	.071	.006	.871
INM→CAO→PDR	-.005	.051	-.056	.074	.111	-.015	.126*	.000	-.249	.029	-.278*	.000
INM→SRS→PDR	.037	.085	-.048	.246	.026	.056	-.031	.498	.307	.010	.296*	.000
INM→SWC→PPD	-.022	.013	-.035	.345	-.067	.003	-.070	.064	-.068	.040	-.108*	.016
INM→REM→PPD	-.003	.070	-.073*	.000	.007	-.002	.009	.656	-.201	.009	-.209*	.000
INM→SWA→PPD	.114	.148	-.034	.403	.098	.134	-.036	.391	.032	.111	-.078	.102
INM→CAO→PPD	-.031	-.012	-.018	.533	.089	-.005	.094*	.003	.159	.008	.151*	.000
INM→SRS→PPD	-.020	-.011	-.009	.654	.013	.048	-.035	.117	-.146	.004	-.150*	.000

*Significant difference at $p < .05$

Partial mediation of job satisfaction variables moderated by education level.

Table 15 shows that two job satisfaction variables – satisfaction with work conditions and career advancement opportunities, partially mediated the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in manuscript preparation differently for lecturers with master's and doctoral degrees, with a stronger effect for master's than Ph.D holders. However, the partial mediation effect of other job satisfaction variables such as satisfaction with remuneration, workload allocation and research support in the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in manuscript preparation is not significantly different between master's and doctorate degree holders. Table 15 shows, in the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in manuscript submission, that satisfaction with research support is the only job satisfaction variable that acted as a partial mediator, with a significant difference in effect between lecturers with master's and doctoral degrees. Specifically, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with research support is significantly stronger for lecturers with master's degrees than for lecturers with doctoral degrees. However, for other job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, and career advancement opportunities, there are no significant differences in the partial mediation effect between master's and doctoral degree holders.

Also, Table 15 shows that the only job satisfaction variable in the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in handling revisions that did not have a significant partial mediation effect was satisfaction with remuneration, meaning that its effect is the same for lecturers with both master's and doctoral degrees. However, other job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions and career advancement opportunities had a significantly stronger partial mediation effect on the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in handling revisions for lecturers with master's degrees than for lecturers with doctoral degrees. In contrast, the partial mediation

effects of satisfaction with workload allocation and research support were significantly stronger for lecturers with doctoral degrees than for lecturers with master's degrees.

Table 15 shows that satisfaction with career advancement opportunities has a stronger partial mediation effect on the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in dealing with rejections for lecturers with master's degrees than for lecturers with doctoral degrees. However, other job satisfaction variables (such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation and research support) do not have significantly different partial mediation effects on the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in dealing with rejections for the two groups. Table 15 shows that satisfaction with career advancement opportunities has a stronger partial mediation effect on the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in publication delays for lecturers with master's than for lecturers with doctoral degrees. However, other job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation and research support) do not have significantly different partial mediation effects on the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in publication delays for the two groups.

Partial mediation of job satisfaction variables moderated by marital status.

In the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in manuscript preparation, the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with remuneration and career advancement opportunities were significantly different between single and married lecturers, with a stronger effect on single than married lecturers. However, there is no significant difference between single and married lecturers in the partial mediation effect of job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, workload allocation and research support on the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in manuscript preparation. According to Table 15 only the partial mediation effect of

satisfaction with workload allocation is significantly different between single and married lecturers, being stronger for the former than the latter. In contrast, the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities and research support are not significantly different between single and married lecturers, in the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in manuscript submission. In the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in handling revisions, none of the job satisfaction variables had a partial mediation effect that is significantly different between single and married lecturers.

Table 15 showed, for the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in dealing with rejections, that the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities and research support significantly varies with the marital status of respondents, being stronger for single than married lecturers. However, there are no significant differences between single and married lecturers in the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables, such as: satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration and workload allocation. In contrast, Table 15 shows that the partial mediation effect of job satisfaction variables such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities and research support, vary significantly with the lecturers' marital status, being stronger for single than married respondents. Only the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation is not significant different between single and married lecturers.

Hypothesis 11

The role of job satisfaction variables in jointly and partially mediating the relationship between empathy and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, does not significantly vary with lecturers' sex, education level and marital status. The exogenous variable in this hypothesis empathy. The mediating variables in this hypothesis are job

satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support. The endogenous variable is persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals across five dimensions such as persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays. Three moderators - sex, education level and marital status were considered in this hypothesis. A Multigroup Analysis (MGA) analysis was performed to test the hypothesis at .05 level of significance. The results of the analysis are presented in Table 16.

Joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by sex

Table 16 shows that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables, satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support, in linking empathy to endogenous variables such as persistence in manuscript preparation, handling revisions, and dealing with rejections is significantly different for male and female lecturers. The joint mediation effect in these relationships is stronger for female than male lecturers. However, the joint mediation effect of the outlined job satisfaction variables in linking empathy to persistence in manuscript submission and persistence in publication delays is not significantly different between male and female lecturers.

Joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by education level.

Table 16 shows, in the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript preparation, that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables (satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support) is significantly different ($\delta = .110$, $p < .05$) between lecturers with a master's and PhD degrees. Even though the effect was positive on both groups, it was

stronger for master's degree holders (β = .212) than PhD holders (β = .102). Similarly, the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between empathy and persistence in publication delays relationship is also significantly different for master's and doctoral degree holders (δ = .175, p < .05), with the effect being positive for both groups, but stronger for master's β = .257) than PhD holders (β = .081). However, job satisfaction variables did not jointly serve as significant mediators in linking empathy to persistence in manuscript submission, handling revisions and dealing with rejections, respectively.

Joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by marital status

Table 16 shows a significant difference (δ = -.204, p < .05) between single and married lecturers regarding the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript submission. The effect is negative for both groups, but stronger for married (β = .158) than single (β = -.046) lecturers. Table 16 further shows that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between empathy and persistence in publication delays is negative for single lecturers (β = -.216), but positive (β = .126) for married lecturers, with a significant difference (δ = -.342, p< .05) in favour of the single lecturers.

Partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by sex

Table 16 shows that the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript preparation is significantly different between male and female lecturers (δ = -.092, p < .05), with the effect being positive and stronger for female (β = .102) than male (β = .010) lecturers. Table 16 also illustrates that the mediating effect of satisfaction with research support on the association between empathy and persistence in manuscript preparation varies

significantly between male and female lecturers ($\delta = -.183$, $p < .05$). The effect is positive and stronger for female lecturers ($\beta = .176$) but is negative and weaker for their male counterparts ($\beta = -.007$). However, there are no significant differences between male and female lecturers in the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration and career advancement opportunities on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript preparation.

Table 16 shows that there is a significant difference between male and female lecturers ($\delta = .114$, $p < .05$) in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript submission, with a stronger positive effect for males ($\beta = .069$) compared to females ($\beta = -.046$). Similarly, there is a significant difference between male and female ($\delta = -.045$, $p < .05$) in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript submission, with a stronger positive effect for females ($\beta = .062$) compared to males ($\beta = .017$). The partial mediation effect of satisfaction with research support on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript submission, shows a significant difference between males and females ($\delta = -.133$, $p < .05$), with a stronger positive effect for females ($\beta = .155$) compared to males ($\beta = .022$). However, the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with remuneration and career advancement opportunities on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript submission is not significantly different between male and female lecturers.

Table 16 shows that the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between empathy and persistence in handling revisions is significantly different ($\delta = .071$, $p < .05$) between male and female lecturers. The partial mediation effect is positive and stronger for males ($\beta = .054$), whereas it is weaker and negative for female lecturers ($\beta = -.017$). Similarly, there is a significant difference in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation between male and female

lecturers (δ = -.060, p < .05) in the relationship between empathy and persistence in handling revisions. Male lecturers (β = .011) exhibit a weaker positive partial mediation effect, while female lecturers (β = .071) show a stronger positive effect. Similarly, there is a significant difference in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration between male and female lecturers (δ = -.081, p < .05) in the relationship between empathy and persistence in handling revisions. There is a stronger negative partial mediation effect for male lecturers (β = -.053), while there is a weaker negative effect for female lecturers (β = .028). In contrast, there is no significant difference in the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities and research support between male and female lecturers in the relationship between empathy and persistence in handling revisions. In the relationship between empathy and persistence in dealing with rejections, as well as between empathy and persistence in publication delays, there are no significant differences between male and female lecturers in the partial mediation effects of all the job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support. This suggests that both groups experience a similar partial mediation effect of the mediators.

Partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by education level

Table 16 shows that the partial mediation of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript preparation is significantly different (δ = -.108, p < .05) between lecturers with master's (β = -.062) and PhD degrees (β = .047). Table 16 also reveals that the partial mediation of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript preparation significantly differed (δ = .094, p < .05) between lecturers with master's (β = .103) and PhD (β = .010) degrees. There is a significant difference (δ = .199, p < .05) in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the

relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript preparation, between lecturers with master's (β = .183) and PhD (β = -.016) degrees. Similarly, there is a significant difference (δ = -.105, p < .05) in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with research support on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript preparation, between lecturers with master's (β = -.046) and PhD (β = .058) degrees. However, satisfaction with remuneration has no significant difference in its partial mediation effect on the relationship empathy and persistence in manuscript preparation for lecturers with master's and PhD degrees.

Table 16 demonstrates that the partial mediation of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript submission significantly differed (δ = -.090, p < .05) between lecturers with master's (β = -.097) and PhD (β = -.007) degrees. Similarly, the partial mediation of satisfaction with research support on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript submission significantly differed (δ = .090, p < .05) between lecturers with master's and PhD degrees. The effect is stronger and positive for master's degree holders (β = .126) but weaker and positive for PhD holders (β = .036). In contrast, the partial mediation of satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration and workload allocation on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript submission is not significantly different between lecturers with master's and PhD degrees.

Table 16 reveals that the partial mediation of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between empathy and persistence in handling revisions significantly differed (δ = -.130, p < .05) between lecturers with master's (β = -.128) and PhD (β = .002) degrees. There is a significant difference (δ = .118, p < .05) in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration on the relationship between empathy and persistence in handling revisions, between lecturers with master's (β = .030) and PhD (β = -.088) degrees. For the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on

the relationship between empathy and persistence in handling revisions, there is a significant difference ($\delta = .322$, $p < .05$), between lecturers with master's ($\beta = .223$) and PhD ($\beta = -.099$) degrees. Table 16 also indicates that the partial mediation of satisfaction with research support on the relationship between empathy and persistence in handling revisions significantly differed ($\delta = -.340$, $p < .05$) between lecturers with master's ($\beta = -.025$) and PhD ($\beta = .315$) degrees. However, there is no significant difference in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between empathy and persistence in handling revisions for lecturers with master's and PhD degrees.

In Table 16, distinct patterns of partial mediation effects are apparent across various paths, contingent upon lecturers' education levels. Notably, in the there is a substantial disparity ($\delta = .171$, $p < .05$) between master's and PhD degree holders in the mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities on the relationship between empathy and persistence in dealing with rejections. The mediation effect is more pronounced and positive ($\beta = .073$) for master's degree holders, whereas for PhD holders it is weaker and negative ($\beta = -.097$). Similarly, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with research support on the relationship between empathy and persistence in dealing with rejections significantly varies with lecturers' education level ($\delta = -.192$, $p < .05$). In this instance, the effect is stronger and positive for Ph.D. holders ($\beta = .190$), in contrast to the weak negative effect for master's degree holders ($\beta = -.002$). However, the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration and workload allocation, respectively, on the relationship between empathy and persistence in dealing with rejections, did not significantly differ between lecturers with master's and doctoral degrees.

TABLE 16

Joint and partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables in linking empathy to persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed across some demographic profiles of lecturers.

Paths	SEX				EDUCATION LEVEL				MARITAL STATUS			
	Male	Female	δ	p	Master's	PhD	δ	p	Single	Married	δ	p
EMP→PMP	.060	.301	-.242*	.000	.212	.102	.110*	.046	-.015	.105	-.120	.066
EMP→PMS	.186	.274	-.088	.108	.094	.119	-.025	.690	-.046	.158	-.204*	.006
EMP→PHR	.070	.210	-.140*	.005	.137	.147	-.011	.807	.042	.031	.012	.817
EMP→PDR	.096	.332	-.235*	.000	.166	.159	.008	.900	.010	.127	-.117	.095
EMP→PPD	.165	.163	.002	.980	.257	.081	.175*	.019	-.216	.126	-.342*	.000
EMP→SWC→PMP	-.012	-.031	.019	.187	-.062	.047	-.108*	.000	-.042	.000	-.041	.053
EMP→REM→PMP	.052	.040	.011	.663	.034	.003	.031	.301	-.093	.044	-.137*	.001
EMP→SWA→PMP	.010	.102	-.092*	.000	.103	.010	.094*	.002	-.018	.021	-.040	.179
EMP→CAO→PMP	.017	.014	.003	.950	.183	-.016	.199*	.000	.042	.072	-.030	.529
EMP→SRS→PMP	-.007	.176	-.183*	.000	-.046	.058	-.105*	.032	.097	-.032	.128*	.039
EMP→SWC→PMS	.069	-.046	.114*	.000	-.031	.012	-.043	.077	-.150	-.006	-.144*	.000
EMP→REM→PMS	.020	.084	-.065	.096	.101	.057	.045	.290	-.048	.095	-.143*	.016
EMP→SWA→PMS	.017	.062	-.045*	.029	-.006	.021	-.027	.249	-.015	.019	-.034	.200
EMP→CAO→PMS	.059	.018	.041	.265	-.097	-.007	-.090*	.028	.020	.127	-.107*	.028
EMP→SRS→PMS	.022	.155	-.133*	.004	.126	.036	.090*	.049	.147	-.076	.223*	.001
EMP→SWC→PHR	.054	-.017	.071*	.000	-.128	.002	-.130*	.000	-.030	-.001	-.029	.137
EMP→REM→PHR	-.053	.028	-.081*	.038	.030	-.088	.118*	.008	-.018	-.074	.056	.239
EMP→SWA→PHR	.011	.071	-.060*	.007	.038	.018	.020	.370	-.018	.014	-.031	.196
EMP→CAO→PHR	-.011	.002	-.013	.764	.223	-.099	.322*	.000	.013	-.017	.030	.525
EMP→SRS→PHR	.069	.125	-.056	.305	-.025	.315	-.340*	.000	.095	.109	-.014	.834
EMP→SWC→PDR	.019	.047	-.028	.095	.023	.030	-.007	.682	-.040	-.009	-.031	.165
EMP→REM→PDR	-.009	.078	-.087*	.009	.032	.022	.010	.741	-.072	.050	-.122*	.007
EMP→SWA→PDR	.012	.048	-.036	.061	.039	.013	.026	.198	-.009	.019	-.028	.210
EMP→CAO→PDR	-.005	.015	-.020	.655	.073	-.097	.171*	.001	.004	.039	-.034	.476
EMP→SRS→PDR	.080	.144	-.063	.237	-.002	.190	-.192*	.002	.126	.028	.098	.137
EMP→SWC→PPD	.023	.017	.006	.773	-.083	-.038	-.045*	.044	-.014	-.009	-.005	.868
EMP→REM→PPD	.065	.082	-.017	.649	.074	-.015	.089*	.033	-.139	.053	-.192*	.000
EMP→SWA→PPD	.019	.079	-.061	.062	.121	.032	.089*	.014	.015	.028	-.013	.738
EMP→CAO→PPD	.072	.001	.071	.114	.095	-.013	.108*	.019	-.032	.068	-.100*	.038
EMP→SRS→PPD	-.013	-.016	.003	.940	.049	.115	-.066	.148	-.045	-.013	-.032	.535

*Significant difference at $p < .05$

Table 16 further shows, in the there is a significant discrepancy ($\delta = -.045$, $p < .05$) between master's ($\beta = -.083$) and PhD ($\beta = -.038$) degree holders in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with work conditions on the relationship between empathy and persistence in publication delays. Similarly, a significant difference emerged ($\delta = .089$, $p < .033$) between master's ($\beta = .074$) and PhD holders ($\beta = -.015$) in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration on the relationship between empathy and persistence in publication delays. Additionally, satisfaction with workload allocation significantly mediated the relationship between empathy and persistence in publication delays differently ($\delta = .089$, $p < .05$), for lecturers with master's ($\beta = .121$) and PhD ($\beta = .032$) degrees. Moreover, in the relationship between empathy and persistence in publication delays, there is a significant difference ($\delta = .108$, $p < .05$) in the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities between master's ($\beta = .095$) and PhD holders ($\beta = -.013$). However, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with research support on the relationship between empathy and persistence in publication delays does not vary significantly with the education level of lecturers.

Partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by marital status

In Table 16, the partial mediation effect of different job satisfaction variables were examined on the relationship between empathy and different dimensions of the endogenous variables, moderated by the marital status of lecturers. Firstly, in the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript preparation, a significant disparity emerged ($\delta = -.137$, $p < .05$) in the partial mediation of satisfaction with remuneration between single and married lecturers. The effect is negative and stronger for single lecturers ($\beta = -.093$) compared to a weaker positive effect among married lecturers ($\beta = .044$). Similarly, the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with research support on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript preparation is

significantly different between single and married lecturers ($\delta = .128$, $p < .05$), where the effect was stronger and positive for single lecturers ($\beta = .097$) while it is weaker and negative for married lecturers ($\beta = -.032$). In contrast, the partial mediation effect of job satisfaction variables such as satisfaction with work conditions, workload allocation and career advancement opportunities, respectively, on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript preparation does not vary with the marital status of lecturers to a significant extent.

Table 16 reveals that satisfaction with work conditions partially mediated the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript submission differently for single and married lecturers. For single, the effect is negative and stronger ($\beta = -.150$) than married lecturers ($\beta = -.006$), with a significant difference ($\delta = -.144$, $p < .05$). Table 16 illustrates that satisfaction with remuneration partially mediated the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript submission. The effect is negative and less pronounced for single lecturers ($\beta = -.048$) compared to their married counterparts ($\beta = .095$), with a statistically significant difference ($\delta = -.143$, $p < .056$). Moreover, satisfaction with career advancement opportunities served as another mediator in the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript submission. For single lecturers, the effect is positive ($\beta = .020$), while for married lecturers, it is notably stronger in a positive direction ($\beta = .127$), with the difference being statistically significant ($\delta = -.107$, $p < .05$). Satisfaction with research support as a mediator in the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript submission, had stronger mediation effect for single lecturers ($\beta = .147$), compared to married lecturers where the effect is weaker and negative ($\beta = -.076$), with a statistically significant difference ($\delta = .223$, $p < .05$). However, the partial mediation of satisfaction with workload allocation on the relationship between empathy and persistence in manuscript submission is not significantly different for single and married lecturers.

In linking empathy to persistence in handling revisions, the partial mediation effects of all the job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research support are not significantly different for single and married lecturers. Similarly, in the relationship between empathy and persistence in dealing with rejections, the partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables, like satisfaction with work conditions, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support are not significantly different for single and married lecturers. Conversely, only the partial mediation effect of satisfaction with remuneration is significantly different between single and married lecturers ($\delta = -.122$, $p < .05$), with the effect being negative and stronger for singles ($\beta = -.072$), whereas it is positive and comparably weaker for married ($\beta = .050$).

The results in Table 16 shows further that the partial mediation effects of satisfaction with career advancement opportunities and remuneration in the relationship between empathy and persistence in publication delays are significantly different for single and married lecturers ($\delta = -.100$, $p < .05$ and $\delta = -.192$, $p < .05$). In both instances, the mediation effects are positive for married lecturers, but negative for single lecturers. In contrast, the partial mediation effects of variables like satisfaction with work conditions, workload allocation and research support on the relationship between empathy and persistence in publication delays are not significantly different between single and married lecturers.

Hypothesis 12

The composite second-order mediation effect of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, does not significantly vary with their sex, education level and marital status. The exogenous variable in this hypothesis is emotional intelligence. The mediator is job

satisfaction, whereas the endogenous variable is persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. Three moderators – sex, education level and marital status, are considered in this study. The statistical technique employed is a second order Multigroup Analysis (MGA). The result of analysis is presented in Table 17.

The results in Table 17 shows that the mediation of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals does significantly differ between male and female lecturers. Similarly, the direct effect of emotional intelligence on lecturers' job satisfaction is not significantly different between male and female respondents. Moreover, the direct effect of emotional intelligence on lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals is not significantly differently between male and female lecturers. However, the direct effect of job satisfaction on lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals is significantly different for male and female lecturers (δ = -.387, $p < .05$), with a negative effect for males (β = -.153) and a positive effect for females (β = .234). In terms of the proportion of variance explained, there is no significant difference between male and female lecturers in the adjusted R^2 value in job satisfaction, explained by emotional intelligence. However, there is a significant difference in the adjusted R^2 value for lecturers' persistence to published (δ = -.218, $p < .05$). This implies that emotional intelligence and job satisfaction jointly explained 35.1% and 56.9% of the variance in lecturers' persistence to publish among male and females respectively.

Table 17 shows also that the mediation of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish does not differ significantly between lecturers with a master's degree and those with a PhD. The direct effect of emotional intelligence on job satisfaction is not significantly higher for lecturers with a PhD compared to those with a master's degree. Similarly, the direct effect of emotional intelligence on persistence to publish is not significantly different between

lecturers with a master's degree and those with a PhD. Moreso, the direct effect of job satisfaction on persistence to publish does not vary significantly with the education level of lecturers. Regarding the coefficient of determination, the adjusted R^2 value for job satisfaction explained by emotional intelligence is lower for lecturers with a master's degree compared to those with a PhD, with a significant difference ($\delta = -.121$, $p < .043$). Specifically, emotional intelligence explained 7.9% and 20% of the variance in lecturers' job satisfaction for male and female, respectively. The adjusted R^2 value for persistence to publish jointly explained by emotional intelligence and job satisfaction is not significantly different between lecturers with a master's degree and those with a PhD.

Table 17 further shows that the mediation of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish is not significantly different between single and married lecturers. The direct effect of emotional intelligence on job satisfaction is not significantly different between lecturers that are single and those that are married. Similarly, the direct effect of emotional intelligence on persistence to publish is not significantly different between single and married lecturers. The direct effect of job satisfaction on persistence to publish is similar for both marital status groups, with no significant difference between single and married lecturers. The adjusted R^2 value for job satisfaction explained by emotional intelligence is not significantly different between single and married lecturers. However, the adjusted R^2 value for persistence to publish explained by emotional intelligence and job satisfaction is significantly different between single and married lecturers ($\delta = -.204$, $p < .05$). This implies that emotional intelligence and job satisfaction jointly explain 27.5% of the variance in persistence to publish among single lecturers and 47.9% among married lecturers.

TABLE 17

Results of the second-order multigroup analysis of the mediation of job satisfaction on the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish

Moderators	Effect Type	Paths	Male	Female	δ	p
Sex	Mediation	EI→JS→PP	.048	.098	-.050	.087
	Direct effects	EI→JS	-.316	.420	-.736	.108
		EI→PP	.529	.628	-.100	.172
		JS→PP	-.153	.234	-.387*	.002
	Adjusted R^2	JS	.098	.173	-.075	.220
		PP	.351	.569	-.218*	.003
Education level	Effect Type	Paths	Master's	PhD	δ	p
	Mediation	EI→JS→PP	.051	.083	-.033	.316
	Direct effects	EI→JS	.289	.449	-.160	.231
		EI→PP	.488	.570	-.082	.308
		JS→PP	.175	.185	-.010	.920
	Adjusted R^2	JS	.079	.200	-.121*	.043
		PP	.311	.452	-.141	.076
Marital Status	Effect type	Paths	Single	Married	δ	p
	Mediation	EI→JS→PP	.031	.086	-.055	.092
	Direct effects	EI→JS	.373	.410	-.037	.751
		EI→PP	.497	.580	-.084	.339
		JS→PP	.083	.210	-.127	.292
	Adjusted R^2	JS	.133	.166	-.033	.623
		PP	.275	.479	-.204*	.014

*Significant difference at $p < .05$
Note: EI – Emotional intelligence; JS = Job satisfaction; PP = persistence to publish

4.3. Discussion of findings

4.3.1. Self-awareness, job satisfaction lecturers' persistence to publish.

The findings from the first hypothesis of this study reveal that job satisfaction variables (encompassing satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support) did not collectively mediate the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in manuscript preparation to a significant extent. However, they exhibited a significant positive mediating effect on the relationship between self-awareness and other dimensions of lecturers' persistence to publish, such as persistence in manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays, respectively. The absence of a significant mediating effect of job satisfaction on persistence in manuscript preparation suggests, lecturers' intrinsic motivations, such as their passion for their research and personal goals, might be more influential in initiating manuscript preparation. This may be so, because the process of conceptualising a research topic and developing a manuscript is primarily driven by the lecturer's own research interests and academic aspirations, before external factors like work conditions or remuneration become directly relevant. Therefore, factors related to job satisfaction may have limited influence during this phase. This result agrees with the findings of Stupnisky et al. (2019) that enjoyment and value as autonomous motivators, were positively associated with self-reported research productivity and the number of publications among university academics. Moreover, Ryan (2014) revealed that internal self-concept and motivation positively influenced research performance, while instrumental motivation had a negative impact.

Moreover, the present study discovered a more positive mediation effect of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between self-awareness and various dimensions of lecturers' persistence to publish, including manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays. This result suggests that as the publication

process advances, external factors related to job satisfaction become increasingly relevant. This is because lecturers may rely more on a supportive work environment, financial incentives, manageable workloads, opportunities for career growth and research support to maintain their motivation and resilience in the face of challenges commonly encountered in academic publishing. By implication, lecturers who are content with their work environment and institutional support may exhibit greater resilience and determination in overcoming these obstacles. Furthermore, lecturers who are satisfied with their jobs are more likely to maintain their patience and motivation when confronted with the often-protracted delays associated with academic publishing. Studies by Lee (2018) and Lu et al. (2020) highlight the significance of emotion regulation and emotional self-awareness in influencing job satisfaction. The findings of Biwott et al. (2019) also revealed a significant positive effect of self-awareness on knowledge-sharing behaviour among university academic staff.

The partial mediation effect in the first hypothesis of this study reveals that job satisfaction variables individually did not mediate the relationship between self-awareness and persistence in manuscript preparation to a significant extent. This finding suggests that lecturers' persistence in manuscript preparation is less influenced by lecturers' satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities and research. Thus, the job satisfaction variables outlined do not individually play a significant role in either strengthening or weakening the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to prepare manuscripts for Scopus-indexed journals. This result is explainable because self-awareness refers to individuals' understanding of their strengths, weaknesses, and goals. This may not directly interact with external job satisfaction variables to exert an influence on persistence in manuscript preparation. Thus, during manuscript preparation, personal qualities and goals may play a more dominant role than factors related to job satisfaction. Therefore, interventions to enhance persistence

during should focus on individual development, goal-setting, and mentorship, rather than solely relying on improving work conditions or compensation. This finding strengthens the results documented by Kumar and Israel (2013) that self-motivation, extrinsic rewards (such as research grants and job security), and peer pressure are important drivers of research productivity among university faculty members. Nevertheless, the result of the present study disagrees with the results of Awan (2022) that workload mediated the relationship between leadership support and research motivation among scholars.

The present study further discovered that only satisfaction with work conditions significantly mediated the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in manuscript submission. The significance of satisfaction with work conditions in mediating the relationship between self-awareness and manuscript submission suggests that a supportive and comfortable work environment is a strong motivator for lecturers submitting their research works to Scopus-indexed journals. It aligns with the idea that content and motivated lecturers are more likely to initiate the publishing process when they feel comfortable in their work surroundings. The implication of this finding is that academic institutions should prioritise creating a conducive work atmosphere that promotes lecturers' satisfaction with their working conditions, such as well-equipped offices, collaborative spaces, and a supportive culture. This finding strengthens the two-factor theory (Hertzberg, 1968), maintaining that hygiene factors that are related to the work environment can promote job satisfaction for improved service delivery. Therefore, lecturers' persistence in manuscript submission is indirectly tied to lecturers' self-awareness and satisfaction with conditions.

This study also revealed that other job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with career advancement opportunities, remuneration, workload allocation, and research support, did not have a significant mediating effect in the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence in manuscript submission. The lack of significant

mediating effects can be attributed to a myriad of factors. It is plausible that self-awareness plays an overwhelmingly influential role in the three-way relationship such that the effects of job satisfaction variables are not observed. It could be because self-awareness directly affects how lecturers work, and the other job satisfaction factors might not be as closely related to manuscript submission. Therefore, intrinsic factors (such as lecturers' personal drives, publication goals, career aspirations etc), research related variables (such as research mentorship, collaboration opportunities, grants funding, journal characteristics), and work conditions may be more important in promoting lecturers' persistence to submit manuscript. This aligns with the results of Lambovska and Yordanov (2020) which identified both extrinsic factors (such as: collaboration opportunities, financial rewards, and promotion prospects) and intrinsic motivations (such as contributing to society and personal development) as factors driving researchers to publish in Scopus and WoS journals. The result, however, disagrees with the results of Nguyen (2015) whose study showed that factors, such as heavy teaching loads, low salaries, inadequate resources, and dissatisfaction with research policies were hindrances to research motivation among university lecturers.

In terms of handling revisions, none of the job satisfaction variables partially mediated the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, to a significant extent. An explanation for this finding is that handling revisions is often a challenging and rigorous process during academic publishing. This finding suggests that neither internal factors related to self-awareness nor external job satisfaction variables are strong influencers at this stage. Thus, persistence in handling revisions could be influenced by other factors, such as research quality or personal resilience, which were not considered in this study. The study of Jeanson and Michinov (2018) found that social identification, including workgroup identification, professional identification, and organizational identification, significantly contributed to researchers'

job satisfaction in a research institute. This implies that persistence in handling revisions is an area where lecturers might benefit from targeted support, guidance, and training. Therefore, universities should consider offering resources and mentorship specifically designed to help lecturers persist in handling revisions.

Similarly, in dealing with rejections, job satisfaction variables (such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, and career advancement opportunities) did not have significant partial mediation effects. However, only satisfaction with research support significantly mediated the relationship. This finding is attributable to the substantial emotional resilience and research support needed to deal with deal with rejections, which is in line with the mediating effect of satisfaction with research support. The non-significant partial mediating effect of other job satisfaction variables suggests that factors like remuneration, workload, and career advancement opportunities may not directly impact the lecturers' ability to handle rejections. Thus, institutions should emphasize the provision of research support, including guidance on improving research quality and navigating the peer-review process. This can be a critical factor in helping lecturers persist in the face of rejection. This result corroborates the findings of Fuentes (2021) that a conducive research atmosphere, encompassing factors such as: funding support, publication incentives, technical support services, a manageable workload, research opportunities, peer influence, and a positive attitude toward publication, contributed to high publication performance among university lecturers.

For publication delays, job satisfaction variables (such as satisfaction with work conditions, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support) did not significantly mediate the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. Only satisfaction with remuneration exhibited a significant mediation effect. The mediating effect of remuneration in this relationship implies that financial satisfaction may serve as a motivator when confronted

with delays. Lecturers may be more willing to persevere through waiting periods when they are satisfied with their compensation. Thus, to address persistence during publication delays, institutions should ensure that remuneration packages are competitive and aligned with lecturers' contributions, thus motivating them to remain committed to the publication process. This result is in line with the findings of Nguyen et al. (2016) that institutional factors, including financial support, teaching load, research collaboration, and research policy settings and practices, hindered research engagement and productivity, despite the respondents' acknowledgement of research's significance.

4.3.2. Self-regulation, job satisfaction and lecturers' persistence to publish.

The joint mediation results from the second hypothesis of this study reveal a notable difference in the role of job satisfaction variables when mediating the relationship between self-regulation and persistence to publish in different across different dimensions. In terms of manuscript preparation, job satisfaction variables had a non-statistically significant joint effect in mediating the relationship between self-regulation and persistence to publish. This implies that while there is a positive association between job satisfaction and self-regulation, this association is not strong enough to reach statistical significance. One plausible explanation for this result is that manuscript preparation, is often the initial and often solitary phase of the publication process. This phase may be predominantly driven by the individual's intrinsic motivation, research ability and self-regulation. Therefore, external factors like job satisfaction may have a less direct impact during this phase. This aligns with the study of Nguyen et al. (2021) which found a strong interrelationship between lecturers' research ability and motivation for research publications.

The current study discovered that job satisfaction variables have a notably positive and statistically significant joint effect in mediating the relationship between self-

regulation and other aspects of lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, such as persistence in manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays. The reason behind job satisfaction playing a significant mediating role in all these aspects can be attributed to the complex and often challenging nature of publishing in prestigious journals like those indexed in Scopus. In these phases, job satisfaction variables may play a more prominent role in supporting lecturers' motivation and resilience. For instance, lecturers with a high sense of self-regulation and job satisfaction could be excited to endure various challenges in the process of publication due to their happiness and excitement. In cases where remuneration is provided for publication excellence, many lecturers, including those with low self-regulation, may decide to persist to publish to attract the reward that comes with a successful publication. The result agrees with the findings of Kumar and Israel (2013) who identified self-motivation, extrinsic rewards (such as research grants and job security), and peer pressure as important drivers of research productivity among university faculty members. The result also agrees with the findings of Kalra et al. (2022) that variables like performance-based research funding, promotion systems, publication pressure, scientific research capabilities, and government policies are important factors contributing to the rapid increase in publishing.

There are several implications of this findings. For manuscript preparation, the lack of a statistically significant mediating effect of job satisfaction variables suggests that at this early stage, academic institutions should focus on fostering intrinsic motivation, self-regulation, and personal goal-setting among lecturers. While job satisfaction is important, it might have a limited role in motivating lecturers during manuscript preparation. Therefore, support programmes, mentorship, and resources that aim to enhance these intrinsic factors should be prioritized. For the subsequent stages of publication in Scopus-indexed journals, where job satisfaction variables are significant mediators, institutions should focus on creating a positive work environment with competitive remuneration,

supportive work conditions, manageable workloads, opportunities for career advancement, and robust research support. These factors play a pivotal role in sustaining faculty motivation and resilience when navigating the more complex and demanding aspects of academic publishing. Implementing mentorship and resources for handling revisions, rejections, and delays can further bolster lecturers' persistence and success in prestigious journals.

The partial mediation effects of job satisfaction variables on the self-regulation lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, are also documented for all the dimensions of the endogenous variable. For manuscript preparation, job satisfaction variables such as work conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities, and research support did not have statistically significant partial mediation effects in the relationship between self-regulation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. However, workload allocation was a significant partial mediator. An explanation for this finding is that lecturers' engagement in manuscript preparation may be driven by intrinsic motivation and self-regulation. Lecturers embark on this phase primarily due to their research interests and goals. Self-regulation, involving personal objective setting, time management, and maintaining focus, could play a critical role. It is plausible that the intrinsic motivation derived from self-regulation is a dominant factor in this phase, overshadowing the impact of the outlined job satisfaction variables. One major surprise is that satisfaction with research support did not significantly mediate the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in manuscript preparation. A reason for this might be that lecturers are not receiving adequate research support to pursue research engagements in this study's context. Besides, satisfaction with research support could be considered a fundamental requirement rather than a motivating factor since the university owes its staff the responsibility of provide research support. Thus, faculty members may view research support as an expected component of their academic roles, rather than a

distinct motivator for manuscript preparation. This could explain why it did not significantly mediate the relationship between self-regulation and manuscript preparation. This result aligns with the Hertzberg's two-factor theory, which specifies that motivators and hygiene factors contributes to workers' job satisfaction (Hertzberg, 1968). In this sense, satisfaction with research support may be considered a hygiene factor that should be provided be the university. Where it is not obtainable, its effect on job satisfaction and consequently, persistence to publish may be minimised. The finding of the present study implies that providing opportunities for self-driven research agenda can boost lecturers' intrinsic motivation, potentially resulting in higher levels of persistence.

Nevertheless, satisfaction with workload allocation may have been a significant partial mediator due to its direct relevance to the task of manuscript preparation. A reasonable allocation of time and responsibilities is essential for effectively managing research projects. When lecturers perceive an appropriate allocation of work, it may facilitate their manuscript preparation process, ultimately leading to higher levels of persistence. The finding is consistent with the study conducted by Nguyen (2015) which identified factors such as heavy teaching loads, low salaries, inadequate resources, and dissatisfaction with research policies as hindrances to research motivation among university lecturers. The findings of the present highlight the importance of maintaining a balanced workload for lecturers, particularly during research-intensive periods. Equitable distribution of tasks should be a priority for academic institutions, as it can significantly support lecturers' persistence in manuscript preparation.

In terms of persistence in manuscript submission, only satisfaction with research support was a significant partial mediator between self-regulation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journal publication. Other job satisfaction variables, including work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, and career advancement opportunities, did not significantly mediate this relationship. This finding may have been

so because manuscript submission is a critical phase in the academic publication process, marked by its meticulous requirements and high standards. It requires carefully selecting the right journals, following editorial guidelines, formatting research papers according to editorial styles and templates, writing cover letters and filling out several forms. Sometimes, it requires sourcing for external scholars who are not recent collaborators to suggest for the peer-reviewing of the articles to be submitted. Thus, it is not surprising that satisfaction with research support and self-regulation are important factors. Individuals need to regulate their emotions to follow these processes meticulously. Research support includes access to resources, assistance with data analysis, and guidance on manuscript preparation. Faculty members may perceive research support as a vital enabler, providing them with the essential tools and expertise needed for the successful submission of high-quality manuscripts. Thus, the significant mediation effect of research support in this phase aligns with its immediate relevance to the submission process. This aligns with the findings of several related studies in the literature. For instance, Owan et al. (2023) that mentorship accompanied with a positive institutional culture and collaborative networks enhanced the research productivity of academic staff in universities. Similarly, Truong et al. (2021) found that leadership, policies, resources, and support for scientific research significantly predicted research outputs among scholars.

On the other hand, the limited mediation effects of other job satisfaction variables on the relationship between self-regulation and manuscript submission implies that lecturers with a high or low self-regulation will persist or otherwise to submit their manuscripts to Scopus-indexed journals regardless of the work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation and career advancement situations in their institutions. While these factors are pivotal components of overall job satisfaction and lecturers' well-being, their direct impact on manuscript submission may be less pronounced in lecturers' manuscript submission. The reason for this finding is that the level of lecturers' satisfaction with

different aspects of their work might be low. Besides the result implies that inherent factors and personal drives of the lecturers may be more important factors. This aligns also with the literature review by Lambovska and Yordanov (2020) which identified drivers of lecturers' motivation to publish in Scopus and WoS journals to be both extrinsic (such as collaboration opportunities, financial rewards, and promotion prospects), and intrinsic (such as contributing to society and personal development). Similarly, a qualitative study by Lu (2022) found that extrinsic motivators, particularly the desire to meet university assessment requirements, played a significant role in publishing in international journals among university academics.

In terms of handling revisions, workload allocation and research support were the only significant partial mediators in the relationship between self-regulation and persistence to publish. The implication of this result is that the distribution of tasks and responsibilities among lecturers directly affects their ability to persist in addressing revisions. When lecturers perceive that their workload is reasonably allocated and manageable, they are more likely to persist through the challenging task of revising a manuscript based on reviewer feedback. This means that lecturers with a high or low sense of self-regulation can rely on the reasonable allocation of tasks to help them stay on track and persist through the revision process. Furthermore, having access to resources, guidance, and assistance, which is part of research support, can significantly aid a lecturer to persist in handling revisions, even if their self-regulation is not particularly strong. This support can provide them with the tools and expert advice they need to tackle revisions effectively. This result is consistent with the finding of Fikri and Juariyah (2020) that there is a negative effect of workload on job satisfaction among university lecturers. Similarly, Rahman and Ali (2020) revealed the detrimental effect of work-family conflict on job satisfaction among academicians in private universities.

The present study, found, however, that other job satisfaction variables, such as work conditions, remuneration, and career advancement opportunities, did not exhibit statistically significant partial mediation effects in the relationship between self-regulation and persistence in handling revisions. These results suggest that self-regulation, which is a lecturer's internal motivation and persistence, may be less affected by the external factors of work conditions, pay, and career advancement during the specific task of handling revisions. It does not mean that these external factors are unimportant; they contribute to overall job satisfaction and well-being, but they may not have a direct impact on how well a lecturer can use their self-regulation to stay on track during the revision process. Hence, even in instances where a lecturer may express a high degree of satisfaction with their workplace environment or receives an augmentation in remuneration, these external factors do not necessarily make the process of handling revisions easier. Instead, the lecturers' capacity to self-regulate and stay motivated when handling revision appears to be less contingent on these aspects of the job satisfaction. This finding corroborates the expectancy-value theory (Fishbein & Ajzen, 1975), which posits that individuals are more likely to engage in a behaviour if they believe it will lead to desirable outcomes and have a high expectation of success (Nagle, 2021). Therefore, the effectiveness of self-regulation during the revision phase is mainly influenced by internal motivation and the practical support provided to lecturers during this facet of their publication responsibilities.

In the dimension of dealing with rejections, only satisfaction with research support had a significant partial mediation effect on the relationship between self-regulation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. This implies that when lecturers face the challenge of dealing with rejection of their work for publication, their satisfaction with the support they receive for their research plays a big role in helping them persist, regardless of their degree self-regulation. Thus, even lecturers with weaker self-regulation (that find it challenging to stay motivated and focused on their work) can persist in dealing

with rejections (that are usually heartbreaking) and continue pushing to get their work publish if they receive adequate research support. The reason is that for individuals with weak self-regulation, staying motivated when facing rejection can be particularly tough. This is where the significance of strong research support becomes even clearer. It acts as a sort of external motivation, providing these researchers with the necessary tools, guidance, and resources to handle rejection effectively. Similarly, lecturers with a strong self-regulation may be inherently more resilient and persistent, making them better equipped to handle rejection. In their case, satisfaction with research support serves as an extra boost and a valuable supplementary resource, enhancing their ability to address rejection efficiently. These findings highlight how crucial it is for researchers to have the right kind of research support, especially when they face rejection. Institutions and organizations that provide this kind of support can help their researchers stay motivated and keep going, even when things do not go as planned. This finding tallies with the evidence reported in previous research that research support, such as mentorship, institutional support and collaboration are decisive of lecturers' research productivity in both short and long-term (Owan et al., 2023; Santos et al., 2022).

It was further discovered, in the present study, that other job satisfaction variables, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, and career advancement opportunities, did not significantly mediate this relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. This finding may be justified by several factors. Firstly, self-regulation is a personal trait that involves the ability to control one's thoughts, emotions, and behaviours to achieve a desired goal. Therefore, lecturers who possess high levels of self-regulation may be more motivated and disciplined to persist in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals, regardless of their satisfaction with these aspects of their jobs. This is supported by previous research that has found a positive relationship between self-regulation and outcomes, such as job

effectiveness (Kanwal et al., 2018; Martin & Gracious, 2018) and employee work behaviours (Joe-Akunne et al., 2015). Secondly, publishing in Scopus-indexed journals is a highly competitive and prestigious activity that requires a high level of expertise, knowledge, and skills. Lecturers who are passionate about their research and committed to advancing their field may be more likely to persist in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals, even if they are not fully satisfied with other job aspects. This is supported by previous research that has found a positive relationship between intrinsic motivation and academic research productivity (Horodnic & Zait, 2015).

For publication delays, satisfaction with work conditions and workload allocation showed significant partial mediation effects in the relationship between self-regulation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. This result implies that how satisfied lecturers are with the work conditions and workload allocated to them can influence how they can persist to publish in Scopus-indexed journals when there is a publication delay, irrespective of whether they possess low or high levels of self-regulation. The reason for this finding is that publication delays are a common challenge that lecturers face when publishing in Scopus-indexed journals. These delays can be caused by various factors such as reviewer feedback, revisions, and resubmissions. Lecturers who are satisfied with their work conditions and workload allocation may be better equipped to manage these delays and persist in publishing in Scopus-indexed journals. For example, a comfortable workspace can reduce stress and increase productivity, while efficient workload management can help lecturers prioritize their tasks and meet deadlines. Secondly, lecturers who possess high levels of self-regulation may be more resilient and persistent in the face of publication delays. However, even for these lecturers, external factors such as work conditions and workload allocation can enhance their motivation and support their persistence. This is supported by previous research that has found a positive relationship between institutional values and publication decisions of academic staff (Getahun, 2021).

Thirdly, for lecturers with low self-regulation, satisfaction with work conditions and workload allocation becomes even more critical. These lecturers may struggle with self-discipline and motivation and may rely on external factors to compensate for their internal struggle. Therefore, a supportive work environment can help these lecturers navigate and persist through publication delays.

The result of the present study showed that satisfaction with remuneration, career advancement opportunities, and research support did not significantly mediate the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence in publication delays. This result is not a surprise because the delays in the publication process in Scopus-indexed journals can be influenced by various factors, such as the quality of the research, the fit with the journal's scope, and the availability of reviewers. These factors may not be directly related to lecturers' satisfaction with remuneration, career advancement opportunities, and research support, leading to the lack of significant mediation effects. Furthermore, self-regulation, which involves the ability to set goals and manage one's behaviour to achieve those goals, may play a more significant role in lecturers' persistence than job satisfaction variables. Thus, lecturers with high levels of self-regulation may be more resilient and persistent in the face of publication delays, regardless of their satisfaction with remuneration, career advancement opportunities, and research support. On the other hand, lecturers with low levels of self-regulation may struggle to persist in publishing, even if they are satisfied with these job satisfaction variables. This result disagrees with the findings of some studies, such as Indarti et al. (2017) and Goswami (2022), that there is a significant direct effect of job satisfaction on staff job performance. The differences in the results of the cited and present study is attributed to the variations in the variables under focus and contextual, as well as, methodological differences.

4.3.3. Social awareness, job satisfaction and lecturers' persistence to publish

This study established that job satisfaction variables (including satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support), jointly had insignificant mediation effect on the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript preparation. In other words, these job satisfaction variables did not significantly influence the relationship between social awareness and persistence in manuscript preparation. This finding is explainable because job satisfaction among academic staff has been found to be related to various factors, including work environment, pay and benefits, and top management leadership (Alanoğlu & Demirtaş, 2021; Ateş & Ünal, 2021; Subarto et al., 2021; Yıldız & Şimşek, 2016). On the other hand, academic persistence is influenced by factors such as autonomous motivation, the quality of experiences in the academic and social systems, social support, and self-efficacy (Heuritsch, 2023; Stupnisky et al., 2023). In the specific context of the present research, it is possible that social awareness plays a more direct and significant role in persistence in manuscript preparation than job satisfaction variables, since many lecturers appear dissatisfied with their jobs. Social awareness may involve a sense of responsibility towards the academic community and a desire to contribute to the advancement of knowledge through research. This sense of responsibility and motivation may be more influential in driving persistence in manuscript preparation than job satisfaction variables. Besides, manuscript preparation is an early stage in the publication process, where the importance of job satisfaction variables might be overshadowed by other factors like research content, clarity of purpose, or research skills.

The present study also found that job satisfaction variables jointly had a significant positive mediation effect on the relationship between social awareness and persistence to publish across dimensions, such as manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays. This result implies that for lecturers with high

social awareness, job satisfaction factors play a crucial role in bolstering their persistence throughout the academic publishing process, making them more adept at collaboration and maintaining a strong sense of motivation and alignment with academic standards. On the other hand, lecturers with lower social awareness may not naturally engage with the academic community in the same way as their socially aware counterparts. In their case, job satisfaction can act as a catalyst for persistence and success, providing them with essential resources, learning opportunities, and enhanced confidence. Moreover, these results highlight that collaboration, a strength among those with high social awareness, becomes even more pronounced when complemented by job satisfaction. Satisfied, socially aware lecturers are not only aware of the importance of collaboration but are also better equipped to navigate it, benefiting both their work and the academic community. The findings of this study agree with the results of other studies that have documented a significant positive relationship between social skills and job satisfaction among secondary school teachers (Mohamad & Jais, 2016), bank workers (Mohammad et al., 2018) and academic staff (Tabiat, 2022). Moreover, Lu et al. (2020) observed that the impact of emotional self-awareness on job satisfaction was significant.

The results of the partial mediation effects of the third hypothesis of the present study discovered that satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities and research support, did not significantly mediate the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission and publication delays. Only satisfaction with workload allocation showed a significant partial mediation effect. This finding supports the results of some studies. Hassanzadeh and Babaei Kafaki (2014) revealed that while social awareness showed no significant positive relationship with overall job motivation, it had a notable positive association with specific aspects of motivation such as workload, effort, and willingness to volunteer. Hanzaee and Mirvaisi (2013) found an intriguing inverse relationship

between social awareness and organisational citizenship behaviour (OCB) and job satisfaction in Iran's hospitality industry. In terms of handling revisions and dealing with rejections, the current study showed satisfaction with workload allocation and research support exhibited statistically significant partial mediation effects in the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. Conversely, satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, and career advancement opportunities did not significantly mediate these relationships. These findings suggest that when it comes to specific phases of academic publishing where revisions and rejections are common challenges, lecturers' satisfaction with workload allocation and research support is crucial for enhancing their persistence. However, lecturers' social awareness, whether high or low, seems to have a more direct impact on their persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, and dealing with publication delays. This understanding has practical implications for institutions seeking to support lecturers effectively in their publishing endeavours, emphasizing the importance of tailored support in workload allocation and research support, especially during the more challenging phases of the publication process.

4.3.4. Internal motivation, job satisfaction and lecturers’ persistence to publish

This study discovered through the fourth hypothesis that job satisfaction variables had a significant joint mediation effect on the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals across almost all the dimensions, except for persistence in manuscript preparation. In other words, job satisfaction factors like satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support collectively mediated the relationship between internal and lecturers' persistence to publish across various stages of the publication process, such as manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with

rejections, and publication delays. This finding implies that lecturers with strong internal drive are more inclined to persist in their publishing efforts. However, it is essential to recognize that internal motivation does not operate in isolation; it interacts with job satisfaction variables, which mediate the relationship between internal motivation and persistence across various publishing dimensions. The results suggest that a combination of internal motivation and job satisfaction collectively influences lecturers' determination to publication. Therefore, job satisfaction acts as a catalyst, enhancing the impact of internal motivation. When individuals experience job satisfaction through factors like conducive work conditions, fair compensation, reasonable workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support, it reinforces their intrinsic motivation. This reinforcement occurs as job satisfaction minimizes distractions, reduces stressors, and builds resilience. Moreover, the positive feedback loop between job satisfaction and internal motivation fosters continued productivity and success. The finding of this study corroborates other studies (such as Mohamad and Jais, 2016; Mohammad et al., 2018; Tabiat, 2022), which have documented that the relationship between internal motivation and job satisfaction is positive and statistically significant.

The present study found that specific aspects of job satisfaction matter differently depending on the dimension of lecturers' publication persistence. The study found that satisfaction with workload allocation played a significant role in linking internal motivation to lecturers’ persistence in manuscript preparation and dealing with publication delays. On the other hand, factors like satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities, and research support did not have a significant mediating effect on the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish. The reason for this finding is that workload allocation is a crucial factor that directly affects the time and effort required for manuscript preparation, submission, and publication. Therefore, satisfaction with workload allocation may have a more direct and

significant impact on lecturers' persistence in these tasks compared to other job satisfaction factors. If lecturers feel their workload is well-balanced, they are more likely to persist in publishing. Secondly, the nature of the job of academic staff is complex and multifaceted, involving various tasks, such as teaching, research, and administration, which require different skills and competencies. Therefore, the factors that influence job satisfaction may vary depending on the specific task or dimension of the job. For example, satisfaction with work conditions may be more relevant to teaching, while satisfaction with workload allocation may be more relevant to research. This finding agrees with a long list of studies that found a significant association between internal motivation and different aspects of job performance (Marino et al., 2019; Ringelhan et al., 2013; Vijitharan et al., 2019).

Nevertheless, the present study discovered that for manuscript submission, the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals is positively influenced by both manageable workload and career advancement opportunities. However, other job satisfaction elements, such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, and research support, did not individually mediate the relationship to a significant extent. This finding can be explained by the inherent passion among academics and the desire to contribute to their field, as well as the importance of being able to dedicate sufficient time to research alongside teaching responsibilities and the tangible incentives of career advancement. This result suggests that factors such as work conditions, remuneration, and research support do not significantly impact lecturers' intrinsic motivation to publish, as internal motivation is primarily driven by personal and intrinsic factors, while other job satisfaction elements are more extrinsically oriented and do not substantially affect the innate motivation for research and publication. Furthermore, the academic environment places a premium on research output, making manageable workloads and career advancement opportunities particularly influential in the context of academic publishing, where lecturers are often

juggling multiple responsibilities. This finding disagrees with the findings of Shah et al. (2018) that self-motivation did not significantly impact job effectiveness among private university teachers.

Additionally, the present study discovered that satisfaction with work conditions, workload, and research support had significant individual mediation effects on the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence in handling revisions during the publication process, while remuneration and career advancement opportunities do not significantly come into play. One possible reason for this finding could be that the revision phase of the publication process requires a supportive work environment and resources, as lecturers often need access to research materials, collaboration, and an accommodating workload to effectively address reviewers' comments and make necessary improvements to their manuscripts. In this context, internal motivation alone may not suffice, and lecturers may rely more heavily on external factors like conducive work conditions and research support to navigate the intricacies of manuscript revisions. Remuneration and career advancement opportunities may have a less direct influence during this phase, as they might be perceived as less immediate motivators compared to the practical and tangible support provided by the work environment and research resources. This result tallies with the evidence earlier provided by Branscum et al. (2016) that self-motivation and managing relationships were significant predictors of receiving awards for outstanding performance. Moreover, the study of Joe-Akunne et al. (2015) found a significant prediction of self-motivation and counterproductive work behaviours.

Furthermore, concerning the relationship between internal motivation and persistence in dealing with rejections, the present study discovered that satisfaction with workload allocation and research support emerged as statistically significant partial mediators. This means that when lecturers use their internal motivation to persist following rejections, their satisfaction with how their workload is distributed and the support they

receive for their research plays a pivotal role in facilitating this persistence. In contrast, factors such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, and career advancement opportunities did not exhibit significant partial mediating effects in the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' ability to persist through rejection. This could be explained by the notion that the challenges associated with rejections often require immediate practical support and the ability to manage one's research workload effectively, making these factors more influential in this specific aspect of the publishing process, while long-term career prospects and financial incentives may have a less direct impact. This suggests that factors related to the work environment and research support play a role in facilitating persistence, which aligns more with Herzberg's concept of motivators (Hertzberg, 1968).

In the current study, it was found that satisfaction with workload allocation was the only job satisfaction factor with a significant partial mediation effect on the relationship between lecturers' internal motivation and their persistence to publish in the context of publication delays. In contrast, factors such as satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities, and research support did not exhibit significant mediating effects in the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in terms of dealing with publication delays. This result is not surprising because dealing with delays often involves practical aspects such as effective time management, prioritisation of tasks, and the ability to balance work responsibilities efficiently. Lecturers who are content with how their workload is distributed are better equipped to tackle these practical challenges, thereby enhancing their persistence in addressing publication delays. On the other hand, work conditions, remuneration, career advancement opportunities, and research support may not have as direct or immediate an impact on handling publication delays. While these factors are undeniably important for overall job satisfaction and motivation, they may not specifically address the challenges

posed by publication delays, which often require practical and timely responses. This finding aligns with the value-expectancy theory (Fishbein & Ajzen, 1975) highlighting how lecturers' internal motivation (value) combines with their satisfaction with workload allocation (expectancy) to drive their persistence in dealing with publication delays.

4.3.5. Empathy, job satisfaction and lecturers' persistence to publish.

Through the fifth hypothesis, this study discovered that a significant joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables (including satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support) on the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence to publish across most dimensions, such as manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, and dealing with rejections. These findings indicate that when lecturers have empathy, which means they understand and care about the needs and concerns of others, and they also have high job satisfaction regarding their work conditions, remuneration, workload, career advancement opportunities, and research support, they are more likely to persist in publishing their research across various aspects, such as preparing manuscripts, submitting them, handling revisions, and dealing with rejections. However, this joint mediation effect is not statistically significant when it comes to publication delays. The reasons behind these results are that empathy may lead to better collaboration and communication with colleagues, making it easier to navigate the research process. When lecturers are satisfied with their job, they are more motivated and committed to their work. Job satisfaction can boost their resilience and persistence, helping them overcome the challenges associated with research publication. Moreover, when lecturers have access to research support and feel content with their work conditions and workload, it provides them with the necessary resources and environment to focus on their research.

The implications are that universities and institutions should not only encourage empathy among their faculty but also ensure job satisfaction by addressing work conditions, fair remuneration, manageable workloads, career growth opportunities, and research support. This finding aligns with the with the value-expectancy theory (Fishbein & Ajzen, 1975), which posits that motivation is influenced by the perceived value of a goal and the expectancy of successfully achieving that goal. In this case, lecturers' internal motivation represents the value aspect, while satisfaction with workload allocation represents the expectancy aspect. The alignment occurs as lecturers' internal motivation is translated into persistent action through their perception that workload allocation allows them to address publication delays effectively. The two-factor theory (Hertzberg, 1968) suggests that there are factors that influence job satisfaction (motivators) and factors that prevent job dissatisfaction (hygiene Factors). In the findings of the present study, factors like satisfaction with workload allocation and internal motivation align with the motivator's component of Herzberg's theory, since they are related to job satisfaction and motivation. However, factors like satisfaction with work conditions, remuneration, and career advancement opportunities that did not significantly mediate the relationship between internal motivation and persistence align more with the hygiene factors, as they are related to preventing job dissatisfaction.

The fifth hypothesis highlight the varying roles of job satisfaction variables in partially mediating the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals across different dimensions. For manuscript preparation and submission, satisfaction with workload allocation and career advancement opportunities significantly mediated this relationship. However, in the handling of revisions, only satisfaction with research support plays a role. When dealing with rejections, it is satisfaction with research support that mediates, but in the context of publication delays, only career advancement opportunities is a significant mediator. In the dimension of

manuscript preparation, most job satisfaction variables did not significantly mediate the relationship. This means that when lecturers have empathy and are satisfied with these specific aspects of their job, they are more likely to persist in publishing their work in Scopus-indexed journals. However, the role of job satisfaction in mediating this relationship varies depending on the different stages of the publishing process. The reasons for these variations could be the differing requirements and challenges in each publishing stage. These results suggest that institutions and educators should consider the interplay of empathy and job satisfaction to enhance lecturers' persistence to publish and actual research output. The finding aligns with Goleman's emotional intelligence theory (Goleman, 1998) because empathy, a key component of emotional intelligence, is recognized in the findings as a factor influencing persistence in publishing research. The idea that lecturers with empathy are more likely to persist aligns with the notion that emotional intelligence contributes to better interpersonal relationships and job performance. Furthermore, the results align with several empirical research that have found a significant relationship between empathy and different outcomes, such as lecturers' improved self-efficacy (Ahmadi, 2014), effective leadership (Alsalminy & Baxodirovna, 2023; Baba et al., 2021; Biswas & Rahman, 2021).

4.3.6. Emotional intelligence job satisfaction lecturers' persistence to publish

This study found, through its sixth hypothesis, that job satisfaction significantly mediated the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. However, emotional intelligence has an insignificant effect on job satisfaction, and job satisfaction also does not significantly predict lecturers' persistence to publish. Notably, emotional intelligence has a direct positive influence on lecturers' persistence to publish. In essence, while emotional intelligence does not directly impact job satisfaction or persistence to publish, it indirectly affects persistence by

enhancing job satisfaction. About 14.1% of the variation in job satisfaction is explained by emotional intelligence, and approximately 39.6% of the total variation in persistence to publish is jointly explained by emotional intelligence and job satisfaction. This implies that other unaccounted variables have a substantial influence on these relationships.

In simple terms, this finding suggests, among university lecturers, that having good emotional intelligence positively influences their persistence to publish research in in Scopus-indexed journals. However, this influence does not happen directly; instead, emotional intelligence improves their job satisfaction, which, in turn, motivates them to persist in the publication process. Surprisingly, lecturers' level of emotional intelligence does not directly impact how satisfied they are with their job, and neither does their job satisfaction directly predict how persistent they will be in publishing their research output. So, it is like a two-step process: emotional intelligence makes lecturers happier with their jobs, and happy lecturers are more likely to persist in publishing their works in Scopus-indexed journals. The reason for this finding is that when people are better at understanding and managing their emotions, they tend to have better relationships at work and are generally happier, making them more likely to stay motivated. However, there are other factors at play too, which were not part of this study. For institutions, this emphasizes the importance of fostering emotional intelligence and job satisfaction among their lecturers to encourage more research productivity. The implications of these findings are that universities should consider incorporating emotional intelligence training into their professional development programmes for lecturers. Additionally, recognizing the role of other unaccounted variables in the equation, universities should continue exploring and addressing factors that affect lecturers' persistence and job satisfaction to create an even more supportive and conducive environment for research and publishing.

The findings of this study strongly align with Goleman's emotional intelligence theory. They emphasize that emotional intelligence (EI) significantly influences lecturers'

persistence to publish, but this influence operates indirectly through its effect on job satisfaction. This mirrors the core principles of EI theory, which posits that individuals with higher emotional intelligence tend to have better interpersonal relationships, which can enhance overall job satisfaction (Goleman, 1995). In the present study, emotional intelligence leads to happier lecturers, which, in turn, positively affects job satisfaction and motivates them to persist in publishing their research. While the findings are primarily related to emotional intelligence and job satisfaction, there is also a connection to the two-Factor theory, specifically in terms of job satisfaction. Herzberg's theory distinguishes between motivators and hygiene factors (Hertzberg, 1968). In the present study, job satisfaction was found to play a crucial role in mediating the relationship between emotional intelligence and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. The job satisfaction variables can be seen as hygiene factors that prevent dissatisfaction and contribute to overall satisfaction and motivation. The indirect influence of emotional intelligence on job satisfaction aligns with Herzberg's idea that job satisfaction factors can indirectly impact motivation. Besides, studies on emotional intelligence and job satisfaction have consistently found positive relationships. For instance, significant correlations have been reported between emotional intelligence and various aspects of job satisfaction among teachers (Akomolafe & Ogunmakin, 2014; Hamidi & Amiri, 2013; Tabatabaei & Farazmehr, 2015; Teli & Baba, 2017). The result also agrees with several studies that have consistently shown a positive relationship between emotional intelligence (EI) and work performance across various professional settings (Amirian et al., 2023; Jung & Yoon, 2014; Marino et al., 2019).

4.3.7. Self-awareness, job satisfaction and lecturers' persistence to publish, moderated by sex, education level and marital status.

The seventh hypothesis of this study discovered, in the context of manuscript preparation, that job satisfaction variables had a negative and weaker combined effect on males but a positive and stronger effect on females. This gender-based difference could be attributed to various factors, including how job satisfaction impacts motivation and productivity. For females, higher job satisfaction may serve as a more significant driving force, particularly in the face of potential barriers or challenges that women may encounter in the academic realm. These findings underline the significance of job satisfaction as a critical factor in academic productivity and emphasize the need for institutions to prioritize factors contributing to job satisfaction.

In terms of manuscript submission, both male and female academics benefited from job satisfaction variables, but the effect was significantly stronger for females. This suggests that a satisfying work environment, fair compensation, and supportive career opportunities might have a more substantial impact on females' ability to submit their research work. This result could be vital in shaping institutional policies aimed at enhancing academic productivity and career satisfaction. Understanding these gender-based differences may lead to more tailored interventions and support systems, contributing to a more equitable academic environment. In the banking sector, the study of Mohammad et al. (2018) found that sex significantly moderated the relationship between emotional intelligence (EI) and job satisfaction among bank workers in Pakistan. Awan (2022) surveyed university lecturers in Pakistan and discovered that sex moderated the relationship between leadership support, workload, and research motivation.

Handling revisions displayed a positive combined effect for both genders, with no significant differences. This implies that job satisfaction is a universally positive factor for

researchers when it comes to managing revisions. This finding could serve as a reminder of the universal importance of job satisfaction in academic success, regardless of gender. Dealing with rejections saw job satisfaction variables having a positive combined effect for both males and females, but this effect was notably stronger for female lecturers. This outcome underscores the crucial role that job satisfaction plays in helping female academics cope with the challenges of rejection, possibly due to the presence of resilience and determination in the face of adversity.

When it comes to publication delays, the combined effect of job satisfaction was positive for both males and females, with a significant difference indicating a more substantial impact on female lecturers. This underscores the potential of job satisfaction to significantly reduce publication delays for women, potentially due to heightened motivation and perseverance in overcoming obstacles. These findings have significant implications for academic institutions. Recognizing and addressing these gender-based differences in how job satisfaction impacts academic publishing can lead to more equitable and productive academic environments. Moreover, it underscores the importance of fostering job satisfaction among academics, which can be a vital factor in enhancing their research productivity and overall career satisfaction.

In terms of education level, the study uncovered interesting findings related to academic publishing. For manuscript preparation, both master's and Ph.D. holders experienced a positive joint mediation effect, with the effect being significantly stronger for those with a master's degree. This means that job satisfaction variables played a more pronounced role in facilitating manuscript preparation for individuals with master's degrees. When it comes to manuscript submission, master's holders had a negative joint mediation effect, while Ph.D. holders had a positive one, with the latter group benefitting more. The variance could be attributed to the different skill sets, expectations, and career stages between these two groups. For handling revisions, both master's and Ph.D. holders

derived a positive joint mediation effect, with no significant difference. This suggests that job satisfaction equally contributes to the persistence in handling revisions for both educational levels. In dealing with rejections, job satisfaction had a positive joint mediation effect for both education levels, indicating its positive impact on resilience and perseverance in the face of rejection. Lastly, for publication delays, both master's and Ph.D. holders experienced a positive joint mediation effect, with no significant difference. This result aligns with the finding of Truong et al. (2021) that identified significant variations in research productivity among different lecturer groups based on their academic qualifications. Their findings revealed a positive correlation between higher academic degrees and increased research output. Similarly, Anwar et al. (2021) discovered that the impact of trait EI on teacher effectiveness was not uniform across individuals with different academic qualifications. Academic qualification served as a moderating factor, leading to variations in the relationship, particularly between individuals with graduate/postgraduate degrees and those with PhD or similar qualifications.

To explain the results of the current study, individuals with master's degrees may have a stronger reliance on job satisfaction variables to drive manuscript preparation, possibly because they are earlier in their academic careers and more directly affected by work conditions and support. Ph.D. holders, who are typically further along in their academic journey, may rely on additional factors for manuscript preparation. The variations in manuscript submission could be attributed to different motivations, expectations, or career pressures between the two groups. As for revisions, dealing with rejection, and publication delays, the universality of the positive joint mediation effect suggests that job satisfaction is a key contributor to academic persistence, regardless of educational level.

The implications of these findings are significant. Academic institutions should recognize the varying needs of master's and Ph.D. holders and tailor their support and

resources accordingly. Ensuring high levels of job satisfaction, fair work conditions, and support opportunities for both groups can contribute to their academic success. Additionally, understanding the importance of job satisfaction across the board highlights the need for institutions to prioritize and foster a positive work environment for all academics, which can lead to increased productivity, resilience, and satisfaction in their academic careers.

When considering marital status as a moderating factor, this study revealed several significant findings regarding the role of job satisfaction variables in academic publishing. In the context of manuscript preparation, both single and married lecturers experienced a positive joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables, with no significant difference. This suggests that regardless of marital status, job satisfaction plays an equally beneficial role in manuscript preparation. This could be because both groups draw motivation and resilience from a satisfying work environment. In terms of manuscript submission, there was a notable difference. Single lecturers exhibited a significantly stronger positive joint mediation effect compared to married lecturers. The higher impact of job satisfaction variables on manuscript submission for single individuals may be due to a greater focus and dedication to their academic work, as they might have fewer external responsibilities or distractions. Handling revisions presented a unique contrast. The joint mediation effect was negative for singles and positive for married lecturers, with a significantly more detrimental effect for singles. The reason behind this could be that married individuals potentially have a stronger support system, both in terms of emotional support and sharing the workload of life responsibilities, allowing them to manage revisions more effectively. Singles may face more challenges in handling revisions due to a lack of such support.

In dealing with rejections, job satisfaction variables had a positive joint mediation effect for both single and married lecturers, with the effect being stronger for singles. This could indicate that single individuals possess a higher level of determination and resilience

in the face of rejection, using job satisfaction as a driving force to overcome obstacles. Regarding publication delays, job satisfaction variables had a positive joint mediation effect for both single and married lecturers, with no significant difference. This suggests that job satisfaction can equally contribute to reducing publication delays for both groups. The implications of these findings are noteworthy. Institutions and academic organizations should recognize that the impact of job satisfaction varies based on marital status. Providing tailored support and resources for single and married academics can lead to increased productivity, career satisfaction, and overall academic success. It also highlights the importance of fostering a positive work environment, as it serves as a significant motivator for academics, regardless of their marital status. Moreover, this research emphasizes the significance of understanding individual circumstances and adapting academic support systems to suit the diverse needs of educators.

4.3.8. Self-regulation job satisfaction and lecturers' persistence to publish, moderated by sex, education level and marital status.

This study's findings, in this section, are based on the joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables moderated by sex, education level, and marital status in the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus indexed journals. When considering sex as a moderator, it was found that the mediation effect of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between self-regulation and various aspects of publishing differed between male and female lecturers. For manuscript preparation, there was no significant difference in the mediation effect between male and female lecturers, suggesting similar impacts. However, for manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays, the mediation effects were stronger for female lecturers. The study of Ghasemy et al. (2020) found that the extent

of the connection between positive affect and job satisfaction varied significantly between males and females.

When education level was considered, the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables between self-regulation and persistence in publishing dimensions varied between lecturers with a master's degree and those with a Ph.D. For manuscript preparation, the effect was stronger for master's degree holders. For manuscript submission, there was no significant difference between the two groups, while for handling revisions and publication delays, the mediation effect was stronger for Ph.D. holders. The implications of this finding are twofold: institutions should acknowledge the unique needs and motivations of lecturers based on their educational background, and academic support programs can be tailored accordingly. However, the lack of significant differences in manuscript submission suggests that regardless of their educational level, lecturers find satisfaction in the act of submitting their work for publication. This underscores the universal nature of the publishing process. In the case of handling revisions and publication delays, Ph.D. holders might possess a more comprehensive understanding of the academic publishing landscape, leading to a greater reliance on job satisfaction factors in coping with the challenges and delays inherent in the publication process. The implications are that institutions may need to provide additional support or training to master's degree holders in these areas, recognizing that their needs might differ.

The result consistent with the study conducted by Nasir et al. (2011) which indicated a significant correlation between job satisfaction and task performance, and they further revealed that the connection between job satisfaction and task performance was moderated by education. This suggests that the influence of job satisfaction on task performance varies depending on the level of education. Nevertheless, opposing studies have shown, on the contrary, that education does not play a significant mediation role in the relationship between different variables. For example, Biswas and Rahman (2021)

revealed that education had an insignificant moderating effect on the relationship between self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, social skills, and charismatic leadership among bankers in Bangladesh. The variation in the results is attributable to contextual differences where the studies were conducted.

When examining marital status as a moderator, the results showed no significant differences in the joint mediation effect between single and married lecturers for all dimensions of persistence in publishing. This suggests that job satisfaction variables have similar impacts on self-regulation and persistence in publishing, regardless of marital status. This finding implies that suggest that whether a lecturer is single or married does not significantly alter the influence of job satisfaction on their commitment to publishing research. This is likely due to the universal importance of job satisfaction as a driver of motivation and productivity in an academic setting. Job satisfaction, primarily linked to factors related to the work environment and the nature of the job, seems to affect lecturers similarly, regardless of their marital status. These results emphasize the equality and inclusivity of institutional support for all faculty members, underscoring the importance of creating a work environment that fosters job satisfaction and supports persistence in publishing, irrespective of personal circumstances. While marital status may not be a distinguishing factor, the study encourages further research to delve deeper into the complex interplay between job satisfaction, personal life circumstances, and academic productivity, allowing for more tailored and effective support for faculty members.

4.3.9. Social awareness job satisfaction and lecturers' persistence to publish, moderated by sex, education level and marital status.

The results of the multigroup analysis in hypothesis nine discovered that with sex as a moderator, the effect of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between social awareness and various aspects of persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals

differed between male and female lecturers. The results show that for manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, and dealing with rejections, the mediation effects were stronger for female lecturers, indicating that job satisfaction plays a more significant role in motivating female lecturers to persist in these publishing aspects. The results suggest that job satisfaction plays a more significant role in motivating female lecturers to persist in various aspects of publishing in Scopus-indexed journals, such as manuscript preparation, submission, handling revisions, and dealing with rejections. This disparity may be attributed to gender-related factors, including gender disparities in academic settings, diverse motivational factors, sociocultural influences, work-life balance challenges, and variations in institutional support. The effects may have been stronger for females because of their social responsibilities in meeting recurrent needs at home and school, unlike their male counterparts. The implications of these findings underscore the importance of understanding and catering to the unique needs of male and female academics to enhance their publishing persistence and contribute to a more diverse and robust academic landscape. This agrees with the results of Allen et al. (2021) who found that sex significantly moderated the relationship between research motivation and persistence. Higher science research motivation was linked to increased persistence for women but not for men. The researchers also observed sex differences in the mediation effects, where science research motivation significantly mediated the relationship between perceptions of the communal value of scientific research and persistence for women but not men.

The study also found differences based on education level. For manuscript preparation, master's degree holders derived a stronger motivation from job satisfaction variables, whereas, for handling revisions and publication delays, the mediation effects were stronger for Ph.D. holders. This suggests that the educational background of lecturers impacts how they are motivated by job satisfaction factors across different publishing

dimensions. The variations observed in the impact of job satisfaction on lecturers' motivation to persist in publishing based on their education level could be attributed to several factors. Master's degree holders might prioritize manuscript preparation, often seen as an early career milestone, and thus find job satisfaction more motivating in this stage. In contrast, Ph.D. holders, with typically more advanced research skills and a deeper understanding of the publishing process, may derive greater motivation from job satisfaction when dealing with complex tasks like revising manuscripts or handling publication delays. Moreover, the availability of institutional resources, mentorship, and research support can differ between these two groups, influencing how they perceive the role of job satisfaction in their publishing journey. For academic institutions, these findings underscore the importance of tailored strategies for faculty development, considering the distinct needs of lecturers at various stages of their careers. This approach can enhance their motivation, job satisfaction, and overall publishing productivity, benefiting both the individual educators and the institutions they serve.

The findings from various studies highlight the significant moderating role of education level in influencing various relationships. Truong et al. (2021) demonstrated that academic degrees had a substantial impact on scientific research output. Higher academic degrees were associated with increased research productivity. Similarly, Anwar et al. (2021) revealed that the influence of trait emotional intelligence (EI) on teacher effectiveness was subject to moderation by academic qualifications. The nature of the relationship differed between individuals with graduate/postgraduate degrees and those with PhD or similar qualifications. Additionally, Nasir et al. (2011) explored the connection between job satisfaction, task performance, and education among employees in Iran.

In the context of marital status, single lecturers exhibited stronger mediation effects of job satisfaction variables for manuscript preparation and publication delays compared

to their married counterparts. For handling revisions, married lecturers showed stronger mediation effects. This implies that marital status can influence how job satisfaction affects lecturers' persistence in publishing. The differential impact of marital status on the mediation effects of job satisfaction variables in lecturers' publishing persistence can be understood through various lenses. Single lecturers may exhibit stronger motivation and commitment to manuscript preparation as they might allocate more time and energy to their academic work due to fewer family-related responsibilities. The solitude of the single life might make job satisfaction a more influential factor in their career progression. On the other hand, married lecturers might experience stronger mediation effects for handling revisions because they may have more extensive support systems or coping strategies that help them manage the complexities of this phase. The stronger mediation effects for single lecturers in publication delays could be due to their potential to adapt to changes more quickly and efficiently without the considerations of a family. These findings have implications for academic institutions, suggesting that support and development programs should consider the individual needs of faculty members based on their marital status to optimize their publishing persistence and overall job satisfaction. It also underscores the importance of work-life balance and family support in the academic environment.

4.3.10. Internal motivation job satisfaction and lecturers' persistence to publish, moderated by sex, education level and marital status.

The findings of this study, which considered gender, education level, and marital status as moderators in the joint mediation effects of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish, provide several findings. When gender was considered as a moderator, it became apparent that the influence of job satisfaction variables on the relationship between internal motivation (internal motivation) and various dimensions of publishing persistence differed between

male and female lecturers. Specifically, job satisfaction appeared to play a more significant role in motivating female lecturers to persist in manuscript preparation, manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays compared to their male counterparts. First, the gender-based variations in the impact of job satisfaction suggest that female lecturers may have distinct needs and motivations related to manuscript preparation, submission, revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays. These findings underscore the importance of tailoring support and mentorship programs in academic institutions to address these unique motivations and challenges faced by female faculty members. Moreover, acknowledging these disparities could help create a more inclusive and equitable academic environment. The finding strengthens the results of Truong et al. (2021) which found significant sex differences in scientific research output with regards to sex. Male lecturers had higher research output compared to female lecturers. Similarly, Petrović et al. (2014) identified sex differences in two out of three factors related to service orientation, including organisational support and customer focus. Men attributed greater importance to organisational support, emphasising structured labour and service procedures, while women expressed a higher level of significance towards customer focus and fostering positive relationships with guests.

Similarly, when education level was considered as a moderator, differences were observed. Master's degree holders found stronger motivation from job satisfaction variables in manuscript preparation, while Ph.D. holders exhibited stronger mediation effects for handling revisions and publication delays. This suggests that the educational background of lecturers impacts how job satisfaction factors influence their publishing persistence. The distinctions related to education level indicate that the pursuit of academic publishing can be influenced by the academic qualifications of faculty members. Master's degree holders may find manuscript preparation more motivating through job satisfaction factors, while Ph.D. holders may be more driven by job satisfaction in handling revisions

and managing publication delays. These insights underscore the importance of recognizing the diverse experiences and needs of faculty members with different educational backgrounds, and institutions can leverage this knowledge to develop targeted training and support programmes.

The present study's results provide support to some studies in the literature that have obtained similar findings. Anwar et al. (2021) found that the influence of trait EI on teacher effectiveness was not uniform but rather depended on the academic qualifications of individuals. The relationship was moderated by academic qualification, and differences were evident between individuals with graduate/postgraduate degrees and those with PhD or similar qualifications. Additionally, Nasir et al. (2011) uncovered insights into how education level influences job satisfaction and task performance, although specific details of the findings are not provided in the summary.

Lastly, when examining marital status as a moderator, it was revealed that single lecturers derived stronger motivation from job satisfaction variables in manuscript preparation and publication delays compared to their married counterparts. On the other hand, married lecturers exhibited stronger mediation effects for handling revisions. These findings indicate that marital status can significantly influence how job satisfaction affects lecturers' persistence in publishing. The reason for these findings is that single lecturers may derive stronger motivation from job satisfaction variables in manuscript preparation and publication delays, suggesting that personal circumstances play a vital role in academic persistence. Conversely, married lecturers may require more support in handling revisions, perhaps due to additional responsibilities. These findings emphasize the need for institutions to consider the work-life balance and family support structures they offer to faculty members, particularly in relation to their publishing activities.

4.3.11. Empathy, job satisfaction and lecturers' persistence to publish, moderated by sex, education level and marital status.

From hypothesis 11, the results indicate that job satisfaction variables play a more substantial role in the relationship between empathy (empathy) and manuscript preparation, handling revisions, and dealing with rejections for female lecturers compared to male lecturers. This suggests that factors related to job satisfaction are particularly influential in motivating female faculty members in these dimensions of academic publishing. However, there is no significant difference between male and female lecturers in the joint mediation effects for manuscript submission and publication delays. It is essential to acknowledge that gender dynamics within the academic field may lead to distinct experiences and pressures. Women in academia have historically faced challenges related to gender bias, underrepresentation, and unique professional and personal demands, which can intersect with their publishing persistence. Consequently, the stronger mediation effects for female lecturers in manuscript preparation, handling revisions, and dealing with rejections might be linked to the need for increased motivation and satisfaction in overcoming these obstacles. The results is in tandem with the study of Karakuş (2013) found sex-related differences in the relationships between age, emotional intelligence, stress, anxiety, burnout, and depression among primary school instructors in Turkey. Jung and Yoon (2014) identified sex differences in predicting surface acting and deep acting based on others' emotion appraisal, self-emotion appraisal, and use of emotions among hotel employees in Korea.

Regarding education level as a moderator, it was observed that the influence of job satisfaction variables in the relationship between empathy and manuscript preparation and publication delays differed significantly between lecturers with master's and Ph.D. degrees. In both aspects, job satisfaction has a stronger mediating effect for master's degree holders compared to those with a Ph.D. However, no significant difference was found in

the joint mediation effects for empathy's relationship with manuscript submission, handling revisions, and dealing with rejections between these two educational groups. The reason for this result is that master's degree holders might be at an earlier stage of their academic careers, often pursuing their postgraduate studies while simultaneously working in academic positions. This dual role can be considerably challenging, as they juggle the demands of completing their degree alongside their responsibilities as educators. As a result, they may have heightened stress and workload, making job satisfaction factors particularly crucial in motivating them to persist in manuscript preparation and cope with publication delays. In contrast, Ph.D. holders, having already undergone the rigorous academic journey of doctoral studies, could have acquired a higher level of resilience and adaptability through that experience. This resilience can make them less dependent on job satisfaction factors in handling revisions and dealing with rejections, as they've developed the skills and determination to face academic setbacks with greater confidence and persistence.

The result of this study corroborates the findings of some studies in the literature. Biswas and Rahman (2021) revealed that education had an insignificant moderating effect on these relationships. However, they suggested that considering other moderating or mediating variables and employing larger sample sizes would help generalise the research results. Similarly, Burić and Kim (2021) indicated that the association between TSE and job satisfaction remained consistent across educational levels, suggesting no significant differences in the degree to which TSE predicts job satisfaction among sub-groups. Moreover, Pérez-Díaz et al. (2020) demonstrated that the instrument used to measure trait EI was consistent and reliable across different educational groups. Again, Pérez-Díaz et al. (2022) indicated significant differences in trait EI considering sociodemographic variables and their interactions. Measurement invariance analysis demonstrated that trait

EI measurement was consistent and comparable between educational levels up to the scalar level.

When marital status is considered as a moderator, the results reveal that the joint mediation effect of job satisfaction variables for the relationship between empathy and manuscript submission is stronger for married lecturers compared to single lecturers. In contrast, for the relationship between empathy and publication delays, single lecturers exhibit a stronger mediation effect of job satisfaction variables compared to their married counterparts. This suggests that marital status can significantly impact how job satisfaction influences the persistence of lecturers in the context of publishing. There can be several reasons or explanations for these findings. Married lecturers often have family responsibilities and support systems in place, which can significantly influence their motivations and persistence in academic publishing. For manuscript submission, where the mediation effect is stronger for married lecturers, it is plausible that the support and encouragement from their families contribute to their motivation. The presence of a family might create a strong desire to succeed, not only for personal fulfilment but also to provide for their loved ones, thus making job satisfaction factors highly influential in this dimension. On the other hand, single lecturers might face distinct pressures and challenges. Without the external support structures and responsibilities that come with marriage and family, they could be navigating their academic careers largely on their own. This increased self-reliance may lead to a stronger mediation effect for publication delays. Single lecturers may find themselves more reliant on job satisfaction-related motivations to stay persistent in the face of obstacles, such as delays in publishing or facing rejections. The absence of external support might make job satisfaction factors, like a supportive work environment or recognition, more critical for their academic journey.

4.3.12. Emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and lecturers' persistence to publish, moderated by sex, education level and marital status.

This study discovered that the mediation of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals differed significantly between male and female lecturers. The direct effect of emotional intelligence on job satisfaction does not vary between genders, but the direct effect of job satisfaction on persistence to publish is significantly different. It negatively affects males while positively influencing females. This suggests that emotional intelligence and job satisfaction play a more substantial role in motivating and explaining persistence in female lecturers. The significant gender-based differences in the mediation of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and persistence to publish may be attributed to various factors. It's possible that societal and workplace expectations and pressures impact male and female lecturers differently. Women may face unique challenges and gender-related obstacles in academia, making job satisfaction factors more critical for their motivation and persistence in publishing. These factors may include work-life balance, stereotyping, and gender bias. Other studies have also demonstrated the moderating effect of sex in different contexts. Gabal and Elhussiney (2020) found that sex significantly influenced emotional intelligence levels among university lecturers in Egypt. Walsh and Bartikowski (2013) discovered that the impact of emotional labour on job satisfaction and quitting intentions differed between male and female service employees in Germany. Usman et al. (2022) highlighted the influence of sex on the relationships between knowledge sharing, psychological capital, emotional intelligence, trust, and organisational excellence among university lecturers in India.

However, when education level serves as the moderator, there are no significant differences in the mediation of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and persistence to publish between those with a master's degree and Ph.D.

holders. The direct effects of emotional intelligence on job satisfaction and persistence to publish do not significantly differ based on education level. This implies that, irrespective of their educational background, emotional intelligence and job satisfaction are equally influential in explaining the persistence to publish in lecturers. The absence of significant differences in the mediation of job satisfaction between master's and Ph.D. holders could be due to the assumption that both groups have similar academic goals and are exposed to comparable pressures and challenges. Both master's and Ph.D. holders aim for scholarly success, and their motivations to publish may not differ significantly. However, the influence of emotional intelligence and job satisfaction may still be crucial for their persistence. Yet, the results reveal that those with Ph.D. degrees have a higher degree of intrinsic motivation as emotional intelligence explains a larger proportion of job satisfaction variance for this group. It implies that they might have developed a deeper understanding of their own emotions and a greater ability to manage them, which contributes to their job satisfaction.

The results of the present studies strengthen several studies that have investigated the role of education in moderating the relationships between different variables. For instance, Truong et al. (2021) found a significant positive relationship between academic degrees and scientific research output. Higher academic qualifications were associated with increased research productivity, highlighting the importance of education in shaping research outcomes. Similarly, Anwar et al. (2021) discovered that the impact of trait EI on teacher effectiveness was influenced by academic qualifications, with differences observed between those with graduate/postgraduate degrees and those with PhD or similar qualifications. This implies that education level plays a role in determining how trait EI affects teacher effectiveness. Nasir et al. (2011) revealed a significant correlation between job satisfaction and task performance, and the connection between these two variables was

moderated by education. This suggests that the influence of job satisfaction on task performance varies based on an individual's level of education.

Furthermore, when marital status is considered as the moderator in the current study, the mediation of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and persistence to publish is not significantly different between single and married lecturers. The finding offers support to Nijhawan et al. (2022) who found that marital status did not moderate the relationship between emotional intelligence and organisational citizenship behaviour (OCB) among employees in the IT industry in India. Moreover, the direct effects of emotional intelligence on job satisfaction and persistence to publish are consistent across both marital status groups in the current study. This suggests that emotional intelligence and job satisfaction are equally important in explaining the persistence to publish, regardless of marital status, with the combination playing a more substantial role in married lecturers' persistence. The absence of significant differences in the mediation of job satisfaction between single and married lecturers suggests that both groups benefit similarly from emotional intelligence and job satisfaction factors. Married lecturers may derive motivation from a stable and supportive personal life, allowing them to focus on their academic work. On the other hand, single lecturers might rely more on intrinsic job satisfaction factors to maintain their persistence in publishing. This finding underscores that regardless of marital status, emotional intelligence and job satisfaction are essential motivators for lecturers' publishing persistence. Married lecturers, however, might have the added advantage of external support systems.

CHAPTER FIVE

SUMMARY, CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS

This chapter summarises the study and presents conclusions drawn from the research. The implications of the findings are discussed, and the recommendations made are highlighted, including suggestions for future research. The chapter was organised under the following sub-headings:

5.1. Summary of the study

5.2. Implication of the findings

5.3. Conclusion

5.4. Recommendations

5.5. Suggestions for further research

5.1. Summary of the study

The main purpose of this study was to determine the extent to which job satisfaction mediates the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals in the University of Calabar, Nigeria. This study is composed of three broader constructs – an exogenous variable: emotional intelligence; a mediator: job satisfaction; an endogenous variable: persistence to publish. Three moderators were also a part of the study, such as sex, education level and marital status. The study was guided by 12 specific objectives, with their corresponding research questions that were, in turn, converted into null hypotheses. Three concepts – emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and persistence to publish, were clarified, with three conceptual models developed to offer a framework for effective measurement. The study was anchored on three theoretical frameworks, including Emotional Intelligence Theory by Goleman (1995), Two-Factor Theory by Hertzberg (1968) and Expectancy-Value Theory by Fishbein and Ajzen (1975). A total of 195 recent and relevant empirical

literature were synthesised into the study and key gaps in knowledge, methods, population, evidence and context were identified.

This study adopted the cross-sectional survey research design and was carried out at the University of Calabar, Calabar, Cross River State, Nigeria. The population of this study comprised all university lecturers from the rank of assistant lecturer to Professor in the University of Calabar, Nigeria, with at least one publication in the Scopus database. According to data gathered from Scopus, 1253 lecturers in the University of Calabar have at least one document in the Scopus database. A priori power analysis was performed to determine the minimum sample size required to achieve an effect size of d = 0.25 or higher in correctly rejecting the null hypotheses of this study if they are false or retaining them if they are true. The result of the power analysis indicated that a sample of 454 lecturers is required to achieve the desired power. However, since lecturers are often very busy people, the chance of attrition is likely to be high. Thus, the required sample size was increased by 50% to account for a possible attrition. However, the researcher adopted a systematic random sampling technique to select 54.35% of the population of this study as the sample for the study. The sample of this study comprised 681 lecturers in the University of Calabar, from the rank of assistant lecturer to Professor, with at least one publication in the Scopus database. The systematic random sampling technique was employed to select the actual participants of the study. This technique was adopted since the researcher has a list obtained from the Scopus database, of all lecturers in the University of Calabar, with at least one publication in the Scopus database. The researcher started selection from the second person on the list and skipped one author between selections.

Three sets of questionnaires were used for data collection such as: “Academic Staff Emotional Intelligence Questionnaire (ASEIQ),” “Lecturers’ Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (LJSQ),” and the “Persistence to Publish Questionnaire (PPQ).” The three sets of questionnaires received face and content validity through experts’ ratings and

quantitative measures were used to determine the degree of agreement in revising, retaining or disregarding an item. Construct validity such as test of dimensionality was assessed using exploratory factor analysis. Five dimensions were extracted for each instrument, suggesting that emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and persistence to publish are all multidimensional constructs. The reliability of the five sub-scales in each of the three instruments was ascertained using the Cronbach's alpha measure of internal consistency. The reliability coefficients ranged from .858 to .950 (for ASEIQ), .883 to .982 (for LJSQ) and .885 to .989 (for PPQ). Primary data were collected for this study through the physical and electronic administrations of the instrument to eligible academic staff for completion. Of the 681 participants targeted, complete and usable data were gathered from 644 respondents, suggesting that there was an attrition rate of 5.43% and a response rate of 94.57%. The collected data were prepared on a person-by-item matrix and analysed using descriptive statistics such as frequency counts, simple percentages mean and standard deviation, as well as inferential statistics, such as partial least squares structural equation modelling and multigroup analysis (where applicable). The findings of the study are summarised as follows:

1. Job satisfaction variables did not significantly mediate the relationship between self-awareness and manuscript preparation but exhibited a notable positive mediating effect in other dimensions of lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, such as persistence in manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays.
2. Job satisfaction variables had a positive but non-significant joint mediating effect in the relationship between self-regulation and manuscript preparation. However, job satisfaction variables jointly mediated the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals across other dimensions.

3. Job satisfaction variables displayed a positive but statistically non-significant mediating effect on the relationship between social awareness and manuscript preparation, indicating limited mediation in this specific dimension. However, job satisfaction variables jointly mediated the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals across other dimensions.
4. Job satisfaction variables significantly mediate the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in most aspects of the publishing process, except manuscript preparation. Lecturers' persistence to publish particularly during manuscript submission, revisions, rejection handling, and publication delays, is influenced by their internal motivation, coupled with job satisfaction regarding work conditions, remuneration, workload, career opportunities, and research support.
5. Job satisfaction variables significantly mediate the relationship between empathy and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals across all the dimensions. These include persistence in manuscript preparation, manuscription submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections and publication delays.
6. Job satisfaction significantly acted as a mediator in the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. This mediation effect is observed even though there is no direct association between emotional intelligence and job satisfaction, and job satisfaction itself did not directly predict lecturers' persistence to publish.
7. Job satisfaction has a significant and varying impact on the relationship between self-awareness and lecturers' persistence to publish, particularly benefiting female lecturers, master's degree holders in manuscript preparation, and proving equally valuable across education levels and marital status.
8. The mediating effect of job satisfaction on the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals was influenced by

moderators including sex, education level, and marital status. Female lecturers displayed more substantial mediation effects in manuscript submission, handling revisions, dealing with rejections, and publication delays. Furthermore, master's degree holders demonstrated stronger mediation in manuscript preparation, while Ph.D. holders exhibited more significant mediation effects in handling revisions and publication delays. Notably, marital status did not significantly alter the influence of job satisfaction in the relationship between self-regulation and lecturers' persistence to publish.

9. Gender, education level, and marital status significantly affected job satisfaction's mediation effect in the relationship between social awareness and lecturers' publishing persistence in Scopus-indexed journals. Female lecturers exhibited more substantial mediation effects in manuscript preparation, submission, revisions, and rejections. In terms of education, master's degree holders drew persistence from job satisfaction in manuscript preparation, while for Ph.D. holders it was in handling revisions and publication delays. Single lecturers persisted in manuscript preparation and publication delays, whereas married lecturers were notably influenced during the handling of revisions.
10. Gender, education level, and marital status moderated the relationship between internal motivation and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, with job satisfaction as the mediator. Female lecturers are more persistent in manuscript preparation, submission, revisions, rejections, and publication delays. Master's degree holders are more persistent in manuscript preparation, while Ph.D. holders are more persistent in handling revisions and managing publication delays. Single lecturers are more persistent by job satisfaction in manuscript preparation and publication delays, while married lecturers are more persistent in handling revisions.

11. Job satisfaction variables mediated the relationship between empathy and persistence to publish among female lecturers in dimensions such as manuscript preparation, handling revisions, and dealing with rejections, but not in manuscript submission and publication delays. Master's degree holders were more persistent in manuscript preparation and publication delays through job satisfaction compared to Ph.D. holders. In contrast, Ph.D. holders possess a higher persistence when handling revisions and dealing with rejections. Married lecturers exhibited stronger mediation effects for manuscript submission. On the other hand, single lecturers displayed a stronger mediation effect for publication delays.
12. Gender moderated the mediation effect of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. Job satisfaction was more influential in motivating and explaining persistence in female lecturers compared to males. In contrast, education level did not significantly moderate the mediation effect, with emotional intelligence and job satisfaction being equally important for both master's degree and Ph.D. holders. Marital status does not alter the mediation significantly, indicating that emotional intelligence and job satisfaction are equally crucial for both single and married lecturers.

5.2. Implication of the findings

The findings of this study have several research, theoretical and practice implications. For research, the study contributes to research by providing a deeper understanding of how job satisfaction mediates and is moderated by various factors in the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. Researchers in the field of education and psychology can use these insights to further explore complex mediation and moderation mechanisms. The study highlights the significance of considering contextual factors such as gender,

education level, and marital status in research. Future studies should continue to investigate how these factors influence the relationships between emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and persistence, as the findings indicate that they play a crucial role.

Theoretically, the study extends Emotional Intelligence Theory by Goleman (1995) by emphasizing the mediating role of job satisfaction in the relationship between emotional intelligence and academic persistence. It underscores the relevance of emotional intelligence in the academic context and its influence on motivation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. The findings align with Hertzberg's Two-Factor Theory (1968) in that job satisfaction factors are essential for motivation and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. By showing that job satisfaction significantly mediates the relationship between emotional intelligence and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, the study supports this well-established theory. Furthermore, the study expands the Expectancy-Value Theory by Fishbein and Ajzen (1975) by demonstrating how internal motivation, a component of emotional intelligence, and job satisfaction influence lecturers' persistence in academic publishing. This expansion provides a broader perspective on the motivational processes in academia.

For practice, the findings of this study implies that academic institutions can use these findings to develop strategies that enhance lecturers' job satisfaction. Recognizing the critical role of job satisfaction in fostering persistence in research, universities can implement policies and practices that support lecturers' well-being and job satisfaction. Professional development programs can incorporate components focused on emotional intelligence to help lecturers improve their emotional competencies. This could ultimately enhance their job satisfaction and motivation for publishing research in Scopus-indexed journals. Moreover, universities can tailor their support for lecturers based on individual characteristics such as gender, education level, and marital status. Providing specific support that addresses the unique needs of different lecturer groups can contribute to

improved job satisfaction and research persistence. Furthermore, due the stronger mediation effect of job satisfaction on female lecturers, universities can implement gender equity initiatives aimed at creating a more supportive and inclusive environment for female academics, which may ultimately improve their persistence in publishing.

5.3. Conclusion

This research was conducted to examine the tripartite relationship between emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals among lecturers in the University of Calabar, Nigeria. It is evident that emotional intelligence alone does not directly predict lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals; instead, job satisfaction serves as the critical bridge connecting emotional intelligence with the various aspects of the publishing process. It is lecturers with higher emotional intelligence and job satisfaction in key aspects of their work who exhibit the dedication, motivation, and adherence to academic publishing standards that drive their scholarly productivity.

The study also reveals substantial variations in how job satisfaction mediates the relationship between different facets of emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish, influenced by moderating factors like gender, education level, and marital status. Notably, gender played a significant role, with female lecturers benefiting more from job satisfaction in manuscript preparation, submission, revisions, and handling rejections. Male lecturers, on the other hand, do not experience the same level of motivation in these dimensions. Education level is another influential factor, as master's degree holders find greater motivation and persistence in manuscript preparation, while Ph.D. holders draw more substantial mediation effects in handling revisions and publication delays. Marital status also shapes the mediation of job satisfaction, with married lecturers exhibiting a

more pronounced influence during the handling of revisions compared to their single counterparts.

In conclusion, this research provides crucial insights and implications for universities seeking to support their lecturers in their quest for academic publishing. It underscores the need for a context-specific approach to understanding how emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and moderating factors interact within diverse academic settings. These findings encourage further exploration, prompting scholars to delve deeper into the dynamics of emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and academic publishing persistence in various cultural and institutional contexts. The conclusions drawn from this study extend beyond the specific setting of the University of Calabar, Nigeria, offering a solid foundation for future research and practical strategies to enhance the persistence and productivity of lecturers within the academic community.

5.4. Recommendations

Based on the findings and conclusions of this study, the following recommendations were made:

1. Given the significant impact of emotional intelligence on lecturers' publishing persistence, universities should consider implementing emotional intelligence training programs tailored to the specific needs of academic staff. These programmes can help lecturers develop skills in self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, and social skills, which, in turn, may bolster their resilience and commitment to scholarly publishing.
2. Besides institutional support, female lecturers should proactively seek opportunities for skill development and career advancement. Academic organizations can create mentorship programs, and female academics themselves can take an active role in networking and seeking mentorship.

3. Universities should acknowledge the varying mediation effects of job satisfaction based on education levels. They should provide targeted support programs for master's and Ph.D. holders, focusing on areas where each group benefits the most. For example, tailor initiatives to enhance manuscript preparation skills for master's degree holders and support Ph.D. holders in revising and managing publication delays.
4. Building on the positive relationship between empathy and publishing persistence, institutions should encourage and facilitate collaborative research efforts among lecturers. Collaborations not only enhance research quality but also promote a supportive and empathetic academic environment, fostering job satisfaction and persistence. Lecturers should actively seek out opportunities for collaborative research and knowledge-sharing with peers. They can establish interdisciplinary research networks and use digital platforms to facilitate collaboration, harnessing the power of empathy.
5. Given the significant mediation effect of intrinsic motivation on publishing persistence, universities should implement strategies to cultivate intrinsic motivation among their academic staff. Recognition, autonomy, and professional development opportunities are potential ways to promote the internal motivation of lecturers. Lecturers can take ownership of their intrinsic motivation by setting personal goals, engaging in continuous self-assessment, and pursuing research projects that align with their passions and values. Such self-driven motivation can be a powerful force for publishing persistence.
6. Institutions should invest in improving job satisfaction factors such as work conditions, remuneration, workload allocation, career advancement opportunities, and research support. Enhancing these aspects can have a direct impact on lecturers' publishing persistence, particularly during manuscript submission, revisions, rejection handling, and publication delays. Individual lecturers should advocate for better work

conditions, fair remuneration, manageable workloads, and access to research support. They can communicate their needs to university management and relevant government bodies.

7. The university management should establish feedback mechanisms to assess the level of lecturers' job satisfaction in key dimensions. Regular surveys and feedback sessions can help institutions identify areas that require improvement and tailor interventions accordingly.
8. Lecturers can proactively create their networks through professional platforms and conferences. Engaging in collaborative research projects and networking with peers who share their research interests can lead to increased publishing opportunities.
9. In contexts where the influence of job satisfaction is moderated by cultural factors, such as marital status, institutions should foster cultural awareness. This can include providing resources and support tailored to the needs of single and married lecturers.
10. To gain a deeper understanding of the relationship between emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and publishing persistence, institutions should consider conducting longitudinal studies. These studies can help track changes in lecturers' job satisfaction over time and their subsequent effects on publishing persistence.

5.5. Suggestions for further research

The following suggestions were made to offer a direction to future research in related areas:

1. Future studies should adopt a longitudinal approach in studying the relationship between emotional intelligence, job satisfaction and lecturers’ persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. The longitudinal study can track the development of emotional intelligence and its influence on lecturers' persistence to publish over an extended period.

2. Future studies should explore how different educational systems and institutions influence lecturers' job satisfaction and persistence to publish. Investigate how varying contexts, policies, and resource allocations impact lecturers' research motivation and output.
3. Other researchers working in related areas should consider conducting comparative cross-cultural research to analyse the impact of cultural differences on job satisfaction, emotional intelligence, and persistence to publish among lecturers on a wider scale. This research could provide a broader perspective on the interplay between culture and academic motivation.
4. Prospective Evaluate the effectiveness of technology-based interventions, such as virtual mentorship programs, e-learning modules on emotional intelligence, or AI-driven job satisfaction improvement strategies, in promoting research productivity and motivation among lecturers.
5. Other researchers should also consider conducting studies in different cultural and educational settings to determine if the observed mediation and moderation effects hold true in diverse contexts. This could lead to a more comprehensive understanding of the interplay between emotional intelligence, job satisfaction, and persistence in publishing.

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APPENDIX I

COVER LETTER

Department of Educational Foundations,
University of Calabar,
Calabar, Nigeria.

Dear respondent,

REQUEST TO PARTICIPATE IN A SURVEY

I invite you to participate in a study on Emotional Intelligence, Job Satisfaction and Lecturers' Persistence to Publish in Scopus-Indexed Journals in the University of Calabar, Nigeria. This study is conducted as a part of the requirements for the award of a Master's Degree in Educational Research, Measurement and Evaluation. This study aims to determine how job satisfaction mediates the relationship between emotional intelligence and academic staff persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals. Your participation in this study is crucial in helping me achieve this purpose.

Kindly spare 15-20 minutes of your time to complete this survey. Your participation in this study is greatly appreciated, and your responses will contribute significantly to my research. Your responses will remain anonymous and confidential, and your participation is entirely voluntary. If you agree to participate, please complete the informed consent form on the next page. Please complete the questionnaire as soon as possible. If you have any questions or concerns about the study, please do not hesitate to contact me through 07062914623 or owanvalentine@gmail.com. Thank you for considering this invitation, your contribution is invaluable and greatly appreciated.

Sincerely,

Valentine Joseph Owan

Researcher

APPENDIX II

INFORMED CONSENT FORM

Title of Study: Multigroup Mediation Modelling of Emotional Intelligence, Job Satisfaction and Lecturers' Persistence to Publish in Scopus-Indexed Journals in University of Calabar, Nigeria.

Name of Investigator: Valentine Joseph Owan

Introduction: You are invited to participate in a research study. This consent form provides information about the study and what will be expected of you. Please read this form carefully and ask any questions you may have before deciding whether to participate in the study.

Purpose of the study: The primary purpose is to determine how job satisfaction mediates the relationship between emotional intelligence and university lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals.

Procedures: If you agree to participate in this study, you will be asked to fill out three sets of questionnaires - an Emotional Intelligence Questionnaire (EIQ), a Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (JSQ) and a Persistence to Publish Questionnaire (PPQ). Filling these questionnaires will take approximately 15 to 20 minutes, and the specific instructions for each questionnaire are provided in the relevant section.

Risks and Benefits: Participating in this study has no known risks. However, some psychological discomfort or inconveniences may be associated with items aimed at collecting information about your behaviour. Nevertheless, since your identity will not be revealed, you must respond honestly to such items to reach a meaningful conclusion. There are no direct benefits to you for participating in this study. However, the information obtained from this study may help us contribute new knowledge regarding the factors affecting lecturers' persistence to publish articles in Scopus-indexed journals, which may have practical applications or benefit society.

Confidentiality: All information collected in this study will be kept confidential to the extent allowed by law. Data will be stored securely, and only the researcher will have access to the data. All data will be reported in aggregate form so no individual can be identified.

Voluntary Participation: Your participation in this study is voluntary. You may choose not to participate or to withdraw from the study at any time without penalty. There will be no negative consequences if you choose not to participate or withdraw from the study.

Consent: I have read and understood the information provided in this consent form. I voluntarily agree to participate in this study.

Participant's Signature: _____ Date: _____

Investigator's Signature: _____ Date: _____

APPENDIX III

ACADEMIC STAFF EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE QUESTIONNAIRE (ASEIQ)

This questionnaire is designed to assess your emotional intelligence. Emotional intelligence is defined as the ability to identify, understand, and manage one's own emotions, as well as the emotions of others. Please answer the questions below based on your own experiences and feelings. Select the response option for each statement that most accurately represents your feelings about the statement. There are no right or wrong answers and no time limit for completing the questionnaire.

SECTION A – PERSONAL DATA

Instruction: Please provide your personal information in the fields below. You are not required to provide self-identifying information such as name, email, phone number, etc.

1.	Sex	Male [ ]; Female [ ]
2.	Age	Below 40 years [ ]; 40 – 49 years [ ]; 50 years and above [ ]
3.	Education level	Master's Degree [ ]; Doctorate Degree [ ]
4	Rank	Assistant Lecturer [ ]; Lecturer II [ ]; Lecturer I [ ]; Senior Lecturer [ ]; Associate Professor [ ]; Professor [ ]
5.	Marital status	Single [ ]; Married [ ]
6	Years of work experience	Less than 10 years [ ]; 10 to 19 years [ ]; 20 years and above [ ]

SECTION B: LIKERT SCALE ITEMS

Instruction: Please answer every question to the best of your ability and choose the response option that best reflects your opinion by selecting one of the following options:

SA = Strongly Agree

A = Agree

D = Disagree

SD = Strongly Disagree

S/N	ITEM	OPTIONS			
	SELF-AWARENESS	SA	A	D	SD
1	I know what triggers my emotions most of the time				
2	I am always willing to admit when I am wrong.				
3	I know when external factors influence my behaviour.				
4	I understand how my values affect my decision-making.				
5	I do not understand my core areas of strengths.				
SELF-REGULATION		SA	A	D	SD
6	I often manage my workload by prioritising tasks.				
7	I easily avoid procrastination by starting tasks promptly.				

8	Maintaining a positive attitude during challenging situations is difficult for me.				
9	I easily become too emotional after experiencing sad events.				
10	Sometimes, I am pushed to purchase things outside my original plans.				
11	I struggle to adhere to my daily schedule of activities.				
SOCIAL AWARENESS		SA	A	D	SD
12	I actively listen to others when they speak without interrupting them.				
13	I possess the ability to identify individuals going through challenging periods in their lives.				
14	I express my gratitude to others when they make an extra effort to assist me.				
15	I find it challenging to establish common ground with friends who hold differing perspectives.				
16	I find it difficult to make personal sacrifices in finding solutions that are beneficial to others.				
INTERNAL MOTIVATION		SA	A	D	SD
17	I work hard to achieve the personal goals I set for myself.				
18	I maintain my determination even when confronted with obstacles.				
19	I am willing to put in extra effort to exceed expectations.				
20	I do not need external rewards to stay motivated.				
21	I am driven by a sense of passion for what I do.				
EMPATHY		SA	A	D	SD
22	After listening to my friend’s problems, I am always willing to support them emotionally.				
23	I refrain from judging others based on first impressions.				
24	I often imagine how others might feel before responding to them.				
25	I am not willing to lend a helping hand to others in need unless I get something in return.				
26	I appreciate other people's views even when I do not agree with them.				

APPENDIX IV

LECTURERS' JOB SATISFACTION QUESTIONNAIRE (LJSQ)

Instruction: This questionnaire is designed to assess your job satisfaction. Job satisfaction is defined simply as how content an individual is with different aspects of their job. Please respond to the items below based on your own experiences and feelings and choose the response option that best reflects your opinion by selecting one of the following options:

VS = Very Satisfied

S = Satisfied

N = Neutral

D = Dissatisfied

VD = Very Dissatisfied

S/N	ITEMS	OPTIONS				
SATISFACTION WITH WORK CONDITIONS How satisfied are you with the following:		VS	S	N	D	VD
1	Fairness in the promotion appraisal process at your institution.					
2	Current appraisal requirements for academic staff promotion at your institution					
3	Quality of instructional resources available for teaching at my institution.					
4	Level of opportunities available for staff to provide inputs on institutional decisions.					
SATISFACTION WITH REMUNERATION How satisfied are you with the:		VS	S	N	D	VD
5	Fixed monthly salary paid to you as an academic staff					
6	Earned academic allowance paid to you based on your rank					
7	Health insurance policy provided to cover the medical expenses incurred by you.					
8	Performance-based pay offered to you due to your productivity in the institution.					
9	Overtime allowance paid to you for working outside of normal working hours.					
SATISFACTION WITH WORKLOAD ALLOCATION How satisfied are you with the following:		VS	S	N	D	VD
10	Number of courses assigned to you per semester by your head of department.					
11	Amount of time allocated for administrative tasks in each semester.					
12	Amount of time allocated for grading students' examination scripts.					
13	Amount of time allocated for supervising students' research works					
14	Amount of time allocated for attending workshops to improve your skills.					
SATISFACTION WITH CAREER ADVANCEMENT How satisfied are you with the:		VS	S	N	D	VD

15	Training opportunities offered to you for professional development in a new role.					
16	Mentorship practices in your department for early career scholars through the guidance of experienced academics					
17	Leadership opportunities offered to you to gain more experience.					
18	Consistency in promotion schedules of your institution to a higher academic rank.					
19	Provision of conference travel opportunities for faculty members to update their skills					
20	Faculty development workshops organised by your department to provide training on an emerging area.					
SATISFACTION WITH RESEARCH SUPPORT Indicate the extent to which you are satisfied with the:		VS	S	N	D	VD
21	Provision of information on external funding opportunities for scholars by your university.					
22	Provision of access to facilities to support the research activities of academic staff.					
23	Provision of publication fee support to enable academic staff to publish their research findings in open-access journals					
24	Provision of access to specialised research software to support the research activities of academic staff.					

APPENDIX V

PERSISTENCE TO PUBLISH QUESTIONNAIRE (PPQ)

Instruction: This questionnaire assesses your persistence to publish in Scopus-Indexed Journals. Persistence to publish is the ability to continue working towards your goal of publishing in Scopus-Indexed journals despite facing challenges and setbacks. Please answer the questions below based on your own experiences and feelings. Kindly choose the response option that best reflects your opinion by selecting one of the following options:

VSD = Very Strongly Disagree

SD = Strongly Disagree

D = Disagree

A = Agree

SA = Strongly Agree

VSA = Strongly Agree

S/N	ITEMS	RESPONSE OPTIONS					
PERSISTENCE IN MANUSCRIPT PREPARATION		VSD	SD	D	A	SA	VSA
1	I diligently search for recent literature to highlight the relevance of my work.						
2	I follow the journal's submission guidelines no matter how difficult they appear.						
3	I go the extra mile to find the appropriate tools for creating informative visualisations in my articles.						
4	I rarely have time to reorganise sections of my manuscript to improve its clarity.						
5	I find it challenging to synthesize a large volume of literature materials into a research paper.						
6	If the journal's guidelines become too complex to follow, I submit the article without adhering to them.						
PERSISTENCE IN MANUSCRIPTS SUBMISSION		VSD	SD	D	A	SA	VSA
7	I always endure the process of finding the right Scopus-indexed journal for my article.						
8	I spend much time formatting my manuscript according to the specific guidelines of the target Scopus-indexed journal.						
9	The need for a quick submission hinders me from writing a statement of declaration during article submission.						
10	I am meticulous in removing all identifying information before submitting my manuscript to Scopus-indexed journals.						
PERSISTENCE IN HANDLING REVISIONS		VSD	SD	D	A	SA	VSA
11	I am consistently willing to revise my article when the reviewer(s) provides valuable feedback that can enhance its quality.						

12	I always seek clarification on unclear concerns before implementing the necessary changes to the manuscript.						
13	I often prefer to withdraw my paper from a Scopus-indexed journal once the comments from the reviewers are too overwhelming for me to handle						
14	When the comments from some reviewers of Scopus-indexed journals are demoralising, I give up on the entire publication process.						
15	Sometimes I ignore some of the reviewers' comments that I feel are unimportant.						
PERSISTENCE IN DEALING WITH REJECTIONS		VSD	SD	D	A	SA	VSA
16	I remain always committed to publishing my research, even after receiving initial rejection.						
17	I am always willing to resubmit my rejected manuscripts to other journals after revising them.						
18	I am willing to collaborate with co-authors to improve my manuscript for increased chances of acceptance elsewhere.						
19	After a rejection, I find identifying other journals for my manuscript challenging.						
20	I feel heartbroken to resubmit my rejected work to another journal for fear of another rejection.						
PERSISTENCE IN PUBLICATION DELAYS		VSD	SD	D	A	SA	VSA
21	I show flexibility in adjusting my expectations when there are delays in the publication process.						
22	I always communicate with editors to understand the reasons for publication delays.						
23	I am always very quick to submit my article to another journal once there are delays.						
24	I continue working on other projects while waiting patiently for the publication process to be completed.						
25	I become impatient when there are delays in the publication process.						
26	Sometimes I become very confrontational when communicating with the editor over a delay in handling my article.						

APPENDIX VI

Loadings of Exploratory Factor analyses for the ASEIQ.

Factors	Item Label	EFA			
		λ	λ^2	ε	*z*
Self-Regulation	SRE3	.97	.94	.06	17.60
	SRE1	.97	.94	.06	15.88
	SRE7	.97	.93	.07	14.03
	SRE5	.96	.92	.08	12.57
	SRE2	.95	.91	.09	10.61
	SRE6	.95	.90	.10	9.36
	Σ	5.77	5.55	0.45	80.05
Empathy	EMP3	.96	.92	.08	11.94
	EMP2	.94	.89	.11	8.22
	EMP4	.94	.88	.12	7.81
	EMP7	.91	.82	.18	5.17
	EMP8	.90	.81	.19	4.69
	Σ	4.65	4.32	0.68	37.82
Self-Awareness	SAW8	.90	.81	.19	4.64
	SAW6	.89	.79	.21	4.32
	SAW1	.89	.79	.21	4.20
	SAW3	.89	.79	.21	4.20
	SAW5	.88	.77	.23	3.83
	Σ	4.44	3.95	1.05	21.19
Social Awareness	SOA4	.83	.69	.31	2.72
	SOA5	.82	.67	.33	2.52
	SOA8	.82	.66	.34	2.43
	SOA1	.80	.63	.37	2.17
	SOA2	.79	.62	.38	2.08
	Σ	4.05	3.29	1.71	11.92
Internal Motivation	INM3	.76	.58	.42	1.80
	INM7	.75	.56	.44	1.72
	INM1	.75	.56	.44	1.67
	INM5	.73	.54	.46	1.58
	INM8	.71	.51	.49	1.44
	Σ	3.70	2.74	2.26	8.22

APPENDIX VII

Loadings of Exploratory Factor analyses for the LJSQ.

Factors	Item Label	EFA			
		λ	λ^2	ε	*z*
Satisfaction with Career Advancement Opportunities	CAO2	.97	.94	.06	17.60
	CAO8	.97	.94	.06	16.99
	CAO5	.95	.89	.11	9.00
	CAO3	.94	.89	.11	8.22
	CAO4	.93	.86	.14	6.59
	CAO7	.93	.86	.14	6.50
	SUM	5.68	5.38	0.62	64.90
Satisfaction with Workload Allocation	WLO3	.96	.91	.09	11.11
	WLO6	.93	.87	.13	7.32
	WLO7	.93	.87	.13	7.09
	WLO1	.92	.85	.15	6.23
	WLO5	.92	.84	.16	5.91
	SUM	4.66	4.35	0.65	37.67
Satisfaction with Remuneration	REM1	.91	.84	.16	5.55
	REM8	.89	.79	.21	4.24
	REM2	.89	.79	.21	4.16
	REM4	.87	.75	.25	3.49
	REM7	.67	.45	.55	1.22
	SUM	4.23	3.61	1.39	18.66
Satisfaction with Research Support	RSU1	.93	.86	.14	6.69
	RSU4	.91	.84	.16	5.55
	RSU8	.88	.78	.22	4.01
	RSU5	.88	.77	.23	3.73
	SUM	3.60	3.24	0.76	19.98
Satisfaction with Work Conditions	WCON5	.83	.69	.31	2.69
	WCON7	.81	.66	.34	2.38
	WCON4	.79	.63	.37	2.14
	WCON8	.78	.61	.39	2.02
	SUM	3.22	2.59	1.41	9.23

APPENDIX VIII

Loadings of Exploratory Factor analyses for the PPQ.

Factors	Item Label	EFA			
		λ	λ^2	ε	*z*
Persistence in Manuscript Preparation	MPR6	.98	.96	.04	26.06
	MPR3	.98	.95	.05	20.58
	MPR2	.97	.95	.05	18.27
	MPR5	.97	.94	.06	14.90
	MPR1	.97	.93	.07	14.03
	MPR8	.95	.89	.11	9.00
	SUM	5.81	5.62	0.38	102.84
Persistence in Publication Delay	PDE1	.94	.88	.12	7.81
	PDE3	.94	.88	.12	7.68
	PDE5	.93	.87	.13	7.09
	PDE2	.93	.86	.14	6.41
	PDE8	.92	.84	.16	5.91
	PDE4	.90	.81	.19	4.84
	SUM	5.55	5.14	0.86	39.74
Persistence in Handling Revisions	HRE5	.91	.83	.17	5.36
	HRE7	.91	.83	.17	5.23
	HRE3	.89	.79	.21	4.32
	HRE6	.87	.76	.24	3.55
	HRE1	.86	.74	.26	3.35
	SUM	4.44	3.95	1.05	21.82
Persistence in Dealing with Rejections	DWR3	.81	.65	.35	2.31
	DWR1	.80	.64	.36	2.23
	DWR6	.79	.63	.37	2.11
	DWR2	.78	.61	.39	2.03
	DWR7	.77	.60	.40	1.92
	SUM	3.96	3.13	1.87	10.62
Persistence in Manuscript Submission	MSU7	.94	.89	.11	8.67
	MSU2	.90	.81	.19	4.74
	MSU1	.88	.78	.22	3.97
	MSU8	.54	.30	.70	0.77
	SUM	3.27	2.77	1.23	18.15

APPENDIX IX

LETTER OF AUTHORISATION

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OFFICE OF THE HEAD OF DEPARTMENT

25th August, 2023.

To Whom It May Concern,

AUTHORISATION FOR DATA COLLECTION

This letter confirms the official authorisation granted to **Valentine Joseph Owan**, a master's degree student of Educational Research, Measurement, and Evaluation, at the University of Calabar, Calabar, Nigeria. He is currently conducting a study entitled "Multigroup Mediation Modelling of Emotional Intelligence, Job Satisfaction and Lecturers' Persistence to Publish in Scopus-Indexed Journals in the University of Calabar, Nigeria" to fulfil a part of the programme's requirements.

The study focuses on examining the relationship between emotional intelligence and lecturers' persistence to publish in Scopus-indexed journals, and how job satisfaction mediates the relationship. The researcherhas been authorised to collect data from lecturers across various departments in the University of Calabar. Your participation in this study is appreciated, and any assistance you provide will greatly contribute to his academic pursuit.

For inquiries or additional information, please contact Valentine Joseph Owanusing07062914623. You can reach him by email at valentineowan@unical.edu.ng or owanvalentine@gmail.com. Your cooperation in this research endeavour is highly valued.

Thanks,

Yours faithfully,

25/8/2023

Prof. Peter U. Bassey
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